BECOMING A CATALYST OF CHANGE

BY LUIS BUSH

2003

BECOMING A SERVANT-CATALYST
A THEOLOGY OF APPLICATION

A READER

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Becoming a Catalyst by Understanding Change Dynamics

Adapted by Luis Bush

Introduction:

A Caveat: "I am uncomfortable with change. It requires that I acknowledge that I need to reflect, rethink and refocus my thought processes and actions. In essence have a shift in paradigm."

A Capacity Needed for the 21st Century: "The ability to cope with change, learning as much a possible with each encounter is the generic capacity needed for the twenty-first century" (Fullan 1993).

Change as a Constant: Change is the only constant in our mortal universe (as mentioned in movie, Jurassic Park as Chaos Theory, also known as a *Systems Approach*)

Four major theorists associated with the study of implementation and change have contributed to much of our understanding of the implementation of change in our day. These four theorists provide four different perspectives on change that helps identify the primary change dynamics components. R. Havelock, Michael Fullan, D. P. Ely and Everett M. Rodgers have provided significant insights out of a great deal of grounded research. Consistently they have discussed the catalyst change agent sometimes with slightly different points of view.

The contents of the section titled *Change Dynamics and the Change Agent* have been adapted from their writings. Since they deal with distinctive yet related aspects of institutional change some of their major contributions are summarized to provide a perspective of the dynamics of change and the change agent.

J. Robert Clinton has culled through the secular theory of change and introduced Christian perspective with strong application. His four-fold approach is very helpful and incorporated in this section along with some other materials from his research.

Its been said that "change is a double-edge sword. Its relentless." We are living in a time in which a changing church engaging a changing world with a changing mission force. Dramatic and accelerating multi-dimensional change in the world presents a complex backdrop to the church, as God's agent for mission.

Its a time when agents of change are called for to discern and respond to the God-initiated paradigm shifts of our day. When things are unsettled, we can find new ways to move ahead and to create breakthroughs not possible in stagnant societies. "If you ask people to brainstorm words to describe change, they come up with a mixture of negative and positive terms. On the one side, fear, anxiety, loss, danger, panic; on the other, exhilaration, risk-taking, excitement, improvements, energizing. For better or for worse, change arouses emotions, and when emotions intensify, leadership is key".

According to Everett M. Rogers, an early writer on this subject, innovation is "an idea perceived as new by the individual," and diffusion is "the process by which an innovation spreads." The essence of the diffusion process is the human interaction in which one

person communicates a new idea to another person. Thus, at the most elemental level of conceptualization, the diffusion process consists of (1) a new idea, (2) individual A who knows about the innovation, and (3) individual B who does not yet know about the innovation. The social relationships of A and B have a great deal to say about the conditions under which A will tell B about the innovation, and the results of this telling.

I. Change Agents and Change Dynamics

On the front cover of December 8, 2003 weekly edition of News and World Report the title of the cover story read: "The New Old-Time Religion Evangelicals defy easy labels. Here's why--and why their numbers are growing."

The article begins: "What would Jonathan Edwards think . . . Gazing across the packed rows, would Edwards recognize the modern face of the religious movement that he played such a key role in launching?" Author Jay Tolson dwells not so much on the present but to Jonathon Edward's and his contribution. In the ensuing pages he refers to Edwards as a major catalyst of the First Great Awakening:

> In 1729, Edwards inherited the Northampton, Mass., pulpit of his widely revered grandfather, Solomon Stoddard. But from the beginning he felt uneasy about his grandfather's lax requirements for church membership. For that reason, Edwards found special value in the revival that he instigated in and around Northampton in 1734. His published account of this spiritual renewal became a major catalyst of the First Great Awakening of the 1740s, but Edwards had a more personal reason to value the 1734 revival: It provided an alternative means of establishing the spiritual authenticity of his congregants. In his later Treatise Concerning Religious Affections, Edwards would caution, however, that intense experience alone was insufficient, even dangerous, unless accompanied by reason, a close regard for Scripture, and a disciplined and regular church life.

According to Fullan, **every person is a change agent**. He writes: "Change is too important to leave to the 'experts'; no one person can understand all of the complexities of change in a dynamic system" (Fullan, M. The complexity of the change process. *Change Forces: Probing the Depth of Educational Reform*, pp. 19-41. Falmer Press).

The following uses of the term by these authors helps to understand the semantic field that clarifies nuances of the meaning of both catalyst and change agent.

- A catalyst, change agent, problem solver, and coach for cross-functional organizations. An energetic, creative professional who has a sense of team, cares about people, and gets results.
- A catalyst is a person who initiates a change process and help the process to proceed to the desired end.

- The catalyst or change agent or person introducing the innovation in a social system should take into consideration the following aspects: the characteristics of the target population (the adopter categories), the characteristics of the innovation or change itself, and the stages of adoption.
- As instructional designers, we are placed in the role of change agent. The concept of change is ALL about people.
- The catalyst change agent helps people "to see that the advocates of the innovation are interested not only in the innovation, but in the people who take the risk of change"
- An instructional technologist, as change agent, must deal with many barriers in promoting diffusion of an innovation used in the learning process.
- A *change agent* is an individual who influences clients' innovation decisions in a direction deemed desirable. He/she usually seeks to secure the adoption of new ideas, but he/she may also attempt to slow the diffusion process and prevent the adoption of certain innovations which would have undesirable effects
- Facilitators. principal investigators and research assistants. variety of roles: catalyst/change agent. facilitator. group recorder. personal support
- The goal of stewardship is not simply to watch over whatever has been entrusted to you, but it is to be a catalyst - "change agent."
- The Guide provides a sample 'road-map' of policy development written primarily for the designated facilitators/catalyst/change agent
- The change agent is viewed as an enabler, a catalyst, a coordinator and a teacher of problem solving skills.
- In community development . . . Closely related to the role of facilitator is the role of a catalyst or change agent. As an outside advisor, the community development professional can challenge the community to acknowledge any problems head on and to address those problems aggressively.
- I came to work with my community as a catalyst, change agent and facilitator. Known as an industry catalyst, change agent and futurist
- The catalyst in the model represents the particular trigger that initiates the community ... be used to keep a record, by the community, the change agent or anyone ...
- The Christian minister is able to be a catalyst, change agent and risk taker in leading the congregation
- If we lack a planned strategy for change, implementation of an innovation (/concept) will have little chance for success. So the question remains, how should instructional designers in the agent of change role go about planning a strategy for change, adoption, and implementation within the diffusion cycle to increase the chances of intentional and effective change?

The change agent's role is to:

- develop a need for change
- establish an information-exchange relationship
- diagnose problems
- create an intent in the client to change

- translate an intent to action
- stabilize adoption and prevent discontinuance
- achieve a terminal relationship

II. Core Mindsets for Change-Agents to increase their effectiveness as they give leadership in a culture of change

Core Mindsets for change had been adapted from Michael Fullan's book, Leading in a Culture of Change. Dr. Michael Fullan is the Dean of the Ontario Institute for Studies in Education at the University of Toronto. Dr. Fullan has written and spoken extensively about the change process. His books, such as *Change Forces, New Meaning of Educational Change*, and *What's Worth Fighting For* are considered to be classics. Core Mindsets comes from his latest book, *Leading in a Culture of Change*.

I identified five major mind-sets, action sets I guess I'll call it, components of leadership. One was a sense of moral purpose, a second was the capacity to understand change, a third was able to develop relationships among diversity, a fourth was to engage in knowledge sharing and building within the organization and outside, and a fifth that we call coherence making, which is in a world of fragmentation, "How do you achieve focus under that complexity?" So those five mindsets constituted effective leadership in both business and in education.

Change agents will increase their effectiveness if they continually work on the five components of leadership—if they pursue moral purpose, understand the change process, develop relationships, foster knowledge building, and strive for coherence—with energy, enthusiasm, and hopefulness. If leaders do so, the rewards and benefits will be enormous. It is an exciting proposition. The culture of change beckons.

1. **Moral purpose** means that the change-agent has clear values and demonstrates a consistent commitment to stimulating positive change. Like leaders, change-agents that have energy, enthusiasm and hopefulness, are the most effective in facilitating lasting change. Moral purpose means acting with the intention of making a positive difference in the lives of employees, customers, and society as a whole. Pursue change with a sense of moral purpose. You need a compass. Why are you doing what you doing? Moral purpose is sense of making a difference. What is the higher order of purpose for this. Moral purpose without a sense of change is moral martyrdom.
2. **Understanding change** means that change-agents not only demonstrate good skills. They understand the nature and impact of change, why changes often don't last, or how positive change can be stimulated and maintained. Moreover, leaders who combine a commitment to moral purpose with a healthy respect for the complexities of the change process not only will be more successful but also will unearth deeper moral purpose. Moral purpose without an understanding of change will lead to moral martyrdom.

    (1) the goal is not to innovate the most;

(2) it is not enough to have the best ideas;

(3) appreciate early difficulties of trying something new—what I call the implementation dip;

(4) redefine resistance as a potential positive force;

(5) reculturing is the name of the game;

(6) never a checklist, always complexity.

Understanding change. What do we know about the change process? Its different than having the innovative best idea. Change agency s the capacity to have good ideas but making those ideas come alive. He has the capacity to take your good ideas, interact with others and produce a set of results that come out of the interaction. It's not to innovate the most the most. Not enough to have the best ideas. They have to come alive. Appreciate the dip and bumps along the road. Redefine resistance. Think of resistance as a tension point to get a better sense of what you are doing. Get a sense of dynamics of change, especially the change process.

Note on (5) reculturing versus restructuring. Re-culturing came from our observation that restructuring was failing. I think we may have coined a word.

Restructuring: So restructuring, let's define that first. That's literally when you change the structure, you say, every school must have a school improvement team. You add roles. You add formal requirements. One thing we know about restructuring is that it was a favorite strategy of legislators because literally we can do it by fiat, you can say every school must have a school improvement team, every school must have beside base management in the following way. We know you can do it that way. We also know that it doesn't make a difference in learning. So you have this structure, but it doesn't really convert into action.

Reculturing: So what we did was say, it's the changes that occur in individuals, and especially how individuals relate. Literally the way we do things around here, which is a definition of culture. Our particular definition of culture focuses on the professional learning community so we could define it in a lot of detail, but what it really says, is that, "If teachers and the principal start interacting with each other in a new way. "New ways" by how well students are doing in their school, and they begin to take that apart and use that as a point of departure to develop action plans and monitor those plans and engage in continuous improvement, they have changed the culture of the school. So our charge to our schools, and our leaders, and our work in that domain, is to say, "Let's engage in a re-culturing process where you ask the question, "What kind of professional culture do we have in this school or district? What kind should we want, and how do we get there?

Culture the driver of structure: And we want re-culturing to be the driver of structure. Culture the driver of structure, culture the driver of retiming. How do you get the time to do this? If you do it the other way around, it doesn't

have the substance to it. The substance of reform, especially the reform process, and somehow the leaders do this, unleash the process of moving from a culture of isolation, lack of focus, to a culture of stronger relationships, focus, and especially focus on student work and the solutions therein, if you do it together, if you re-culture that, you literally develop a new capacity to be able to engage and reform successful in the short run and you can keep going in the mid to long term.

3. **Relationships** are at the core of every successful change. If you want your clients to change, build good relationships with them and help them to build positive relationships with others. The single factor common to every successful change initiative is that relationships improve. If relationships improve, things get better. If they remain the same or get worse, ground is lost. Thus leaders must be consummate relationship builders with diverse people and groups—especially with people different than themselves. Effective leaders constantly foster purposeful interaction and problem solving, and are wary of easy consensus.

4. **Creating and sharing knowledge** means that change-agents constantly are learning and increasing new knowledge in the people with whom they work. The new work on knowledge creation and sharing reflects an amazing congruence with the previous three themes. We live, after all, in the knowledge society, but that term is a cliché. What is deeply revealing is that new theoretical and empirical studies of successful organizations unpack the operational meaning of the general term "knowledge organization." I will show how leaders commit themselves to constantly generating and increasing knowledge inside and outside the organization.

   What is astonishing (because it comes from an independent theoretical tradition) is how intimately the role of knowledge relates to the previous three themes. What has been discovered is that, first, people will not voluntarily share knowledge unless they feel some moral commitment to do so; second, people will not share unless the dynamics of change favor exchange; and, third, that data without relationships merely cause more information glut. Put another way, turning information into knowledge is a social process, and for that you need good relationships.

5. **Coherence** making involves letting others face enough ambiguity to keep the creative juices flowing but periodically synthesizing ideas so there is a sense that things are coming together. All this complexity keeps people on the edge of chaos. It is important to be on that edge because that is where creativity resides, but anarchy lurks there too. Therefore, effective leaders tolerate enough ambiguity to keep the creative juices flowing, but along the way (once they and the group know enough), they seek coherence. Coherence making is a perennial pursuit. Leadership is difficult in a culture of change because disequilibrium is common (and valuable, provided that patterns of coherence can be fostered).

In summary, moral purpose is concerned with direction and results; understanding change, building relationships, and knowledge building honor the complexity and discovery of the journey; and coherence making extracts valuable patterns worth retaining. But, alas, none of this is quite so linear and fixed as it would seem when one reads a simple description of each component.

There is another set of seemingly more personal characteristics that all effective leaders possess, which I have labeled the energy-enthusiasm-hopefulness constellation. I do not think it is worth debating whether this constellation is a cause or an effect of the five leadership components. No doubt there is a dynamic, reciprocal relationship between the two sets. Energetic-enthusiastic-hopeful leaders "cause" greater moral purpose in moral purpose is usually accompanied by a sense of urgency. Leaders in some such cases are in a hurry. If they are in too much of a hurry, they will completely fail—you can't bulldoze change.

III. The Stages of Planned Change, R. Havelock

Havelock, R.G. with Zlotolow. (1995). The Change Agent's Guide. Englewood Cliffs: Educational Technology Publications.

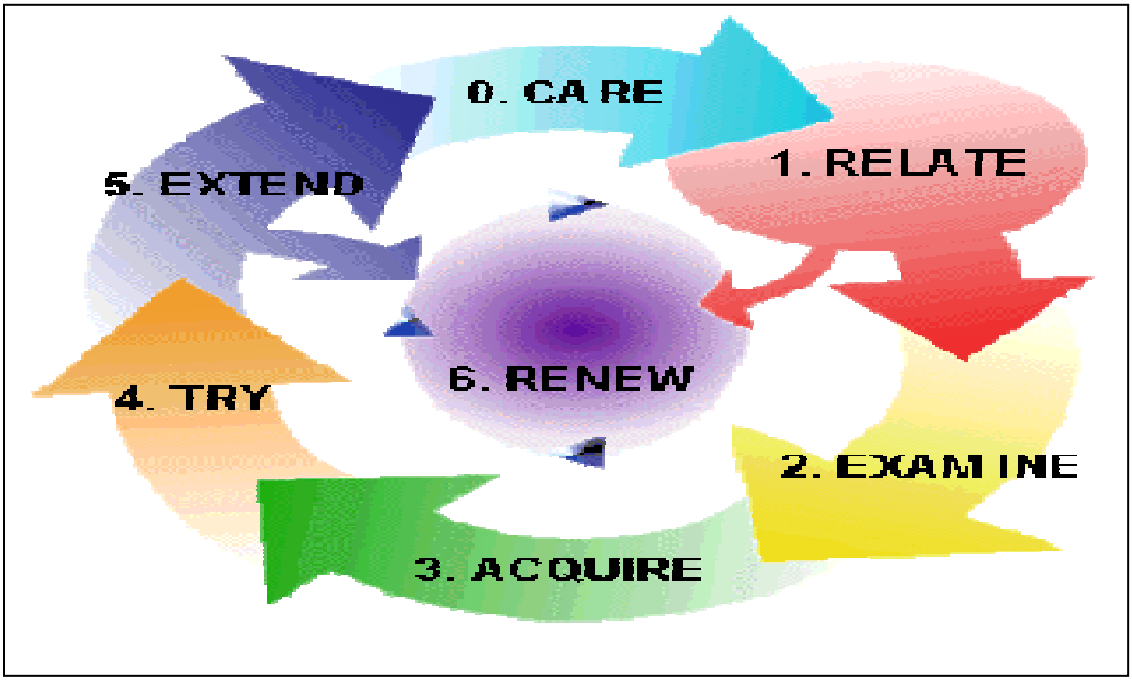


Figure 1: The Stages of Planned Change: C.R.E.A.T.E.R. Model

The Stages of Planned Change: C.R.E.A.T.E.R. Model

Stage 0: Care: arouse or connect to the concern that counts the most
Stage 1: Relate: build relationships to client and within the client system
Stage 2: Examine: define the problem in workable teams
Stage 3: Acquire: search and find relevant resources
Stage 4: Try: find what looks like the best solution and put it to the test
Stage 5: Extend: diffuse the change through the system and gain acceptance
Stage 6: Renew: stabilize, build capacity for continuing

Care: In this the first stage of the model, there are several individuals who have expressed the desire or need for change. In essence, they care about the situation or issue. The more individuals showing concern at this stage, the faster the change wheel starts to move. For example, if several in-service teachers voice their opinion for more staff development training for successful diffusion technology in the classroom movement into the second step will be quicker.

Relate: Individuals with a common vision or goal are able to relate and bond to some degree based on the issue raised. When in-service teachers see the need for integrating computer technology in their classes the level at which they relate will be high rather than if one or two in-service teachers are trying to voice such a concern. Leaders are more inclined to examine issues and effect changes when many individuals voice their opinion about the need for change.

Examine: The concern will then move on to the next level—to be examined. During this stage, the pros and cons will be analyzed and recommendations made in order for the leader to acquire the needed resources to effect the change postulated in step 1.

Acquire: Using the example of in-service seeing the need for changing the ways in which they are prepared for technology integration, the leader would need to identify resources for the successful implementation of a staff development initiative. In this regard, it may be simply making use of the human resources available such as computer technicians to conduct staff development training. On the other hand, based on the need assessment (examination) of the issue, resources may need to be acquired from the outside to carry out such training.

Try: The leader in the school will then try with the resources available for staff development and make an assessment whether or not the goals of the in-service teachers are adequately met. An evaluation at this stage will allow the leader to move to the next step of extending the program or to revert to the previous step to acquire other resources.

Extend: Based on the feedback received about the staff development initiative, the leader will be able to make a decision to broaden the scope of the initiative to include other individuals who may not have started out at the beginning of the change model. In some cases, if the program is a success, it may be extended to other schools in the district. This will then complete the cycle leading to renewal.

Renewal: This is the final step in the planned change model, which leads to "Re-C-R-E-A-T-E" (recreating) the change process. Havelock and Zlotolow (1995) suggested that many change agents stop at that point. However, change agents should seek ways of extending and keeping the cycle moving with new initiatives and a constant vision for change. In this regard, in-service teachers would have recognized that the issue they cared about led to the creation of change in staff development programs provided for successful diffusion of technology in the classroom.

Unfortunately this model is based on the old mode of thinking -- defining a problem as clearly as possible and then moving forward with "steps" to correct it. Doesn't take into consideration the dynamic nature of problems and emphasizes the change agent as the expert who has the correct answer to implement.

IV. The Conditions that Facilitate the Innovation of Change, D. P. Ely

Ely, D.P. (1990). Conditions that facilitate the implementation of educational technology innovations. *Journal of Research on Computing in Education,* 23 (2), 298-305.

Ely proposes eight conditions that facilitate the adoption, implementation and institutionalization of educational technology innovations that are transferable concepts to other kinds of change domains.

Ely confirms the common factors/conditions that explain successful implementation efforts. Then he further details and highlights which of the factors each are often linked to.

1. Dissatisfaction with the status quo - often linked to *leadership*
2. Existence of knowledge and skills - linked to *resources, rewards and incentives, leadership, and commitment*
3. Availability of resources - *commitment, leadership and rewards and incentives*
4. Availability of time - *participation, commitment, leadership and rewards and incentives*
5. Rewards or incentives exist - *participation, resources, time, and dissatisfaction with the status quo*
6. Participation - *time, commitment, knowledge and skills and rewards and incentives*
7. Commitment - *time, resources and rewards and incentive*s
8. Leadership - *participation, commitment, time, resources and rewards and incentives*

V. A Framework of Change Forces, Michael Fullan

Fullan, M. The complexity of the change process. *Change Forces: Probing the Depth of Educational Reform,* pp. 19-41. Falmer Press.

Fullan's work with change focuses on philosophical and policy issues related to educational change, particularly curriculum changes. Rather than offering prescriptions for change his writings serve as a framework for viewing the change process.

Fullan lists 9 characteristics that have a direct and profound impact on adoption and implementation of an innovation. Each characteristic fits into one of three categories: 1) characteristics of change, 2) Local characteristics, and 3) external factors. The diagram below helps to visualize the arrangement of the factors.

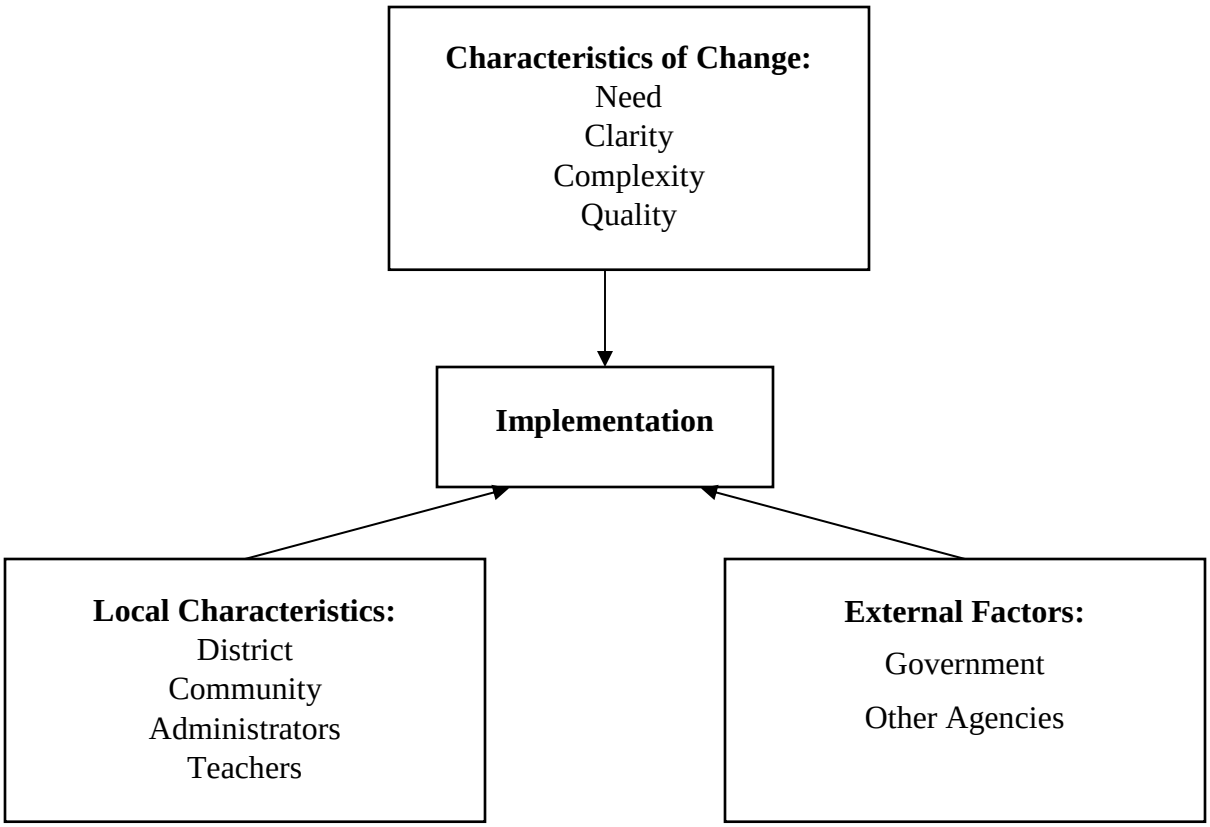


Figure 2: Change Implementation Links

The characteristics of change include need, clarity, complexity, and quality. Many large scale studies within the United States confirm the importance of relating *need* to decisions about innovation or change direction. At the beginning of any complex change, precise needs are often not clear. *Clarity* issues create roadblocks in virtually every study of significant change. *Complexity* "refers to the difficulty and extent of change required of the individuals responsible for implementation" (Fullan, 1996, p. 275). Change agents should never underestimate the manner in which adoptions decisions are made by believing that the importance of *quality* and *practicality* are self evident. "*Practicality* changes are those that address salient needs, that fit well with the teachers situation, that are focused and that include concrete how-to-do-possibilities" (Fullan, 1996, p. 276).

Toward a Framework for Change: 8 Lessons of the new change paradigm

(1) You can't mandate what matters and the more complex a change the less you can force it
(2) Change is a journey, not a blueprint; it is non-linear, leaded with uncertainty and sometimes perverse; change does not involve a checklist of items to be marked off one-by-one
(3) Problems are our friends: they are inevitable, you can't learn or be successful without them but they only help if you do something about them; you need to have an attitude of acceptance to alter your course
(4) Vision and strategic planning come later; premature visions and planning can "blind"
(5) Individualism and collectivism must have equal power -- no one-sided solutions or groupthink; a tight-knit shared culture is not a desirable endpoint
(6) Neither centralization or de-centralization works -- both top-down and bottom-up are necessary
(7) Connection with the wider environment is essential

Every person is a change agent -- change is too important to leave to the "experts"; no one person can understand all of the complexities of change in a dynamic system

In view of the complexity using the framework practical steps for implementing change include:

- simultaneously push for change while allowing self-learning to unfold
- being prepared for uncertainty
- seeing problems as sources of creative resolution
- having a vision but not being blinded by it
- valuing the individual and the group
- incorporating centralizing and de-centralizing forces
- being internally cohesive but externally oriented
- valuing personal change as the route to system change

It is this complexity that prohibits a prescriptive approach to change -- you can prepare for it but because of the unique environment for each change situation you can't prescribe a blueprint.

VI. The Communication of Change, Rogers, E.

Rodgers, E. (1995). Diffusion of Innovations, 4th edition. New York: The Free Press.

A diffusion of Innovations. This involves the process by which an innovation is communicated through certain channels over time among the members of a social system in order to reach a mutual understanding

Roger's theory of diffusion of innovations was adopted, implemented and diffused into many others fields and disciplines. A fundamental component in his thinking is the change agent.

A *change agent* is an individual who influences clients' innovation decisions in a direction deemed desirable. He/she usually seeks to secure the adoption of new ideas, but he/she may also attempt to slow the diffusion process and prevent the adoption of certain innovations which would have undesirable effects.

The change agent's role

- develop a need for change
- establish an information-exchange relationship
- diagnose problems
- create an intent in the client to change
- translate an intent to action
- stabilize adoption and prevent discontinuance

Overview

Rogers defines diffusion as the process by which an innovation is communicated through certain channels over time among members of a social system. Diffusion of an innovation is essentially a social process in which subjectively perceived information about the new idea is communicated.

He points out, as he identifies the four components of diffusion, the time frame in which an innovation diffuses is considerable. A common problem to diffusion is speeding up the rate of the diffusion of an innovation. Time is the period over which the diffusion occurs and the social system constitutes the boundary within which an innovation diffuses (Rogers, 1983).

Change agents must put themselves in the position of the adopter rather than narrowly focusing on the innovation. This philosophy is substantiated by Rogers in *Communication of Innovation: A Cross-cultural Approach*. In order for diffusion to occur, we must first consider the culture, the environment and the individual. Decentralized diffusion can only be anticipated when decisions are more widely shared by participants and potential adopters Rogers, 1983). The lynchpin to increasing the quality and chances for adoption of an innovation is understanding the culture and the communications channels.

The Nature of the Diffusion of Innovation Process:

Diffusion is the process by which A. an innovation B. is communicated through certain channels C. over time D. among the members of a social system. Diffusion is a special type of communication concerned with the spread of messages that are perceived as new ideas. The four keys/main elements in the diffusion of new ideas are A. the innovation, B. communication channels, C. time, and D. the social system (Figure 3).

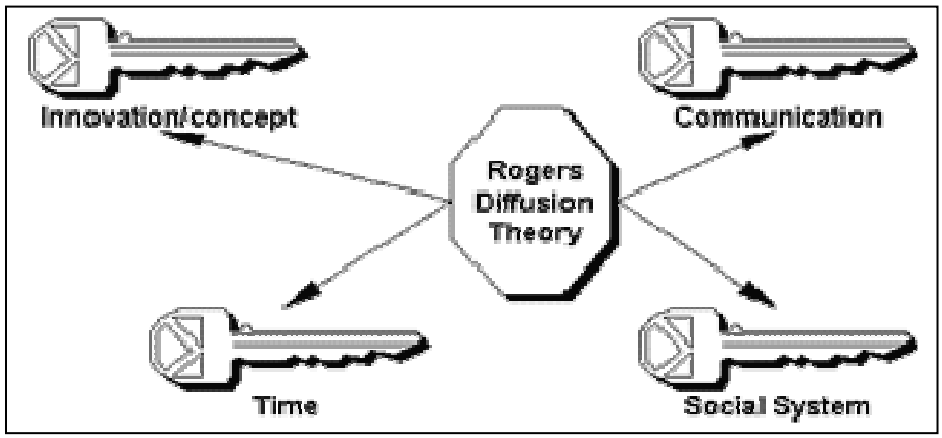


Figure 3: The Four Keys in the Diffusion Process

A. The Innovation

An innovation is an idea, practice, or object that is perceived as new by an individual or other unit of adoption. The characteristics of an innovation, as perceived by the members of a social system, determine its rate of adoption. Figure 2 shows the relatively slower, and faster, rates of adoption for three different innovations. Why do certain innovations spread more quickly than others? The characteristics which determine an innovation's rate of adoption are: (1) relative advantage, (2) compatibility, (3) complexity, (4) trialability, and (5) observability.

(1) Relative advantage is the degree to which an innovation is perceived as better than the idea it supersedes. The degree of relative advantage may be measured in economic terms, but social prestige, convenience, and satisfaction are also important factors. It does not matter so much if an innovation has a great deal of objective advantage. What does matter is whether an individual perceives the innovation as advantageous. The greater the perceived relative advantage of an innovation, the more rapid its rate of adoption will be.

(2) Compatibility is the degree to which an innovation is perceived as being consistent with the existing values, past experiences, and needs of potential adopters. An idea that is incompatible with the values and norms of a social system will not be adopted as rapidly as an innovation that is compatible. The adoption of an incompatible innovation often requires the prior adoption of a new value system, which is a relatively slow process.

(3) Complexity is the degree to which an innovation is perceived as difficult to understand and use. Some innovations are readily understood by most members of a social system; others are more complicated and will be adopted more slowly. New ideas that are simpler to understand are adopted more rapidly than innovations that require the adopter to develop new skills and understandings.

(4) Trialability is the degree to which an innovation may be experimented with on a limited basis. New ideas that can be tried on the installment plan will generally be adopted more quickly than innovations that are not divisible. An innovation that is trialable represents less uncertainty to the individual who is considering it for adoption, who can learn by doing.

(5) Observability is the degree to which the results of an innovation are visible to others. The easier it is for individuals to see the results of an innovation, the more likely they are to adopt it. Such visibility stimulates peer discussion of a new idea, as friends and neighbors of an adopter often request innovation-evaluation information about it.

In summary, then, innovations that are perceived by individuals as having greater relative advantage, compatibility, trialability, observability, and less complexity will be adopted more rapidly than other innovations.

B. Communication Channels

The second main element in the diffusion of new ideas is the communication channel. Communication is the process by which participants create and share information with one another in order to reach a mutual understanding. A communication channel is the means by which messages get from one individual to another. Mass media channels are more effective in creating knowledge of innovations, whereas interpersonal channels are more effective in forming and changing attitudes toward a new idea, and thus in influencing the decision to adopt or reject a new idea. Most individuals evaluate an innovation, not on the basis of scientific research by experts, but through the subjective evaluations of near-peers who have adopted the innovation.

C. Time

The third main element in the diffusion of new ideas is time. The time dimension is involved in diffusion in three ways. First, time is involved in the innovation-decision process. The innovation-decision process is the mental process through which an individual (or other decision-making unit) passes from first knowledge of an innovation to forming an attitude toward the innovation, to a decision to adopt or reject, to implementation of the new idea, and to confirmation of this decision. An individual seeks information at various stages in the innovation-decision process in order to decrease uncertainty about an innovation's expected consequences. The second way in which time is involved in diffusion is in the innovativeness of an individual or other unit of adoption.

Innovativeness is the degree to which an individual or other unit of adoption is relatively earlier in adopting new ideas than other members of a social system. There are five adopter categories, or classifications of the members of a social system on the basis on their innovativeness: (1) innovators, (2) early adopters, (3) early majority, (4) late majority, and (5) laggards.

(1) Innovators are the first 2.5 percent of the individuals in a system to adopt an innovation. Venturesomeness is almost an obsession with innovators. This interest

in new ideas leads them out of a local circle of peer networks and into more cosmopolite social relationships. Communication patterns and friendships among a clique of innovators are common, even though the geographical distance between the innovators may be considerable. Being an innovator has several prerequisites. Control of substantial financial resources is helpful to absorb the possible loss from an unprofitable innovation. The ability to understand and apply complex technical knowledge is also needed. The innovator must be able to cope with a high degree of uncertainty about an innovation at the time of adoption. While an innovator may not be respected by the other members of a social system, the innovator plays an important role in the diffusion process: That of launching the new idea in the system by importing the innovation from outside of the system's boundaries. Thus, the innovator plays a gatekeeping role in the flow of new ideas into a system.

(2) Early adopters are the next 13.5 percent of the individuals in a system to adopt an innovation. Early adopters are a more integrated part of the local system than are innovators. Whereas innovators are cosmopolites, early adopters are localites. This adopter category, more than any other, has the greatest degree of opinion leadership in most systems. Potential adopters look to early adopters for advice and information about the innovation. This adopter category is generally sought by change agents as a local missionary for speeding the diffusion process. Because early adopters are not too far ahead of the average individual in innovativeness, they serve as a role-model for many other members of a social system. The early adopter is respected by his or her peers, and is the embodiment of successful, discrete use of new ideas. The early adopter knows that to continue to earn this esteem of colleagues and to maintain a central position in the communication networks of the system, he or she must make judicious innovation-decisions. The early adopter decreases uncertainty about a new idea by adopting it, and then conveying a subjective evaluation of the innovation to near-peers through interpersonal networks.

(3) Early majority is the next 34 percent of the individuals in a system to adopt an innovation. The early majority adopt new ideas just before the average member of a system. The early majority interact frequently with their peers, but seldom hold positions of opinion leadership in a system. The early majority's unique position between the very early and the relatively late to adopt makes them an important link in the diffusion process. They provide interconnectedness in the system's interpersonal networks. The early majority are one of the two most numerous adopter categories, making up one-third of the members of a system. The early majority may deliberate for some time before completely adopting a new idea. "Be not the first by which the new is tried, nor the last to lay the old aside," fits the thinking of the early majority. They follow with deliberate willingness in adopting innovations, but seldom lead.

(4) Late majority is the next 34 percent of the individuals in a system to adopt an innovation. The late majority adopt new ideas just after the average member of a

system. Like the early majority, the late majority make up one-third of the members of a system. Adoption may be the result of increasing network pressures from peers. Innovations are approached with a skeptical and cautious air, and the late majority do not adopt until most others in their system have done so. The weight of system norms must definitely favor an innovation before the late majority are convinced. The pressure of peers is necessary to motivate adoption. Their relatively scarce resources mean that most of the uncertainty about a new idea must be removed before the late majority feel that it is safe to adopt.

(5) Laggards are the last 16 percent of the individuals in a system to adopt an innovation. They possess almost no opinion leadership. Laggards are the most localite in their outlook of all adopter categories; many are near isolates in the social networks of their system. The point of reference for the laggard is the past. Decisions are often made in terms of what has been done previously. Laggards tend to be suspicious of innovations and change agents. Resistance to innovations on the part of laggards may be entirely rational from the laggard's viewpoint, as their resources are limited and they must be certain that a new idea will not fail before they can adopt.

(6) The third way in which time is involved in diffusion is in rate of adoption. The rate of adoption is the relative speed with which an innovation is adopted by members of a social system. The rate of adoption is usually measured as the number of members of the system that adopt the innovation in a given time period (see Figure 2). As shown previously, an innovation's rate of adoption is influenced by the five perceived attributes of an innovation.

D. The Social System

The fourth main element in the diffusion of new ideas is the social system. A social system is defined as a set of interrelated units that are engaged in joint problem-solving to accomplish a common goal. The members or units of a social system may be individuals, informal groups, organizations, and/or subsystems. The social system constitutes a boundary within which an innovation diffuses. How the system's social structure affects diffusion has been studied. A second area of research involved how norms affect diffusion. Norms are the established behavior patterns for the members of a social system. A third area of research has had to do with opinion leadership, the degree to which an individual is able to influence informally other individuals' attitudes or overt behavior in a desired way with relative frequency.

A change agent is an individual who attempts to influence clients' innovation-decisions in a direction that is deemed desirable by a change agency.

The fourth area of research involves the types of innovation-decisions (whether individual adoption decisions or organizational decisions, and whether they are made by

an authority or by consensus). The last area of research has analyzed the consequences of innovation.

The Critical Mass

A final crucial concept in understanding the nature of the diffusion process is the critical mass, which occurs at the point at which enough individuals have adopted an innovation that the innovation's further rate of adoption becomes self-sustaining (the shaded area in Figure 2 depicts the critical mass). The concept of the critical mass implies that outreach activities should be concentrated on getting the use of the innovation to the point of critical mass. These efforts should be focused on the early adopters, the 13.5 percent of the individuals in the system to adopt an innovation after the innovators have introduced the new idea into the system. Early adopters are often opinion leaders, and serve as role-models for many other members of the social system. Early adopters are instrumental in getting an innovation to the point of critical mass, and hence, in the successful diffusion of an innovation.

Rate of adoption is the relative speed with which an innovation is adopted by members of as social system.

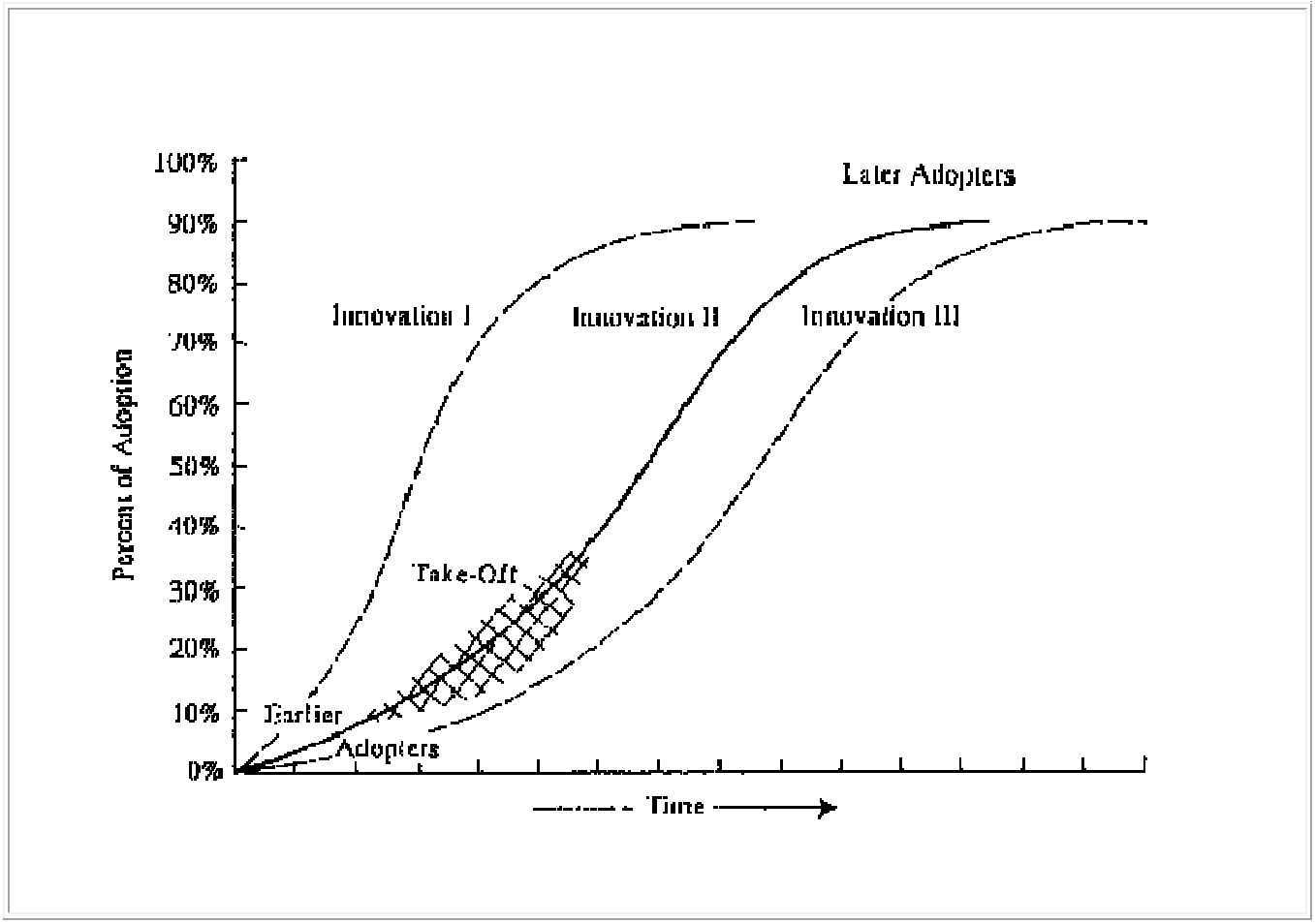


Figure 4: Rate of Adoption

Terms as defined by Everett M. Rogers (1995

- Innovation – an idea, practice, or object that is perceived as new by an individual or other unit of adoption.
- Diffusion- a kind of social change, defined as the process by which an innovation is communicated through certain channels over time among the members of a social system.
- Communication- a process in which participants create and share information which one another in order to reach a mutual understanding.
- Uncertainty- is the degree to which a number of alternatives are perceived with respect to the occurrence of an event and the relative probability of these alternatives.
- Information – a difference in matter-energy that affects uncertainty in a situation where a choice exists among a set of alternatives.
- Technology- the design for instrumental action that reduces the uncertainty in the cause-effect relationships involved in achieving a desired outcome: It has two components:
- Hardware- consisting of the tool that embodies the technology as a material or physical object
- Software- consisting of the information base for the tool
- Perceived characteristics of innovations that influence the different rate of adoption.
- Relative advantage- the degree to which an innovation is perceived as better than the idea it supercedes.
- Compatibility- the degree to which an innovation is perceived as being consistent with the existing values, part experiences, and needs of potential adopters.
- Complexity- the degree to which an innovation is perceived as difficult to understand and use
- Trialability- the degree to which an innovation may be experimented with on a limited basis.
- Observability- the degree to which the results of innovation are visible to others.
- Communication Channel- the mean by which messages get from one individual to another
- Mass-media channels- all those means of transmitting messages that involve a mass medium
- Interpersonal channels- involves a face-to-face exchange between two or more individuals.
- (Mass-media channels has more impact at the knowledge stage and interpersonal channels are relatively more important at the persuasion stage in the innovation-decision process).

Key Attributes of the Speed and Permeability of the Diffusion Process

Relative Advantage	Is the innovation perceived to be better than what it will replace?
Compatibility	Does the innovation appropriate intended audience?
Complexity	Is the innovation easy to use?
Trialability	Can the innovation be adopted on a trial basis?
Observability	Are the results of the innovation observable and measurable?
Impact on social relations	Does the innovation have a disruptive effect on the social environment?
Communicability	Can the innovation be understood clearly and easily?
Reversibility	Can the innovation be reversed or discontinued easily?
Time required	Can the innovation be adopted with a minimal investment in time?
Risk and uncertainty	Can the innovation be used effectively with only the modest commitment?
Commitment required	Can the innovation be used effectively with only modest commitment?
Modifiability	Can the innovation be updated, modified, or reinvented over time?

Source: Glanz, K, Lewis, FM, & Rimer, BK (1997). *Health Behavior and Health Communication*

VII. *Bridging Strategies: Leadership Perspectives for Introducing Change*, J. Robert Clinton

An Overview of the Model

Step one of the model involves an *evaluation of the people resources* in the change situation. This includes the person of change, other change agents, the individual change participants, and the groups of change participants. A careful evaluation requires not only the identity of these people involved in the change but also an understanding of the history and relationships between the change agents and various people. Relationships are the key to any change situation--reactive or proactive. Step 1 helps us evaluate the present situation--in terms of people. Where are we today?

Step two of the model *assesses the change climate* in the situation. It identifies the essential factors that affect the situation. How has the group reacted to change in the past? Where is the organization in its cycle of development? What is the history of change? How much change can be absorbed? It goes on to analyze the opportunities in the situation as well as the problems involved. If the change is a reactive change, the problem analysis is particularly critical. This step also necessitates a systemic analysis of the situation. Step 1 assesses the people in the change situation.

While probably the majority of change needed will come as a result of disturbance (things aren't as they should be and need fixing) there is a place for leadership which introduces change because of vision, a movement forward, or a developmental posture. Step 2 assesses the situation itself. Both of these are critical and a prerequisite to Step 3, applying leadership to the situation to bring change. Step 2, helps us assess the past and present--in terms of the possible change situation today.

Step 3, looks for a *solution set*, that is, a range of possible solutions or changes to be introduced, that fit the people involved and fit the situation. It considers inside resources for change as well as outside resources for change. It looks for the ideal solution as well as the pragmatic. It pinpoints the actual changes that will be involved if a given solution is enacted. Actual changes usually affect people, structures, and philosophy. These are weighed for their possible ramifications. Wise change agents know that while most people think that introducing change solves problems, introducing change does not really solve problems it simply exchanges one set of problems for a new set. The new problems that might arise must be anticipated. Which set of problems do you really want to live with? Step 3 points us forward to the future, what can be.

Step 4, called the *bridging steps*, helps us move from where we are today, the results of our thinking in Steps 1 and 2, to where we ought to be, the results of our thinking in Step 3. It assesses ownership of possible solutions and how to deepen it. It looks for adaptation of solutions that will bring about the greater good--ownership and less negative ramifications. It looks at the actual steps that must be taken and the timing and sequence of those actions. Various kinds of time analysis are important at this juncture. It recognizes the need for stabilizing the changes in the system in the future. The careful application of this four step model does not guarantee success. But it does lessen the degree of failure and trauma involved in the change process. It does heighten the probability of more effective leadership.

VIII. A Summary List of Change Dynamic Principles

This summary provides a list of change dynamic principles which J. Robert Clinton culled from his reading and study of numerous authors on change in the past. I have selected, modified and re-categorized for the purposes of this course.

A list of change principles from multiple sources of change-experts and students are organized by broad category and may be repeated in different categories

A Christian Perspective of Change

- Do not assume that because something is the right thing to do, or that it is in the Bible, or that it is God's now word that people will automatically accept and do it.
- People's motivations are not always spiritual.
- Perspective is needed when in a change situation.
- A broad perspective allows one to see that there are some things one can do something about and there are others where one cannot.
- There are far more micro and macro contextual factors that influence change situations than one is aware of at first inspection.

Needs Assessment/Analysis and Diagnosis

- The result of assessment and diagnosis of needs in a system is a defined problem set stated in such a way that the change agent and the change participants can understand and work rationally on its solution.
- Surface Symptoms of problems or expressions of felt needs are not necessarily identical with the real problems. Often there are underlying causes below these surface symptoms.

Understanding Change

- *Approach to Change*
  A systematic and anticipatory approach to planned social change is the most effective style for an agent of change.
- *Outlets*
  In a change situation there must be a constructive outlet provided for mounting discontent.
- *Necessity*
  If it is not necessary to change, it is necessary not to change.
- *Motivations to Change*
  Change comes because of internal motivations, external motivation or those finally necessitated because of indecision.
- *Increasing Pace of Change*
  Crises, increase level of discontent, increase attractiveness of proposal, increase frequency of communication about change, build up level of trust, minimize precedent and tradition.
- *Lag Principles* There is a lag between perceived need for change and an institutions response to it.
  - The more complex and older the organization the more likely the lag is longer.
  - There is usually a lag between the time when the period of crisis actually begins and when it is perceived.
  - People perceive a crisis long before they are prepared to admit its existence.
- *Crisis/Intervention Principle*
  - Change in a perceived crisis tends to arouse a different set of change principles than would be normally expected.

- In a time of perceived crisis most people recognize that the cost of inaction is greater than the cost of action.

- *Proper Channels*
  A change agent who wants change (not witness to a situation needing correction) will work along normal decision making mechanisms.
- *Counterstrategy Principle*
  - Every theory of how to achieve change produces a theory of how to counter the first theory.
  - Eventually a counterstrategy will include an attack on the motivation, reliability, or credibility of the advocates of change.
- *Stages of Acceptance*
  Individuals accept change most readily in a series of stages which gradually works from initial awareness, to interest, to evaluation, to trying for oneself, to adoption, to internalization.
  - you can't mandate what matters and the more complex a change the less you can force it
  - change is a journey, not a blueprint; it is non-linear, leaded with uncertainty and sometimes perverse; change does not involve a checklist of items to be marked off one-by-one
  - problems are our friends: they are inevitable, you can't learn or be successful without them but they only help if you do something about them; you need to have an attitude of acceptance to alter your course
  - vision and strategic planning come later; premature visions and planning can "blind"
  - individualism and collectivism must have equal power -- no one-sided solutions or groupthink; a tight-knit shared culture is not a desirable endpoint
  - neither centralization or de-centralization works -- both top-down and bottom-up are necessary
  - connection with the wider environment is essential

Danger Signals

A change agent may well decide that the time is not right to bring change into a system if one or more of the following danger signals are present

- A linear history with an anti-change bias,
- A marker event in linear history against the particular changes being sought
- Power conflicts in the organization
- The change team's participants have little or no power in the organization
- The organization has a history of problems
- The organization is in a later stages such as aristocratic, or bureaucracy
- Risky outcomes of change exceed perceived benefits of change:
  - Change may succeed and make obsolete current practices and patterns of operation,
  - It may fail,
  - It will succeed and may produce unforeseen consequences that create new problems.

Organizations and Decision Making Paradigms

- An organization needs two opposing kinds of thrusts: (a) the efficient maintenance of the system the way it is; (b) The changing of the system so that it performs better.
- Decision making processes of religious organizations are a hybrid mix which follow both organizational and voluntary associations paradigms.
- Decision making processes of churches and parachurch organizations will always be strongly influenced by the contemporary societies organizations.
- Self-preservation usually dominates the decision making processes of an organization.
- Original purposes of an organization, over time, are subverted to give priority to the needs, preferences, and convenience of the professional staff.
- The purpose and the output or product are often not in harmony.
- Every organization seeks to be free from accountability to any other organization.
- Institutional considerations are normally far more influential than theological or philosophical considerations whenever changes in the institution or its finances are being considered.
- The normal result of pressures is resistance to change and maintaining the status quo.
- The further along an organization is in stages the more likely it is that institutional pressures will dominate the decision-making processes. Stages identified are 1) Courtship, 2) Infant, 3) Go-go, 4) Adolescent 5) prime, 6) mature, 7) aristocratic, 8) early bureaucracy, and 9) bureaucracy.
- Conversely, the less further along an organization is the more likely it is that institutional pressures will not dominate the decision-making processes. Purposes, values, mission, and ideology will dominate, not institutional pressures.
- A long established behavior pattern in an organization usually takes one full generation to substantially change.
- The number of times when the leader of a religious organization has remained too long in one place/job/role/position greatly exceeds the number of times when a leader has moved prematurely.
- Most major change proposals that depart from tradition are voted down at least once before being adopted.
- A negative vote on a proposal for change is not necessarily final but a favorable vote on some alternative often does eliminate other alternatives that were never directly voted down.
- Decisions for major change in voluntary organizations or hybrids with large voluntary components (in democratic cultures) normally require a consensus or overwhelming majority not just a simple majority if it is to be implemented effectively and without disruptive consequences.
- Ridicule, perceived crisis, financial pressures tend to reduce the impact of tradition upon decision making.

- In general, the higher up in the hierarchy that decisions are made, the more chance it is that the decision will be made under conflict or under uncertainty.
- Decision making processes are improved radically in quality when questions, problems, issues, or action plans are examined from some relevant framework.

Qualities of Effective Leaders

- Effective leaders recognize that supervision is always relational.
- Effective leaders recognize their different roles and assess which role is active in a given situation.
- Effective leaders listen to other leaders and non-leaders.
- Effective leaders know where boundaries are (permissibility, resources, time, previous commitments, and available information) but he/she is not always restricted by those boundaries.
- Effective leaders know when it is time to move on to new assignments. He/she knows this personally and for others.

Change Agent Roles

- Acknowledge my personal change agent role/mix and those of the major players in the game would have been valuable to me.
- The change agent should have first hand experience of the change she/she is seeking to implement through personal experience, through direct observation, or interviewing of those doing it.
- Internal pressures ought to motivate change agents who want to be proactive in change.
- Insiders or outsiders can bring about change. Each has advantages and disadvantages.
- Know your own suggested changes inside and out: what works well, what doesn't, why, what to do about it in this system, etc. Be an expert in terms of your ideas.
- Inside change agents, even working from below, have the advantage of being there.
- Change agents in power positions can bring about change though it is not as easy as a non-power person thinks.
- Change agents in non-power roles can also bring about change but must eventually have access to power.
- Be persistent and keep plugging away.

Hints for Change Agents from Below

Change can be introduced by those in power and by those not in power. Those not in power need to:

- Diagram the system as a whole in order to be thoroughly familiar with its goals, cultural values, change agents, and change participants.
- Form a change team made up of favorable or neutral change participants that you can recruit.

- Analyze the system from the standpoint of the neutral or unfavorable change participants.
- Be aware of not only what but when. Timing is critical. Be aware of when to push hard for your changes.
- Get ownership so that others share the credit with you and the changes are as much theirs as yours.

Postmortem Lessons

- Postmortem refers to a past change situation.
- Frequently, past situations foreshadows future happenings.
- Analysis helps understand what went right, what went wrong and what can be done better in the future.
- Planned change has tremendous advantage over forced change.
- Ideas are accepted not because of their inherent goodness, but because of the depth of the relationships between the change agent and change participants.
- Goals and objectives must be shared by an outside change agent/consultant with the client system and stakeholders. In fact, if they themselves formulate them, then they will have bought ownership in the change. Similarly, they must buy ownership in the solutions.

IX. Change Agent Roles Worksheet

In the process of change, people play different roles. For those who are trying to initiate change, being able to anticipate the roles people play helps the process flow more smoothly. This worksheet is designed to help you identify those roles. This is a first step in developing a change strategy.

The table below lists possible roles people might play on the left side. Space is left for you to add roles that you observe. The vertical column has space for you to write the names of people involved in the change process. Mark for each person the roles that might apply to them. The back of the sheet gives definitions for the roles.

Change Participants → **Roles ↓**											
Catalyst											
Process Helper											
Solution Giver											
Resource Linker											
Innovator											
Ally											
Potential Ally											
Compatibility Person											
Key Informant											
Formal Leader											
Influential											
Gatekeeper											
Vocalizer											
Public Relations Link											
Defender, Resister											
Faction Leader											

Role Definitions

- Catalyst-Those who initiate a change process and help the process to proceed to the desired end.
- Process Helper- Those who join in to help other people in the change process communicate with one another.
- Solution giver- Those who are able to quickly offer creative solutions once they see the problem.
- Resource Linker- A person who is aware of resource material-people, books, seminars, training experiences- and is eager to share that knowledge with others.
- Innovator- Those who are most likely to adopt a new idea and experiment with it before his/ her colleagues do.
- Ally- Those who silently or vocally share the concerns of the change agent. They may form part of the group that initiates change later.
- Potential Ally- Those who with some effort at recruiting are likely to join with you in initiating change.
- Compatibility Person- One who can work with you as a change agent without creating stress or strain.
- Key Informant- A person who has access to strategic information and gives it to the change agent in time for him/her to use it advantageously.
- Maintainer- Those who are good at sticking with something, applying it systematically and conscientiously, until it works.
- Formal Leader- Those who are in the structural chain of command, holding roles that are recognized as decision making roles by the organization.
- Influential- Those key persons to whom others turn for new ideas and fresh directions or approval of the same.
- Gatekeepers- Individuals who hold key strategic positions with respect to the flow of new ideas and information.
- Vocalizers- Those who will speak up about their feelings/ ideas concerning the situation. They can be for or against the change.
- Public Relations Linkers- A person who has the ability to create or influence the public image of the change situation.
- Defender or Resister- Often the critic of innovation. They defend the system the way it is. They may resist change due to vested interest in the system.
- Faction Leader-A leader of a group that has a vested interest.

The above definitions are from a handout produced by J. Robert Clinton of Fuller Seminary for his class on Implementing Change. The original author was Havelock.

Sovereign Mindset

By: Bobby Clinton

Mindset burst upon our English language scene in the mid-eighties. So it is a relative newcomer to English speakers. Not all English speakers even know it. But its definition is as old as the Bible itself. What is a mindset? A mindset is a fixed mental attitude or disposition—formed by experience, education, prejudice, or the like—that predetermines a person's responses to and interpretations of situations. One of the great Bible leaders, Paul the Apostle, demonstrated a special kind of mindset. I call it a sovereign mindset. A sovereign mindset represents one leadership value that can make the difference for a Christian leader.[1] And I want to suggest that if you do not have this mindset you probably won't make it in ministry—at least not as an effective leader who will finish well.

A leadership value is an underlying assumption a leader holds which affects how the leader acts or perceives in leadership situations.

It is a mindset, an underlying controlling force, which gives meaning to ourselves and explains whey we do things or think things. It can relate to a belief. It can relate to personal ethical conduct. It can relate to personal feelings desired about situations. It can relate to ideas of what brings success or failure in ministry. It can be rooted in personality shaping. It can be rooted in heritage. It can be rooted in the critical shaping activities that describes our personal history of leadership development.

Paul models this leadership value, a sovereign mindset, more than any other New Testament Church leader.[2] Quickly glance through the two passages below to catch the flavor of this important leadership insight. Pay special attention to the boldfaced words.

> 3 Blessed [be] God, even the Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, the Father of mercies, and the God of all comfort; 4 Who comforts us in all our tribulation, **that we may be able to comfort them which are in any trouble**, by the comfort wherewith we ourselves are comforted of God. 5 For as the sufferings of Christ abound in us, so our consolation also abounds by Christ. 6 And whether we **be afflicted, [it is] for your consolation and salvation**, which is effectual in the enduring of the same sufferings which we also suffer: or whether we be comforted, [it is] for your consolation and salvation. 7 And our hope of you [is] steadfast, knowing, that as you are partakers of the sufferings, so [shall you be] also of the consolation. 2 Corinthians 1:3-7
>
> 8 For we would not, brethren, have you ignorant of our trouble which came to us in Asia, that we were pressed out of measure, above strength, inasmuch that we despaired even of life: 9 But we had the sentence of death in

[1] It can for a secular leader too. A Christian leader believes that God is involved in the events of life and therefore looks to learn what God has for him/her in the happenings of life. A secular leader who does not believe that God is or is involved in life's events can still also profit greatly from the happenings in life if that leader has a learning posture and believes that life's experiences can be used to teach lessons. The learning posture needed is simply, All of life is preparing us for all of the rest of life. We can be better leaders if we learn from life's experiences and let that learning inform our leadership.

[2] Paul is a major model for a Christian leader in the N.T. Leadership Era. We have more biographical information on Paul than any other Church leader. He himself recognizes the importance of modeling. See Php 4:9 and other cross-references.

ourselves, **that we should not rely on ourselves, but in God which raises the dead: 10 Who delivered us from so great a death**, and does deliver: in whom we trust that he will yet deliver [us]; 11 You also helping together by prayer for us, that for the gift [bestowed] upon us by the means of many persons thanks may be given by many on our behalf. 2 Corinthians 1:8-11

Once you know what a sovereign mindset is, you can easily see it in the these two previous quotes. But this sovereign mindset just leaps out from the pages in the following quotes.

- For this cause I Paul, the **prisoner of Jesus Christ** for you Gentiles, Eph 3:1
- I therefore, the **prisoner of the Lord**, implore you to walk worthy of your Christian calling. Eph 4:1
- So that my **bonds in Christ** are manifest in all the palace, and in all other [places]. Php1:13
- Don't be ashamed of the testimony of our Lord, nor of me **his prisoner**: but share also in the afflictions of the gospel according to the power of God; 2Ti 1:8
- Paul, a **prisoner of Jesus Christ**, and Timothy [our] brother, unto Philemon our dearly beloved, and fellow laborer, Phm 1:1
- Yet for love's sake I rather implore you, being such an one as Paul the aged, and now also a **prisoner of Jesus Christ**. Phm 1:9

Paul don't you have that wrong? Aren't you a prisoner of the Roman empire? Why do you say a prisoner of Jesus Christ. What a strange way to make your point! It is all in how you see it. Yes, Paul was a prisoner of the Roman Empire. But no matter what they intended, Paul knew God would use it for God's purposes. For you see, You Paul operated under a sovereign mindset?

Definition A <u>sovereign mindset</u> is a way of viewing life's activities so as to see and respond to God's purposes in them.

Remember, a mindset is a 1. A fixed mental attitude or disposition that predetermines a person's responses to and interpretations of situations. Paul had a fixed mental attitude toward the things that happened to him. He saw God in them. Or as he says in 2Ti 3:11, "...out of them all God worked."

God was sovereignly and providentially working through all of life's circumstances to shape Paul, guide him, and make him the great leader he became. Four keys to Paul's sovereign mindset include:

1. Paul recognized God's hand in life happenings—no matter who or what the immediate cause.
2. Paul submitted to God's deeper purposes in life happenings.

3. Paul learned and used the lessons derived from these life happenings.
4. Paul shared those lessons (and God's provision in them) with others.

His deep experiences with God were at the heart of the spiritual authority he had with followers.

Let me come back to the two passages I first cited as indicating a sovereign mindset. I want to draw out some leadership observations that directly apply to Christian leaders.

From 2Co 1:3-7:

1. God will meet us in deep processing.
2. We are helped in order to help.
3. Deep processing tests our own value in the sufficiency of Christ.
4. Our own development through processing gives us hope that our followers can also know the sufficiency of Christ in their deep processing.

From 2Co 1:8-11

1. We really trust in God when we come to the end of our own resources.
2. Deep processing is meant to be shared.
3. Deep processing shared brings partnership in prayer.
4. God receives much more praise when our situation is solved.

A leader with a sovereign mindset recognizes that at the heart of all God's shaping activities is the idea that processing is never just for himself/herself alone. We as leaders are shaped by critical incidents and shaping activities for our development, yes! But our processing is also for our followers. It is this confidence in God's meeting us in deep processing that gives us confidence in His sufficiency. And a by-product of that confidence is spiritual authority, the dominant power base of a Christian leader.

Stated as a leadership value, the sovereign mindset strikingly challenges us.

Value **Leaders Ought To See God's Hand In Their Circumstances As Part Of His Plan For Developing Them As Leaders.**

Paul had a sovereign mindset. He kept it till the end. It was one of the secrets of his finishing well. This leadership value is fundamental to a Christian view of the development of a leader.

Becoming A Catalyst By
Unlocking Your Spiritual Giftedness

Adapted By: Luis Bush

For further study read *Unlocking Your Giftedness—What Leaders Need To Know To Develop Themselves and Others* by J. Robert Clinton and Richard W. Clinton published by Barnabas Publishers 1993, 1998. I am indebted to Bobby Clinton for this material which I have culled, slightly modified and re-organized for purposes of this course. Any further personal references in the material are made by Bobby Clinton.

I. Motivation to Unlock Your Giftedness

Ministry flows out of beingness. Beingness describes the inner life of a person and refers to intimacy with God, character, personality, giftedness, destiny, values drawn from experience, gender influenced perspectives. The axiom, ministry flows out of being means that one's ministry should be a vital outflow from these inner beingness factors. Giftedness is a strong factor in beingness.

When Christ Calls Leaders To Christian Ministry He Intends To Develop Them To Their Full Potential. Each Of Us In Leadership Is Responsible To Continue Developing In Accordance With God's Processing All Our Lives.

Christians are stewards of the talents, treasure and time God has given them. Stewardship values which relate to giftedness include:

1. Leaders ought to build upon abilities, skills, and gifts to maximize potential and use for God.
2. Leaders should recognize that they will be uniquely gifted both as to gifts and the degree to which the gift can be used effectively.
3. Leaders should know that they will receive rewards for their productivity and for zealously using abilities, skills, gifts, and opportunities for God.

II. Nature of/Components of Giftedness

God endows a leader with natural abilities and later spiritual gifts. Along the way leaders pick up acquired skills. Together they become the giftedness set.

Defining Giftedness

Definition The giftedness set describes natural abilities, acquired skills, and spiritual gifts which a leader has as resources to use in ministry. Sometimes shortened to giftedness.

Development Giftedness Set

God endows a leader with natural abilities and later spiritual gifts. Along the way leaders pick up acquired skills.

A leader can not develop natural abilities. These are givens, innate with their personhood. Though a leader may discover some latent natural ability later in life due to circumstances of ministry. Can a leader develop a spiritual gift? The answer is not certain from Biblical evidence. But certainly a leader can develop acquired skills and can develop synergizing issues related to spiritual gifts.

Definition Development of a leader means an increase in efficiency and effectiveness in ministry due to addition of skills or other issues which enhance the leader's use of natural abilities, acquired skills, or spiritual gifts in ministry.

My research studies show that leaders develop their giftedness due to programmatic means (designed training), happenstance (day-to-day learning in the normal course of life's activities and processes), and by deliberate development (disciplined self-initiated learning).

Deliberate development takes place through formal or informal apprenticeships or other mentoring relationships, personal growth projects, and/or some identified plan of growth. Deliberate development ought to be the norm for a leader who has a developmental bias.

Studies into each of the leadership gifts[3] (Apostleship, Pastoral, Evangelism, Teacher, Prophecy, Exhortation) from a developmental perspective have resulted in numerous suggestions for development for each of the gifts.

[3] These are the primary gifts in the Word Cluster. All leaders have at least one of these words gifts and usually are multi-gifted.

Comparative studies resulted in a time-line which describes how the process develops over time. Figure 1 shows this.

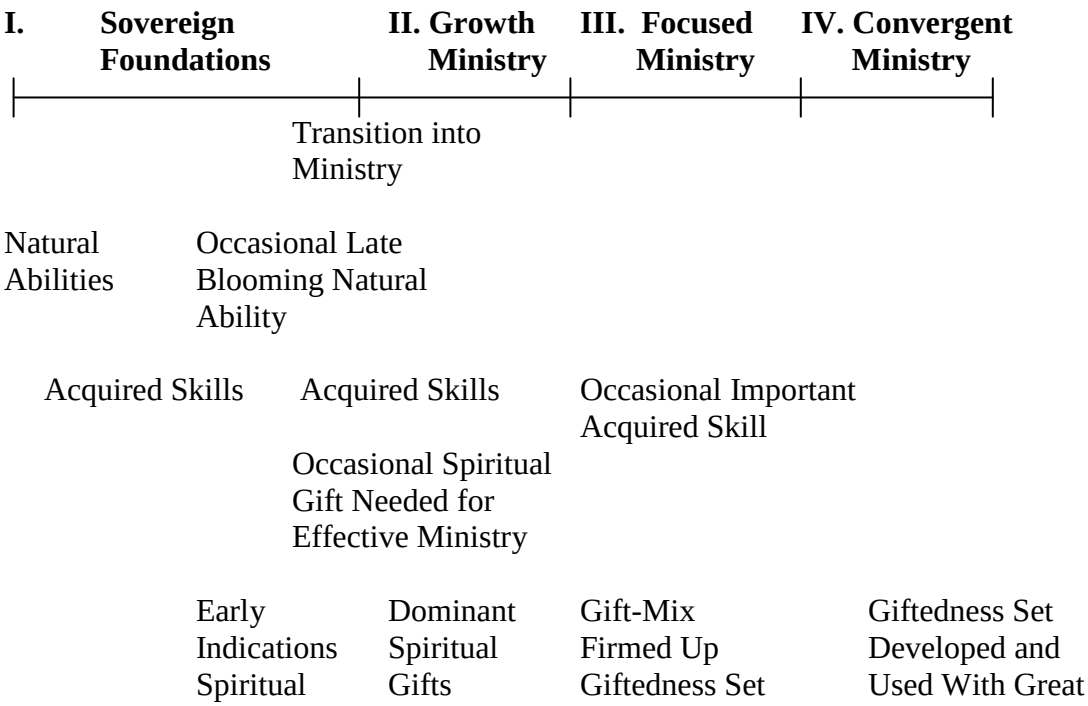


Figure 1. Giftedness Development Over Time

As the giftedness set begins to emerge, a leader soon finds that one component of the set dominates the others. The other two components supplement or synergize with the dominant element.

Definition The dominate component of a giftedness set—either natural abilities, acquired skills, or spiritual gifts is called the <u>focal element</u>.

About 50% of leaders studied in the research have spiritual gifts as focal. Another 35% have natural abilities as focal. About 15% have acquired skills as focal. This is important self-knowledge for a leader who wants to develop and wants ministry to flow out of beingness.

It is toward the notion of giftedness set developed and used effectively that I am talking when I say that Christ intends to develop a leader to full potential.
Leaders can develop over a lifetime. It happens. But with an awareness of how development can happen, a leader can much more efficiently develop, when self-knowledge and self-initiative are taken.

II. Spiritual Gifts and Giftedness

All Christians have at least one spiritual gift. In this major section unlocking spiritual giftedness the meaning, categories, list, development, identification and display of spiritual gifts are reviewed.

A. Meaning of Spiritual Gift

Definition A spiritual gift is a *God-given* unique capacity imparted to each believer for the purpose of releasing a Holy Spirit empowered ministry via that believer.

While this is true for the body in general, leaders usually are multi-gifted. Over their time of ministry experience, at any one given time, they will repeatedly exercise a combination of gifts. The set of gifts that a leader is demonstrating at any given time is important. It has a special label

Definition A gift-mix is a label that refers to the set of spiritual gifts being used by a leader at any given time in his/her ministry.

The identification of clusters of gifts that did those functions followed as did the actual naming of them as **WORD**, **POWER**, and **LOVE** clusters. This identification of clusters led to the correlation between Word gifts and leadership. *All leaders we had studied always had at least one word gift in their gift-mix; many had more than one*. This idea is a powerful implication for the selection and development of leaders.

The notion of spiritual gift clusters provides a special perspective, in fact a tool, that can aid strategic planning for a corporate group.

B. Spiritual Gift Clusters

The three categories or clusters of spiritual gifts are the Word, Power, and Love clusters. In learning theory, educational technologists describe four learning domains that must be addressed for learning to become habitual. There is cognition, that is ideas, knowledge and the like. There is affective learning, that is feelings which become associated with values. Then there must be conative learning, that is willful decisions to enter in and use the truth. Finally there is experiential learning--learning which integrates cognitive, affect, and conative all into daily life.

The three clusters of gifts, word, power, and love, focus on different aspects of these learning domains. The word cluster primarily addresses the cognitive domain, with some attention to the will, and a minimum to the affective domain. The power cluster focuses on the experiential and volitional domains. The love cluster dominantly affects the experiential and affect domains. Taken together these clusters affect all the domains of learning and help us to integrate our experience with God.

These three clusters called power gifts, word gifts and love gifts and are described and illustrated as follows.

Description Power gifts demonstrate the authenticity, credibility, power and reality of the unseen God.
Examples Miracles, kinds of healings, word of knowledge

Description Love gifts are manifestations attributed to God through practical ways that can be recognized by a world around us which needs love. They demonstrate the reality of relating to this God.
Examples Mercy, helps, pastoring

Description Word gifts clarify the nature of this unseen God and what He expects from His followers. People using these gifts both communicate about God and for God.
Examples Exhortation, teaching, prophecy

Below in Figure 2, given in pictorial form,[4] are the three clusters, along with the individual gifts that aid these functions. Notice some gifts operate in more than one cluster.

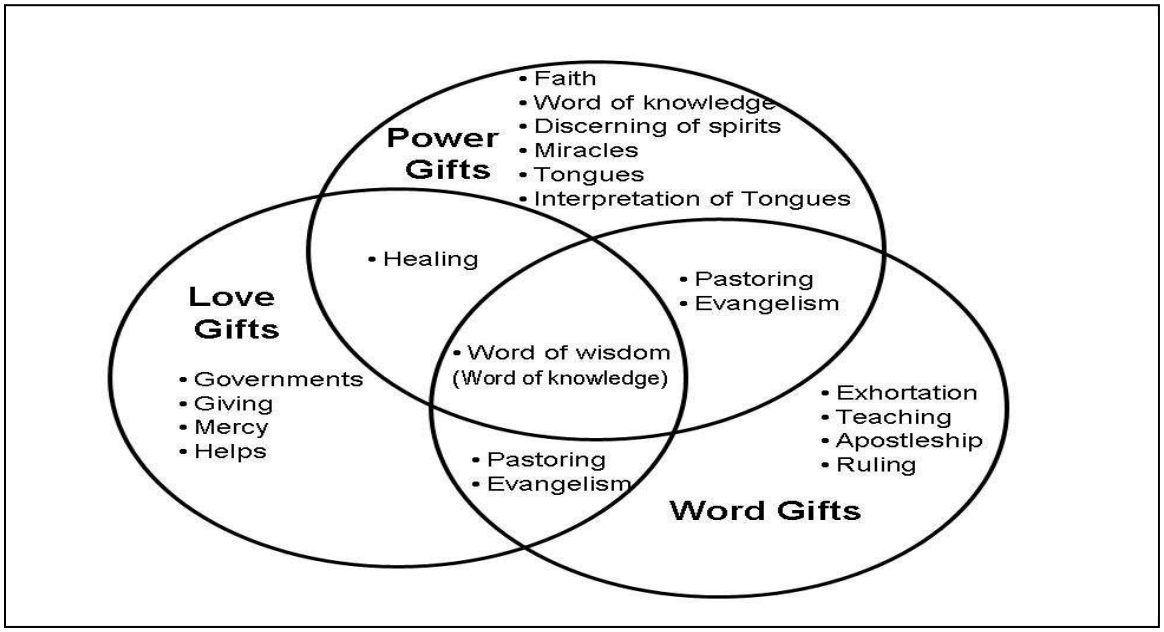


Figure 2. Power, Love And Word Gifts Pictured

[4] This is technically called a Venn diagram. All of the gifts listed in a circle belong to that circle. Where there is overlap, it means that the gifts in the overlap belong to both circles involved in the overlap (or all three circles as the case may be).

Love Cluster Introduction The love cluster is a very necessary group of gifts. Work will not be carried out and needs in the body will not be met if these gifts are not operating.

Gifts = governments, giving, mercy, helps, pastoring, evangelism, healing, word of wisdom, word of knowledge. These all demonstrate the beauty of that unseen God's work in lives in such a way as to attract others to want this same kind of relationship.

Affirmation Strong leaders need to counteract their natural tendency to project their own dominant word gifts on others. They especially must see to it that people with love gift clusters get the affirmation they deserve and sense fulfillment out of these gifts.

Word Cluster Introduction The following are miscellaneous remarks concerning the word gift cluster. All leaders have at least one word gift in his/her gift-mix.

Gifts = exhortation, teaching, apostleship, ruling, prophecy, faith, pastor, evangelism, word of wisdom, word of knowledge[5]. These all help us understand about this God including His nature, His purposes and how we can relate to Him and be a part of His purposes.

Power Cluster Introduction If the power cluster is absent what is missed? The central thrust of the vacuum power gift cluster--to know firsthand the reality of God. We can know cognitively (a theoretical belief). But the power cluster pushes us to an experientially reality of God. People who experience God's working via the power cluster have radically different paradigms for viewing reality than people who deny them. In leadership emergence theory, we have noted the concept of a paradigm shift, one of God's breakthrough processes for transforming a leader and infusing new life into his/her ministry. Power experiences stimulate such paradigm shifts.

Risk. Normally when we exercise word gifts (prophecy excluded) and love gifts and there is no threat, no risk, or no assessment of how we did. But with every power gifts one of the power gifts it is always a risky venture. Awareness of the supernatural involvement is high, on the part of all, the one exercising the gift and the ones receiving the ministry. And there is always the fear that what we do may not be genuine, may not be of

[5]Prophecy is a power cluster gift as well but we include it here since it is grouped with the Ephesian leadership gifts. We place the ruling gift here since it is a local leadership gift and we have already noted that leadership gifts will relate to the word of God. We could have included it in the love cluster because in the final essence it is dominantly a service gift. All leaders in using their giftedness with the body will be responsible to the truth of the word. Some will more directly use the word than others. But for all it will serve as the authority for their ministry.

God. Will God work? Your belief in God, view of God, convictions, and reputation are on the line when you exercise these gifts. It would be safer not to exercise these gifts or to allow them to be used in our situations. But each time we do and we sense again the fresh touch and reality of God we know that we must take the risks. We should not think that our exercise of the gifts must be ideal. We should not expect any more perfect use of these gifts than we do of any other--say teaching. We allow teachers to be less than perfect in their insights and interpretations. We can do no less for the power gifts.

Gifts = faith, word of knowledge, discernings of spirits, miracles, tongues, interpretation of tongues, healing, word of wisdom, prophecy. These all help demonstrate the reality of the unseen God[6].

The Notion of Balance

Balance describes a proper relationship between manifestations of love, word, and power clusters operating in a given context so that God's witness in that situation can be adequate. Balance does not mean equality or equal amounts of gifts. Balance means having the appropriate mix of word, power, and love gifts for God to accomplish His purposes through the individual or a group to the people of its geographic area.

C. List of Spiritual Gifts by Cluster

There are nineteen gifts listed. We will give a definition along with the central thrust of using each gift. We will group the gifts in terms of word, power and love clusters.
We don't ask you to necessarily agree with our definitions. You may need to modify them to fit your own understanding. But we do ask you to at least understand our definitions and where we are coming from. With that in mind, by the time you complete this section you will be able,

- to give the central thrust of each of the 19 definitions,
- to be familiar enough with our definitions to recognize them,
- to recognize a given gift if we give you the symptoms for it.

The 7 Word Cluster Gifts

Teaching A person who has the gift of teaching is one who has the ability to instruct, explain, or expose Biblical truth in such a way as to cause believers to understand the Biblical truth.
CENTRAL THRUST - TO CLARIFY TRUTH

[6]We recognize that some of these power gifts also do word functions, at least sometimes: word of wisdom, word of knowledge, faith (occasionally), and tongues/ interpretation of tongues. But for the most part it is the demonstration of the reality of God that is usually carried when these gifts are exercised so we have grouped them with the power gifts.

Exhortation The gift of exhortation is the capacity to urge people to action in terms of applying Biblical truths, or to encourage people generally with Biblical truths, or to comfort people through the application of Biblical truth to their needs.
CENTRAL THRUST - TO APPLY BIBLICAL TRUTH

Prophecy A person operating with the gift of prophecy has the capacity to deliver truth (in a public way) either of a predictive nature or as a situational word from God in order to correct by exhorting, edifying or consoling believers and to convince non-believers of God's truth.
CENTRAL THRUST - TO PROVIDE CORRECTION OR PERSPECTIVE ON A SITUATION

Apostleship The gift of apostleship refers to a special leadership capacity to move with authority from God to create new ministry structures (churches and para-church) to meet needs and to develop and appoint leadership in these structures.
CENTRAL THRUST - CREATING NEW MINISTRY

Pastor The pastoral gift is the capacity to exercise concern and care for members of a group so as to encourage them in their growth in Christ which involves modeling maturity, protecting them from error and disseminating truth.
CENTRAL THRUST - CARING FOR THE GROWTH OF FOLLOWERS.

Evangelism The gift of evangelism in general refers to the capacity to challenge people through various communicative methods (persuasion) to receive the Gospel of salvation in Christ so as to see them respond by taking initial steps in Christian discipleship.
CENTRAL THRUST-INTRODUCING OTHERS TO THE GOSPEL.

Ruling A person operating with a ruling gift demonstrates the capacity to exercise influence over a group so as to lead it toward a goal or purpose with a particular emphasis on the capacity to make decisions and keep the group operating together.
CENTRAL THRUST-INFLUENCING OTHERS TOWARD VISION

The 8 Power Cluster Gifts

Word of wisdom The word of wisdom gift refers to the capacity to know the mind of the Spirit in a given situation and to communicate clearly the situation, facts, truth or application of the facts and truth to meet the need of the situation.
CENTRAL THRUST-APPLYING REVELATORY INFORMATION

Word of knowledge The word of knowledge gift refers to the capacity or sensitivity of a person to supernaturally perceive revealed knowledge from God which otherwise could not or would not be known and apply it to a situation.
CENTRAL THRUST - GETTING REVELATORY INFORMATION

Faith The gift of faith refers to the unusual capacity of a person to recognize in a given situation that God intends to do something and to trust God for it until He brings it to pass.
CENTRAL THRUST - A TRUSTING RESPONSE TO A CHALLENGE FROM GOD.

Gifts of healings The gifts of healings refers to the supernatural releasing of healing power for curing all types of illnesses.
CENTRAL THRUST - RELEASING GOD'S POWER TO HEAL.

Workings of powers The workings of powers, gift of miracles, refers to the releasing of God's supernatural power so that the miraculous intervention of God is perceived and God receives recognition for the supernatural intervention.
CENTRAL THRUST - THE RELEASING OF GOD'S POWER TO GIVE AUTHENTICITY.

Discernings of spirits The discernings of spirits gift refers to the ability given by God to perceive issues in terms of spiritual truth and to know the fundamental source of the issues and to give judgment concerning those issues; this includes the recognition of the spiritual forces operating in the issue.
CENTRAL THRUST - A SENSITIVITY TO TRUTH AND ITS SOURCE.

Tongues The gift of tongues refers to a spontaneous utterance of a word from God in unknown words (to the individual giving the word) to a group of people.
CENTRAL THRUST - SPEAKING A MESSAGE IN AN UNKNOWN TONGUE.

Interpretation of tongues The gift of interpretation of tongues refers to the ability to spontaneously respond to a giving of an authoritative message in tongues by interpreting this word and clearly communicating the message given.
CENTRAL THRUST - INTERPRETING A MESSAGE GIVEN IN TONGUES.

The 4 Love Cluster Gifts

Gifts of governments The gifts of governments involves a capacity to manage details of service functions so as to support and free other leaders to prioritize their efforts.
CENTRAL THRUST - SUPPORTIVE ORGANIZATIONAL ABILITIES.

Giving The gift of giving refers to the capacity to give liberally to meet the needs of others and yet to do so with a purity of motive which senses that the giving is a simple sharing of what God has given to you.
CENTRAL THRUST - A SENSITIVITY TO GOD TO CHANNEL HIS RESOURCES TO OTHERS.

Mercy The gift of mercy refers to the capacity to both feel sympathy for those in need (especially the suffering) and to manifest this sympathy in some practical helpful way with a cheerful spirit so as to encourage and help those in need.
CENTRAL THRUST - THE EMPATHETIC CARE FOR THOSE WHO ARE HURTING.

Gifts of helps The gifts of helps refers to the capacity to unselfishly meet the needs of others through very practical means.
CENTRAL THRUST - THE ATTITUDE AND ABILITY TO AID OTHERS IN PRACTICAL WAYS.

D. Identification of Spiritual Gifts

III. Natural Abilities and Giftedness

Introduction Our understanding of God's sovereignty recognizes that God gives each person a set of natural abilities. Remember that ministry flows out of beingness. Beingness describes the inner life of a person and refers to intimacy with God, character, personality, giftedness, destiny, values drawn from experience, gender influenced perspectives. The axiom, ministry flows out of being means that one's ministry should be a vital outflow from these inner beingness factors. Natural abilities are a strong factor in beingness.

Definition *Natural abilities* refer to those capacities, skills, talents or aptitudes which come naturally to a person and allow him/her to accomplish something.

Summary of Natural Abilities can be subsumed under four categories

Creative Abilities	**Cognitive Abilities**	**Physical**	**Dexterity Abilities**	**Relational Abilities**
Artistic	Attitudinal	Athletic		Leadership/Motivational
Drama	Intellectual	Strength		Communicational
Music		Stamina		Relational/socially sensitive

Comment When you are identifying your natural abilities for the giftedness set, there will be man natural abilities that you may have. For the giftedness set diagram, focus on the two or three most important natural abilities which are an important part of who you are. You will want to identify general categories of natural abilities.

Identification of natural abilities In our attempts to identify various natural abilities, we have developed several categories. The following list is not meant to be exhaustive but it is rather a representative list of natural abilities which have been revealed through leadership research. Go through the list and pick out the items that fit you best.

Detailed Natural Abilities Table

Creative Abilities	**Artistic**	1. Creative designing for art projects, painting etc 2. Implementing creative ideas 3. Painting, sculpturing 4. Strategizing or visualizing art projects
	Music	1. Musical ear 2. Good voice 3. song writing 4. Playing instruments 5. Organizing music
	Drama	1. Acting 2. Creating character personalities 3. Communicating through drama 4. Ability to memorize 5. Few inhibitions around people 6. Good stamina
Cognitive Abilities	**Attitudinal related Abilities**	1. Achievement oriented 2. An appreciation for diversity 3. Competitiveness 4. Desire for excellence 5. A disciplined approach to life 6. Endurance, perseverance, determination 7. Value towards faithfulness 8. Loyalty or high commitment 9. Self motivated 10. Sense of optimism 11. Task orientation
	Intellectual Related Abilities	1. Creativity in thinking and problem solving 2. Formal academic tasks were easy 3. Able to do self-directed learning 4. Good judgment 5. An inquisitive nature 6. Good intuition 7. Good memory for facts and statistics 8. Able to grasp overall perspective in situations
Physical Dexterity Abilities	**Athletics**	1. Good individualistic sports 2. Good in group sports 3. Good in movement
	Physical dexterity	1. Good with hands 2. Stamina and strength

Relational Abilities

Leadership/ **Motivational**	1. High sense of responsibility 2. Implementing and creating ministry 3. Organizing and planning office systems 4. Organizing and planning events 5. a persuasive nature 6. Good at completing tasks 7. Good vision setting, goal setting 8. Good at building teamwork 9. Able to inspire and motivate others
Communication abilities	1. Verbal abilities 2. Good at teaching 3. Good with visual communication 4. Good with written communication
Socially sensitive abilities	1. Compassion, empathetic, caring, gentle 2. Good with children 3. Able to be diplomatic 4. Good listener 5. Able to make friends easily

IV. Acquired Skills and Giftedness

Introduction Many natural abilities have counterparts in acquired skills. The major difference is the notion of it being innate versus a learned thing. Natural abilities can be seen in seed form early on in a life. It of course can be enhanced by analytical skills which build on the tendency.

Definition Acquired skills refer to those capacities, skills, talents or aptitudes have been learned by a person in order to allow him/her to accomplish something.

Summary of Acquired Skills

Creative Support Skills	Acquired Cognitive Skills	Physical Dexterity Support Skills	Relational Support Skills
Artistic Drama Music	Attitudinal Educational Support Skills Analytical Technical	Athletic Technical	General Leadership Special Leadership /Mentoring /Ministry /Prayer /Technical Support /Communication /Linguistic /Relational

Detailed Acquired Skills Table

Creative Support Skills	**Artistic skills**	1. Calligraphy 2. Art Design 3. Drawing 4. Painting 5. Organize composition
	Music	1. Playing an instrument 2. Voice training 3. Develop worship lading 4. Develop a musical ear
	Drama	1. Designing dramatic concepts 2. Speech articulation, projection 3. Improvise in situations 4. Learn to present a public presence
Cognitive Support Skills	**Attitudinal Skills**	1. Self-discipline 2. Time management 3. Personal goal setting 4. Ability to perceive, receive and obey orders 5. Generosity 6. Hospitality
	Educational and analytical	1. Bible skills 2. Reading skills 3. Critical thinking
	Support skills	

Physical Dexterity	**Athletics**	1. Strategizing 2. Concentrating 3. Adaptation 4. Perseverance
	Physical dexterity	1. Carpentry 2. Building things 3. Sewing 4. Weaving 5. Fixing things
Relational Support Skills	**Leadership/ Motivational**	1. Budgeting 2. Decision making 3. Delegating responsibility 4. Group dynamics 5. Organization skills 6. Writing proposals 7. Designing brochures 8. Goal setting for a group 9. Planning
Relational Support Skills	**Communication abilities**	1. Persuasion skills 2. Motivating others 3. Communicating new ideas
	Special Leadership skills	1. Mentoring: coaching, counseling, discipling, modeling, sponsoring 2. Ministry: Evangelism, preaching, teaching 3. Prayer: How to fast, how to use the Bible in prayer, how to lead conversational prayer in a group, laying on of hands for impartation o 4. Technical support skills: Management of office machines, fund-raising, basic business management

V. Developing Giftedness: Spiritual Gifts + Natural Abilities + Acquired Skills

A. How Leaders Develop in Giftedness

Introduction In this section, we discuss the issue of developing in your giftedness. By this point, you have identified and displayed your giftedness set. How can I develop to use my gifts more effectively? That's what this section is all about. We'll give some suggestions for development for each of the spiritual gifts.

What is development?

When we talk about development in the context of giftedness, we mean moving toward maturity. By maturity, we mean that a person is operating in maximum potential as it relates to his/her giftedness set.

Maximum potential is measured in several ways.

- First, a person operating in maturity in his/her giftedness does it in a Godly way. The character of God is revealed in all that is said and done.
- Secondly, the various elements of the giftedness set are operating in balance, harmony and synergistically. Each person's giftedness set is unique to him/her so maturity in this regard looks different for each person.
- Thirdly, a person operating in maturity in his/her giftedness bears appropriate fruit and is accomplishing the things that God has set out for him/her. The process of development involves anything that helps move us along in any of these three areas.

Many spiritual gifts writers focus on defining the gifts; a few in helping the readers identify their own gifts. We go a step further: know, yes; identify, yes; but also develop. The stewardship model and its values spur us on to be developing toward maturity in our giftedness. And we are to be proactive and deliberate in this pursuit.

When a person looks at his/her giftedness set, the question is: what can be developed? Can you develop a natural ability? In our opinion, no. Natural abilities are not developable. God had sovereignly given us our natural abilities. You can't sit down tomorrow and say, "I think I'll develop a natural ability!" You either have it or you don't. However, it is possible to discover some latent natural abilities and when you discover them it feels like you are developing it.

By definition, all acquired skills are developed and learned. Some acquired skills enhance our natural abilities. Some acquired skills enhance our spiritual gifts. This arena is an important one in terms of developing in our giftedness set.

Can you develop a spiritual gift? Many would say...no. We say...a qualified yes. We believe that you can develop (remember, moving toward maturity) in the area of spiritual gifts. Experience is a great teacher. If a person is oriented to learning from experience, then he/she can learn a great deal about the use of spiritual gifts in ministry. And it is definitely possible to acquire skills which enhance the use of spiritual gifts.

B. The Giftedness Development Pattern

Introduction: A spiritual gift is a unique capacity for channeling a Holy Spirit led ministry in and through the life of the believer. Wagner (1979) coined the term gift-mix to talk about multi-gifted people. How a gift-mix is discovered and matures as a gift cluster is the focus of this pattern.

Description The Giftedness Development Pattern refers to the process a leader goes through in moving from initial discovery of a gift to convergence.

Stages The pattern includes: (read ---> as "may lead to")

1. Ministry experience --->
2. The discovery of gift/natural abilities --->
3. Increased use of that gift/abilities --->
4. Effectiveness in using that gift/abilities --->
5. More ministry experience or new ministry roles --->
6. Which stimulates further discovery of gifts in order to meet new situation -->
7. Which over time eventuates in the identification of the gift-mix --->
8. The development of a gift-cluster --->
9. Convergence (maturity in giftedness).

Explanation: Gift-mix is a phrase which is used to describe the set of spiritual gifts a leader repeatedly uses in ministry. Gift-cluster refers to a gift-mix which has a dominant gift, supported harmoniously by other gifts and abilities. The giftedness discovery process item describes any significant advance along the giftedness discovery pattern and the stimulus (trigger incident) that brought the discovery. This might be an event, person, or reflection process. The repetition with increased clarity of this giftedness discovery process item is an important feature of the ministry phase.

Inclusive: The pattern actually refers to all elements of the giftedness set. The pattern latter stages refer only to spiritual gifts since most natural abilities and acquired skills are discovered or obtained in the early stages of ministry. As one matures in giftedness, the emphasis primarily involves the development of spiritual gifts or supplementary skills related to them.

If natural abilities are the focal element, then steps 5,6,7 most likely ability collapse into one step. In this step, acquired skills and spiritual gifts as focal are recognized as supplements which support the natural abilities.

Viewed pictorially the giftedness development pattern looks like the following.

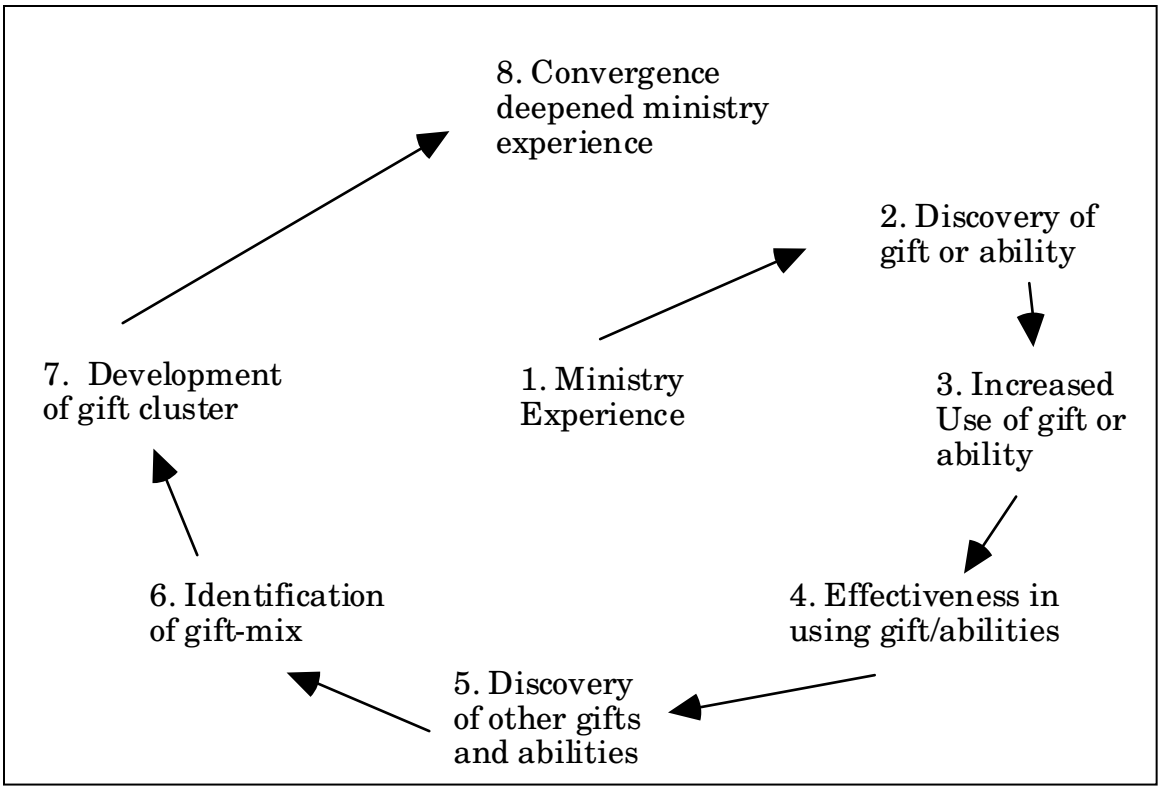


Figure 3: The Giftedness Development Pattern

VI. How to develop the Catalytic Gift: The Gift of Exhortation

Introduction The Bible contains much about the gift of exhortation. It is definitely a distinct gift and not just a part of another gift such as prophecy. It is listed in Romans 12 as a gift. The epistles are full of examples of this gift which imply that it was a very important gift in the life of the church.

Remember that the exhortation gift is one of the Word Cluster gifts. It is the primary linking gift to becoming a catalyst change-agent for God. It is a primary word gift since it deals so directly with using the Word of God with others. Each of these gifts all contribute to the major aims of that cluster which is

Word gifts clarify the nature of this unseen God and what He expects from His followers. People using these gifts both communicate about God and for God.

Whereas teaching focuses on *clarifying*, Exhortation focuses on *what He expects from His followers*. The gift of exhortation like the teaching gift is central to this Word Cluster thrust, for it motivates people to use God's truth. As you think through developing yourself for a more effective use of this gift always remember the central thrust to which it is contributing.

Before you work through the ideas for development, refresh yourself with the definition of the exhortation gift. Keep it in mind as you ponder the developmental suggestions.

Definition The gift of exhortation is the capacity to use Biblical truth to urge people to action, or to encourage people generally, or to comfort people with truth that meets their needs.

CENTRAL THRUST - TO APPLY BIBLICAL TRUTH

Certainty of definition We are fairly certain that is a strong definition. The definition comes from good Biblical data--word studies, and illustrations. Exhortation, with teaching and prophecy have the greatest certainty of all of the word gifts.

Comment There is a three-fold expression of this gift: admonition, encouragement, and comfort. There is the admonition aspect in which the person urges others to take action based on Biblical truths. This implies a strong application of truth and can come across as a type of correction. There is the encouragement aspect in which the person tries to lift or build others up by applying Biblical truths. There is the comforting aspect in which the person provides a measure of comfort to a hurting person as a result of applying Biblical truths to the situation.

Generally speaking, most people will start out stronger in one of the three aspects of this gift than the other two. The mature development of this gift will see all three aspects of the gift operating in harmony.

Symptoms Here are some common symptoms of this gift:

- people generally react strongly (sometimes for, sometimes against) what you say,
- you frequently find yourself giving advise to others to do this or that,
- you often find that you have a word to share with someone in need and the person receives it as a comforting word from God,
- people frequently confide their inner thoughts to you because they sense that you have an empathetic ear and they are comforted in the process,
- people like to be around you because you often cheer them up simply by your attitude or demeanor,
- you often sense an urgency to get something done and are willing to communicate that urgency to others,

- you love to share with anyone a truth from a passage of the Bible that means something to you,
- you are not satisfied with a superficial acceptance of truth but you want people to use that truth in their lives,
- you enjoy sharing stories about God's involvement in your life because you know that God can use it to encourage others.

Comment The gift of exhortation is the major way through which God allows the body of Christ to enable each other to live practical Godly lives and fulfill His purposes. Christians encourage one another to face trials by sharing what God has done for them in similar situations. Christians urge one another to take action in terms of applying Biblical truths. Christians encourage one another to have faith and be confident in God and the future. It is a gift that quite a few people in the body can expect to have and operate in.

Here are some areas to work in to develop in this gift.

8 MAJOR GUIDELINES

1. General Bible Study of Applicational Passages

STUDY REGULARLY THE PASSAGES OF SCRIPTURE WHICH ARE HEAVY IN APPLICATION.

Detailed Suggestions:

a. Your regular Bible reading program should focus on application passages. Your devotional life should focus on Scriptures which are applicational in nature.
b. Seek to apply these Scriptures to your own life. Write down your personal applications and note your personal obedience to God.
c. Be particularly sensitive to the Holy Spirit. He will quite often emphasize Scriptures which will apply to current situations around you.

Explanation

Exhortation is one of the foundational word gifts and demands that the person be immersed in the Word of God at a deep level throughout life. Every year new projects should be tackled. In particular, a focus on applying Biblical truth should be the theme of study. In order to get Biblical truth, much needs to be studied and learned from the Scriptures about how truth is applied.

2. Specific Bible Books and Passages Focusing on Application Skills

STUDY BIBLE BOOKS WHICH WILL HELP YOU BECOME SENSITIVE TO PEOPLE'S NEEDS.

Detailed Suggestions:

a. Read regularly in the Psalms and note:
   - The moods and changing experiences faced by people as they walk with God,
   - God's method of meeting men in these situations,
   - How you can use the various Psalms to bring comfort to those facing the same kind of situations.
b. Study Job to note:
   - How to and how not to empathize with those in suffering,
   - The stress on the sovereignty of God--this will be a foundational principle in comforting and encouraging people.
c. Study Ecclesiastes to see areas in which people seek satisfaction.
d. Study especially the Parables and Jesus discourses. In almost each of them Jesus is applying truth to real life situations.
e. Other passages that put special emphasis on the application of truth include: Proverbs, Romans 12-16, the book of 1 Corinthians, many of Paul's other epistles such as Galatians, Ephesians 4-6, Philippians and Colossians, the books of Hebrews and James.

Explanation

The more you are familiar with application of truth to life such as described in Biblical situations the more you will find yourself modeling what you have learned in life.

3. Apply Scripture From Memory

MEMORIZE VERSES WHICH WILL PROVE HELPFUL TO YOU AS YOU USE YOUR EXHORTIVE GIFT.

Examples:

Proverbs 9:8 10:17 11:14 15:28,31 17:10 20:5 25:11,12 26:4,5 27:5,6,9,17 John 14:26 16:13 2 Corinthians 1:3,4 12:9 Hebrews 10:24,25 James 1:22 and many others.

Explanation

Exhortation can have a powerful impact when truth which fits a situation is sensitively applied. When a person knows Scripture and get bring it to mind orally it carries great authority. Often the Holy Spirit will bring to mind Scripture that has been tucked away at a timely moment when it is needed.

4. Study Motivational Skills

DELIBERATELY ACQUIRE MOTIVATIONAL SKILLS.

Explanation
Exhortation because of its applicational nature deals a great deal with motivation. You should study communication skills which deal with motivation.

5. Linking Up With a Mentor

SEEK OUT A MENTOR WHO HAS AN EXHORTATION GIFT

Explanation
A mentor is a person who empowers you with God-given resources. In this case, the resources would be anything that relates to the gift of exhortation. People who operate in this gift in a mature way are extremely important as models. Watch how they exhort, how they communicate, how they are sensitive to the people they are exhorting, etc. Form a relationship with the person if you can and watch them in action.

6. Learn To Be Sensitive to the Holy Spirit

BE READY TO BE PROMPTED TO EXHORT BOTH IN SMALL GROUPS AND INDIVIDUAL SITUATIONS.

Detailed Suggestions:

a. Be alert to the Holy Spirit in small groups and one-on-one situations for promptings. He will call your attention to situations or problems to which He has previously given you help.
b. The experiences you face will be particularly used of God to teach you lessons to be used with others.
c. You will find that you are unusually sensitive to lessons learned from others' experiences also. You will also notice quick recall of verses, past experiences and principles from tome-to-time in your discussions with others.
d. Share these with others always in love and with the principles of Philippians 3:15, 16 in mind.

Explanation
Modeling is a dominant way that exhortation happens. God will teach you lessons which He will also use with and for others. You must learn to share your experiences when opportunities arise.

7. Exploit Opportunities

TAKE ADVANTAGE OF OPPORTUNITIES IN SMALL GROUPS AND THE GATHERED CHURCH TO SHARE YOUR CURRENT EXPERIENCES WITH GOD.

Detailed Suggestions:

a. Because of the nature of your gift you can expect an unusual sensitivity to God in everyday circumstances.
b. Your sharing of your everyday experiences will be used by God to meet others facing similar situations though you many not even be aware of their situation. Your sharing may involve critical timing for them.
c. Share in a God-centered way rather than an experience-centered way or a self-exalting way.

Explanation.
There is nothing that beats gaining experience in ministry situations. In order to get the most out of every situation, you need to get some honest feedback and do some honest evaluating of your exhortation efforts. Maintain a learning posture.

8. Self-analysis of Your Exhortation Gift (working on the weak side)

RECOGNIZE THAT THERE WILL BE GROWTH IN YOUR EXHORTATION GIFT OVER TIME.

Explanation.
As you begin to gain experience in ministry, you will probably notice that you tend to exhort others in primarily one of the three types of exhortation (either admonishment, encouragement or comfort). Most people with exhortation gifts either begin with a strong admonition bent or a comfort bent. The admonition types are usually confrontive. The comfort types are those who seek peace. Over time God will move you toward picking up some of the other thrusts. For example, those people that start out dominant in admonishing and correction will usually mellow somewhat in their abrasive nature (via shaping processes of God) and move toward the encouragement thrust of exhortation. Those with the comfort thrust will become more active in moving the people to action. They move toward the encourage thrust also. So a good general rule is to set up some growth projects which will focus you on developing exhortation skills in your weaker areas.

TABLE OF PASSAGES: FOCUS ON APPLICATION OF TRUTH TO LIFE

Introduction For each passage be alert for truth for your current situation.

Books or Passages	As You Read or Study You Should Focus on:
Proverbs	• practical advice for all kinds of daily living, • verses telling how to give advice.

Parables and Jesus' other Discourses	• various central truths taught by each parable, most of these are • fundamental principles of Christianity, • Jesus' method in applying truth to situations, • the thrust of Jesus' exhortation: whether admonition, encouragement, or • comfort.
Romans 12 to 16	• principles of interrelationships between Christians, • principles concerning disputed practices, • principles concerning government.
1 Corinthians	• The entire book illustrates Paul's approach to various problems. Note principles for applying truth to problems.
Galatians 1:6-10; 2:1-21; 3:1-5; 5:13-6:10	• intensity needed when correcting serious problems • importance of taking a stand if essential truth is involved, • fervor in admonishing and example of admonishing.
Ephesians 4:1 to 6:23	• examples of extortive teaching.
Philippians	• how to share from your present experience to meet the needs of others, • exhortations to unity,

Colossians	• examples of admonitions.
Hebrews 2:1-4; 3:7-4:13; 5:11-6:20; 10:26-39; 12; 13	• examples of admonition, the book contains cycles of truth followed by • warnings--note especially the corrective aspect in the warnings, • the importance of prefacing admonition by teaching.
James	• practical use of Scripture to life situations, • use and misuse of tongue, • description of practical wisdom and principles for applying it, • truth for current situation.

VIII. Steps to Display Your Giftedness

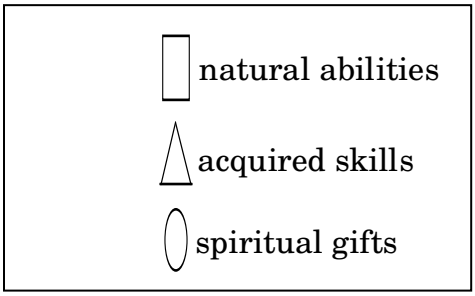
Introduction The final product in your display is the Venn Diagram along with a brief description of your primary gifts indicating the dominant spiritual gift, your acquired skills, natural abilities and focal element.

By now you should have identified the basic elements of your giftedness set. You should have the two or three top natural abilities, acquired skills, and spiritual gifts. In this short chapter, we are going to teach you to display your giftedness set using a Venn diagram. A Venn diagram is a pictorial diagram which uses symbols, spacing and sizes to communicate information. By the end of this chapter, you should be able to draw your Venn diagram and display your giftedness set.

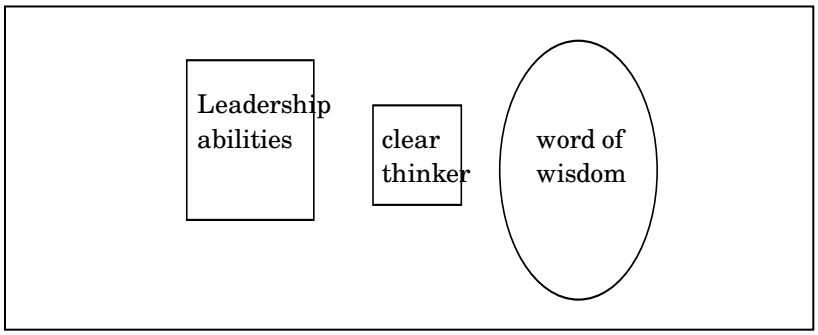
Explaining the Venn Diagram

This diagram uses three elements to communicate information.

Symbols: We use three different symbols to display giftedness.



Size: The size of the symbols is important. Bigger size denotes more importance. Smaller size denotes lesser importance. For example:



In this example, there are two natural abilities listed and one spiritual gift. The leadership abilities are being displayed as more important than the natural ability of clear thinking. The word of wisdom gift is larger than the leadership abilities and the clear thinking natural ability. It is the most important. The natural abilities next most important.

Spacing: Spacing is the most complex feature of a Venn diagram. When you space the symbols on the diagram you are showing the relationship between the symbols. If two elements of the giftedness set are seen as working together, they would be placed in such a way as to demonstrate the relationship. Overlap means that some of both occur simultaneously. Where there is no overlap it means that the item also occurs alone. The most important elements are the largest ones and are placed in the center of the diagram. For example:

Steps to Display Your Giftedness

Step 1: Gathering Your Data

At this point you should have identified the most important elements of your giftedness set. List them here.

Your Natural Abilities:

Your Acquired Skills:

Your Spiritual Gifts:
(List only your primary gifts)

Step 2: The Focal Element

Before you can actually start drawing your giftedness diagram, you need to decide which element is the focal element or the element that dominates your giftedness. Whichever element it is, you will make it the biggest. Occasionally there will be two elements which are equally important but this is not common.

Step 3: Determining the Relationships and Importance of each part.

Begin with the focal element. Determine how dominant each component is. For example, if spiritual gifts are the focal element, then look at your list of gifts and determine which one of those is dominant and make it the biggest. Then decide how the other gifts relate to that gift. When you overlap symbols the overlap area indicates that all the items that are overlapping operate together. Then move to the other two elements of the giftedness set and repeat the process.

Step 4: Begin Drawing Your Diagram

By now you should have assigned some degrees of importance and some degree of relationship between the various components of your giftedness set. Begin drawing and start with your focal element. Make the dominant component the largest and place it in the center. Then begin to add the other components according to the importance and relationships as you see them. It will probably take you two or three tries so do the first few in pencil.

Step 5: Get Feedback

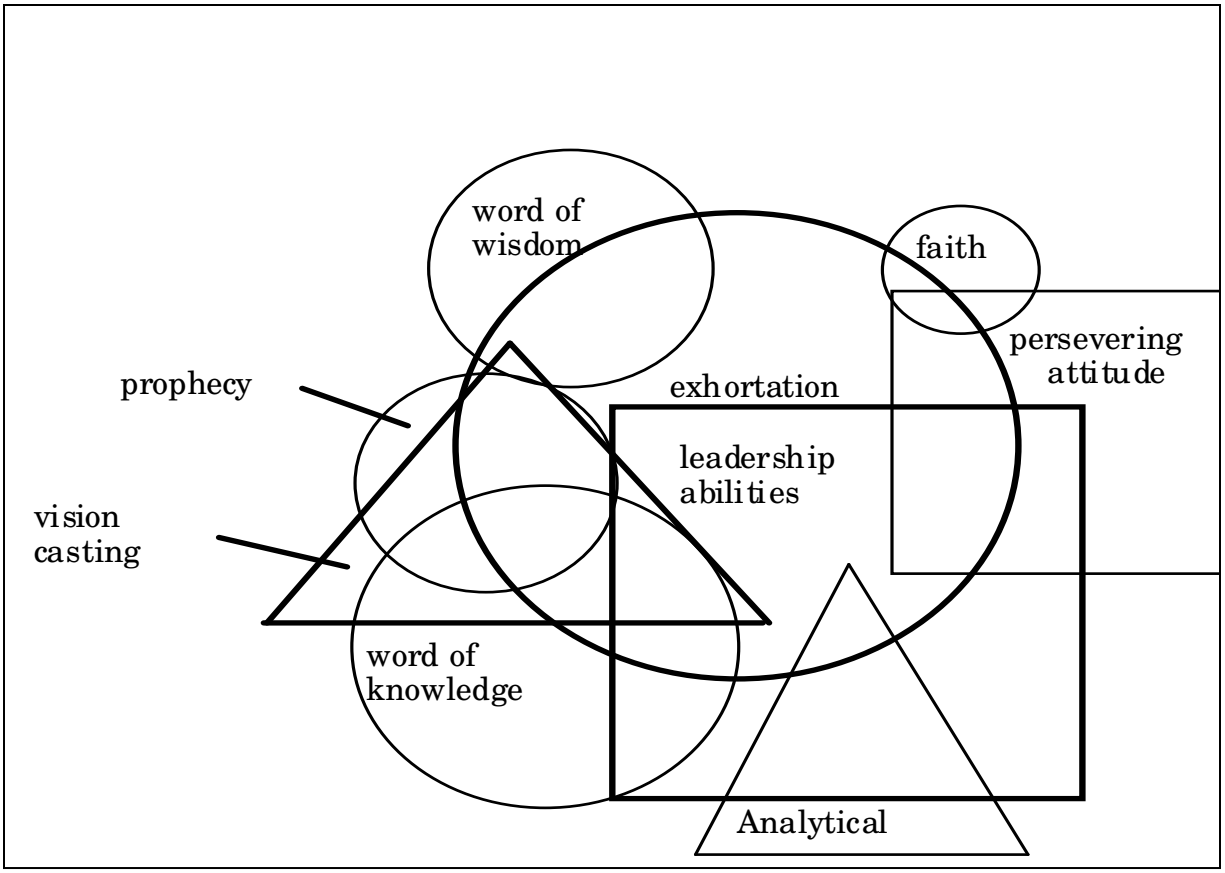
Once you have drawn a rough draft. Contact some people who know you and have observed you in ministry. Share your diagram with them. Talk through the relationships

of the various components and describe how you see the importance of each component. Get feedback. As you share the diagram and talk about it, you will see more or learn more. You may want to modify your diagram based on what you have learned.

Step 6: Prepare Your Final Draft

Once you have gotten some feedback, you can draw your final draft. Recognize that giftedness development is not static. Your giftedness set will change over the years as you grow and mature. From time to time, review your giftedness set and modify it as you see fit.

Example 1 of Giftedness Diagram--Leader A



Natural Abilities: leadership abilities, persevering attitude

Acquired skills: Analytical thinking, vision casting

Spiritual Gifts: Exhortation, Word of Knowledge, Word of Wisdom, Prophecy, Faith

Focal Element: Spiritual Gifts

Dominant gift: Exhortation

COMMENTARY ON EXAMPLE 1--Leader A

Background Leader A is a 34 year old male with about 12 years ministry experience. He has church planting experience and pastoral experience. He did research and writing of public presentation materials for an international leader. He has training design experience. He has done non-formal training in workshops, seminars, and conferences around the U.S.

Focal element

Lets be clear on terminology as we discuss these sample diagrams. When we refer to *element* we are speaking of the elements of the whole giftedness set. That is, natural abilities, acquired skills, and spiritual gifts. When we talk about an *item* we are talking about some member of one of those elements. In this diagram, two items stand out as larger than the rest: the leadership abilities item of the Natural Abilities element; the exhortation item of the spiritual gifts element. In determining the focal element the first thing you look for is the largest single item on the diagram. In this case two are equal. But a closer look at the diagram as a whole shows that a number of spiritual gifts are listed and cluster around the large exhortation item. It is this overall effect that would allow us to declare **spiritual gifts as the focal element**, closely followed by natural abilities.

Tightness

This is a relatively *tight* diagram. By **tightness** we mean a close-knit, focused diagram in which there is much overlap between elements and items. A *loose* diagram is one in which some of the items do not overlap much or are even away from the central focus of the diagram. Frequently, this means that the ministry tasks, ministry assignments or Christian roles probably have not enhanced the giftedness so that the loose element or item occurs generally outside the ministry context. One value of Venn diagrams is to discover this looseness and determine ways to tighten up the diagram.

Spiritual Gifts

In terms of spiritual gifts, exhortation is the **dominant gift** of the gift-mix. The total gift-mix is exhortation, word of knowledge, prophecy, word of wisdom, and probably faith used occasionally, notice how small and not tightly placed. The word of knowledge is obviously frequently used as the basis for exhortation--having a clear word from God on something adds authority to the exhortive ministry. Because we are keeping the clutter down, we don't show secondary or tertiary gifts. In this case, Leader A in the past has exercised gifts of healings, most likely a role enabled gift, while in a church planting ministry. During a period of 7 years in church planting and pastoral work he prayed for more than 5000 people for healing. But now that gift is rarely used. Discernings of spirits has been evident also.

Natural abilities

Leadership is a strong natural ability. Seeing it as a *dominant natural ability* and not a spiritual gift (ruling) probably indicates that Leader A exercised leadership during childhood and teens before recognition of spiritual gifts. Notice the importance of persevering attitude to leadership--what an asset!

Acquired Skills	Vision casting, the skill of organizing strategic thinking and motivating skills others with it, is an important skill. Note it overlaps almost entirely the prophecy spiritual gift. This means that a lot of the vision is probably based in revelation from God. But the acquired skill of vision casting means that he has learned how to frame the thinking and present it so as to promote it well and motivate followers toward it. The analytical skill has to do, for the most part with discerning leadership situations.

Becoming A Catalyst By Understanding The Reasons For The Catalytic Impact Of Mission Conferences

A review of selected conferences in the twentieth century provide some important lessons to be learned which are listed here. Conferences from the evangelical world were more successful in it than the Catholic or Ecumenical. Several facts emerged in conversation with Wilbert Shenk.

> Evangelicals kept up the momentum when WCC and the Catholics have subsided in the last fifteen years. The evangelicals have maintained the confidence of the lay people and managed to raise the funds for the events. Evangelicals have used conferences to create stronger unity."

There are several reasons that global conferences have a greater impact on world evangelization among which are the following:

1. Planners of every international mission conference face a tension in the purpose. "Shall the primary purpose be to inspire and educate for mission? Or shall the purpose be to study thoroughly and reach a new consensus on vital questions of mission thought and action?" The genius of Edinburgh 1910 was that it achieved both goals. The conference was the climax of an essential process of reflection (Thomas 1996:153).

2. A conference is more effective if it is part of a process rather than an end in itself. "The Edinburgh Continuation Committee, through follow-up conferences, stimulated the formation of missionary councils on national and regional bases, which became building blocks of the future ecumenical movement" (Thomas 1996:153).

3. A conference does not stand in isolation. Every mission conference is a part of historic line of events convened for the purposes of enhancing mission. "Any consideration of the future of the missionary movement must take into the factors that originally produced it (Walls 1996:258). Yet there are times to assess when a movement has run its course. "The missionary movement is now in its old age. It is not a useless and decrepit old age. There are situation where it provides the most effective…means of making any witness to Christ…But the conditions that produced a movement have changed…(Walls 1996:261).

4. A conference is more effective if it follows up with a continuation committee that carries the conference spirit and essentials around the world. This occurred in relation to Edinburgh 1910, the Lausanne conferences and the GCOWE events.

5. A conference which makes a catalytic impact on world evangelization understands and is able to articulate the significance of the historical context in which it is taking place. For example the IFMA '60 conference, at the close of the Congress a world survey overview appealed to the fact that the

world's population had increased seventy-five percent in the preceding fifty years and that most of increase had been among the underprivileged people (Percy1961:8). It also emphasized the need of the hour.

> You and I live in a world of turmoil. It is a day of drastic upheaval and unparalleled change. The fifty years which have passed since the Edinburgh Conference in 1910 have been the most revolutionary in man's history. The technical advance in man's ingenuity has brought the most remote nations to our doorstep… The speeding up of travel and communications ahs telescoped centuries into decades, years into months and days into hours (Percy 1961:7).

6. A conference needs to address the issue of appropriate structures for mission. Each generation of Christian leaders are to keep an eye on what God is doing in and through the Church, be prepared to reinvent their structures and find the appropriate *wineskin* to support those divine initiatives. In his chapter *on Missionary Societies and the Fortunate Subversion of the Church*, Andrew Walls observes the values of different kinds of structures. The voluntary association offers "…its instrumental character, its relatively recent origin, and its special structure…individuals, churches and congregations freely act together for an object of common interest. It is essentially a pragmatic approach, the design of an instrument for a specific purpose" (Walls 1996:242). On the other hand church structures "…could only do what they had always done; a new concept needed a new instrument" (Walls 1996:243).

7. A conference needs to watch its mission theology closely. We may well take heed to some of the last written words of Paul to one of his mentorees when he wrote: "Watch your life and doctrine closely. Persevere in them, because if you do, you will save both yourself and your hearers" (1 Ti. 4:16).

What the role of global mission conferences will be in the twenty-first century is yet to be seen.

> Is a new model of international mission conferences possible in the twenty-first century? Will it address needs both for inspiration and collective action--both for global unity and local autonomy? In this information age, new possibilities are emerging. Electronic networking and the sharing of information through the Internet make possible not merely rapid transmission of information before international conferences but also wide and deep discussion of issues before, during, and after them (Thomas 1996:154).

My own conclusion is that global mission conferences have had and always will have an impact on world evangelization.

21st Century Emerging Streams Of Mission

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Reflections: Emerging Streams of Mission

Luis Bush

Introduction

In the early hours of April 23, 2002, the compelling need to seek and identify emerging streams of mission as part of the World Inquiry process became clear in my spirit. That morning I wrote down quotes gathered from a number of people during the first nine months of the Inquiry process in a new journal titled: New Streams in the Desert. In reflecting on those words that morning, (see below) the need to identify emerging streams of renewal and mission led to the compilation of this compendium.

- "The Inquiry is focused on God's future action in the world what ever that may be."
- "We are at a new stage in the worldwide evangelical movement that deserves to be considered carefully."
- "The Inquiry should not be bound by too much structure within or without."
- "If the present structures in any way significantly influence the outcome, (pro or contra to their vested interests) you will negate the value of the whole process."
- "And no one puts new wine into old wineskins. The new wine would burst the old skins, spilling the wine and ruining the skins. New wine must be put into new wineskins" (Luke 5:37-38).
- "Most organizational structure is a monument to past effectiveness and not a good predictor of future success."
- "In this new century we will need new structures—and they will need to be discovered."
- "New structures may indeed be required to meet the new day in world evangelization."
- "Yes, there is resistance in some places but the Holy Spirit is challenging us to meet the future with a refocused vision and fresh energy. This requires new wineskins supple enough to carry the power the Holy Spirit wants to release into the body the world over."
- "In general, historically, churchly structures have had different agendas from mission structures, and tended to take over mission structures and diminish their action and effectiveness . . . this historical fact needs to be constantly remembered. So an understanding of history and a constant repetition of the importance of putting mission at the center of the agenda of both kinds of structures is essential."
- "Listen with your ears and spirit for what God is saying to his people."

Emerging Streams of Mission

From that day in April 2002 a key question in the Inquiry process became: What vital renewal movements, spiritual ministry initiatives or fresh streams of mission are emerging at the beginning of the twenty-first century?
This compendium is titled "Some Emerging Streams of Mission." Of the multiple emerging movements of mission observed worldwide only some were selected that resulted from a distinct process of observation. Of those selected most chose to include a brief report. In almost every instance emergence is defined as within the last twenty-five years. The majority of these streams have emerged over the past decade.

The authors of these papers were given ten guidelines (see Appendix IV-A) and asked to evaluate their emerging streams against the renewal characteristics listed below which came to be called the Pierson "renewal scale" (See Figure IV-1).

It became obvious immediately that an emerging stream of mission was rarely embraced enthusiastically by influential Christian leadership. In fact, often to the contrary, there was lack of acceptance and sometime resistance to the emergence of a new movement. One of the primary characteristics of a movement is that there *is* opposition, according to the research of L.P Gerlach and V.H. Hine.

Gerlach and Hine studied several major social movements in the twentieth century and discovered five common threads of commitment of individuals

- to personal involvement;
- to persuade others to join;
- to the beliefs and ideals of the movement;
- to participate in a flexible, non-bureaucratic organization;
- to endure opposition and misunderstanding[1].

Gamaliel left us a good example of how to respond to emerging streams in our day. He spoke to the secular leaders of his day concerning the new spiritual movement of Christians.

> ". . . consider carefully what you intend to do to these men. . . . Leave these men alone! Let them go! For if their purpose or activity is of human origins, it will fail. But if it is from God, you will not be able to stop these men; you will only find yourselves fighting against God" (Ac. 5:34-35, 38b-39).

From the vantage point of Church history there are lessons to be learned which can be applied to the present to identify the emergence of fresh streams of mission. They often

[1] See Gerlach, L.P. and V.H. Hine. *People, Power, Change: Movements of Social Transformation*. New York: Bobbs-Merrill co (1970).

provide hints about how God is moving through his people to fulfill his purposes in this generation.

In the process of consultation with Fuller Seminary's faculty of World Mission and two courses by Paul Pierson — the Historical Development of the Christian Movement and the History and Theology of Evangelical Awakenings — characteristics of movements of renewal and Christian advance were produced, as adapted below.

TABLE IV-1
Emerging Stream Self-Check Against the Pierson Renewal Scale

Author	Title	Renewal of 20
Aoun, Henri	Technology	15
Abraham, A	Vision 2010 UP Transformation Movement	18
Askildsen, T	NORWE – Restructuring for Mission in Norway	4
Baldandorj, M	Mission Movement in Mongolian Churches	19
Bendor-Sam.	Emergence of a Church in North Africa	16
Bock, Darrell	Progressive Dispensationalism and Mission	13
Botelho, D	The Radicals – from Latin America to the World	17
Campbell, R	Movement of African National Initiatives	19
Cedar, Paul	Lighthouse Movement in the USA	16
Cepeda, E	Church in the Marketplace of Latin America	11
Choudhrie, B	Empowering Women: Case Study from India	20
Claydon, D	Lausanne Committee for World Evangelization	12
Dalton, M	Messianic Renewal in Latin America	19
Dantas, Elias	Primary Health Care and Evangelism	16
De León, J	Renewal Movement among Hispanic Young	18
De Villiers, I	*Reaching Children at Risk in South East Asia*	17
Ezemadu, R	Two Thirds World Missions	18
Hamilton, D	Project 4K	20
Gupta, Bobby	Leadership Development for Discipling the Nations	16
Hashweh/Reid	United Family International	14
Jebasingh, E	Trans World Radio Networking in India	--
Johnson, Ron	Emerging Stream in the Persian World	20
Kao, John	Development of the Overseas Chinese Church	--
Kim, S	Church renewal in the Turkic World	18
Lawinson, R	Accountability and World Evangelization in Africa	18
Lee, Peter	Back to Jerusalem Movement from China	18
Li Hing, M	Association of Evangelicals in Africa	4
Medhin, Me	African Leadership Training in North Africa & Horn	15
Musekura, C	Rwanda: Lessons from the last 25 Years	19
Name	The Dalit Bahujan	14
Name	The Third Way Chinese Christian Revival Fellowship	17
Okuyama, M	Third World Missions Association	--
Perry, Cindy	Emerging Mission in the Himalayas	16
Pousson, Ed	The Antioch Effect in Singapore	18
Santoso, Iman	A Facilitating Ministry for the Movements of God	--
Shehadeh, I	An Emerging Stream Among the Iraqi people	18
Smith, John	Transformation in a Post-modern World: U.K.	12
Sterk, Vern	Christian Response to Persecution: Case Study Chiapas	N/A
Voth, Esteban	Kairos Community	17
Warton, John	International Business Professional Network	18

Yu, Danny	Mission Work through China's Front Door	13
Zwick, Rolf	Transformation as Mission in a Global World	--

Characteristics of a Renewal Movement as Questions

1. Is the spiritual/ministry initiative/ stream arising on the periphery of the larger ecclesiastical structure, that is, the institutional church?
2. Is it led by men or women of little status in leadership? Some may be ordained, some unordained?
3. Is it occurring in a context of political, economic, or social crisis?
4. Does it involve certain spiritual factors such as fervent prayer, a new experience of the holiness and transcendence of God, of our sin, and of grace?
5. Are there any unusual manifestations in some cases, including a renewed emphasis on the Holy Spirit?
6. Does it include elements specific to the context? e.g., unity in the Moravian movement, reconciliation in the Korean and East African revivals.
7. Is it counter-cultural to some degree?
8. Does it involve some degree of recontextualization, that is, in terms of the aspects of the gospel: which are communicated, who communicates, to whom, where, and how?
9. Is there a sense that distance is decreasing between God and humans, (paradox of the transcendent and holy God who comes near)?
10. Is there a sense that distance is decreasing between men and women in the movement?
11. Is there a sense that distance is decreasing between races, and social classes?
12. Is there a sense that distance is decreasing between Christian groups and denominations?
13. Is there a return to the study of Scripture?
14. Does it bring opposition from some as being non-conformist, too radical by Christians outside the movement, often in the traditional church?
15. Is there a heightened sense of spiritual warfare?
16. Does it to reach out beyond its normal constituency, to the poor and marginalized?
17. Does it lead to greater social concern and social transformation at the personal level, in ministries and to the poor?
18. Is there a flexibility of structure in the movement?
19. Is it leading to mission beyond the own social, cultural, and geographical contexts of the participants in the movement.
20. Is it messy, less than perfect?

Characteristics of Emerging Christian Movements

1. A drive for a deeper, more authentic Christian life usually on the part of a small group leading to a broader concern for changing society. As men and women go

deeper in their life with God then they hear the voice of God sending them out into the world.

2. They arise on the periphery of the larger Church usually in surprising ways through surprising people; often the leaders have no status in Church or society
3. Concern for the reform of the broader Church; often this happens to a degree but never totally
4. Mission movements always seem to come out of movements of renewal. The renewal of the church and its expansion are interlinked. Isaiah depicts the classic order in renewal movements.
5. Sometimes there appear to be logical causes underlying a fresh outburst of vitality. But many times it is inexplicable — except to say that God works in the heart of some key individual through whose influence renewal springs forth.
6. A characteristic of any significant renewal movement is that the distance decreases between clergy and laity and the gifts of the people are affirmed and the people are encouraged to use them. God works through all kinds of people.
7. Influence on the broader society and a desire for social transformation breaks forth with eventually a desire to reach beyond that society with the gospel to evangelize others.
8. Good renewal is the work of God resulting in a fresh outburst of Christian movements (new agencies) AND new vitality and expansion in modalities. Latourette repeatedly uses the term 'recrudescence' in describing a renewed vitality in the Christian movement. In particular, he uses it in connection with the proliferation of movements in the Christian infrastructure.
9. They always involve some significant re-contextualization, new ways of communicating, new people communicating, new places where the Gospel is communicated and new people who hear the Gospel
10. Barriers of race, social class, gender, clergy-laity, are distinctly lowered
11. One of the characteristics of renewal movements is disenculturation, i.e., loosing the roots -- the bonds of culture. Our primary citizenship is not in our culture but the Kingdom of God.
12. Leadership is often broadened, new people formerly excluded, come into leadership
13. Usually there is some theological re-discovery involved

The Relationship between Renewal Movements and Emerging Christian Movements

In a March 14, 2003 e-mail exchange with Dr. Pierson he observes the cause-effect relationship between movements of renewal and movements of mission. Mission springs from renewal.

In so doing there is an important lesson for us as we listen to our colleagues who represent or are giving leadership to some of the emerging streams of the twenty-first century. Let us be open to the unexpected people and movements through which God may be working in our time.

> "As we examine mission movements throughout history, one factor stands out above all others. Mission springs from renewal. As men and women have sought to go deeper in their life with God, they have felt His heartbeat for the world and the Holy Spirit has empowered and motivated them to leave places of security and comfort in order to take the Good News to those who have never heard it. In addition, as they have caught God's vision for the world, they have known how to communicate that vision to others. More often than not, the Spirit has initiated such movements through unexpected, surprising people, often on the periphery of the Church. This is both an encouragement and a lesson to us; encouragement, because it shows us that the initiative is with God, and we can trust Him, a lesson, because it tells us to be open to the unexpected people and movements through which God works in history. That is especially relevant today as a myriad of new movements, which do not always fit our preconceptions, are being raised up around the world."

Usually the boundary between renewal movements and streams of mission are indistinguishable. In a sense we are considering both types of movements in this compendium. However, authors have been encouraged to test the emerging stream they write about against the characteristics of the renewal based on the assumption that mission springs from renewal.

Movements should not be forced to fit into a particular grid. After all these are historical observations and we are learning more in our studies. However they are helpful. After doing the text John Warton wrote an email and commented: "I think this is very critical for missions now". (April 13, 2003).

The Categories of Emergence of Fresh Streams of Mission

There are various ways the emerging streams in this compendium were organized after collation and analysis of the reports that were submitted:

- Emerging Streams related to church planting (see Figure IV-2)
- Emerging Streams related to holistic ministry (see Figure IV-3)
- Emerging Streams related to leadership development (see Figure IV-4)
- Emerging Streams related to mission concepts (see Figure IV-5)
- Emerging Streams related to mission movements (see Figure IV-6)
- Emerging Streams related to mission structures (see Figure IV-7)

Author	Title
Abraham, Raju	Vision 2010 UP Transformation Movement
Bendor-Samuel, Paul	Emergence of a Church
Cepeda, Enrique	Church in the Marketplace
Jebasingh, Emil	Trans World Radio Networking in India
Kao, John	Development of the Overseas Chinese Church
Kim, Sam Seong	Church Renewal in the Turkic world
Name withheld	The Third Way Chinese Christian Revival Fellowship

Figure IV-1

Emerging Streams Related to Church Planting

Author	Title
Dantas, Elias	Primary Health Care and Evangelism
De Villiers, Ian	***Reaching Children at Risk in South East Asia***
Name withheld	The Dalit Bahujan Movement for Socio-spiritual Freedom
Voth, Esteban	Kairos Community
Warton, John	International Business Professional Network
Zwick, Rolf	Transformation: Mission in a Global World

Figure IV-2

Emerging Streams Related to Holistic Ministry

Author	Title
De León, Jeffrey	Renewal Movement among Young Hispanics
Gupta, Paul	Leadership Development
Medhin, Mesghina	African Leadership Training
Musekura, Célestin	Rwanda: Lessons from the Last 25 years
Shehadeh, Imad	Among the Iraqi People

Figure IV-3

Emerging Streams Related to Leadership Development

Author	Title
Bock, Darrell	Progressive Dispensationalism and Mission
Botelho, David	The Radicals
Choudhrie, Bindu	Empowering Women: Case Study from India
Hamilton, David	Project 4K
Lawinson, Remi	Accountability and World Evangelization
Rohland, Ray	Technology
Smith, John	Transformation in a Post-modern world
Sterk, Vern	Christian Response to Persecution

Figure IV-4

Emerging Streams Related to Mission Concepts

Author	Title
Cedar, Paul	Lighthouse Movement
Dalton, Mercedes	Messianic Renewal in Latin America
Hashweh, Victor	United Family International
Johnson, Ron	Emerging Stream in the Persian World
Lee, Peter	Back to Jerusalem Movement
Perry, Cindy	Emerging Mission in the Himalayas
Pousson, Ed	The Antioch Effect in Singapore
Yu, Danny	Mission work through China's Front Door

Figure IV-5

Emerging Streams Related to Mission Movements

Author	Title
Askildsen, Tore	NORWE: A Merger for Mission: Case Study for Norway
Baldandorj, Mojic	Mission movement in Mongolian churches
Campbell, Ross	Movement of African National Initiatives
Claydon, David	Lausanne Committee for World Evangelization
Ezemadu, Reuben	Two Thirds World Missions
Li Hing, Mario	Association of Evangelicals in Africa
Okuyama, Minoru	Third World Missions Association
Santoso, Iman	A Facilitating Ministry for the Movements of God within Society

Figure IV-6

Emerging Streams Related to Mission Structures

A Concluding Question: Tracking Emerging Streams

What may look like an emerging stream today may disappear. Some of these streams may change significantly from their appearance today. Many emerging streams were not seen and are not recorded in this compendium. Some emerging streams are about to appear yet are not visible at the present time.

Would it not be useful to track the emerging streams reported in this compendium over the next sixteen months and re-examine what happened to them in the final report of the World Inquiry at the World Evangelization Issues Forum in September/October 2004? Should we not be alert to identify and record other and new emerging streams over the next sixteen months in preparation for the final report of the World Inquiry?

Acknowledgment

The authors of each of these emerging streams have provided us not only with an opportunity to see and respond to some of the historic ways and means but also some of the new ways and unexpected means of "God at work" in our time.

All but one of the authors of these emerging streams is planning to be present at the World Inquiry International Coalition meeting in Korea, May 2003. Their bios are in Compendium I, Appendix IV-A. You are encouraged to get to know them and the stream they represent during the course of the consultation.

I want to thank David Greenlee who has kindly served as the collector and editor of the forty-three papers that tell the story of some of the emerging streams of mission at the beginning of the twenty-first century.

Technology: Both an Old and Emerging Strategic Stream in Missions

Henri Aoun & Ray Rohland

Human progress and the spread of the Gospel have always advanced hand-in-hand as Christians have been ready "users" of new technology to advance the Kingdom of God. However, the more we embraced the mass outreach solutions these new technologies provided, the further we removed ourselves from personal one-on-one contact with spiritually hungry individuals. Today, technology is no longer a tool but rather a strategic partner and a strategy that can be used to reach hundreds of millions with the Gospel and yet enable us to touch each life one-on-one.

Life Agape's Communication Center Strategy

Beginning with radio broadcasts into the Middle East and North Africa via the transmitters of partner ministries, our ministry outreach has expanded to include television programming and satellite broadcasts. Utilizing our own programs and materials, we have worked in partnership alongside many other media organizations (SAT-7, TWR, IBRA and others) to make the Gospel available to the half billion individuals living in our ministry area.

Our area director, Henri Aoun, saw the need for a comprehensive strategy to bring a personal touch to our broadcast-based ministry outreach. In 1989, the concept of a "Communication Center Strategy" was developed. This involved correspondence between our staff and interested individuals. Since the inception of this strategy, nearly 500,000 individuals have been contacted. During the last six months of 2002, 45,000 new individuals have contacted our ministry through this strategy. Forty-three percent of these individuals let us know about their interest through websites, e-mail or chat sessions.

Technologically-informed Seekers

As the number of individuals contacted grew from hundreds to nearly a half million individuals today, the volume drove the need to utilize database tools. The web was not even a factor for consideration in the original development of the Communication Center Strategy, yet today it is its fastest growing segment. Recently we have received the following notes:

- Could you send me books and material to understand more the bible and I prefer that will be in digital (electronic) format. RH
- Please send me a copy of the bible to my email because it's not easy to get Bibles in [my country] and my friends can't let me barrow [sic] their bibles. IA

The surprising aspect of these two contacts (from thousands received daily) is the technically savvy nature of their requests. They know exactly what they want and how they want it!

Merging Old and New for Personal Contact

As a result of expanding capabilities and the growing versatility of technology and communication tools, the "old" technologies of media and content provision are now merging with the new technologies in communication and information science to re-enable a personal touch with the individual. In many ways, we are now back to where we started from in the days of Jesus – the Gospel message is being taken by individuals to other individuals all over the world every day. This contact takes place person-to-person via chat sessions, voice chat, text messaging, or by video "conferencing" over the web in real time. It is two-way communication! It can involve the sight and sound of two people who will NEVER actually meet communicating heart-to-heart and face-to-face about the person of Jesus Christ.

The most significant advantage that comes from a strategy of technology-based outreach today is that we once again bring the Gospel and the follow-up of individuals back to a one-on-one basis while still utilizing the benefits of mass media and mass distribution.

There are two primary challenges, however, to the expansion, growth and acceleration of this stream. The first, of course, is financial. The second challenge is for churches, ministries and missions to develop and then retain qualified individuals with adequate technical skills and background. With the secular marketplace offering lucrative salaries and the "technology is a tool" mentality of most Christian ministries, many "techies" do not use their skills in missions. Unless addressed by changes in the "corporate" mindset of worldwide Christianity, we may find ourselves unable to compete or indeed function in this "New World" of technology because we lack the manpower to proceed.

Ongoing Innovation

Over the next several years our ministry will be upgrading and improving yet again our technological infrastructures. Newly designed software integrated with new and emerging communications technologies will enable our staff to more effectively keep in personal touch with individuals throughout the area. As the threads of technology continue to integrate, our ability to minister personally to individuals will grow at an even greater rate. Even as we distribute more information digitally and via mass media means, that message will become more personal and meaningful to the individual contacted.

The day has now arrived when the message being communicated by an individual sitting at his or her computer or media device has the same touch and feel to the person at "the other end" as to someone sitting at the feet of Jesus or Peter or Paul. Perhaps it is ironic that technology has become the strategic bridge to help us fulfill the Great Commission by reaching a mass audience yet doing it with a profoundly personal touch.

Contact: <jrrohland@aderes.net> (a secure email service)

Pierson's "Renewal Movement" Scale: 15/20

Vision 2010: UP Transformation Movement

Alex Abraham, Raju Abraham and Mohan Philip

Vision 2010: UP Transformation Movement is the God-given strategy to reach India's Uttar Pradesh state, with multiplying, reproducing, disciple-making house churches through a consortium of organizations and networks committed to the Great Commission.

U.P. is India's largest state with 174 million people (including Uttranchal). If U.P. was a separate country it would be the fifth largest nation in the world. The center of political control of India, it is also a state of utter poverty, violence, corruption and religious fundamentalism with the most powerful spiritual strongholds in India. In the year 2001, during the Hindu Kumbh Mela festival, 70 million people from all over the world came to the city of Allahabad to have a dip in River Ganges with the hope that their sins would be washed away.

Our Response

A massive prayer initiative was launched by several organizations with approximately 500,000 around the world mobilized to pray. Many did prayer walking on site. About seven hundred people from nearly thirty organizations distributed nearly 20 million pieces of literature in six languages.

As we prayed and sought the Lord, He revealed a systematic saturation church planting strategy to reap the end-time harvest in the next ten years.

The government administers U.P. through one thousand geographical units, with 100-125 villages and 100-150,000 inhabitants in each unit. Our strategy is to place two people as block coordinators (BC's) in each unit. BCs will

- systematically reach out to all the villages in the next ten years to plant house churches
- do systematic research and spiritual mapping followed by intercessory prayer walks, supplemented by national and international prayer coverage.
- identifying the "man of peace" and open his/her home as HOPE (Houses Open for Prayer). Stage-by-stage training is given to the man of peace until he is able to lead a house church, defined simply as a group of at least ten believers meeting regularly with at least a few baptized members. Each church should reproduce and multiply and make disciple.
- move on to new villages.

New believers are encouraged to attend our brief training program designed for them. Able men and women are trained as house church leaders in a twenty-one days training module. Potential BC's are identified from the new converts through systematic on-the-job training.

Achievements

- Half of the blocks have been activated with one thousand BC's
- Five thousand villages have been targeted, eight thousand house churches and thirty thousand houses of prayer started
- Monthly two to three thousand new believers trained under a three to five day program.
- Three thousand house church leaders trained under twenty-one day modules.

Participants

Operation Agape and Athmik Viaks Trust in collaboration with the North India Harvest Network initiated the movement in partnership with over fifteen missions and denominations. Partners include YWAM, National Prayer Network, Allahabad Agricultural University, Assemblies of God, Campus Crusade, Medical Ambassadors and several independent missions**.**

Surprises

The Lord brought together highly competent professionals with no theological background from various denominations to lead the movement

One church in the Allahabad Agricultural University with two hundred members now has an average of 15,000 attendance, an indicator of responsiveness.

The powerhouse of the movement has been already existing, independent indigenous missions which were in need of nurture, strategic development and encouragement.

Dreams and Goals

Our slogan is

- Every Believer a Disciple
- Every Disciple a Potential Church Planter
- Every Disciple's Home a Potential Church
- Every Church a Training Center

For 2003 our goal is

- 50,000 house churches
- 200,000 Houses of Prayer
- 1000 blocks to be adopted with 2000 BCs

And by 2010

- 1 million house churches
- 10 million believers
- 100,000 lay leaders

Biblical Basis and Key Conceptual Issues

We are committed to the Great Commission (Mathew 28:18-20), convinced that the Lord wants the task to be completed before his Second Coming (Mathew 24:14). Revelation 7:9 points to reaching every people group. The Book of Acts points to training and rapid release into ministry and Ephesians 4:11,12 to the fivefold ministry of itinerant teachers.

Further,

- A thorough effort should be done to complete the task with clearly-defined, achievable goals for every region of the country.
- Only on-the-job training can produce the large harvest force needed to complete the task with the balance of head, heart and hand content.
- Early discipling of new believers and intensive early discipleship training for all new believers will ensure quality of churches.
- Much of church planting follows power encounters following intense spiritual warfare and breaking of strongholds.
- A true Kingdom mentality enables people to partner wholeheartedly without fear of losing. It is the principle of partnership with performers.

Benefits and Problems

The fear of shallow Christianity in mass movements has been a great concern. We are making every effort through training and prayer initiatives to make sure that quality is maintained and the movement sustained.

We need to be men of faith who will take bold initiatives to see the task completed in our generation. We also need to see such initiatives in other regions in the Indian Subcontinent.

Resources: A VCD presentation and other materials will be available at the May consultation from the presenter.

Contact: Mr. Mohan Philip <avtnoida@cs.com>
Dr. Alex Abraham <alexagapeldh@cs.com>
Dr. Raju Abraham <maraju@compuserve.com>

Pierson's "Renewal Movement" Scale: 18/20

Unity in Mission and Evangelism: Renewing the Vision for Mission and Evangelism

Tore Askildsen

A New Vision for Mission

For many years world mission has been a very important part of churches and mission organisations in Norway. The Evangelical Alliance and the Lausanne Movement have had great influence on the churches in Norway, but we have seen a decrease in involvement and vision in the last few decades.

During the late 1990s a few mission leaders talked about how to change this and develop a new vision for mission within the churches and mission organisations in Norway.

We wanted to:

- Renew the focus on world mission and communicate a living vision for mission and evangelism.
- Combine this with the existing increasing focus on evangelism and church building in Norway.
- Reduce the number of committees and networks that were working alongside each other with almost the same purpose and almost the same members.
- Strengthen the fellowship among evangelicals in Norway.
- Secure a broader representation of people and churches in networks and committees.

New Structures

To make this a reality we needed some radical changes. Focus was put on the existing networks: the Norwegian Missionary Council, the Evangelical Alliance, the Lausanne Movement and the AD 2000 and Beyond Movement. These were all movements

- with almost the same basis of faith
- focused on mission and evangelism
- consisting of almost the same members (organisations, churches and individuals).

On March 1, 2000, these networks were closed down and a new and fresh church and mission based structure came into existence, the Norwegian Council for Mission and Evangelism – NORME.

Networks an Important Element

Right from the start a number of existing task-orientated networks were included under the umbrella of NORME. Among these networks are the Persecuted Church, Natural Church Growth, Willow Creek Norway, Mission and Theology, Tentmaking, Media, Prayer, and DAWN Norway. These are all autonomous networks, but with NORME as their central contact and reference point.

NORME coordinates this and makes sure that people from all churches and mission organisations are being informed about new networks and invited to join them or in another way (email, internet) stay in contact with them. These networks play a vital part in the effort to renew vision and make it become a reality for people on the local and national levels.

Renewal for Cooperation

"Time for Faith" was a project that most churches and mission organisations took part in. Our experience with this project showed us that there is a need for more contact, fellowship and cooperation in order to inform each other, inspire, learn and build relationships. This is more than cooperation about campaigns, which often demand more than they give and can create problems relating to whom you cooperate with, etc.

There is a growing awareness that we have to work together or alongside each other and join forces if we want to make a difference in the local society and on the global scale.

Churches and organisations want to build their own ministry, and must be given the chance and freedom to do so with full autonomy. But, by simultaneously developing relationships, sharing information and learning from each other we can build and develop our own ministry and visualise the unity in Christ.

Working together in such a way will contribute to the growth of His Kingdom in Norway and elsewhere and "let a thousand flowers bloom".

Focusing on what that links us together rather then what divides, and together focusing on the challenges we all are facing will be a great blessing to the Church both locally and globally.

It is possible, but it takes some effort, time and a change in attitude so that we focus on the important things that we have in common rather then less important things that might divide.

Pierson's "Renewal Movement" Scale: 4/20

Mission Movement in Mongolian Churches

Mojic Baldandorj

The oldest church in Mongolia is now over ten years of age. In the early 1990s, missionaries introduced the Good News of Jesus to Mongolian students they had been teaching English, and to language tutors they hired for learning of our local language. The result was the bursting movement of people to newly-established Christian groups that had never before been in the land. All of a sudden, many young churches mushroomed all over the cities, and thousand of young people turned to the Lord.

Today, there are over 180 churches established all over the country and over fifty Christian mission agencies have been involved in various kinds of ministries with a hope to change the nation for Christ.

Church and Mission Shaped by a Nomadic Mind

Mongolians are nomadic-minded people. They like to explore new things, new pastures, new land and are always on-the-move in their minds. Once the forefathers of Mongolians conquered half of the world on horseback, without sleeping or eating for many days. So, as the descendents, Mongolians easily pack up and move to another place. They are adaptive to any climate, lifestyle, culture or situation. By nature, they can cope with a hard life and tough conditions.

The nature of people shapes the image of the church. Most indigenous churches in Mongolia speak of a mission, sending Mongolians to the world. Although the churches are, probably, too young to think of mission, a Mongolian single and a family have been sent to the autonomous regions of Tuva and Byriat in Russia by the local churches. The missionary vision is the main vision for many young churches in Mongolia.

Mongolian Christians believe that they are obligated to take the Gospel to the nations their forefathers once ruled harshly. This time, instead of conquering the world with the e sword, Mongolian churches pray and cry for sending missionaries to those nations.

Mongolian United Mission Assembly (MUMA) is a new mission movement whose vision is to send Mongolian Christians to the world. To reach the aim, MUMA has the following objectives:

- to mobilize local churches for the world mission,
- to provide theological and missiological training to equip Mongolian missionaries for cross-cultural ministry,
- to send trained missionaries to their chosen destinations, and
- to support and administer those who are sent to the field.

Mobilizing Local Churches for a Mission

The primary calling of MUMA is to mobilize the local churches for the world mission. There are almost no mission books, magazines or information available in the Mongolian language. Although most churches have a heart for a mission, no mission education and mobilization has taken place among the churches. MUMA plans to translate many articles, and information regarding world mission and will publish a mission magazine in the near future. Also, MUMA is planning to run a mission conference in August or September to educate the churches about world mission. In mobilization, we include providing information, publishing a mission magazine, running conferences and seminars on mission, and regular prayer meetings for world mission.

Training Local Churches for a Mission

MUMA strongly believes that cross-cultural mission education is necessary for a mission. MUMA plans to organize two or three mission conferences per year to give vision to local churches and make them aware of the need of the world. It is very important to pass the vision to every member of the church so that the whole church, from children to adults, sees the same vision.

Apart from constant conferences and seminars, MUMA plans to open a school of mission soon to start training individuals for cross-cultural ministry. Without completing mission school and theological school, no one would be accepted as a missionary.

Sending of Mongolian Missionaries

MUMA has a vision of planting strong local churches, first throughout Mongolia, then Asia and the world. No one will hear the Gospel unless someone tells them about it. None will believe in the Lord, unless someone witnesses about Christ. So, MUMA has a real heart for sending Mongolian missionaries to the world. We do not have a fixed time to start sending missionaries, but we should prepare ourselves for the calling of the Lord. Soon there will be Mongolian Christians working in the field, witnessing about Christ among the unreached people groups.

Supporting the Mission Work

One of the essential parts of a mission is continual support for missionaries who are sent. MUMA will interact with different policies of current international mission agencies in regard to supporting their missionaries. We believe that local churches in Mongolia should be fully responsible for backing of the missionaries they send. It will need continual prayer support, words of encouragement and financial support for those who will work in the field

At present, MUMA is in the stage of forming the network. Five local churches have expressed their willingness to join the network. MUMA is preparing all necessary documents regarding the function, partnership and ministry of the network.

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Pierson's "Renewal Movement" Scale: 19/20

Birth of a Church
Paul Bendor-Samuel

B. Background

The indigenous North African Church was greatly diminished by the Arab Muslim conquest of the late 7th century. It completely disappeared as a by-product of the Crusades in the 11th -14th centuries.

Continuous mission activity over the past one hundred years has lead to occasional response leading to the formation of small groups of believers but these have not been reproducing and have never lasted many years.

Recently a new move of the Spirit has led to the birth of an autonomous, reproducing church in four of the five countries that make up the North African Magreb. These young, small churches are functioning in a way that suggests that they will endure and grow.

C. A New Move of the Spirit

In the 1980s a fresh move of the Spirit began amongst Algeria's Kabyle Berbers. The spark was the healing of a young man. Despite considerable opposition, within a few years a number of worshiping groups were established. These are now numbered at over one hundred, with a few thousand baptized believers. It remains a largely non-Arab movement.

Although slower, the church has grown in Morocco with groups now in all major cities. In Tunisia and Mauritania the breakthrough came at the end of the 1990s with a sudden and significant increase. Although smaller in numbers than Algeria and Morocco, the hallmarks of an authentic breakthrough of the Spirit are there to see:

- relatively rapid increase in baptized believers,
- new worshiping groups established,
- initiative increasingly from national believers,
- emerging national leadership,
- desire to reach out in mission.

D. Development of the NAP

As God was stirring the Kabyles, He was birthing the North African Partnership (NAP). Initially bringing together those engaged in radio, the NAP rapidly grew to involve all aspects of international mission efforts, reflecting the overwhelmingly international, rather than national church composition at the time.

As the Church has grown, so the NAP has changed to provide a space for NA believers and church leaders. This became a conscious goal of the Partnership at the end of the 1990s, expressed in several ways, including:

- A regional forum exclusively for NA church leaders in which they set their own agenda and develop their own programme.
- A regional forum in which NA leaders and internationals meet for shared worship, vision building and evaluation of church development and ministry. A key factor has been to protect the balance of nationals and internationals so that the former are not swamped numerically by the latter.
- Raising the visibility of national leaders in the main Partnership meetings. This delicate process has the goal to offer opportunity that recognizes existing capacity and encourages further growth. The Partnership has sought to live on the growing edge of capacity, giving opportunity for ministry whilst avoiding asking nationals to do what they are not yet equipped to do.
- The NAP Steering Committee is now predominantly North African, reflecting the belief that ministry partnership is predominantly taking place within the region and involving national churches, not simply inter-mission partnership.

E. Building Regional Identity, Ownership and Capacity

The emerging church in NA is young, small and relatively at risk. Internal threats include disunity through theological or personality conflicts and unrenewed cultural influences, especially impacting leadership styles and the development of Christian community. External threats include societal or governmental opposition.

Given the ratios of international workers to church leaders and the lack of alternative models, the church has struggled to find its own identity.

Individual national churches, a tiny national minority, can be encouraged and enriched through regional interaction. The NAP facilitates this in a number of ways:

- Twice yearly gatherings exclusively for NA church leaders
- Exchange visits between NA church leaders in the NA countries
- Strengthening NA involvement on the Partnership Steering Committee, providing opportunity for NAs to grow in their regional vision and understanding of common issues facing the Church and mission

The NAP has encouraged and enabled the development of national church councils in three of the four countries where the Church visibly exists in the region. Although not totally representative, these new councils are providing a place for building relationship, shared understanding and common approaches.

F. Lessons to Learn

The Church in North Africa is very young and vulnerable. The world-wide church needs to be mindful of its call to intercede on behalf of our NA brothers and sisters.

It is vital that national and regional identity and leadership capacity be developed rapidly to ensure its independence from the largely Western missions community. Non-Western mission movements from Africa, Asia and the Middle East should be given maximum support in the development of their vision and ability to work for and alongside the NA church.

Western-led groups like the NAP must learn to build capacity and include national leadership. These are parallel, not serial, processes. Positive discrimination is sometimes required in order to protect the growing space of the minority group.

Involving nationals deeply in multi-mission, multi-cultural networks such as the NAP has enormously positive potential in the development of open, inclusive, servant-based models of ministry. It is critical to have national leaders involved in leadership as soon as possible. It is important that these leaders are identified by the church and not by the mission agencies.

Pierson's "Renewal Movement" Scale: 16/20

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Dispensational Theology in the 21st Century

Darrell L. Bock

Background

Dispensationalism has been a significant theological movement within the church, especially over the last century. This theological view is best known for its distinction between Israel and the church, as well as its emphasis on eschatology and the end times that gives a role to national Israel at the end. However, recent developments in dispensationalism mean that many who know about it do not understand where it is today.

Many dispensationalists today affirm the unity of God's people, in the midst of the administrative diversity that is a part of God's plan. God's people are one; even as the means by which God has structured those people over time has changed (Israel is not the church is not the intermediate kingdom of the end is not the new heavens and earth). Every Christian affirms the distinction in structures between the periods of the Old and New Testament. What dispensationalism has emphasized is that further structural distinctions lie ahead in the future when Jesus returns. The theme of unity in diversity is the major theological principle that is emerging from this fresh emphasis.

What is New Here?

First, there is an affirmation that when God brings reconciliation among the people of God, it does not obliterate their unique ethnic and cultural contributions to the body (It is *Jew and Gentile* who remain *one* in Christ). This is very significant in thinking through Christianity and the church at a global level. The mosaic of the one body should draw on the various cultural and ethnic elements that make it up. The world seeing such variety working in unity stands in contrast to the myriad of ethnic divisions that plague and infect our globe.

Second, there is a renewed emphasis on wedding holistic ministry to the proclamation of the word. Dispensationalists, especially in the two-thirds world, are developing churches that not only preach the gospel but that engage in concrete outreaches to the poor and discussion of issues at a social and political level.

The Central American Theological Seminary in Guatemala City is training students to engage in such a full orbed ministry. It is not the case that the movement's focus on the future causes them to ignore the church's task in the present.

Third, fresh work has been done hermeneutically with an ethical reading of the prophets and the gospels so that the church can meet God's call to live out the great commandment and carry out the great commission. Many who think that dispensationalism means that the OT is only good for discussing the end times or that the four gospels are not relevant to us today because they are a part of a dispensation past or looking only to a

dispensation future do not understand the current streams in dispensationalism that are emphasizing the current central relevance of these texts for our present task. A full kingdom theology is emerging that reflects such emphases.
Fourth, collaborative discussions with other traditions that share such concerns have surfaced at the Evangelical Theological Society in North America helping us to appreciate our foundational unity in Christ and to explore how we can better work together in the large concerns that are a part of the body's calling. These emphases need further development as various traditions begin to interact constructively with what is happening within dispensationalism and take advantage of the new dialogue and its new, more edifying and unifying tone. This global inquiry is an example of such helpful dialogue.

Resources:
Herbert W. Bateman, *Three Central Issues in Contemporary Dispensationalism: A Comparison of Traditional and Progressive Views* (Kregel)- summarizes recent hermeneutical discussions within dispensationalism

Craig Blaising and Darrell Bock, *Progressive Dispensationalism* (Baker Book House)- presents and summarizes the biblical grounds of the new emphases with a focus on God's covenant program

Emilio A. Núñez C. and William D. Taylor, *Crisis in Latin America: An Evangelical Perspective* (William C. Carey)- application of the view to issues in Latin America

Darrell Bock, *Jesus according to Scripture* (Baker Book House) has a sample of how the gospels are handled in this fresh light with an analysis of Jesus' kingdom theology.

Pierson's "Renewal Movement" Scale: 13/20

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The Radical Project: A Revolutionary Latin American Model for Mission Mobilization

David Botelho

In 1999 Missão Horizontes, a Latin American mission organization headquartered in Brazil, sent ninety-six missionaries to several destinations in the 10/40 Window as part of a revolutionary mobilization initiative called "The Radical Project". "Radical Project 2" is currently in training and will arrive on the field in 2004.

Missão Horizontes began in 1990, after David Botelho, a Brazilian pastor and former missionary to Bolivia, connected with World Horizons, a Welsh-based international mission. As a result Botelho developed his vision to mobilize Latin Americans from a distinctively Latin organization. Missão Horizontes Horizontes was created under the broad umbrella of World Horizons. The Radical Project has become one of the fruits of this vision.

The Radical Project is a training and sending effort, drawing candidates from every region of Brazil and a growing number of other Latin American countries. Candidates make a five-year commitment, and are accepted with a minimum educational requirement and a minimum pledged monthly support (equivalent to $126). The first two-and-a-half years are spent in training: one year at the base in Brazil, one year in another Latin American country (where Missão Horizontes has bases), and a few months at the World Horizons base in Wales. The final two-and-a-half years are spent on the field in the 10/40 Window.

Radical Commitment

Radicals commit to intense and trying living conditions. Since support is raised from Brazil, inflation of the Real causes a serious financial challenge. As a result, teams on the field live at a financial level which is usually very similar to that of the local population.

Radical Community

Radicals live and work in community during the entire training period. All finances are administered in a "common fund", which encourages an incredible sense of mutual responsibility and accountability. When a box of chocolates arrives in the mail, it does not belong to the person whose name is on the envelope, but to the entire group. Teams of Radicals go on trips to make presentations in churches and to raise funds, not as individuals, but as a community. The Radicals are even sent as teams, not as individual missionaries. In this way, Radicals arrive on the field with pre-established relationships and leadership. In the Middle East, the existing strength of the Radical team meant that teams were able to be planted for the first time in previously unreached locations.

Radical Partnership

One of the most "radical" and counter-cultural characteristics of the project is its success in drawing people and establishing partnerships among a broad range of denominations and theological backgrounds. There is a "distilling" effect as Radicals learn to appreciate perspectives which would otherwise have been a source of division among believers, and come to live around a solid core of commonality. On the field, several organizations receive teams of Radicals. The teams remain "Radicals," while joining in the vision of established ministries. From this atmosphere there is a unique emphasis on the nature of the church as *community*, and an appreciation of the need for cooperation to complete the missionary task.

Radically Multi-cultural

A unique strength and challenge of the project is its multi-cultural nature. On the field, multi-cultural teams often combine Brazilian, Paraguayan, Venezuelan, British and American team members. This also offers a significant challenge to teams, introducing a cross-cultural element to relationships, but the benefits outweigh the potential problems in the broadened perspectives that may not exist on mono-cultural teams.

Radically Accessible

Hearing about the project, the average person gets the sense that he or she truly could "do missions". The low cost, and shared finances contribute to this accessibility of this project. Nearly one-third of all Brazilians in the 10/40 Window is in the Radical Project. This success has encouraged the Baptist Convention in Brazil to start "Project Radical Africa", and the YWAM base in Goiania to make preparations for "Radical Wave," both based on the model of the Radical Project.

Radically Focused

The project is focused on sending missionaries to 10/40 Window. This commitment to tip the balance of mission effort worldwide toward the most unreached people groups is an integral part of the "personality" of the Radical Project. For example, the team of Radicals in North India is involved in literacy work, sports evangelism, children's work, and is also working alongside the churches in youth work, worship and teaching in Uttar Pradesh, the neediest state in India. Raju Abraham of Mission UP also praised the project as a blessing to him and his ministry.

The "radical" characteristics of the project make it an excellent model for mission mobilization in the church worldwide. The vision of Missão Horizontes is to send three hundred more Radicals to the field in the next five years and to encourage other *culturally authentic* projects, emphasizing radical *commitment*, and *unity* in the body of Christ, engaging in strategic *partnerships*, cultivating *multi-cultural* teams, which are *accessible* and *focused* on the unreached people groups of the 10/40 Window.

Resources:
Onde Estão os 7000 que Não Dobraram os Joelhos a Baal by David Botelho.

Murray Decker and Ryan Keating, article forthcoming, *Evangelical Missions Quarterly*, July 2003

Websites: www.mhorizontes.org.br; www.worldhorizons.org

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Pierson's "Renewal Movement" Scale: 17/20

Movement for African National Initiatives (MANI)

Ross Campbell

MANI is a movement focused on catalyzing and networking African National Initiatives for the fulfillment of the Great Commission in Africa and the world.

Over the past thirty years more than thirty African countries have launched National Initiatives to mobilize churches and ministries for national and global evangelization. The movement for political independence in the 1960's and the New Life for All and Evangelism in Depth saturation evangelism strategies, launched in the mid 1960's, gave birth to a new sense of African destiny. African churches began to commit to work together for the evangelization of their countries. What began as a trickle in the 1970's became a flood by the 1990's.

In the 1990's three global movements and ministries found Africa to be a fertile soil in which to plant their strategies: the AD 2000 and Beyond Movement with its emphasis on unreached people groups; Interdev – strategic evangelism partnerships and Dawn Ministries - saturation church planting.

In July 1997 1,200 African leaders from forty-six nations came together in a consultation on African National Initiatives at the GCOWE '97 in South Africa. This consultation accelerated the birthing and development of African National Initiatives. A further development in 1997 was the adoption of African National Initiatives as its basic strategy by the Evangelism and Missions Commission of AEA. At the end of 2000 forty-six African countries linked with the African National Initiatives movement planned to attend 'Celebrate Messiah 2000' in Jerusalem. When the event was cancelled African delegations determined that they must still go to Jerusalem to consult together on the unfinished task in Africa and the world.

In March 2001, 320 delegates from 36 African nations met in Jerusalem for the African Millennial Consultation and MANI was birthed on the following convictions: that Africa's hour had come; that the Church in Africa was to take primary responsibility for the final gospel thrust in Africa, and that the African Church was uniquely positioned to play a major role in world evangelization in the 21st century.

MANI's Purpose

MANI's stated purpose is to affirm, motivate, mobilize and network Christian leaders by inspiring them with the vision of reaching the unreached in Africa, and the wider world, through the communication of up to date research, reports and models; consultations and prayer efforts focusing on the unfinished task.

MANI's Dreams Include

- A pioneer church planting movement within every major unreached ethno-linguistic people in every country in Africa;

- National indigenous missions initiatives for unreached peoples, where none already exist;
- The involvement of a significant number of African churches and Christians in global missions from every African country;
- The establishment of a saturation church planting movement in every African country;
- A broad spectrum of the Body of Christ in every African nation networking and partnering together to achieve the above;
- Ultimately to see a gathering of Bible-believing Christians within practical and cultural distance of every person in every class and kind of people in every country of Africa and significant advance toward global evangelization.

Basic Assumptions Underlying MANI

- That the Church in Africa has a critical role in the fulfillment of the Great Commission in the 21st century.
- That the Church in Africa has the primary ministry gifts, manpower and material resources needed to complete the task in Africa, and to make a significant contribution towards global evangelization.
- That through the mobilization and focused deployment of the resources of the African Church - in partnership with the global church – the vision, of 'a church for every people and the gospel for every person' can be realized in the countries of Africa, and a significant contribution made toward global evangelization.

MANI Leadership and Operational Mode

The MANI vision at a continental level is facilitated and coordinated by a team consisting of a Continental Coordinator and eight Regional Coordinators. They work with National Coordinators, regional and national church and missions leaders, network coordinators and task force leaders.

MANI is primarily a catalytic movement networking and operating through existing organizational structures at national, regional, continental and global levels.

MANI does not see itself as having a monopoly on the task of evangelization in Africa. Rather MANI sees the denominations, churches, ministries, structures and mission agencies, that make up the Body of Christ in Africa as the primary stake holders in the task.

MANI's commitment is to servanthood and cooperation with global, continental, regional and national structures, networks and ministries called to the Great Commission mandate.

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Pierson's "Renewal Movement" Scale: 19/20

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The Lighthouse Movement in the USA

Paul Cedar

Jesus said "You are the light of the world… Let your light shine before others, that they may see your good deeds and praise your Father in heaven." (Matt. 5:13a, 16)

The Lighthouse Movement is a significant response to that command from our Lord Jesus Christ to let His light shine through committed Christians who are allowing the light of Jesus to shine through them to minister to others.

The Lighthouse Movement is far more than a program. It is a movement of the Holy Spirit that was initiated in various forms from a number of different Christian ministries and denominations in the USA, India and Argentina during the last decade of the twentieth century. This collaborative initiative focuses upon establishing Lighthouse Churches and enlisting and enabling committed Christians of every age, gender and culture to share the love and grace of Jesus Christ with every man, woman, young person and child in America.

Three-Part Strategy

The strategy is both simple and effective. A lighthouse has been defined as *one or more Christians gathered together in Jesus' name, committing to be involved regularly in **prayer** for their friends, family members, co-workers and classmates, then seeking ways to **care** for them with the love of Jesus and then building relational bridges which provide natural opportunities to **share** their faith in Jesus Christ.*

Dr. Billy Graham has said, "The Lighthouse Movement of the Mission America Coalition has brought the Body of Christ together in a way that is unique in American history. I am praying that God will use this movement to help bring about a massive nationwide renewal and spiritual awakening in the days ahead."

God is using this movement to energize and equip the Church to enlist Christians to become involved in the strategy of **prayer**, **care** and **share**. Thousands of churches and hundreds of thousands of Christians have become involved in the Lighthouse Movement. Lighthouses have been launched in cities, communities and rural areas from California to Maine and from Texas to Minnesota.

Lighthouse Impact

Lighthouses are being established in various forms and locations including home, offices, school, baseball dugouts and even country clubs – wherever Christians live, work and play. These Christians are committed to pray and to share the love and grace of Jesus Christ wherever they live, work, study or play. These followers of Christ realize that He is the Light and that they can become effective lighthouses only when they submit to

Jesus as Lord and allow the Holy Spirit to fill them and minister through them. This is a simple, Biblical approach that is having very significant results.

There are many expressions of how the Lord is using this remarkable movement. For example, in South Dade County, Florida, the Good Samaritan Church has had ninety converts since beginning its Lighthouse ministry. During the first six months of launching lighthouses, the Orlando Baptist Church reported 350 guests at worship, 165 professions of faith and forty-two family units added to the membership of the church.

At the same time, individual Christians who are letting the Lord minister through them as Lighthouses are sharing some wonderful reports of God literally transforming their neighborhoods, offices and schools as multiple numbers of Christians are practicing the prayer, care and share ministry with the love of Jesus Christ and the power of the Holy Spirit.

Hundreds of Christian ministries, denominations and local churches are involved in the Lighthouse Movement in the USA. The Mission America Coalition has become a "connecting point" for many ministries to work together in the collaborative evangelism strategies for the establishment of Lighthouses. For example, the Promise Keepers have challenged some 300,000 men to become lighthouses. Over 700 Christian radio stations in the nation have hosted special "Turn on the Light" days or have shared special programming encouraging their listeners to become lighthouses. *Pray Magazine* has released a special Lighthouse edition. Several denominations have adopted the Lighthouse strategy to be their major ministry of evangelism across America.

Spreading the Vision

With all of the blessings of the movement, there are also some challenges that are being faced. The major challenge is that many U.S. churches and denominations have become program centered. They tend to view the Lighthouse Movement as another short-term program or fad that will soon disappear.

However, Lighthouse leaders stress that the Lighthouse Movement is a long-term commitment to a lifestyle of prayer evangelism. Those leaders are now gearing up for a "next wave" of launching lighthouses through the nation. Within that context, it is interesting to note that this movement/initiative has at least 16 of the 20 characteristics of a renewal movement as defined by Dr. Paul Pierson.

At the same time, inquiries are coming from many other nations from around the world. Many Christian leaders believe that this simple strategy can be used in various nations and cultures with appropriate adaptations and modifications for collaborative evangelism.

Although individual Christians can carry on a personal lighthouse ministry, the most effective approach is to establish lighthouse churches were those serving as lighthouses can be enlisted, equipped, encouraged and supported in this vital ministry.

Resources: "Turn on the Light" website at www.lighthousemovement.com

Pierson's "Renewal Movement" Scale: 16/20

Church in the Marketplace: The Church of the XXI Century?

Enrique R. Cepeda

"I believe one of the great moves of God is going to be through the believers in the workplace." Dr. Billy Graham

Background

It has been said that Latin America is a window of opportunities especially for commerce and tourism; its cultural riches, historical background, and diversity has marked this continent with a friendly touch that characterize its people. Hispanics are responsive to hear the Good News of the Gospel; however we have seen a great gap among Christian organizations and churches that can't reach the business and professionals for Christ. Because of Latin American historical background, there is a strong thought that religion is for poor people, for women, for uncultured, and for fools. We know that is a lie that Satan has sown in the minds of people to keep them in bondage.

Observations of Marketplace Believers

We have seen this as a great challenge. We want these people to come to a deep relationship with Jesus Christ. It is all about relationship, a connection with the Creator, with God himself! In the last ten years God has placed me in a ministry to the marketplace with professional and business people in Latin America. These people of influence are the toughest to bring to Christ. However, God is moving throughout this community. As I traveled throughout Latin America I have noticed several things:

1) Some of these people reached at the marketplace are eager to hear and to know more about God.
2) They are willing to be discipled in a non-church environment like a home, office, or restaurant.
3) When they are ready to be part of a local church, it is difficult to find one where they can fit and feel "at home"
4) This is producing an interesting phenomenon. Churches have been started in the businesses. In Monterrey, Mexico, there is company where people are being discipled by teaching them the Bible every day. The sixty-plus employees have received Christ and many changes have taken place, both in the people and in the company
   The atmosphere of the work place has changed:
   - No more fighting
   - No more stealing
   - The tools and equipment are neither broken nor stolen anymore.
   - No more rotation of employees.
   - Productivity up 60%.

   None of them are attending a church. They consider their work as the place where they receive from God.

5) Another expression is "house churches". In Costa Rica, Venezuela, Colombia, and Mexico such churches are active today led mainly by lay people. In the twenty-first century there will be churches in the marketplace led by a lay leader or a team of leaders (Acts 14:8, 16:18; 19:23)

Biblical Principles

There are ten biblical principles with respect to how Christians can today penetrate the marketplace based on the book of Acts. "… for I have many people in this city" Acts 18:1-10.

1. God in His will has provided his people in every city; this is God's work. Our part is to respond with obedience to those that God has place beforehand. Acts 8:26 9:10 ; 10:21-22 ; 16:6-10; 16:14-15,34
2. We should be willing to start churches in the marketplace with the people that God has prepared. 16:40
3. We need to be open to involve lay people to plant new communities of faith. 20:1-12
4. Ministers can be bi-vocational. Churches in the marketplace need professionals and business people that can be bi-vocational 18:3-4
5. Church in the marketplace eventually will require full-time workers. Transition from the tentmaking to the apostolic ministry. 18:5
6. We need to work as one team if we want to penetrate the marketplace world with the Gospel. Paul took a team in his missionary trips. 20:4
7. We should expect opposition, because we are working on God's agenda not on the world's agenda. 14:8-16; 18:17; 19:23
8. Opposition to God's agenda means "go to the next open door" 18:6-8
9. Fear is not in God's plan. 18:9
10. We need to find a man of peace/faithful in those cities. Luke 10:6; Matthew 10:11

May God help us to be open to this opportunity the Holy Spirit is presenting us in the twenty-first century.

Pierson's "Renewal Movement" Scale: 11/20

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Empowering Women for Church Planting

Bindu Choudhrie, India

The Paradigm Shift

In the 1970's I started attending many national and international seminars in connection with equality and empowerment of women in the church. It was our theologically trained women who were fighting for ecclesiastical equality with men. That struggle made little significant change in the advancement of the kingdom of God. The good news is that there is a new wind of change. In this mighty move of God, it is the ordinary women, the housewives and the young girls who are spearheading the change. The rapid advancement in church planting movements in the 10/40 Window is unfolding an exciting story.

Biblical Basis

The ministry of women in Central India began with a clear understanding of the word of God. Beginning with Genesis both man and woman were given joint stewardship and equal responsibility for managing the earth. Genesis.1: 27,28. With the fall of Adam and Eve, Satan usurped their authority. The Lord Jesus came and raised the fallen status of both men and women and restored the lost authority. Now men and women and not just religious leaders, have to reclaim the lost world.

The Concept

Plan A: **From the beginning God's vision is for the redemption of the whole creation. He chose Israel to be a holy nation (Exodus 19: 6), to spread abroad like the dust (Genesis 28:14) and be a blessing to all the families of the earth (Genesis 12:3). Instead Israel chose the temple, the limited priesthood and the 'bless me' model of the Sabbath worship. However, God did not fail; when Israel did not go voluntarily God scattered them abroad as slaves. The Jews spent the better part of their history in Diaspora.**

Plan B: The Lord Jesus came with the same vision and declared that all believers are to be royal priests (1 Peter 2:9). He gave them the mandate to disciple all nations (Matthew

28: 18-20). Instructed that 'House of peace' will be the operational base (Luke 10: 5-9) from where believers of all nations tribes and languages and people groups will be equipped to stand before the Throne. Sadly, the church also followed the temple, the limited priesthood and the bless me Sunday worship model. Since the traditional church failed to disciple the nations, the Lord is now preparing a new wineskin, the house church.

Selection and Skills are Key to Success

On the basis of these foundational texts we began training ordinary women who had a heart for doing something for the lost. Selection of women is crucial. Faithful women, regardless of their educational qualification, are trained in the 'skills' of 'how-to' rather than just the theology of church planting.

Church-planting Steps

Steps taught by our Lord in Luke 10 are used as the basic model of church planting. Going two by two, praying as you go. Praying for the local laborers as commanded by our Lord. Binding the 'strongman' is crucial to finding the 'Person of peace' (Huis Eirene). Until the 'House of peace' (Shalom Bayit) is found, the prayer walk continues because that is where the House-Church is to be established.

Harvest is Plentiful but the Women Laborers are Few

The church is consumed with the male hierarchical leadership of the church but the Lord is asking for laborers. Go to any paddy field and see that it is the men who plow the field but it is the women who plant the seed, weed the tares and when it is ready, reap the harvest with the sickle and joyfully carry the sheaves to the threshing floor. When the Lord was saying the laborers are few, he was really expressing the truth that the women who sow and plant, weed and reap the spiritual harvest are truly few. The Samaritan woman was an illiterate, despised woman but the Lord Jesus encouraged her and the next thing He had to tell his disciples, was to lift up their eyes and see the incredible thing this woman was able to do, bringing the whole town to the feet of Jesus.

New Wineskins for the New Wine

The 'Samaritan Woman Syndrome' is happening now all over the place and certainly in my place. I have so many non-literate and semi-literate women who are discipling, baptizing and equipping their sisters of other faiths and the Lord is adding to their numbers daily. According to our Lord, the meek shall inherit the earth and I can tell you for sure that the weak, the meek, and plain nobodies are slowly but surely inheriting the earth and the humble women are winning the race, hands down. The Lord is building His Church Universal and the gates of hell cannot stop Him.

Resources: Books by Victor Choudhrie, available from the author: *The Prayer Warrior* (A daily devotion for church planters); *The House Church*. (Profound principles of church planting explained in simple words)

Contact: <victor_btl@sancharnet.in>

Pierson's "Renewal Movement" Scale: 20/20

The Lausanne Committee for World Evangelization

David Claydon

Lausanne 1974: A New Cutting Edge

Over four thousand evangelical leaders from 151 nations gathered in Lausanne, Switzerland, in July 1974 and under God's gracious hand they gained a new confidence and bonding as evangelicals and a new challenge to work hard to take the gospel to every corner of the globe.

The presentations at this Congress generated a new cutting edge to the forward thinking of those present which has had a number of long term results. One of these was the production of the Lausanne Covenant. This covenant repeated doctrines contained in the traditional church creeds, but gave these doctrines a strong mission perspective. It also reminded the Christian community of their responsibility to share in God's concern for justice and reconciliation, affirmed the need to make the gospel known in a culturally relevant way and declared their resolve to work for the evangelization of the world. This covenant has proven to be a benchmark for gospel minded people and ministries.

Another consequence of this outstanding event hosted by the Billy Graham Association was the establishment of an International Committee to pursue outstanding issues which are blockages to evangelism or to unity among evangelicals. This Committee appointed Senior Associates and Working Groups in various specialized areas of ministry to enable others to make the gospel known to those who have not heard about Jesus and His free gift of salvation and to continue the work of identifying issues which are blocking the spread of the gospel. These Senior Associates and Working Groups have brought evangelicals together in various parts of the world and have conducted conferences on strategic topics. Out of these activities it has been possible to produce twenty-nine think-tank papers known as Lausanne Occasional Papers which have made a contribution to the thinking of people in ministry across the nations.

A New Forum

The Lausanne International Committee has continued through these thirty years to renew its membership ensuring reasonable geographic, age and gender balance. This Committee felt a strong leading from the Lord to hold another international Forum. Research has indicated major issues which the gospel-minded Christian community is facing today and needing both thoughtful leadership and examples of how to respond for the extension of the kingdom of God. With much prayer and hard work such an event is now well-planned and is to be held in Thailand in 2004.

Leadership for this Forum is drawn from around the world with able women and men from thirty countries leading the Issue Groups which form the core of this Forum. It is our expectation that the Christian community in almost every nation will be represented and will work together to gain a new vision and a new heart and declare a renewed call

for the proclamation of the gospel. They will develop specific action plans for Christians to use in addressing our most difficult local and global evangelism issues.

It is our prayer that the Church world wide will be challenged by the outcomes and specific recommendations of this Forum such that where the church needs to gain a new enthusiasm for discipling their nation or where the Christian community needs guidelines for crossing boundaries which seem to limit the spread of the gospel, there will be a roadmap as to the way forward.

It is hoped that future leaders of the church will be present at the Forum so that these participants as members of their home church will bring to their churches a new commitment for change and energetic action bringing the news of the saving love of Jesus to a fractured and hurting world.

Resources: Lausanne Occasional Papers can be read and information on the 2004 Forum on the Lausanne website at www.lausanne.org

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The Messianic Renewal in Latin America

Mercedes E. Dalton

The Messianic Movement is one of the fasting growing movements in Latin America. Its unique focus is impacting the Church as well as the Jewish communities in the whole continent. This movement could be described as the "second Acts 2 movement," gathering Jewish and Gentile believes in "one body and in one Olive Tree".

Impacting Jews and Gentiles

The emphasis on the full context of the Word of God, the Hebrew world view of both Testaments, and the need of reviewing Hellenistic and Roman traditions in our modern Christianity, have refreshed the faith of many Christians and have brought thousands of Jews to the recognition of Jesus as their true Messiah.

Gentiles are discovering some of God's purposes in bringing them to the commonwealth of Israel, such as:

- Jews will be crafted back into the good Olive Tree by the Gentiles who provoke them to jealousy by a contextualized Jewish faith (Romans 11:11)
- Praying for the Peace of Jerusalem, implies the returning of the Prince of Peace, which includes blessings for all nations (Arab world, and all)
- The Lord will not return until the Jewish people declare "Blessed is He who comes in the Name of the Lord" (Mathew 23:39). This places great importance on their evangelization.

Not Without Controversy

Ministry to the Jewish people is controversial and difficult. For Jewish communities, there is no greater traitor than a Jew who believes in Jesus, or Y'shua. In many cases actual burials are made by their families, because of the historic persecution of the Church against Israel. In essence, the price they pay for their faith in Jesus in very high On the other hand, Gentiles who embrace the calling to minister the house of Israel and attend Messianic congregations are often misunderstood, persecuted, and alienated from the rest of the Christian Community. In some extreme cases thy have even been tagged as "demonic judaizers".

In spite of persecution, the movement is growing tremendously in Latin America. More and more Gentiles are being called to bless Israel and the Jewish people by bringing their gospel back to them.

Latin America has millions of "crypto-Jews", descendants of Sephardic Jews who escaped persecution in Spain during and after the Inquisition, changing their names and

religion in bringing their families to safety. Believers from this group constitute the majority of Messianic believers in Latin America today.

Alliances and Networks

From Mexico to Argentina, groups, congregations, ministries and alliances have been formed to fulfill this calling and ministry, and to promote unity with the Church at different levels. Some examples are:

- Intercessory Prayer movements for the Peace of Jerusalem, and the fulfillment of God's covenants exist in many countries.
- Christian Embassy of Jerusalem promotes visits to Israel and the celebration of the Feast of Tabernacles. Has representatives throughout Latin America.
- Messianic congregations, Hebrew Christian churches, and Israel Adopting churches are numerous in Argentina, Brazil, Colombia, Venezuela, Peru, Panama, Costa Rica, Honduras, El Salvador, Guatemala, Cuba, the Dominican Republic, Puerto Rico, and Mexico.
- Teaching ministries have been foundational to the furtherance of the movement. The main emphasis is on return to the study and full context of the Word of God.
- Messianic Jewish worship and dance has brought revival to worship in the Church. Several Jewish groups and singers have introduced the flavor of Israel as well as scriptural teaching of worship and adoration.

Renewal Traits

Although the Messianic Movement parallels the model of the "first church" where Jews and Gentiles worshipped together as one body, its growth has been taking place as a peripheral movement. It is led by men and women both lay and ordained. For some, there is a political connotation that the focus on Israel excludes and antagonizes the Arab nations.

This initiative involves a great deal of prayer for the fulfillment of blessings to Israel and the Church. t places great emphasis on holiness and obedience of the commandments of God, those applicable to our lives without the temple, and salvation by grace without works as the only way God has ever provided salvation to the Jewish people.

The promises to Israel are so sure that great manifestations of the work of the Holy Spirit have impacted the lives of many. Jesus has appeared to many Jewish people. All over the world Jews are coming to faith in Jesus by the direct work of the Holy Spirit. Another evidence of the work of the Holy Spirit is the unity of Jew and Gentiles as one body as in the book of Acts. Although cultural tensions are the same, now it is the Gentile Church which finds difficulty in believing a Jew could be a believer without being "gentilized".

To bring cohesion to this movement, it is crucial for the Church to understand God's timing of the re-insertion of Israel into the Olive Tree, and the Jewish roots of our Bible, in order to properly communicate the Gospel to them with the same heart that our Jewish teacher Paul shared to the Gentiles.

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Primary Health Care and Evangelism

Elias Dantas

Primary health care is the basic level of health care that should be accessible geographically, economically, and culturally to all persons. It includes curative care for common illnesses, prevention of many illnesses, and maintenance or improvement of health by people and communities and should involve the full participation of the community.

Jesus the Model

Health care began almost two thousand years ago one Saturday evening in Capernaum in Galilee. Jesus modeled the full range of primary health care – bringing hope, purpose, and joy to life, teaching healthy relationships with God and others, and healing sick persons. His Good News embraced all aspects of life – physical, emotional, social, and spiritual – as he brought new life and eternal life to all who trusted in him. As teacher, Jesus did more than simply impart information to people. Through parables, questions, and dialogue, Jesus stimulated people to learn truth for themselves. He tried to empower them to discover how God wants us to live. As healer, he healed people suffering from physical, psychological, and spiritual illnesses, an expression of his love and compassion and testimony to his identity. To follow the model he set for us, we must understand how these dimensions of ministry complement one another and should be fully integrated.

The Need for a New Model

How can we expand this holistic model to existing ministry ?

The Peeke School of Christian Mission at King College developed a survey among missionary health workers to discover their needs in this area. Surprisingly, the vast majority indicated a strong need for practical theological training. They wanted to know how to reach the whole person with the Gospel. Instead of just treating the body, they wanted a program that could teach them how to go beyond the level of curative medicine. Their felt need was in the area of Bible, evangelism and the integration of their activities with the growth of the church. They also mentioned the desire of being trained in areas of community health among the poor.

The desire of the medical mission community for a more integrated approach to ministry raises a key question for schools in charge of training future church leaders: do future pastors and leaders need training in basic elements of health and community development?

Research in the area of holistic curriculum has been developed at Nigeria's Theological Seminary of the Evangelical Church of West Africa and the Evangelical Theological Seminary in Cairo, Egypt. The question they tried to answer centered on the adequacy of their training model for their African reality. Their discoveries were in line with the felt

needs demonstrated by the mission personnel community in the King College study. The seminaries were highly focused on systematic and historical theology in their curriculum, a direct influence of the pioneer Western missionaries, trained in Western seminaries, who had adopted their model of training for the leaders of the new churches.

These researchers interviewed alumni pastors from several schools and discovered they judged their training as completely inadequate for the needs of the field such as dealing with questions of illiteracy, hygiene, poverty, lack of employment, health, community organization and community development, and folk religion. They had no answer for these issues because they had no training in those areas.

A Two-sided Model

Can a new model cover both sides of the same coin? The obvious answer is "yes." The advantages of a new approach, meeting the needs of both groups noted above, are evident.

- Allows better communication and cooperation between two of the main branches of Christian missionary ministry: local church communities and the health mission community.
- Allows us to develop a more comprehensive approach to a specific target community from a holistic perspective.
- The final goal will be not only to communicate the gospel to an evangelized person, but to form a new disciple and a new community which will be able to serve God and their people according to the model taught to us by the Great Teacher, Healer, Missionary, Pastor, and Evangelist of our lives, the Lord Jesus.

Conclusions

- Jesus modeled an integrated approach to evangelism, caring for physical, emotional, social, and spiritual needs as he encountered them.
- The Bible is the foundation for an understanding of health and the health sciences.
- Obedience to God's laws as revealed in the Bible or as discovered by scientific investigation favors health and a healthy lifestyle.
- Pastors, evangelists, and church leaders can effectively integrate evangelism, education in health, and community development in proclaiming the Good News.
- The health missionary community can increase their effectiveness through a better training in the areas of Bible, evangelism, and church growth.
- Development workers on all levels can integrate evangelism and social concerns in their ministries of healing, health and community development. This approach promotes the expansion, growth, and strength of the local church.

Resources:

"Health, the Bible, and the Church," Daniel E. Fountain, M.D., Billy Graham Center Monograph 1988, EMIS, Wheaton, IL, USA, 60189

"Let's Build Our Lives," Daniel E. Fountain, M.D., 1990, MAP International, Brunswick GA, USA, 31521

Pierson's "Renewal Movement" Scale: 18/20

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The Renewal Movement among Young People in Hispanic Latin and North America

Jeffrey D. De León

It is evident to all leaders working with Latinos, especially in the Americas, that in the last twenty years God have been moving leaders toward strategic leadership development (training) and resource development.

Nature of the Initiative

In Latin American history the predominant force in education (training) has been "formal education." Universities, seminaries and other similar institutions have been providing the support for the existing ministry initiatives. But for the last ten years the nature of this movement has been non-formal education including:

- short-term training workshops
- training conferences
- non-accredited institutions (many part of mega churches)
- the use of creative ways of delivering training and resources such as the Internet.

Background

According to Dr. William Taylor, in the first century seventy percent of the Christian population was located within the Roman Empire. Persecution brought about the disbursement ("Diaspora") of Christians who became the first missionaries to impact the world.

Northern and Western Europe were the mission fields of the time and Jewish, Greek and Roman Christians were the first missionaries. In the fourteenth century, the percentage of Christians in Europe began to increase dramatically.

During the 1500s through the early 1800's, seventy percent of the world's Christian population was found in Europe. Seventeenth and eighteenth century missionaries came from Europe, spreading the gospel to parts of Africa and the Americas.

In the late 1800s and the 1900s, seventy percent of the Christian population was found in North America. The United States became the largest missionary sending force in the world.

Today, seventy percent of the Christian population is found in Third World countries. This historical background shows that God is heading this ministry initiative because

training and resources have always been important for the fulfillment of the Great Commission.

God at Work "Outside the Box"

These consortia are primarily seen as movements and ministries not related to major denominations. Even though the consortia are in good standing with the big denominations, they are not directly controlled by any denomination.

God continues to break the denominational walls and continues to use the youth to accomplish this. Strong Christian movements continue to emerge.

Two great dreams of Christian leaders involved in the ministry initiative are to see

- millions of young professionals in the mission field
- churches and youth ministries committed to the Great Commission.

Key Issues

The biblical basis for the initiative is found in

- Matthew 28:16-20
- I Timothy 4:12
- II Timothy 2:1

Key conceptual issues emerging in this ministry initiative are

- integral mission (simultaneous, Acts 1:8)
- complete gospel (Good News and social work)
- relational ministry

Potential benefits and problems include more accessible training and resources but with the danger of less accountability.

What is God saying to His church from this ministry initiative? Networks and partnerships are very important!

Resources:

info@liderazgojuvenil.com www.liderazgojuvenil.com
www.caribe.com
www.certezajoven.com
www.especialidadesjuveniles.com
www.lideresjuveniles.com

www.otraonda.com
www.paralideres.com

www.unilit.com
www.visionjoven.com

Pierson's "Renewal Movement" Scale: 18/20

Reaching Children at Risk in South East Asia

Ian de Villiers

The Asian church is reaching out to children at risk with a multitude of what I call "Gracious Acts of Simple Mercy."

The Largest Human Problem?

This is a response by the largest ever body of civic care, to what is arguably the largest human problem of our time. In the next twenty-five years, over 4 billion children will be born, ninety-five percent of them into the developing world[1], most to families living on under US$2 per day. Already 100 million live or work on our streets; 10 million are in commercial sex work[2]. This is about churches reaching into the lives of hurting children with food, shelter, development, love – and the possibility of relationship with Jesus. It comprises both professional programmatic responses of large organizations and spontaneous vital outreaches of small groups of Christians across SE Asia (and the world!) to pockets of need around them. A small group of women providing breakfast and books enables children to study in Metro Manila, a church reaches out with food and hope to illegal cousins in Malaysia, a project takes in refugee children in Jakarta.

Credible Outreach, Maximizing Impact

Increasingly recognized is the need to match the incredible local commitment of sacrificial believers with the resource and professionalism of the parachurch. So Viva Network has created local networks that maximise ministry impact, prevent duplication and burnout, and synergise efforts. Autonomy is not compromised as each member is built up in their own ministry and calling (Eph. 4:16). This is made practical by the use of trained, honest-broker facilitators who build relationships and a sense of joint purpose.

Understanding God's Heart for Children

In many places there has been a new understanding of God's heart for children. We recognise children not so much as passive victims but individuals built in God's image. In Cambodia, their vision and understanding teaches adults ways to build community for the future. In the Philippines, Malaysia and elsewhere children's prayers echo from the rooftops. In Indonesia a leadership programme for project graduates is producing tomorrow's Christian leaders. Simultaneously, adults are recognizing the possibilities for their own childlikeness and thus enter further the safety and love of the kingdom of God for themselves.

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[1] World Population Profile 1998, US Census Bureau.

[2] Statistics compiled in the 'Oxford Statement on Children at Risk', Oxford Centre for Mission Studies / Viva Network 1997.

Our dream is that the church could show a concerted and credible outreach to those who Jesus called 'the least of these my brothers' (and sisters!). In this, the church demonstrates both the Lordship and nature of God, who declares himself (with apparent delight) 'father to the fatherless' (Psalm 68:5) and defender of orphans (Exodus 22:22-24). Statistics suggest the problem of children at risk is not going to be solved soon[3]. It is both a vital need and opportunity for the church to be the salt and light of its calling; to be relevant and to be able to speak its message of hope.

Diversity in Leadership

Leaders of this movement are very diverse: educated women in urban communities, male leaders of western NGOs, national seminary professors, community leaders and more. It is excitingly flat, because we need to learn together. Women's leadership skills are increasingly valued – no monopolies on resource, wisdom or love are held by locals or foreigners, rich or poor, men or women. The functionality of the Filipino children at risk community is a good example. But increasingly our conception of church is challenged, as the needs of urban children are demonstrably not met by adult-centred worship services on Sunday mornings.

Coming to Christ

The number of at-risk children who come to Christ when they are given consistent love and care is phenomenal. This is apparent in numbers of converts and in today's Christian leadership in India, Myanmar, the Philippines, Indonesia, Malaysia. And all this with less than fifteen percent of church resources spent on fifty percent of the population[4]. But if the Church turns from them, it will continue its slide into irrelevancy and isolation.

Are the Walls Down?

One young woman's drawings in a church consultation[5] in Cambodia showed two different possibilities of church. In one, high walls surrounded people sitting in lines on pews. She had an unhappy face, excluded along with her community. In the second picture, the walls were down and the church was part of a community, and this young woman was smiling. The challenge is ours.

Resources: Many on www.viva.org, including Dr Dan Brewster's '4-14 window', Report of the Penang Consultation on Child Theology. Books include Glenn Myer's 1998 'Children in Crisis' (UK: STL); Phyllis Kilbourn's 1996 'Children in Crisis: a New Commitment' (USA: MARC), and Glenn Miles' and Josephine Wright's 2003 'Celebrating Children' (UK: Paternoster/Viva Network).

Contact: Viva Network Asia, www.viva.org idevilliers@viva.org

[3] See, for example, UNICEF: State of the World's Children 2003 www.unicef.org/sowc2003.
[4] P. McDonald, Viva Network, unpublished research.
[5] With thanks to Evangelical Fellowship of Cambodia Children's Commission, and Glenn Miles/Tearfund UK.

Pierson's "Renewal Movement" Scale: 17/20

Two-Thirds World Missions

Reuben Ezemadu and Larry Keyes

Missionary outreach is undergoing a quiet yet very radical change. We have entered a phase highlighted by "two-thirds world missions". Paul Pierson says this is "the most significant new development in modern missions since Carey sailed for India in 1793."

This Fourth Phase has moved from the West to the non-West, from the North American center to all of Africa, Asia, Latin America and the Pacific. Many assumptions concerning the ways of doing mission are changing. The majority of missionaries are now sent from cities like Lagos, Pretoria, Sao Paulo, Seoul and Madras. The leadership role and dominant influence in global missions is shifting to the South. Most of the workers in world missions today are sent from cultures and countries that are developing; many come from places which might be seen as antagonistic to the gospel in their political and social structures. With the issues of sending, financing, economic viability and ability to enter countries hostile to the West, the importance, leadership and influence of the two-thirds world mission movement cannot be overstated.

Key Issues

Implications of this growth for cross-cultural missions include

- Many missionaries and leaders from the two-thirds world will not follow traditional Western patterns of doing mission
- The linkage between church and mission structures is common
- In many cases, the assumption of "wholism," is not dichotomous (or even divisive)
- Tentmaking is often the normative method; training programs prepare candidates in both God's spiritual call and one's personal trade or craft.
- Two-thirds world missionaries will minister with less resource but, also, will connect with far greater identity with the poor and needy.

Oftentimes the return rate in these groups is uncomfortably high, but there is a growing awareness of the need for simplified infrastructure and pastoral care that will meet the needs of the workers and maximize retention on the field.

Much of the research done to date has focused on describing needs, strategies, placement and numbers of workers from the Western viewpoint. An entire arena needs to be shored up which details the same information from the broader perspective of seeing those in the entire two-thirds world as, also, the "sent ones." A stronger emphasis must be given to the receiving side of missions, for example which ethnic or language groups are most accepted by any of the yet unreached, helping to prioritize the successful deployment of those from the two-thirds world.

Demographics of the two-thirds world demand a new appreciation of when a huge percentage of a country's population is under twenty, how to minister to huge numbers of people impacted by the AIDS epidemic or moving from rural to urban settings because of globalization, war, or natural disasters.
Finally, many missiological concepts enter our discussions because of this growing army of new workers from the two-thirds world.

- Redemption is rarely a dichotomous concept among these new missionaries who will, naturally, dull or blunt any perceived separation between the sacred and secular.
- Power is commonly understood and viewed in spiritual terms, not political; conversion and control are seen not by man's power or might but by God's Spirit.
- The unseen Kingdom of God can be proclaimed fervently as many two-thirds world workers have possessed so little of a material kingdom on earth.

One Response: Global MissionThrust21

With these and other widespread perceptions among two-thirds world mission leaders there is a growing "sense" that a platform for networking among themselves is needed. Many mission leaders have expressed a desire to fellowship and network where they determine the agenda. They take seriously their increasing responsibility and crucial role in global outreach, seeing the possibilities of partnerships among themselves as critical to their own development and effectiveness.

One response has been the formation of Global MissionThrust21 (GMT21), purposing to collaborate with two-thirds world mission movements in obeying the Great Commission, focused on receiving and giving encouragement and resource to colleagues of like vision and commitment in the two-thirds world.

Global MissionThrust21 consists of Facilitators (mission leaders who remain working in their own groups, agencies or associations yet represent and assist in the joint-ministry of GMT21) and Partners (pastors, businessmen and other leaders who join hands with mission leaders within the two-thirds world). Projects are presented to the Partners and Facilitators and, with global experience and representation, decisions are made to assist, equip, strengthen and cooperate with mission need in Africa, Asia, Latin America and the Pacific. The goal is to increase the strategic effectiveness of cross-cultural missions from the non-Western world which will enhance completing our Lord's Mandate.

God is encouraging His people to begin to expect new activity from Him. Isaiah 43:16-21 refers to water springing up in the desert; in our application, He is adding to the global missionary force by the thousands and changing its central sending point. As we look as this exploding movement of missionary activity from the two-third world, we anticipate seeing with Isaiah, "do you not perceive it?"

Resources: Global MissionThrust21 produces a quarterly newsletter, MissionThrust21, and can be obtained by writing to: 72064.2174@compuserve.com.

Contact: Rev. Reuben Ezemadu (Co-Chair) <reubenez@skannet.com>
Dr. Larry Keyes (Co-Chair and President) <72064.2174@Compuserve.com>
Dr. Met Castillo (International Director) <gcmtc@pacific.net.ph>

YWAM's Project 4K Rationale
David Joel Hamilton

Nothing Less than "All"

God's forever dream is for every individual to be redeemed and every society to be transformed. The Great Commission is always described in the most universal of terms– as nothing less than "all" or "every" (see Genesis 12:2-3; Joel 2:28-32; Habakkuk 2:14; Matthew 28:18-20; Mar 16:15-18; Luke 24:46-49; Acts 1:7-8; 1 Timothy 2:3-6; and Revelation 7:9 among others). Whereas the "all" factor is unchanging, what the "all" describes varies from one passage to another. The above verses include all individuals... all families... all tribes... all peoples... all nations... all languages... all... all... all... Each expresses a portion of God's multifaceted desire for His creation. His redemption will run its full course and history will culminate with Him becoming the "all in all" (1 Corinthians 15:28).

As we consider the future of missions it is crucial for us to reflect upon the "allness" of the Great Commission. God does not state His will in a series of five year plans, each reflecting an incremental growth over the prior period. In Revelation 7:9 God holds before us an unwavering, all-encompassing image of the future, urging us not to see the future as a modified extension of the present, but to modify the present so as to be conformed to the future. We are given glimpses of the fulfilment of His plan so that we can pull that vision of the future reality into our present day existence. Thus God's foresight is the foundation for our present strategic planning.

Toward a Focused, Comprehensive Framework

In missions there is no one paradigm to see every individual redeemed and every society transformed. Redemptive transformation occurs through a wide variety of ministry strategies. Our unity lies not in methodological uniformity, but in a passionate commitment to follow the God who is passionate about reaching this world in its entirety. Because God's heart is not confined to narrow agendas or mono-dimensional issues, we must recognize that there are myriads of opportunities for compassionate service in a Biblically holistic, non-dichotomized approach to God's world.

Still the question remains. How do we find a cohesive overall corporate framework to maximize our efforts to reach the world? A key lies in geography (as indeed Jesus' words in Acts 1:8 suggest), for all ministry has a geographic expression – whether it involves evangelism, discipleship or mercy ministries. It is carried out some where between here and the ends of the earth. Therefore, we must look at the empty places, the unreached zones, those areas where we are not and devise a simple but clear form of keeping that image before the emerging generation of leaders. They will then be inspired to a new Spirit-led, pioneering thrust until all the empty places are filled with living expressions of God's love and care.

However, when considering a geographic framework for strategic vision it is unhelpful to build a grid upon the 238 recognized countries of the world. For this taxonomy puts the few dozen inhabitants of Pitcairn on a par with China's nearly 1.3 billion citizens. We obviously need a framework that breaks the world down into similar sized units. We need to do this not by imposing an artificial grid, but by using the natural administrative units utilized by the peoples of the earth.

A Grid of Natural Geo-political Unites

Based on this reality, Youth with a Missions's Global Leadership Team has embraced a strategic framework of natural geo-political units of similar size to better pursue the unfinished task. In this framework larger countries are sub-divided into their major civil divisions (*eg* India into 37 states and union territories). When these are still large (*eg* Uttar Pradesh, one state of India with a population exceeding 171 million) they are in turn broken down into the next level of administrative units, and so forth. In order to emphasize the mission purpose of the church, this framework takes into account where the church is not, by emphasizing the least reached areas. So we subdivide World A (distant unreached) areas until no zone exceeds 3 million; World B (near unreached) areas until no zone exceeds 6 million and World C (majority reached) areas until no zone exceeds 9 million. This simple grid subdivides the world in four thousand-some zones, thus the name Project 4K.

This framework gives us a fresh approach to the missions challenge before us. While it is simple in its formulation and comprehensive in its scope, it encourages focused attention on the areas where the church is least present, and speaks of people in terms that they are most familiar with. This framework can readily serve any missions agency to identify where they are and where they are not. Project 4K gives all of us an opportunity for clearer focus and stronger collaboration. For indeed, this intentional grid encourages pioneering initiatives to zones that have been overlooked in the past. If this helps us reach more cities, more tribes, more unreached peoples, plant more churches, care for more of the needy and equip more of those called into extending the kingdom of God as we seek to reach the "all" of the Great Commission, then we will have been faithful stewards of the trust placed in our hands.

Pierson's "Renewal Movement" scale: 20/20

Developing Leaders to Disciple a Nation

Paul R. Gupta

The traditional approach to develop leadership for the church in the last 100 years has been through formal theological training. The task force was first developed to be a pastor who was expected to do evangelism and possibly inspire the church to plant new churches. The first 75 years of the twentieth century sustained the paradigm. However, if this is to continue we will never accomplish the Great Commission in our generation.

Three factors must force the church to reconsider the paradigm:

- **Understanding the real task and the task force needed to fulfill the mission**: What would a nation look like if it were discipled to Christ? The answer to this question would require hundreds of thousands of churches and suitably trained task force to fulfill the mission. The formal paradigm will never make it possible to fulfill this task in our generation.

- **The challenge of the enormous harvest**: Patrick Johnstone's research indicates that the church is growing at an unprecedented rate of seven percent AAGR. Many churches are emerging and many are entering the ministry without any training. It is estimated today that ninety percent are untrained and not able to constructively disciple those responding.

- **The tremendous impact of nationalization and tribal resurgence** is calling for a contextual identity. The need for a church indigenous to the people must force the church to find ways of equipping the task force so the church is culturally contextual.

Hindustan Bible Institute began training workers in 1952. After twenty-five years of training and establishing an accredited program it came to realize the program dislocated and urbanized the trainees. They felt trained only to work in an already existing church. This forced the question, "How should we train and equip leaders for effective ministry?"

A New Paradigm

God unfolded a paradigm. We began a process of equipping in a non-formal context. The trainee stayed in his village and every three months came for training. Our first phase equipped them to share their faith, study and communicate the word. The second phase of the training was shifted to the field and in the next two years the task force were skilled in planting churches and discipling leaders. In four years they planted a mother church and two to three other churches. The third phase of the training equipped them to be pastors. As a result of this program in 15 years 500 trainees planted 2424 churches and over

110,000 were discipled. The paradigm that unfolded was to train the task force first to be evangelists, then disciplers and church planters and finally to equip them to be pastors.

While this was going on God birthed a DAWN type movement called the council of national service to mobilize the church to fulfill the great commission by planting a church in every village and colony of every town and city of our nation, so there would be a church for every 1000 persons in every people group of the nation. This resulted in the birthing of many networks though out the nation. As the church was mobilized with the vision an incredible reality began to emerge. It is estimated that in the last fifteen years the nation saw the adding of over 250,000 new churches and is presently growing at an AAGR of 20,000 churches.

Most of these churches are led by church planters who have no training. If these churches are going to have the effect of bringing transformation in community the church must develop these church planters into committed, competent mature leaders. In partnership with TOPIC and T-NET God is leading us to develop an informal training program that will give the church planters an opportunity to develop skills, information and character to lead and enable their churches to be Great Commission churches. But the challenge is not over.

Responding to the Leadership Development Challenge

How should the church respond to the challenge of leadership development to discipling a whole nation?

- First, we must be willing to visit the existing paradigm and consider its strengths and limitations.
- Secondly, we must determine the various kinds, functions and levels of leadership required to disciple a nation and develop contextually relevant programs to equip the task force for those functions.
- Thirdly, the Church must restore the function of every member in the Body in order to be a part of fulfilling the Great Commission. The church is the task force.
- Fourthly, intentional efforts must be taken by nationals to develop cross-cultural missionaries to reach the unreached people groups by developing a church planting movement to reach the whole people group in the region.
- Finally, the global missionary needs to evaluate the purpose and role of his/her function and develop partnerships with the national church and agency.

The task of fulfilling the Great Commission in this generation is a tangible reality but it requires a complete reengineering in its strategy for leadership development. The Church has all the resources necessary to fulfill the Great Commission. The essential factors to be identified are the type of leadership needing to be trained, the curriculum to develop the various leaders, the tools that are contextual to the leaders and a program to develop trainers. The vision must be to develop leaders who will result in building committed,

competent, mature leaders that will make disciples to affect our world with transformation.

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Pierson's "Renewal Movement" Scale: 16/20

A United Family among Muslim Background Believers

Victor Hashweh and Stephen Kelley

During the nineteenth and twentieth centuries many evangelical missionaries from across the denominational board have been sent to the Middle East and North Africa to share the Gospel of Christ with our people. So many have labored and prayed for a harvest. Some of our relatives here have come to Christ in the past through the sacrificial ministry of Western missionaries. We are eternally indebted to these men and women of God and the heritage they left behind.

For the last twenty years we have seen a significant increase in the number of believers not only from historic Christian background but also from Muslim background, especially in North Africa. We believe this will bring great joy among past and present missionaries in our region.

As their number increased, new churches and fellowships needed to meet together for fellowship and training. They had so many physical, emotional and spiritual needs that were common to all. The Holy Spirit has been moving both men and women on fire for God to share the greatest story ever told, not only within their respective countries but also within the region and beyond. In this context the United Family International (UFI) was launched on 14 May, 2002.

It is strongly felt that the prodigal who returned home fully accepted by the Father is now enabled to take initiatives on his own. Many ministers from a Muslim background are already serving as pastors, counselors, evangelists and teachers in their own countries and elsewhere in the region. Many serve as skilled writers, television program producers and presenters as well as administrators. Many others have taken creative initiatives for the advancement of the Kingdom of Christ in its full spectrum among their own people.

UFI is a movement consisting mainly of Muslim Background Ministers (MBB) already serving in many countries in the Muslim world and beyond, thus being a servant movement to their own.

Purpose Statement

We Muslim Background Believers (MBB) from the Arab World, having the same roots and facing the same future are gathered together as a united family in response to the call of Christ. With the help of the Holy Spirit, we endeavor to stand shoulder to shoulder with the Church of Jesus Christ in the Muslim World as it seeks the lost, bind the broken hearted, strengthen the weak, provide relief to the oppressed, equip the workers and send those who are called for the glory of God. Luke 4: 18-19.

Core Values and Goals - UFI

- Provide spiritual and pastoral care to MBBs from the Arab world, wherever they are. This is done in close cooperation with local leadership.
- Provide relief services through appropriate means.
- UFI is a spiritual gathering place as well as a home for MBBs.
- UFI is inter-denominational.
- UFI desires to cooperate with others in preparing, training and encouraging all those of the Muslim faith or persuasion. We will support those servants spiritually, emotionally and financially as the Lord leads and provides.
- UFI desires to prepare discipleship materials and other subjects that agree and harmonize with the need and the culture of believers, with the goal of training them for their country and work place.
- UFI desires to network with the universal Church to build on, develop and improve the ideas and principles in Evangelism, discipleship and church planting in the Arab as well as the Muslim World.
- UFI desires to establish houses of refuge for the persecuted, training centers, relief projects in close cooperation with specialized agencies.
- UFI desires to meet the needs of believers and their families in a holistic manner.
- UFI desires to send workers from one country to another with consultation with the concerned parties.
- UFI desires to initiate and maintain relationship with MBBs and the Christian Church and those serving in the Muslim World. We believe we are an inseparable part of the local Church and the Universal Body of Christ.

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Pierson's "Renewal Movement" Scale: 14/20

Trans World Radio Networking in India

Emil Jebasingh

Introduction

When our Lord said the harvest was plentiful the world population was not more than 25 million. Today the challenge in India tracks thirty-three births a minute, 2000 an hour, 48,000 a day resulting in nearly 12 million a year, which is roughly the population of Australia. According to the 1931 census of India, 4.1% of the population were Christians; in the 1991 census this was reduced to 2.4%, implying that the growth of Christianity is much lower than the population explosion in India. "People are becoming Christians at a slower pace than the population growth," says Dr. Rajendran and concedes, "The way population is growing out of control calls for innovative and varied strategies"[1].

Radio as an Innovative Tool for Church Planting

In 1977, Trans World Radio, under Dr. Paul Freed[2], provided a powerful tool - a 400 KW medium wave (AM) broadcasting opportunity to blanket the nation with the gospel.

Beginning with six languages and daily five hours of broadcasting, TWR today broadcasts in fifty-two languages for over nineteen hours thirty minutes a day. Letter response has grown from 5,000 per month to 75,000. Eighty percent of the response was from people of other faiths. From this "Macedonian Call," I saw a great opportunity in radio as a door opener for Church planting. The challenge was to send forth labourers to develop personal evangelism in these virgin soils. It was during this time the Lord raised the Vishwa Vani movement.

The Birth of Vishwa Vani Movement

The Vishwa Vani movement was born out of intense prayer in 1980 with seven workers to open mission fields in strategic locations. A worker placed in these bases would reach six villages. This web concept allowed a vibrant mother church to bring forth many daughter churches. In a time when cross-cultural evangelism was prevalent we opted for a paradigm shift to place native workers, carefully recruited, properly trained, well equipped, highly motivated and totally supported by Indian Christians. Today the movement has 1100 workers.

Our training strategy includes Type I, II and III for the field workers and Type IV for pastors[3] and nursing training for wives. The target is to start home Bible schools, which

[1] Dr. Rajendran is General Secretary of India Missions Association. This observation was stated in his book 'Which Way Forward Indian Missions?- A critique of Twenty-five Years 1972-1997', SAIACS Press, 1998

[2] For more information on Dr. Paul Freed and how he established Trans World Radio, refer to his book 'Towers to Eternity,' 1976

[3] Please refer to David Bennett's paper on "India Leadership Study, A summary for Indian Christian Leaders," Dec 2001.

within a year become house churches. When people desire to confess their faith publicly, they fill in the prescribed baptism form and file an affidavit wherever applicable in the Indian states. The strategy is to relate them to a nearby Bible-believing and cooperative church. Wherever it is not possible, the Lord led the Vishwa Vani movement to initiate pastoral care.

The Birth of India Believers Fellowship

As people started placing their faith in Christ and the amount of worship centers increased, the pastoral care department of Vishwa Vani movement was organized as India Believers Fellowship to administer these newborn churches. At this point the field worker turns into a pastor taking the responsibility for the native churches in the six villages. It is in IBF that the quantitative response of TWR turns into a qualitative fruit. IBF churches are self-governed and self-supported. Their origin is under thatched roofs, but when a building is provided it is called a community center, rather than a church.

The Link to the Good Samaritans

The Good Samaritans step in to provide community care not only for the church but also for the entire village at the invitation of IBF Community Centres. The entire TWR-VV-IBF-TGS approach becomes a holistic approach resulting in transformation of the entire community.

Conclusion

The high result areas are (Lingayats) Karnataka, (Gonds) Andhra Pradesh and Madhya Pradesh, (Banjaras and Koyas) Andhra Pradesh and Orissa, (Parakh) Tripura, (Rajvanshis) West Bengal, (Newaris, Limbu, Letcha, Boro and Nepalis) Himalayas, (Maithili and Oraon) Bihar, (Bhojpuris, Awadhis and Bundelkhandis) Uttar Pradesh, (Kumaonis) Uttaranchal, (Kui, Ho and Santhalis) Orissa, (Bhili) Rajasthan and Gujarat, (Kuknas, Varlis, Kotuwalias, Gamits and Choudharies) Gujarat and (Mavchi) Maharashtra.

The VV movement as of today has 325 web centres among the 1,950 villages, 1,200 Home Bible Schools out of which 640 congregations are raised and governed by IBF.

It has a five year vision plan during which most of the above people groups should be totally won and discipled.

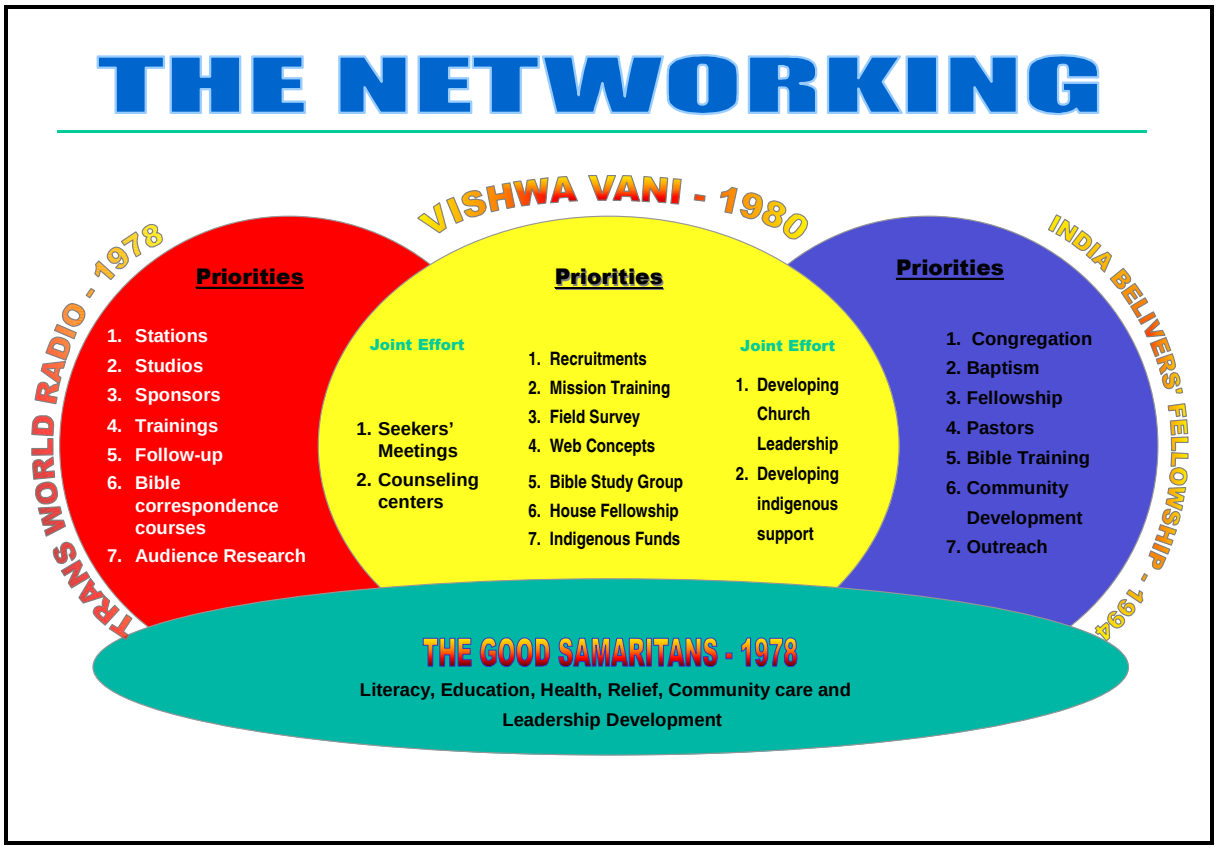


FIGURE IV-7

THE VISHWA VANI NETWORKING MODEL

An Emerging Stream in the Persian World
Ron Johnson

Do you not say, 'There are still four months and then comes the harvest? Behold, I say to you, lift your eyes and look at the fields, for they are already white for harvest! John 4:35

The 1979 Revolution

Prior to the 1979 revolution, the Shah of Iran put the country on a rapid program of modernization. Iranians in urban areas were extremely well educated and highly cultured. In fact, it was the Shah's disdain for Islam and efforts to remove it from Iranian daily life as part of his modernization program that ultimately led to his demise.

Various political groups joined forces to oust the Shah in 1979. Within the first eighteen months, various groups vied to orchestrate what the new Iran would look like. Islamic groups prevailed. The ritual prayers of Islam became mandatory. Freedom of speech, press, and conscience ended. Religious minorities, including Christians, Jews, Bahais, and Zoroastrians were persecuted.

The Iran-Iraq War

Before Iranians could mount an effective resistance to these radical changes, Iran and Iraq went to war. For eight years, the Iranians and Iraqis massacred each other. Each side lost more than one million men and boys. The war further devastated the Iranian economy, education system, and culture. However, it rallied the country behind the new government, distracting them from its extreme abuses, utter corruption, and complete incompetence.

When the war was over, the distraction ended. People began to resent the government and talked of change. Unlike other totalitarian regimes, this one could not close off its population from outside knowledge. Internet usage grew, as did satellite television. Most Iranians had either friends or relatives living outside Iran, and they communicated freely. Iranians knew full well that their government was a pariah and that the proud, industrious people were being sapped of their potential for greatness. The cry for reform grew.

Overview of Iranian Society Today

Seventy percent of Iranians are under thirty, and at least in the cities, see themselves as modern, cosmopolitan members of the world community, despite the government. Iranians long for freedom of speech, press, and thought and a social and economic system based on the rule of law.

Iranians often say "We have seen the face of Islam, and we hate it." ranians are extremely hungry and open for the gospel. God has raised up a few evangelical Armenians, and others that have found faith in Jesus through gospel radio broadcasts.

There is a small but growing number of underground Muslim background believers. They and the few outsiders attempting to reach Iran feel that if Iranians were ever able to come to an accurate understanding of the gospel, millions would come to faith overnight. One pastor recently shared that he has seven or eight Muslims come to his church every day asking how to become a Christian.

The small group of underground believers is increasingly bold in sharing their faith, despite extreme risk. Gospel radio is still broadcast into Iran. Recently, Iranians in the United States have launched satellite television stations in Persian that are accessible inside Iran. Increasingly, Iranians living outside Iran are coming to faith. Persian language churches exist in most major cities of the world, and Iranian leadership training schools exist in both England and Germany. These Iranian believers have increasingly begun to look back at Iran with their gospel efforts. And some of the new believers inside Iran are even beginning to consider reaching out to the rural areas and nomadic tribes, where there is virtually no access to the gospel, and where people are still living as they did a thousand years ago.

Foreign Mission Work

Very few people are involved in attempting to bring the gospel to Iran. Even most mission organizations do not consider work with Iran, since the barriers are so great. Precious human and financial resources are thought better spent elsewhere. Some are attempting to use the internet and satellite TV. Some efforts include placing gospel materials and the "Jesus" film on CD and DVD where they can be more easily smuggled into Iran and then copied electronically for further distribution. Some make short term trips as tourists, making contacts with Iranians along the way and corresponding with them through e-mail and regular mail. Others focus on reaching Iranians outside Iran and encouraging them to return to Iran to share their newfound faith.

Conclusion

The Iranian population is starving for the gospel, and responds in faith a high percentage of the time when receiving an understandable gospel presentation. However, that population is insulated from the gospel by the full force and effort of the government. It is unclear how long this window of openness and responsiveness in the Iranian heart will last.

What can you do?

- Pray for the underground church in Iran, for its growth and maturity,
- Witness to Iranians in your community, or even visit Iran yourself. Become an advocate for Iran work among your churches.
- Team with workers, to raise funds for projects such as broadcasting the gospel, or create Persian-language websites.

Pierson's "Renewal Movement" Scale: 20/20

The Development of the Overseas Chinese Church

John Kao

In the last one hundred years, China experienced a period of radical change. Political turmoil in the past few decades, in particular, has had an immense impact on the development of the Chinese Church, both domestic and abroad. For the sake of brevity, let us examine four important transitional points during this period of time.

Four Transitional Points

1949: After the Mao-led Communist takeover of China, refugees by the hundreds of thousands fled the country and settled in Hong Kong, Taiwan, Southeast Asia, and various cities all over the world. While the Communist government practiced isolationism from the outside world, it curbed religious freedom within the country, and evangelism appeared to have screeched to a halt. Because of the political change, some students who were studying abroad at the time were prevented from returning to China. In turn, they became a catalyst in an evangelism movement in Hong Kong, Taiwan, Southeast Asia, and beyond. Many ministries that were established during this time thrived for thirty years or longer thereafter.

Around 1967: From the mid-60s to the 70s, although the economy took off both in Hong Kong and in Taiwan, the few universities in the regions were unable to meet growing demands for post-secondary training. Consequently many families sent their children abroad to pursue further education. As well, since 1967, relaxed immigration policies in the United States, Canada, and Australia allowed many Chinese students to become permanent residents in these countries. Being young and open-minded, these students were open to the gospel. Their collective positive response meant a harvest for the gospel, and paved the way for the equipping of new leaders for an emerging Overseas Chinese Church.

The years leading up to 1997: Even in the 1980s, many Hong Kong residents began to follow through with their plans to leave the Colony, long before Hong Kong was to revert back to the regime in which they had placed little faith. Coincidentally, countries like Canada and Australia had relaxed their immigration policies. Significant out migration to the United States, Canada and Australia then followed, with profound effects on the Overseas Chinese Church. (In a slightly earlier period, a significant out migration from Taiwan to the United States had also taken place: many Taiwanese students had also chosen to stay after their studies were finished. Since most of the immigrants of this period were Mandarin speakers from Taiwan and the Mainland, Chinese churches before the 1980s were mainly Mandarin-speaking.) Now, as more Hong Kong immigrants arrived, especially into Canada, the Overseas Chinese Church had been infused with many more Cantonese speakers. The number of Cantonese-speaking churches also increased as a result.

1989: When China's doors began to open in the 1980s, many Mainlanders from a growing intelligentsia studied abroad, some under the sponsorship of the government and some self financing. After the "June 4 Incident" in 1989, many sought refugee status and were allowed to remain. Out of this group many have since accepted the Lord, as have their families who have come to join them at a later time. With increased political stability and openness, many more student-scholars from China are out migrating, representing the single most significant source of newcomers to overseas Chinese communities.

Chinese immigrants from the different periods came with different needs and their arrival has had a profound effect on the development of the Overseas Chinese Church. We may describe its development in terms of three stages:

- The earliest Chinese immigrants were not well educated. Working arduously seven days a week, they neither had the time nor the desire to reflect on the meaning of life. As a result, the Overseas Chinese Church grew at a rather slow pace during this stage.
- During the 1970s, gospel ministries amongst the students brought many well-educated, enthusiastic and open-minded new Christians into the Overseas Chinese Church. Their arrival signified the establishment of a leadership core for the Church for many years to come.
- Since 1989, the steady influx of new immigrants from Mainland China has prompted the Overseas Chinese Church to respond by organizing Bible study classes and fellowships to equip future workers for the gospel needs of the China Mainland.

Spreading the Gospel with One Accord

It was in 1974, at the "International Congress on World Evangelism" in Lausanne, that some seventy Chinese church leaders first shared the vision of convening an international Chinese congress. Soon thereafter, in January 1976, the first "Chinese Congress on World Evangelization" (CCOWE) convened in Hong Kong and The Chinese Coordination Centre of World Evangelism (CCCOWE Movement) was established. The aim of CCCOWE is to encourage the Chinese church worldwide to spread the gospel with one accord. Ever since inception, CCCOWE conferences have been held every five years, in different locations. With everyone's hard work in the past twenty-five years, we are happy to report that about thirty percent of the Chinese churches worldwide now are involved in world missions in some

A Church Renewal Movement in the Turkic World

Sam-Seong Kim

As a missionary and a pastor of a local church for thirteen years in Almaty, Kazakhstan, I was seeking the discipleship model or concept in the local church to fulfill the Great Commission. In this struggle, my church has grown to 6,000 Sunday attendance with 950 cell groups in these twelve and a half years. What made my church grow from zero to 6,000 Sunday attendance composed of mainly local Russians and Kazakhs?

I found out some factors for this growth. Beyond the impact of my personal encounter with Jesus, this includes the evangelism and discipleship stages, and a factor at the motivational level.

Evangelism Stage

Modern society needs more community-based evangelism than one-to-one evangelism. Using the "Alpha" Course as the "evangelism body" penetrating society, we made a breakthrough to win souls for the Lord and gain the possibility to make them disciples of Jesus Christ.

By using the "Alpha" Course

- People do not just hear the gospel, but establish deep relationships with other non-Christians *and fit into the home cell-group lifestyle*. (Acts 2:42-47)
- The atmosphere of our church became friendlier and showed a servant lifestyle.
- Our lay leaders began to penetrate into their work place and marketplace to open "Alpha" Courses where they are living.
- We see evangelism as the optimal way of valuing people as a person in an ongoing community relationship.

Discipleship Stage

Churches need to develop a logical, holistic process to make disciples of Jesus Christ of all non-Christian people groups. For that reason, in 1993 our church implemented Ralph Neighbour's cell church model. The church grew from 400 to 2,000 by 1999. This model laid the groundwork for all the lay people to be mobilized for ministry and identified many potential young leaders.

Real change took place in our ministry in 2001 when I traveled to Bogotá, Colombia, to attend the "International G-12 Convention" where I grasped "Jesus' Vision" for discipling nations. From February 2002 we began to implement G-12 ("Global 12") model in our church. In a period of eight months 375 cells exploded into 950 cells. Wonderful testimonies about "the changed life" through "teacher-disciple relationship" and about "commitment to Jesus" through "mentoring" overwhelmed our church.

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Everyone in the church is diligent to win souls, consolidate them, disciple them and send them into ministry. Moreover, I see the real model for "team ministry" consists of one leader and twelve disciples who are committed each other.

One young Kazakh leader with her twelve disciples opened an "Alpha" Course to evangelize students at the best university in Kazakhstan. In the first week eighty students came and ninety percent of them accepted Jesus. The next week 150 students came to hear the gospel. Kazakh people are Muslims and it is really difficult to win even one Kazakh for the Lord.

What makes it so successful? The team of twelve with this leader was very much committed to the vision for their Kazakh people and did not want to yield because of resistance to the gospel. Everyone in our church is eager to form their own twelve disciples and make teams to go into the world they are living to win, consolidate, disciple and send.

Motivational Level

God has begun His special work for us to dream and see the vision for the accomplishment of His will on earth, discipling the nations. Our church got the vision from the Lord in the year 2000, right after the "Silk Road Festival" in Almaty, Kazakhstan.

As a result, we formed the "Vision Silk Road Center" to reach the Turkic people groups along the "Old Silk Road" including Turkey, Azerbaijan, Turkmenistan, Tajikistan, Uzbekistan, Kyrgyzstan, Kazakhstan and Xinjiang Uygur Province of China. We have a clear goal: to plant 1,000 churches along the "Old Silk Road" by 2010.

Everyone in our church knows that this vision came from the Lord. The Lord clearly communicated to us to hold a "Silk Road Youth Festival" every year until 2010 to disciple thousands of young people for future ministry. Every year more than 2,000 young men and women are coming from these 8 countries for the purpose of being trained with "Alpha" Course and G-12. We are sure that we are preparing the way "Back to Jerusalem" together with Chinese brothers and sisters paving the road along the Silk Road among the Muslim Turkic and Arab peoples.

Resources: The Alpha Course is developed by Holy Trinity Church, Brompton, in London, UK, www.alphacourse.org or www.htb.org.uk

The G-12 Ministry is developed by César and Claudia Castellanos, Bogotá, Colombia, www.mci12.com or www.vision12.com

Pierson's "Renewal Movement" Scale: 18/20

Accountability and World Evangelization: Issues and Challenges for Church and Mission Agencies in Africa

Remi Lawanson

The task of evangelizing the unreached people groups in Africa with the gospel of our Lord Jesus Christ is enormous, while the resources available appear limited. There is, therefore, the need for prudent management and honest stewardship of the resources to maximize the returns on the mission field as well as enhance the support for mission.

Furthermore, the emerging mission force in Africa with its outstanding God-given giftedness needs to be strengthened with sustained support for lasting impact.

Biblical Basis

Providing for honest things, not only in the sight of the Lord, but also in the sight of men. 2 Corinthians 4:21.

The Need for Accountability

It is demanded in Scripture. Matthew 25:19; 1 Corinthians 4:1, 2, 7.

- Growing church and mission assets and growing public awareness of same.
- For ensuring the use of funds for the purpose for which they are given.
- Increased government scrutiny.
- To create an atmosphere of trust.
- To encourage more giving and support.
- To make partners and church members part of the "Team."

Accountability Principles

- ***Right people.*** Ezra 8:24, 30. From the example here in Ezra, it is extremely important that those charged with overseeing the church and mission agencies' resources should be people who evidence biblical integrity. They ought to be people who have demonstrated faithfulness in previously assigned tasks.
- ***Right accountability procedure.*** Ezra 8:24. Church leadership and mission executives should take time to develop agree on and follow standard procedures and policy. Each organization should adopt accounting systems appropriate to its size, location and setting, yet simple enough for its use.
- ***Right and standard documentation.*** Ezra 8:34; Jeremiah 32. This establishes the fact that leaders of God's people in the days of Ezra and Jeremiah ensured documentation of records. The literacy level in Africa today should be seen as being better than that in the days of Ezra and Jeremiah. Therefore, right and standard documentation is possible in Africa today even with the present level of literacy.
- ***Apostolic ministry and networks.*** Paul is a great model in this area. He provided apostolic oversight to several protégés such as Timothy, Barnabas,

and Philemon, which facilitated their accountability. This principle is in consonance with African cultural context which encourages oversight and accountability by elders.

Benefits

- Maximal returns on mission fields.
- Enhanced trust and confidence of partners and donors leading to more support. Genesis 39:5; 2 Corinthians. 9:10-11.
- Ministry expansion and growth. Genesis 39:1-6, 19-23.

Conclusion

Since 1997, the Association of Evangelicals in Africa (AEA)'s Stewardship & Accountability Commission (SAC) has been involved in running accountability training seminars in various parts of Africa for over two thousand key church leaders and mission executives in Africa with encouraging results. The SAC faculty has consisted of predominantly people "outside the box" in terms of conventional seminary and bible college training. Heads of denominations with their trustees, provosts of seminaries, pastors, missionaries and mission executives have participated.

The results have been encouraging. Some of the participants have subsequently invited SAC to run customized training seminars for their organizations. The impact has cut across language and regional lines. Training seminars have been held in French in Cote d'Ivoire (1997) and Burkina Faso (1999) with participants coming from Senegal, Cape Verde, Benin, Niger, Togo, Mali, and the host countries. Other training seminars were held in English in Uganda (1999) and Kenya (1997) for participants from all East African countries as well as Ghana (1997) and Nigeria (2000) for participants from West African countries.

Accountability is an organic function that demands a dual component of *being* and *doing*, ***accounting*** is an organizational function that basically demands *doing.*

We need to embrace the organic function of accountability without neglecting the organizational function of accounting as we prayerfully believe God to lead the church in Africa to the next level in world mission and evangelization.

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Pierson's "Renewal Movement" Scale: 18/20

The Back to Jerusalem Movement
Peter Lee

Awakened Generals

In November 2001 twenty men and women leaders representing the majority of house churches in China met to discover how the Lord wanted them to prepare the Chinese church for the great social changes expected as China joined the World Trade Organization and Beijing hosted the 2008 Olympics. They voiced fear that massive socio-economic changes were slowly overpowering the faith of many while the authorities pressured remaining unregistered house churches to register.

The Holy Spirit spoke to those present: instead of focusing on inward problems the church in China should enter the stream of world mission. They were reminded that God is opening China so they may reach the unreached. God no longer expects China to remain isolated, but to proclaim in the rest of the world what God has done in China over the last decades.

Those present, like old generals awakened from a long rest to lead an army, stood up in dignity. Suddenly one cried out, "Westward to evangelize the rest of China." They all shouted it back in unison. Someone shouted, "Westward, back to Jerusalem." With a great voice, everyone present affirmed it. Their fears disappeared and they were all charged up to go the ends of the earth. God reminded them of the "Back to Jerusalem Evangelistic Band." They were suddenly joined with their forefathers in determination and commitment to reach all the way to Jerusalem to prepare for the coming of Jesus Christ.

Historical Roots

They remembered their history. On November 25, 1942, Rev. Mark Ma of Northwest Bible Institute at Paoki, Shensi, China, heard God's voice: "The door to Xinjiang is already opened. Enter and preach the Gospel." He was afraid to go, afraid to change his life, so he waited.

On Easter 1943, God sent a co-workers to reconfirm His call. That morning the Holy Spirit gave eight students a heart burning to reach the Turkistan people in Xinjiang. They started weekly prayer meetings called the Back to Jerusalem Evangelistic Band (Pien Ch'uan Fu Yin T'uan- literally "Preach Everywhere Gospel Band").

In summer 1946, two male students traveled westward to Tulan, Tsinghai, the last outpost of northwest China and began evangelizing. In spring 1947, six women and one man began the journey by camel to Xinjiang. God had given them specific instructions to reach seven countries: Afghanistan, Iran, Arabia, Iraq, Syria, Turkey and Palestine.

When they reached the Chinese border they found that it had been closed just one month before. They never received permission to leave due to the political changes in China so they settled in Tulan to preach the gospel to Chinese Turkistans. Some of the original seven still live and preach in Xinjiang, still praying and waiting for the Lord to appoint someone to take their baton through the Muslim nations back to Jerusalem.

While these worked and waited on the border, Chinese house churches grew. Prevented from sending missionaries internationally, the church turned inward. By the 1980s a few house church movements had begun sending missionaries to other regions. They called this work, "Immigration Mission." The sending church gave their appointed missionary enough money to buy a one-way bus fare and covered bare minimum living expenses for one year to eighteen months. They expected their missionary to become self-sufficient within eighteen months and continue spreading the gospel. This entirely indigenous missionary movement was completely self-supported and proved the basis for unprecedented church growth.

The Holy Spirit is now calling the Chinese church to finish the task, taking the Gospel on its last leg, back to Jerusalem. These house church leaders recognized their responsibility to this call. The church continues to grow and desires to fulfill this responsibility, but how?

Missiological Myths Reinforced

By ignoring the principles of the Back to Jerusalem Evangelistic Band and the Immigration Mission movement and teaching only from Western experience, external missiologists are reinforcing certain myths that hinder the Chinese church's development. Through the influence of Western missionaries, many Chinese leaders have become convinced of certain myths. For example, Chinese leaders are learning that: (1) every missionary must have a large financial support base; (2) every missionary must be an accredited pastor; (3) every missionary must have studied missiology; and (4) every missionary must speak English so they can be part of the international mission community. These myths greatly reduce the missionary sending will and capability of the Chinese church.

Two Questions

The Holy Spirit is hard at work in China. Now the Holy Spirit is encouraging the Chinese church to return to their original call of continuing the westward move of the Gospel. In that nondescript back room, the twenty Chinese house church leaders representing a huge segment of the Chinese church, heard the Holy Spirit's challenge and determined to answer it. They have asked foreign missionaries to help train them so that they can send 100,000 missionaries by the year 2007, to celebrate the bicentennial of the first missionary coming to China.

The church in China certainly needs training for mission. Two questions remain:

- How should the international mission community help, if at all, without jeopardizing the lessons the Holy Spirit has already taught the Chinese church about their role and their context?
- How can we work in partnership with them, sharing learned experiences, in our common call to take the Gospel westward, all the way back to Jerusalem?

Association of Evangelicals in Africa (AEA)

Mario Li Hing

The Association of Evangelicals in Africa is a continental movement of evangelical churches and para-church agencies committed to discipling the nations strategically for Christ through collaborative action with the vision '***Evangelicals in Africa united for holistic ministries to make a difference***'.

AEA was born in February 1966 in Kenya as a result of a felt need for a permanent association which would help build up a united movement of the Body of Christ that would promote evangelical unity, fellowship and Christian witness for total evangelization and effective transformation of Africa.

It has grown to a wide family of over 70 millions Christians throughout the African continent comprised of forty-six National Fellowships made up of numerous local churches, forty-two Associate Members consisting of para-church organizations and fourteen Special Members who constitute local churches in countries where there are no national fellowships yet representing.

Where are We?

Africa is a complex region, held together by the fact that it is one continent of infinite variety and cultural richness. This broad spectrum of humanity is reflected in its religious life in general and in the Christian church in particular where indigenous theologies are adding to the vitality and vibrancy of faith. Stronger national churches are evident in West Africa, persecution is fierce in the North East, and there is strong legalism and intolerance even within parts of the Christian church. Christian social concern in the face of AIDS is high and growing and there is a strong desire to see overt evangelism given a higher priority. Many reports provide a valuable insight into the unique challenges and opportunities of that continent. It also confirms the common difficulties being faced.

AEA carries out its various objectives through its ten commissions. Relief and Development is one of them and it serves the evangelical constituency and the wider society with programmes aimed at enhancing available resources and transforming the society raising the banner of hope for Africa.

The scourge of the HIV/AIDS epidemic cannot be ignored any longer. The UNAIDS report at the end of 2001 indicates that out of the 40 million people living with HIV/AIDS, 28.1 million (70.25%) are from Sub Saharan Africa, and a total of 5 million who died of the disease worldwide, 2,4 million (48%) were from sub-Saharan Africa.

In light of the devastating impact, the subject of HIV/AIDS will be given emphasis at its General Council meeting in November 2003 in Addis Ababa. Other agencies such as World Relief would be contacted for a collaborative action as we recognise the need to establish partnerships with those whose aims and approaches are complementary to our

own. For example Scripture Union ministry, 'Aid for AIDS', has a three-year project in West Africa in partnership with Tear Fund for HIV awareness programs in order to mobilize a cohesive Christian response. At first four countries will be involved: Sierra Leone, Ghana, Liberia and Nigeria.

We wish to build on what God has graciously provided for us through the Holy Spirit and His people. The need our Lord clearly stated is missions "*The Spirit of the Lord is on me, because he has anointed me to preach good news to the poor. He has sent me to proclaim freedom for the prisoners and recovery of sight for the blind, to release the oppressed."* Luke 4:18

Some Potential Benefits and Problems

Political destabilization is likely to occur. There will be increased global people movements as a result of local civil unrest, war, climate change and economic instability.

With the decreased global economic stability in the coming decade the world economy will be increasingly influenced by fewer and fewer larger players – America, Europe and China. Generation and distribution of funds will be affected.

Technology has transformed the way the world communicates. The Church has yet to take full advantage of this opportunity. With hardware costs failing and access growing exponentially, significant changes are needed in the way we communicate.

Humanity's need for God has never been greater, if only because the world's population continues to grow faster than the Church. In the same way, the opportunities for our Movement have never been greater.

Contact: AEA Nairobi <info@aea.co.ke>, a source for publications about AEA – AFROSCOPE

Pierson's "Renewal Movement" Scale: 14/20

An African Training Model

Medhin Mesghina

African Leadership Training (ALT) is an organization doing training programs every year to fulfill the enormous needs in the church of the southern Sudan and in Egypt. The training covers many different fields, such as evangelism, discipleship, theological studies, family ministries, and counseling.

A Credible Witness

ALT, though, is not limited just to leadership training among the Sudanese but also responds to the felt needs of the people. Service evangelism can be defined as those ministries which meet physical, social, and economic needs of Christians and Muslims. Done in Jesus' name, such activities build quality relationships and earn credibility for the believers. Successful missionaries have learned that they must address more then just the spiritual needs of those they seek to reach. In a cross-cultural context, one must first earn the right to be heard through service meeting the most pressing needs of the people.

There are currently three million Sudanese refugees in Cairo, Egypt. The most urgent reason people leave their home country is the violence against them, the looting of their possessions, and the bombing of their towns, cities, and their churches. Although, the process of leaving one's country is very difficult, many of them feel they have no alternative.

My Personal Call

The background of this ministry is rooted in my personal convictions. I was living as a refugee for five years in Sudan and Kenya before coming to the United States of America. When I first came to Biola University as a graduate student, I went to the cafeteria for breakfast. You can just imagine my eyes as I looked at all the plentiful food they had. I went around the cafeteria and filled my plate with all the various foods. I went to the table and prayed for my meal. When I opened my eyes, I saw many students playing and wasting their breakfast. I could not help myself but to cry. At that point, I told myself that I would go back to the refugees every year to help them with their situation.

After working for twenty years at Biola the Lord has called my wife and me to work full time with the Middle East refugees.

A Special Claim on the Church

Why do displaced people have a special claim on the Church in its pastoral mission? The fundamental reason is simple: Christ identified himself with the poor and the neglected, the most vulnerable, those who are marginal and cast off by society. The conclusion is that God is present in a special way with those who suffer — the widows, orphans and

refugees. God speaks to us in and through them, as they call to us for assistance and help in changing the underlying conditions which caused them to flee their homes. In this sense, they are a "sign of our times."
The surprising way God is at work with this ministry is evident against the dark background of the Sudanese refugees in Egypt. The Lord began to move powerfully across the refugee camps. During a time of terror and lawlessness, ordinary Christians found great courage and boldness to move outward, reaching other Sudanese and Egyptians for Christ. In spite of great adversities, men and women of great passion had the desire to spread the good news of our Lord Jesus Christ to the people.

Hope for the Future

The dream of this ministry is to have strong national leaders who can plant new churches in the areas that have no local church in Khartoum, southern Sudan, and in Egypt. The other goal is to equip the twenty percent of refugees that are going to the United States, Canada, Australia, and Germany in church planting skills so they can build a strong contextualized church.

The revival that is taking place amongst the Sudanese people is having a great impact on the traditional Egyptian churches, like the Anglican and the Coptic Church. When I was in Cairo last summer, I was so blessed to meet a former foreign minister's wife and her son who had dedicated their lives to Christ.

This type of movement is bringing conflict amongst the traditional church and the strong evangelical Sudanese church. While the Anglican Church is losing members the Sudanese church is growing by two hundred percent.

Resources:
Adeyemo, Tokumboh. *Solution in African Tradition*, Nairobi, Evangelical Publication House
Barrett, David B. *Schism and Renewal in Africa*, Oxford University Press
Kraft, Charles. *Readings in Dynamic Indigenicity*, William Carey Library, 1968.
Okerstorm, Lois. *Touched by the African Soil*, 1979
Mesghina, Medhin. *Eritrea the Agony of my People*.

Pierson's "Renewal Movement" Scale: 15/20

Rwanda: Lessons from the Ministry and Life of the Church

in the Last Twenty-five Years

Rev. Célestin Musekura

Introduction and Background

Until the mid-1980s the Western missionary community presented Rwanda as a success story with the growth of Christianity and the eradication of the ancestral worship and animistic practices in the country. Membership of the Protestant community was growing rapidly in a country dominated by Roman Catholicism. By mid-1990, Rwanda was said to be more than eighty percent Christian. Socially and economically, Rwanda was a success story also for Western political leaders.

Nine years ago, the world witnessed the worst human self-destruction in recent history. Out of a population of eight million, about one million Tutsis and moderate Hutus were massacred within 100 days. About three million fled the country and lived in refugee camps in neighboring countries where more than 3,000 people died every day for the first six months.

Questions and Struggles

After these unparalleled intertribal massacres, the church of Rwanda has been blamed for failing to reconcile ethnic groups despite the high Christian presence in the country. Christians in the West are still asking: "How could such a killings take place in a country that is predominantly Christian? How could a Church that was once the source of a revivals that swept the whole of the East Africa in 1930s and '70s fail to rise above tribalism to achieve unity and reconciliation? Are these Christians killing Christians?

While the church of Rwanda (which lost about seventy percent of its leadership) is struggling to answer questions like these, little is being done by the Western Church to help the Christian community in Rwanda recover from its loss and failure and to strengthen its already weakened leadership. A handful of educated Christian leaders who survived the genocide are struggling, without adequate tools and resources, to carry on a ministry of spiritual and social transformation through the biblical message of repentance, forgiveness, and reconciliation.

African Leadership & Reconciliation Ministries (ALARM, Inc.) was born in this setting to empower the African Church to impact the African continent by developing and equipping leaders with skills and tools to nurture and deepen the Christian faith for the transformation of African communities.

God at Work through ALARM, Inc.

Through this ministry,

- Hutus and Tutsi pastors, church leaders, and lay leaders are working together to model reconciliation and build trust between the two tribes
- Compensation is made for failures of the formal theological education system by providing education to disadvantaged indigenous evangelical leaders already involved in Christian ministries.
- Indigenous African leaders provide biblically-based, theologically-sound, and pastorally-relevant education to their fellow countrymen without paying attention to Western-imposed denominationalism.

Dreams and Key Issues

The dream of ALARM leadership is to strengthen the African church through building capacity of pastoral leaders. Training opportunities are provided to the majority leaders through nonformal education programs so that each congregation will have mature, trained leaders who can train and equip others to impact their communities and to bring reconciliation among denominations and tribes.

ALARM's biblical basis is the Great Commission and the Great Commandment. Discipling the nations include not only converting the nations but teaching them to obey all which Christ teaches in His Word. These include loving God and loving neighbors no matter their tribe, race, region, and religion. The ministry of reconciliation is an important component in the fulfillment of the Great Commission. Matthew 28:18-20; 22:37-40; 2 Corinthians 5:17-21; Ephesians 2:11-22.

Conceptual issues emerging in this ministry include the lack of teaching materials that addresses issues of tribalism, HIV/AIDS, polygamy, relationship between evangelism and social responsibility, the nature of indigenous leadership, new relationships between the Church in the West and the African church during the social crises, growth of fundamental Islam and the Islamization of the black Africans in sub-Sahara Africa through relief and humanitarian aids.

Benefits and Problems

Benefits of this ministry include bringing together leaders from different denominations and tribes. The emergence of the role of women in the ministry has been strengthened by our focus on training pastor's wives and women leaders for ministry. Indigenous national leaders play the roles once held by Western missionaries forced to leave due to tribal and political crises.

Problems include lack of adequate facilities and resources to provide more training to more needy leaders who are applying for the training opportunities. The lack of Bible study materials and the lack of knowledge of basic Biblical doctrines continue to be a hindrance to a dynamic discipleship programs in the church of East and Central Africa.

What is God Saying to His Church?

In a world characterized by divisions and alienations, the Church must play its role as agent of hope, healing, and reconciliation through its life and ministry. The Church as a community of the forgiven must model individual and communal forgiveness among all nations with the goal of presenting the Risen Christ who alone is able to bring true justice, peace and reconciliation.

Resources: Publications by Celestin Musekura include

"When the Foundations are Being Destroyed, What can the Righteous Do?" *The Mediator*, September 1995

"Mentoring: Remedy for The African Christian Leadership Crisis." *The Church Leader in Africa,* 1999.

Ubutabera no Gukiranuka [Justice and Righteousness], and *Inshuti ya Pastori* [The Pastor's Companion: Sermon Outlines for Refugee Pastors], Nairobi, Kenya: MAP International Publications.

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Pierson's "Renewal Movement" Scale: 19/20

The Dalit Bahujan Movement for Socio-Spiritual Freedom

The Dalit Bahujan peoples of India are comprised by the Scheduled Castes (SC), the Tribals and the Other Backward Castes (OBC). Together they make up over seventy-five percent of the population of India. Their identity as Dalit Bahujan people is born out of the Hindu caste system. .

Historical Background

Caste revolt and exodus from the caste system has been going on for centuries. In fact, the first major caste reformation and revolt took place under Buddha and Buddhism. By the fourth century A.D., most of South India was Buddhist. If Buddhists are a very small minority in India today it is because of the vicious persecution and mass genocide initiated by caste Hindus in the fifth century A.D. Buddhism was wiped out of India.

The present resurgence of Buddhism is mainly due to Dr. B.R. Ambedkar's rejection of Hinduism and his subsequent turning to Buddhism soon after Indian independence from British rule. It was Ambedkar, a Dalit, and his mentor, Mahatma Phule, an OBC, who launched the fiercest attack on Hinduism and gave the call for Dalits and OBCs to turn to faiths that offer spiritual equality and full rights.

Recent Moves

Caste turmoil in Indian society has erupted politically, socially and spiritually in the last decade and is a full-blown reality in Indian society. The mass conversion to Buddhism of Udit Raj and other Dalit leaders on November 4, 2002, and the call to Dalits to leave Hinduism and join non-casteist faiths has today become a major movement. The exodus of the Dalits is driving the anti-conversion laws in India. The persecution of Christians by extremist Hindus is also because of this exodus. The Hindutva strategy is to focus on "external" enemies like Christians or the Muslims in order to keep the lower castes within the Hindu system and mobilize them as a political bloc.

Since November 4, 2002, the public stance of solidarity by Indian Christians with hundreds of Dalit groups and many thousands of their leaders in their personal and public quest for socio-spiritual freedom is leading many Dalits and OBCs into the Kingdom.

Three Dimensions and the Full Gospel

This movement towards the Gospel has social, spiritual and community dimensions. These oppressed communities are looking for major reformation spiritually and socially. The Christian commitment to the Dalits is to help build a caste free society – and more so, a caste free Church. The traditional caste-dominated churches in India are being challenged by the nature of this movement that challenges their own compromise on the issue of caste- the Dalits are rightly asking for equal spiritual and social rights within the Body of Christ.

Caste-based Hinduism is being defined as spiritual fascism by OBC ideologues such as Kancha Ilaiah and others. Faiths that offer spiritual democracy and freedom are the alternatives being proposed by these ideologues. Many of these leaders openly state that the Christian faith is the first and only alternative if Christians are willing to practice the teachings of Jesus.

The request of the Dalit Bahujan community and its leaders is that Christians would bring the full Gospel to them and address the personal, social and community bondage that they face under the dehumanizing caste system. Christians in India are committed to this and are therefore seeing one of the biggest movement towards the Gospel.

Key Features of the Movement

This movement toward Christ is marked by the following significant features.

God has placed Kingdom-oriented leaders within the Dalit Bahujan community who are guiding their people ideologically and socially into the faith that gives them freedom from spiritual fascism. The Kingdom-oriented leaders are spread across the nation and will not compromise on their people finding human equality and full spiritual rights this side of eternity.

There is a sovereign move of God as He has used the persecution of Christians to bond the Christian community and the Dalit- Bahujan people in a new way. The direct interaction and bonding is leading to major social and leadership and community networks across the nation. There is a spirit of repentance and contrition among Christians for their own mistreatment of Dalits within the Church. The Christians and the Dalit-Bahujan people are together victims of oppression of the Hindutva forces that have unleashed religious violence in the nation

The Dalit Bahujan movement has called upon the Christian Church to establish tens of thousands of English-medium schools for their children who are their future generation. They have stated that their children and communities need quality education with a Biblical worldview that speaks and teaches about the equality of human beings, the compassionate nature of the Biblical work etc. Christians are responding and hundreds of new schools have started in the last couple of years.

God himself has visited the Dalit Bahujan people and there is a clear revival among them. Accounts of miracles, divine working and healings abound across the nation. Stories of divine transformation among these communities abound.

The movement has resulted in tens of thousands of new disciples being added to many of the independent denominations, mission groups and other agencies who are responding to the needs of these people. One independent Church body for example

has seen over 100,000 people from these communities added to their churches across the nation. Another network of churches and agencies has initiated a national fellowship of churches called the "Good Shepherd Community Churches" which has seen over 500 fellowships being born with an average of more than fifty people in each fellowship. Another Church group reported close to 50,000 people being added to their denomination during the year 2002'.

Avoiding Blunders of the Past

Mission societies and mission leaders committed one of the biggest mission blunders of mission history when they unwittingly accepted the Brahmin's definition of Hinduism and the nature of Hindu society. In the name of contextualization, the Church has tried to adjust the Gospel to "Brahminism." which is nothing but spiritual fascism of the worst kind in operation for nearly 3500 years. Religiously sanctioned racism operates within the caste system. The doctrine of the purity of race, blood and Aryanism is the basis of casteism. By trying to contextualize the Gospel to Brahminism Christians compromised on many of the basic tenets of the Gospel. It is because of this that the Dalit-Bahujan people have seen Buddhism and Islam as better options to escape spiritual fascism. It is common knowledge that vast numbers of Sudras and Dalits have turned to Islam in the last 500 years voluntarily and not because of the sword.

Thus, it is in this context that believers in India must now forsake the traditional caste-based Christianity so long perpetuated, and cling to the spiritual, human and social equality and freedom offered by the Gospel. The defeat of spiritual fascism is the task of the Kingdom of God. Jesus will set the victims free. The Dalit-Bahujan people increasingly know that Jesus has the answer to their needs.

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Pierson's "Renewal Movement" Scale: 14/20

The Third Way Chinese Christian Revival Fellowship

This paper is based on notes taken in the February 2002 China consultation involving the main strategists of core fellowship groups who are anticipating and facilitating emergence of a new church stream bringing together Three-Self Patriotic Movement (TSPM) and House Church Movement.

Vision

A new model of local churches allied with the strength of the Three-Self churches and house churches for launching China as a Mission country in the twenty-first century

Identity

The third model of local churches in China

Mission

To establish a fellowship of evangelical influence in China to plant third way churches as an alternative model for local congregations.

Motto

- We are in union in the Holy Spirit
- We are partners in biblical truth
- We are a mission

Values

- No conflict between Three-Self Churches and House Churches
- No compromise on biblical truth
- No concealment of local church witness
- No contradiction with "stability and development" policy
- No competition with any existing denominations, church models, organizations and systems.

Actions

- Form a consultative committee for the strategies and holistic arrangements such as fund raising and promotion
- Form a core work group for implementation and administration.
- Arrange a series of conferences, forums and multi-dialogues
- Put out a document of the Third Way Church model
- Establish a training center for spiritual study and leadership training
- Make contact with the government, TSPM, House Churches, and the worldwide church who have this burden
- For the future church mission and its development develop a networking relationship

Facts

- After the Cultural Revolution closed the doors of all churches including TSPM they were opened in 1978. At that time an estimated seventy percent of the Protestant stream of the church in China was TSPM churches while thirty percent were house churches.
- In 1994 (about fifteen years later) the percentage had almost inverted. Now forty percent are TSPM and fifty-five percent house churches, but new a new stream has emerged, five percent, called the New Model Movement. Many ministers left the TSPM for the house churches at this time.
- In 2002 (eight years later) TSPM was only thirty percent, house churches sixty percent but the new model movement ten percent

Pierson's "Renewal Movement" Scale: 17/20

A Short History of the Third World Missions Association

Minoru Okuyama

The Third World Missions Association (TWMA) is a fellowship of missions in the Third World. I am the chairman working with six other officers, including vice-chairman, treasurer, and general coordinator. These seven are key figures of TWMA. Further, we have executive members who represent each continent.

Every three years we have held our General Council and, at the same time, the Third World Mission Congress. At our Brazil congress in 1996 we decided that the next congress should be known as the "World Mission Congress," since, as everybody knows, non-Western missionaries are more than their Western counterparts in number. This event was held in Kyoto, Japan, in 1999, the first world mission congress in the Japanese church history.

The Birth of TWMA

Touching this short history of TWMA, we have to mention Asia Missions Association (AMA), the mother of TWMA. AMA was launched in Korea by Rev. David Cho, Rev. Petros Octavianus, Dr. Philip Teng and other mission leaders of Asia in 1973. AMA held missions conferences every three years and in 1986 proposed the formation of TWMA. In May 1988, TWMA was launched in Portland, Oregon, USA, with the cooperation of Western Theological Seminary and IICC (headed by Dr. Donald Smith).

The preamble of TWMA's constitution explains its founding:

> In fulfillment of the mission of God, in obedience to the Lord's commission and the Holy Spirit's guidance and in response to the urgent in the world today, a consultation on the Third World Missions Association took place in Portland, Oregon, USA from 9-13 May 1988. The Consultation brought together some 35 church and mission leaders from 21 countries (Argentina, Bangladesh, Bolivia, Brazil, Egypt, El Salvador, England, Guatemala, Greece, Hong Kong, India, Indonesia, Japan, Kenya, Korea, Lebanon, Nigeria, Pakistan, Philippines and USA) to consider the way on which Third World Missions can advanced today.

Objectives and Organization

TWMA has nine concrete objectives, but the sum and substance of it might be that we encourage each other to participate in the accomplishment of the task of world mission (Matthew 24:14).

TWMA's constitution defines four categories of membership

- Full membership will be granted to national or regional missions' associations in the Third World and/or mission agencies on good standing where national or regional associations are non-existent.
- Associate membership will be granted to churches, organizations and individuals from non-Western countries/regions who are involved in missions and willing to be part of the Association.
- Special membership will be granted to individuals, local churches and organizations in countries in the Third World where no national association exists at the moment and who are involved in missionary activities which promote and/or support the Third World Missionary initiatives.
- Cooperative membership will be granted to non-Third World Mission agencies and individuals who are involved in missions activities that are supportive of Third World missionary initiatives and/or promote such interests

Congresses, Cooperation and Future Plans

As many missiologists know, mission congresses often bear many good fruits of cooperation among missions in missionary activities. TWMA congresses have also led to good cooperation among missions in the Third World, such as a covenant of cooperation between missions in South America and the Middle East.

We planned to have the General Council Meeting and Congress in Cairo, Egypt, in 2002, inviting delegations from about 150 nations. The government of Egypt agreed to this and was ready to offer the best international congress hall in Cairo. Due to the political situation in Palestine, the government of Egypt asked us to postpone the event. Since we could not postpone, we decided to hold a smaller event at a Coptic Church in Port Said.

We are planning to have our next General Council meeting and Congress in 2005. Church and mission leaders of Egypt have proposed to us to hold a big congress in Egypt in 2004. In the near future our steering committee will discuss which should have priority. The more we hold these mission congresses, the more missions and churches will join TWMA. At present, we are concentrating our ministries on the Muslim World. We need prayer support and advice to do our task of world mission.

May our Lord bless all of you!

Emerging Mission in the Himalayas

Cindy Perry

Birth of a Movement

Since the mid-1990s ***HIM-COE*** has become a watchword among Nepali and Himalayan churches for mobilization for evangelism and mission. In 1994, Dr Thomas Wang of the AD2000 & Beyond movement was welcomed to Nepal. In the concluding Kathmandu Declaration the vision was cast for 'the Gospel to every person and the church among every people' to the wider Himalayan region. In 1996 the first HIM-COE was organized in North Bengal, in the Eastern Himalayas, the beginning of a Nepali-Himalayan movement, bringing together for the first time nearly 1500 Christian leaders from across the Central & Eastern Himalayas. The emphasis was cooperation in evangelising and planting churches throughout the region. The Himalayan AD2000 movement was birthed, with a central committee of church leaders and regional coordinators to carry the momentum to local regions and the grass-roots level. Identification as 'Nepali' was found to be a high value, overriding denominational and organisational loyalties, especially in the wider Himalayan context.

Over the next few years localised regional movements emerged across the region (and some again disappeared) — some took on a life of their own from which dynamic younger leaders and creative strategies emerged. In 1998 the second HIM-COE was held, casting the vision for missions, with the rallying call, *"Himalayan Jati (peoples) Missionary Jati"!* and the challenge of reaching the widespread Nepali-Himalayan diaspora. Sikkim picked up this cry, and held a second SIK-COE in '99 with specific challenge to reach the surrounding unreached Himalayan nations of Bhutan and Tibet.

With the turn of the century came an emphasis on younger potential leaders. HIM-MEET was held in 2001 for over 2000 young people, including invitations to Christian professionals for career-counseling sessions, and workshops on burning social issues rarely addressed in the churches. HIM-COE 2003 called a more select cross-section of Himalayan leaders once again, this time for practical teaching and strategizing for missions mobilization.

A Progression of Emphases and Cooperation

In less than ten years, the following progression of emphases can be seen in this Himalayan mission stream:

- Evangelism
- Mission vision-casting
- Younger leaders and professionals
- Social issues
- Missions mobilization
- and now Transformational/Integral Mission.

It has been an emerging progression, by the primary leading of the Holy Spirit, and a small core of visionary local leaders, clearly identifiable only in retrospect; not pre-conceptualized. This is one of the most surprising ways God has been at work through this movement – not by any well-planned long-term strategy, but touching hearts, and using the weak, those willing to listen to His direction and risk steps of faith, to accomplish beyond what any of those involved imagined.

This movement has been based on hard-won cooperation, demanding a lot of 'Christian diplomacy' and perseverance. None of the key leaders have compromised their primary ministry commitments, and all partners within the movement have retained their autonomy and distinct identity. One partner serves the movement for administration and international links, while the Himalayan Prayer Fellowship has provided prayer covering.

Key Features

One important aspect of this movement has been the impact of creative, culturally honoring, highly visual, and dramatic means of presentation, which were ground-breaking among Himalayan churches – for example, Gospel culture shows using ethnic dance forms; prayer in all local languages at Gospel rally (some languages used for first time in a public meeting); Torch Rally of young people marching ninety kilometres into the hills visiting all churches along the way; Passing the Torch from honorary pioneer foreign missionaries to the local leaders; mobilizing over 100 young people for one-month voluntary Winter Gospel Trekking; mobilizing Christian professionals for self-financed mission outreach, and urban research tour of dispersed Nepali communities.

A second aspect that stands out is the impact of research, as leaders were motivated by graphic presentations of the harvest field, and by providing accurate information for focused outreach and placing of workers into neediest fields.

Potential benefits include greater unity among churches and better understanding of the Kingdom of God, strength by working together, avoidance of duplication, networking and cooperation re manpower, multi-media, and financial resources. But there are also problems – lack of dedicated leaders, dependence on foreign funds, misunderstandings and jealousies between leaders, power-seeking, rising tribalism and communalism, and the challenge of keeping the momentum.

Himalayan leaders continue to dream. One dreams of at least fifty percent of the Himalayan region responding to Christ (currently less than five percent), through a strong local harvest force, and also reaching Nepali-Himalayan peoples dispersed around the world. He also has a burden to reach the local Bhutias of Sikkim and N. Bengal and build them into a harvest force to reach the wider Tibeto-Buddhist world. Another dreams of mobilizing the Nepali churches and peoples in self-supporting global mission beyond their borders. Another dreams of transformational mission grabbing the hearts of Himalayan churches, and seeing their communities and society transformed from the inside out.

Resources: This movement has produced very little documentation. A short video of HIM-COE 1996 was produced by Caleb Ministries. Two books by Dr Cindy Perry give historical and ethnic background, but don't deal with the movement itself: *Biographical History of the Church in Nepal* (1990, NCHP, Kathmandu); and *Nepali Around the World*: *Emphasizing Nepali Christians in the Himalayas* (1996, Ekta Book Publishing, Kathmandu).

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Pierson's "Renewal Movement" Scale: 16/20

The Antioch Effect in Singapore

Ed Pousson

Late last century several voices independently designated Singapore an Antioch for Asia.[1] This paper describes one initiative that takes this designation seriously. "Antioch 21" is an effort by Singapore churches and ministries to bring the gospel to countries, cities, and unreached peoples of Asia and beyond. It has an intermediate goal of planting churches in 100 unreached people groups in Southeast Asia by 31 December 2004.

The initiative began in 1996 as a regional application of Joshua Project 2000 of the AD2000 & Beyond Movement. God used Joshua Project to sharpen Singapore's focus on unreached peoples. It later became the fifth of five strategic goals of "Vision 2001/Love Singapore," which also began as a local expression of AD2000 & Beyond.

Love Singapore spent her early years pursuing her first four goals:

- Unite the Body,
- Serve the Community,
- Establish a Prayer Cell in Every Block by the year 2000, and
- Launch a Seven-Wave Harvest in 2001.

After 2001, however, "Goal 5" began to receive primary attention, when it restructured and took the name, "Antioch 21."

Antioch 21 hopes to achieve her mission objectives through a broad-based strategy that includes prayer, research, communication, special events, training, church mobilization, and youth mobilization. For church mobilization, Antioch 21 adapts from such models as the "Gateway Strategy" of Willie Crew's World Mission Center in South Africa and Interdev's Partnership model developed by Phil Butler.

Antioch 21 is one initiative, along side others, that has passionately seeks to realize Singapore's "Antioch calling." Conceptually, Antioch 21 is:

A Dream to Relive a Biblical Legacy

The ancient Antioch church bridged the Gospel between the Jewish world and Gentile world. Before Antioch, Christianity was little more than a sect within Judaism. After Antioch, Christianity became a worldwide faith., As an Antioch for Asia, Singapore must play a similar role within Asia, linking the energies and resources of the church with the needs of the unreached peoples beyond her borders. The true indicator of our progress will be, not the number of missionaries—Singapore has about 450 missionaries, one for every church here—but the number of new, indigenous, contextually effective churches planted among the unreached.

[1] These include Billy Graham in 1978, David Yonggi Cho in 1982, and Patrick Johnstone in an early 1980s edition of *Operation World*.

A Beginning on the Periphery

Anonymous refugees founded the Antioch church. Men who had little connection with the leadership in Jerusalem launched the Gentile mission from Antioch. The apostles in Jerusalem embraced both the church and the mission, but not without some scrutiny.

In a similar way, Antioch 21 had its beginnings (as Joshua Project 2000) on the periphery of Singapore's established church and mission structures. Today it has moved to the center of Love Singapore's program and is now led by a pastor of apostolic caliber. But some leaders in mainline denominations would still consider LoveSingapore/Antioch 21 a fringe movement. However, it draws pastors and leaders from a broad range of denominations, including the mainstream.

A Timely Transition to a Missions Focus

Although it adopted a missions focus early on, LoveSingapore's initial focus was on loving God and loving neighbor in Singapore. Goal 1—uniting the body—employed relatively "new" spiritual dynamics of repentance and reconciliation across church and denominational lines. Goals 2, 3, and 4 were evangelistic and saw much fruit. In keeping with the historic pattern of renewal movements birthing missionary movements, LoveSingapore is now committed to loving Asia and the world through Antioch 21 and other related initiatives.

A Church-based Missions Effort

Antioch 21's tagline is "churches planting churches to reach all peoples." Its leader, Rick Seaward, pastors a Singapore church that has planted over 500 churches overseas, either directly or through daughter churches. While recognizing the historical biblical role of missions agencies, Antioch 21 seeks motivate local churches to become the seedbed of missions and to play a proactive and pivotal role in church planting among the unreached.

An Effort to Unite Sending Churches and Sending Agencies

The relationship between Paul's apostolic team and the church in Acts provides a biblical model for church and mission relationship today. These relationships, however, weathered anxious moments. Acts 15 and Galatians 2, for example. But the leaders resolved these tensions and partnered together to reach out to their world. Antioch 21 seeks to engage churches and mission agencies as equal partners in God's mission to all peoples.

Pierson's "Renewal Movement" Scale: 18/20

A Facilitating Ministry for the Movements of God within Society:
A Case Study of Indonesia

Iman Santoso

Background and Biblical Basis

If our purpose and goal is toward the transformation of the cities or of the country, we need to have a holistic and global perspective on the movements of God that work simultaneously in different areas of life. We cannot separate the prayer movements from mission movements or other movements of God, for example, in mass media, in church planting, evangelism, or in acts of mercy.

In order to have a maximum impact for the work of the Kingdom of God, there needs to be the role of facilitators who can relate and join many functioning parts of the Body of Christ. Within the last one or two decades, we have seen the movements of God in rising up a new model of ministry that is: **the facilitating ministry**.

The biblical basis for such ministry is found in 1 Corinthians 12-14; Ezekiel 37; Ephesians 4:1-16

Conceptual Issues

Like blood vessels, joints or the nervous system, which function in joining different parts of the human body, the nature of the work of a facilitator is to be a linkage or a bridge that joins or relates different centers (hubs) of ministries, in such ways that they can work in synergy for certain purposes.

The **basic assumption** is that we work together for the establishment of the Kingdom of God and not for our own organizational or church empire. Therefore, our work is not based upon what we can do, but what needs to be done. Our eyes are seeking the best persons to do each job that needs to be accomplished, no matter what organization or church that person comes from, as long as he/she is the right person to do such a thing that needs to be done and fulfill its requirements.

Everybody or every ministry can be the center of its network and does not have to be under another ministry or person, but each relates to others in a **synergic relationship**. If this happens, the work can grow and expand very fast while those involved have a high degree of ownership.

This is **not meant to negate any kind of structural organization**. In fact, we still need that structure as well. But this model allows relationship between and among different structural organizations without having to be in a huge hierarchical system among the many different organizations or church denominations.

Every ministry could be working on its own specification, and through the role of the facilitators, each would know what other people or ministries are doing. Therefore, **costly overlapping and unneeded duplication could be reduced**, in order that **the work could be done more effectively and efficiently**. As the matter stands, every ministry or network could be interdependently related without losing its autonomy and distinctiveness.

Some of the Surprising Ways God is at Work

In a Muslim-majority country like Indonesia, unity among Christian groups is very important, yet it had been very difficult to attain. Since 1990, **the prayer movement** through its network of major denominational groupings brought Christians together for prayer, God's amazing work started happening. Within the last twelve years (until the end of 2002), prayer networks among different church denominations and Christian organizations have been growing in about 350 cities. Through the mission network (the National Research Network), the ministry to the unreached peoples could be mobilized within thousands of churches. The dream of Christian leaders involved in this stream is that this movement could lead into a transformation of the country.

Potential Benefits and Problems

This trend in Christian ministries could benefit the movements of God as a whole. It is building up the Kingdom of God rather than human empires. It also gives room to anyone with the ability and willingness to be involved in various ministries, owned not by men but by God Himself.

The problems, among others are: the possibility of ambitious persons to use this big influence — in area and masses of people — for their own social or political benefits. Some may try to use the credibility of the movement, built up over many years by others, for their own reasons. These people would like to take leadership positions in the regional or national networks, after it has already become very much accepted and influential.

What God is Saying to His Church

Before, there should be one star leadership; now there needs to be many people or ministries, working together, for the purpose God has put in many people's hearts and minds.

It is important to the global Christian community, because globalization has been the common trend and could not be hindered. Wherever we are, in whatever ministry, we should have a global perspective. Whatever we do will impact the body of Christ as a whole, globally. Either personally or organizationally, the role of facilitators is needed in many areas. The style of leadership needed now is a facilitating leadership.

God at Work among Iraqis
Imad Shehadeh

This report on Iraq, of about 23 million people, is against the background of governmental limitations on the establishment and growth of churches in that country. There are five evangelical churches in Iraq: two in Baghdad (one of which is Assyrian, not Arabic), one in Karkouk, one in Musel, and one in Basra. All these churches belong to the Presbyterian Church. No matter what attempts have been made to start new evangelical denominations, the government has not allowed it.

A vital ministry for Iraq has been the training of new leadership. Until the 1991 Gulf War, mainly Egyptians, not Iraqis, ministered as pastors for the evangelical churches of Iraq. Since then, over fifty Iraqis have been trained at Jordan Evangelical Theological Seminary, and one each in three other Arabic seminaries. The growing amount of theological and ministry training is in sharp contrast to its virtual absence in preceding decades. With drastic changes in Iraq, there is a strong feeling that the Lord must be preparing for an unprecedented future harvest.

Jordan's experience has been unique with the influx of a half million Iraqi refugees, originally planning to emigrate to the West with no intention of ever returning to Iraq. However, many met Christ through Jordanian believers, found their way to the seminary there, and now many are returning to Iraq!

Graduates of Jordan Evangelical Theological Seminary (JETS) were able to start home groups in Jordan. Some grew to become the largest churches in the country, with membership outnumbering Jordanian churches, with seven fully-developed Iraqi churches in Jordan. Other Iraqi graduates emigrated to the West where they serve as evangelical leaders and pastors to Iraqi communities. Three JETS graduates returned to Iraq, three more will be there by the end of the summer of 2003, and an average of at least five every year.

A new generation of Iraqi students has come to Jordan not as fleeing refugees but for ministry training. Some had served in the Iraqi military with amazing stories of conversion. While in the battlefield some heard the Gospel through radio broadcasts. Many of these converts have seen the need for seminary training.

These emerging future leaders have great dreams for Iraq. Their dreams include reaching the majority Muslim population, planting new churches from north to south, training more workers, and establishing training centers as needed.

Even under the intense pressure of past years, a mark of Iraqi Bible College and Seminary graduates has been innovation in ministry strategy. One growing ministry has been that of personal discipleship through small group home meetings. According to this plan, one mature and trained believer would befriend, win, and disciple a selected group

of believers whom he would then send to do the same. This home-based movement came about partly due to government prohibition of overt church-planting and partly due to the limited vision of existing churches.

Another innovative ministry has been the opening of a kindergarten in Baghdad, resulting in strong relationships with Muslim parents and countless opportunities to share the Gospel.
Other leaders have crossed traditional lines to establish vibrant evangelical ministries within the "historical" non-evangelical churches. This has been welcomed by priests and bishops who could not resist the love, wisdom and influence of these evangelical visionaries. This work has especially been successful among teenagers and college and career age groups. Some of these leaders are now pursuing seminary training to multiply their effectiveness. Even some of the priests started seeking evangelical seminary training!

The pastoral ministry of seminary graduates has been particularly successful in Karkouk and Basra where the evident work of the Holy Spirit has been strongly felt. A new work is beginning in the Kurdish-controlled area of northern Iraq by a JETS graduate. The ministries of these returning graduates have been helped through financial support extended from the institution from which they completed their preparation. In this way, Arab-trained missionaries are being sent from Arab countries.

Jordan has also been used through the Bible Society which has distributed hundreds of thousands of Bibles and study tools across the Jordan-Iraqi border. Another Jordan-based ministry has been the inter-church relief efforts before, during and after the war. This has opened further bridges with the Iraqi communities.

What is God Saying to the Church?

- God is never hindered by governmental limitations, war or famine from carrying out His will. His people are always to look for fresh ways by which He is at work.
- The Lord has His people and His witnesses even in difficult circumstances, yet needing help and encouragement from brethren in more fortunate circumstances.
- Though the world may be exposed to nothing but news of war and suffering, the news of heaven is quite different, yet only known to those who search for it. God was all along drawing many Iraqi military personnel and refugees to Himself and preparing them to be His dedicated soldiers for a future kingdom campaign.
- The importance of proper theological and ministry training cannot be underestimated in its far-reaching value in multiplying impact and balanced doctrinal stability.

- The work of reaching the world knows no cross-cultural or political barriers. We are Christians first, called to help each other regardless of background.

Resources: Check links from www.jets.edu

Pierson's "Renewal Movement" Scale: 18/20

The Mission of Transformation in a Post-modern World
Case Study of the UK
John Smith

- Seventy percent of those in England and Wales call themselves Christian while only seven percent attend church.
- As a modern institution church is struggling for survival in a post-modern world.
- There is little consensus on values in a self consciously tolerant and pluralist society.

In 2000 Evangelical Alliance, representing a constituency of 1 million across the UK, launched the vision of a mass movement – a Movement for Change - setting a mission agenda for unity, that of societal transformation – uniting to change society. At its heart is a call to holistic or integral mission which takes seriously the full gospel mandate as expressed for example in Jesus' Nazareth manifesto of Luke 4. It stresses grassroots identification and involvement, emphasizing the 'me' in the move**me**nt and the 'all' in **all**iance.

In 2002, *facevalues* provided a framework for churches to engage in social justice, and social action agendas alongside evangelism.

Seventy mission agencies badged their products and programmes under *facevalues*.

Evangelical Alliance made available

- a mission menu
- adaptability, a CD Rom based diagnostic tool for social action;
- prayer resources; a provocative poster set featuring kingdom values;
- a Say Sorry Sunday
- a National Forgiveness Day.

Advertising and PR provided a backcloth for local activity in a campaign with a national identity. Some 3000 local churches participated in some way in this mission project. An independent review concluded 'no-one can undertake national mission in the UK again without taking account of *facevalues*.'

facevalues was a short-term expression of Movement for Change designed to raise the profile of holistic mission and to engage with society on the issue of values.

Movement for Change continues to develop on several fronts.

- a theological colloquium has reflected on the characteristics and influence of other transformational movements
- a strategic forum draws together thinkers from several agencies considering opportunities to influence education, politics, arts and media, business and professions, identified as key change-drivers in society;

- salt and light research will quantify the benefits of Christian based social action projects
- an annual values engagement will raise the profile of a kingdom value – this year 'hope' – this will include resources for churches and a press and media campaign.

A major strategy of Movement for Change taken up principally by the Alliance– *changemakers* – is designed to help church leaders equip, mobilise and support church members to become agents for change through their daily activities. This involves a serious reflection on the purpose of church, and emphasises a paradigm shift from simply 'the church gathered' to include 'the church dispersed' or scattered. The task has been described as 'turning the church inside out to turn the world upside down'.

A major essay by Mark Greene of the London Institute of Contemporary Christianity entitled 'Imagine' and published in idea, the member magazine of Evangelical Alliance presents a challenge to change and has generated widespread enthusiastic response. The ongoing task is to share ideas, tools and resources so that the vision may become a reality as leaders become *changemakers* who release *agents for change*.

In pursuing the vision of a Movement for Change, Evangelical Alliance is conscious of a number of parallel initiatives using similar language of change and movement, and with closely related objectives, e.g., the faithworks movement of Oasis and the change activist programme of Care. A clear priority for Movement for Change is the avoidance of competition and the concern to bless and encourage what God is raising up.

Meanwhile the Alpha movement, the Countdown missions led by J John which profile the Ten Commandments, and the large-scale city-wide missions fronted by Soul Survivor and involving thousands of young people, represent effective contemporary evangelistic expressions; experiments in new or emergent church are widespread; and prayer movements are burgeoning, not least among young people.

Evangelical Alliance seeks to be at the heart of this Movement for Change, Resourcing, Networking and providing a prophetic Voice to society and a provocative voice to church.

Resources: Check the Evangelical Alliance website at www.eauk.org

Contact: Rev John S Smith, UK Director, Evangelical Alliance <jsmith@eauk.org>

Pierson's "Renewal Movement" Scale: 12/20

A Christian Response to Persecution: Affirm and Fulfill Worldview

Vern Sterk

Background

Oppression and injustice have long filled the history of the Indian tribes of Chiapas, from the time of the Spanish conquest until today. However, with the emergence of the Protestant evangelical movement in the indigenous areas of Chiapas, the dynamic has changed. Instead of oppression from foreign conquest and invasion of the Indian tribes, tribal leaders and Indian *caciques* are persecuting their own people. The new oppressors are now the tribal mafias who deny freedom and justice to their own people. In the midst of this setting, the Protestant evangelical Indians are voicing the cry for physical and spiritual freedom. Their new faith comes as a result of their search for freedom from oppression. Persecution follows as a counter reaction to the changes that are caused by this new faith.

Principles of the Affirm and Fulfill Model

The principles of the affirm and fulfill model are not new. Jesus emphasized them when he spoke in Matthew 5:17-18 of the fulfillment of the Law: "Do not think that I have come to abolish the Law or the Prophets; I have not come to abolish them but to fulfill them. I tell you the truth, until heaven and earth disappear, not the smallest letter, not the least stroke of a pen, will by any means disappear from the Law until everything is accomplished."

It is obvious that Jesus was not specifically discussing worldview transformation in his stated intention of fulfilling Jewish Law and traditions. However, his life and ministry demonstrated that he was not on a mission to abolish or destroy anything in the Jewish culture, but that he had come to fulfill it. It wasn't that Jesus could not identify many aspects of Jewish life and culture than needed transformation, but he knew that his Father's will for communication and transformation was not to destroy but rather to fulfill. The affirm and fulfill model for worldview transformation follows this same intention.

Simply stated, the affirm and fulfill model intends to affirm everything in the culture's worldview that can be attested by the biblical record and example, and then fulfill those elements in the worldview that are not in accord with scriptural concepts.

The basic principles of the affirm and fulfill model are as follows:

- Transformational change can best be brought about by affirming the worldview concepts of a culture that are not in direct conflict with biblical teaching. This must take place especially in the clear focus area of the worldview. This clear focus area is defined in the elaborate rituals of the specific culture.

- In specific worldview concepts, there often exist some fuzzy areas, those that are not well defined or that have lost their clear focus in the culture's thinking and beliefs. We must look for these fuzzy areas, and fulfill them with biblical teaching (see Figure 2.2). When the apostle Paul addressed the men of Athens (Acts 17:22-23), he found a fuzzy area described in an inscription on the altar "TO AN UNKNOWN GOD." And he immediately set out to fulfill the fuzzy area by proclaiming a clear biblical message (Acts 17:24-31) related to that unknown concept or object of worship.
- Change will take place in the whole worldview concept as time is allowed for the "ripple effect" (1979:347) to transform the clear focus area of the worldview concept. Figure 2.3 for an example of the "ripple effect" in a test model.)
- The pressure for change is kept on by concentrating on the communication of biblical meanings in the fuzzy areas. This is done by using the cultural forms that are well known to communicate the biblical meanings.
- The insiders of the culture are the only ones who have the right to determine what the Bible has to say to both their worldview concepts and cultural forms.

In applying this model, the missionary begins with any affirmation that can be found through initial study and contacts. In very general terms, the missionary can begin by a biblical affirmation of historical and ethnic pride. In the Tzotzil tribes, this attempt to affirm their culture not only reveals a non-threatening attitude of the missionary toward the receptor culture, but it also communicates the idea that the Bible itself is not a confrontational enemy. To then affirm, by means of the Word of God, some of the specific parts of the Tzotzil cosmology and their concepts of deity and spirits serves to deepen the perception of the receptor culture that the gospel and the missionary have not arrived to threaten or destroy their cultural worldview.

Note: This is an excerpt from a Ph.D. dissertation of Dr. Vern Sterk, at the Fuller Seminary School of World Mission, adapted by Luis Bush, March 2003.

The Kairós Community

Esteban Voth

The Kairós Community is a movement that has undergone many changes throughout its history and ministry. It began as a movement interested in theological reflection within a community environment. It has now moved aggressively toward developing integral mission goals throughout all of its ministry.

Integral Mission in the Workplace and the Family

One can safely say that the entire movement is permeated by an "integral mission" distinctive. This distinctive has been developed through years of theological reflection and experimentation at different levels. Kairós is a movement, a living organism that lives and breathes "integral mission" in all of its multiple expressions.

As a movement, Kairós is deeply committed to the theological training of professionals The Centro de Estudios Teológicos Interdisciplinarios (CETI, Center for Interdisciplinary Theological Studies) is dedicated to this very end. This ministry has as its main goal helping professionals from all walks of life integrate their Christianity into the workplace. This, in and of itself, requires an "integral mission" perspective, whereby the theological teaching is integrated, applied and understood in terms of the reality that the person faces daily. The courses that are taught are based on a theoretical framework that is defined by an "integral mission" perspective.

Another area of ministry that exemplifies this distinctive is the one that is directed towards "family." There is deep concern for family life in the Kairós Community. A ministry called "Eirene" deals with this area of life. Family as the core institution of any society has suffered tremendously in a globalized (*trivialized*?) neo-liberal economy. This ministry to the family seeks to integrate theological concepts into family structures thereby treating both the family and biblical teaching as parts of the same reality. Eirene´s ministry aims to provide a holistic framework for the development of healthy families in a society that does not provide sound foundations for families. The Kairós Community is on the cutting edge of developing this kind of framework both in theory and in practice. It provides a service that no one else provides in quite the same manner.

Training Churches in Integral Mission

A very significant arm of the Kairós Community is the department called Ministerios Comunitarios (Community Ministries). One of its main responsibilities is to train churches in the whole area of integral mission. A qualified team of professionals goes into a church and implements a training program whereby the church awakens to the need and challenge of integral mission. This is perhaps the most intentional integral mission ministry of the Kairós Community.

There are a number of projects that involve micro-business endeavors that truly are helping people who live in very difficult situations. The Kairós Community is very involved in the development of these programs and is now being asked to help in many other countries of Latin America. This indeed has become a very significant focus for the integral mission of the Kairós Community.

Kairos Publications

Related to the "Community Ministries" is the whole area of literature. Many volumes have now been published under the new rubric called "Ediciones Kairós." During the most difficult year in all of Argentina's history, the Kairós Community was instrumental in publishing more than twenty volumes. Most of these volumes have a definite integral mission agenda. It is quite interesting to note that more and more of the literature published by "Ediciones Kairós" has a definite integral mission distinctive. This is evident in different kinds of publications, whether they are biblical commentaries, theological works or contemporary issues/essays. The underlying theme is the need to develop and practice integral mission concerns.

Integral Mission, a Work in Progress

The five main ministries of the Kairós Community are permeated by integral mission priorities and concerns. Even the staff who works on a daily basis for the Kairós Community is deeply aware of these distinctives and attempts to put them into practice in terms of their personal relationships as well as in institutional policy making. It is in this sense that the Kairós Community is a movement of renewal with regard to integral mission. The concept or reality of integral mission is not just one department or one branch of the community. It is part and parcel of its entire life. It certainly is not perfect. It is a work in progress that has exciting spiritual ramifications and possibilities.

Resources: Check www.kairos.org.ar

Pierson's "Renewal Movement" Scale: 17/20

Business Professional Network

John Warton

Jesus said, "I was hungry and you fed me, I was thirsty and you gave me drink, I was naked and you clothed me, I was in jail and you visited me." He could also have said, "I was unemployed and you gave me a job!" Much of the world is unemployed and poor, and longs to have work as much as they desire food, clothing, or a drink. When the Church provides real work for the least of these, especially our brethren, we do it unto Him. In the unevangelized nations of our world, unemployment is both a serious problem and a great opportunity for the Church.

A Global Strategy

The ministry initiative that I and others have been focusing on for the past five years is a global strategy of stimulating businesses in the developing world that create jobs and generate earnings for Kingdom purposes. Call it "Doing Missions through Business" or Business as Mission or Transformational Business. Not to be confused with doing business to make money to give to missions, or running a business to gain access to mission fields to do ministry, this is a strategy of economic growth and leadership development that

- creates jobs,
- generates income,
- reduces dependence of national churches on the West,
- builds a middle class of Christian business managers, and
- succeeds uniquely at reaching that unreached people group, the business world.

This is a fulfillment of the Apostle Paul's admonition to the Thessalonian believers: "I want you to work with your own hands, just as we taught you, that you may behave properly towards outsiders and not be in need of anything." Clearly the Apostle understood the apologetic opportunity of the marketplace and had no expectation that Christians would be poor or dependent upon the State for their material welfare.

Holistic, Self-sustaining, and Leading to Transformation

With historic precedents going back to the Nestorians and Moravians, this approach to discipleship and evangelism is holistic and self-sustaining. In northwest Romania, for example, where more than 300 companies have been expanded through the efforts of the Swiss Christian East Mission (COM) since the early 1990s, the county has the lowest unemployment rate in all of Romania, and is the third highest contributor of tax revenues of all counties in the country, following only the counties surrounding the capital of Bucharesti and the Black Sea port of Constanza.

Christian micro-enterprise agencies (MEDs) have recognized the spiritual and social transformation that can occur in the context of a business development program. The poor often prove to be good risks in an environment offering training, small short-term loans, and accountability. Remarkably small amounts of money properly administered have enormous impact for the local church - tragically unseen by the Church in the West.

Growing Involvement

Over the past ten years, other organizations and coalitions have begun to work among small and medium size businesses (SMEs) and even larger corporations. No longer working among "the poorest of the poor," these programs focus on business owners who possess the greatest potential for building stable companies and will eventually form the middle class, both in terms of leadership ability and wealth. With basic business training and access to capital, national entrepreneurs can create growing, profitable businesses. In every healthy economy worldwide, most jobs (seventy-five to eighty-five percent) are created by SMEs. This sector can provide the national church self-sufficiency and new leadership.

There is also a growing interest to stimulate larger companies for Kingdom purposes as well as shared profit. Overseas Private Equity (OPE) is venture capital carefully placed into selected enterprises to maximize potentials for achieving multiple goals. The equity position guarantees participation in the business and a mentoring relationship with the principals, along with the resources for growth. Rather than focusing just on maximizing profits, a Christian worldview for business results in quality goods and services becoming available to domestic and internationals markets at sustainable profit levels in the context of spiritual relationships.

In all these models, commerce becomes the means for witness and discipleship.

This movement to do missions through business is being rapidly adopted by new alliances of ministries – denominations like the Mennonites and Christian Reformed Church, development agencies like Integra Ventures, World Vision, and Opportunity Int'l; mission agencies, like Latin America Mission and the Southern Baptist Convention; marketplace ministries like Christian Businessmen's Committee International (CBMC Int'l), the International Christian Chamber of Commerce (ICCC), Fellowship of Companies for Christ International (FCCI), and new umbrella groups, like Christian Micro Enterprise Development, the Kingdom Business Forum, and the Business Professional Network (BPN).

May God grant wisdom, perseverance, zeal, and success to all involved.

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Pierson's "Renewal Movement" Scale: 18/20

Mission Work through China's Front Door

Danny Yu

The article, "Pitfalls of Student Selection in Leadership Training in Russia," by Mark Harris in the March 2003 issue of *Mission Frontiers*, outlines some of the lessons he learned in the former Soviet Union in the 1990s. The article talks about "the fear that 'time is short' due to the potential for renewed persecution, closed borders, or a fading in Western giving," "a rush to meet the demands of the many new churches," and the unfortunate fact that the rapid response to the needs "was accompanied by the lack of missiological reflection." Furthermore, the article talks about the problem of "Western leaders who understood theology and training from a Western perspective only", and were often backed by "Western businessmen who had very little appreciation for foreign culture and tend to have a franchise mentality".

I read the article with great interest, because in many ways China ministry faces similar challenges. But one thing sets the Chinese situation apart. The Communist government of China did not disintegrate, and therefore remains to be the major factor for consideration in any China ministry strategization. This paper is written upon the assumption that the Communist regime in China continues to govern within the foreseeable future.

The diagram below is a case study of East-West cooperation regarding China ministry through the website "Christianity In China". For a list of projects and agencies that illustrate this China ministry approach, please go to www.ChristianityInChina.org. So far, the outside-of-mainland-China participants include: Americans, Canadians, Overseas Chinese in North America, some Hispanics, and many Hong Kong Chinese.

There are three groups involved in Christianity in China East-West Cooperation:

- Indigenous China Church – is active through all phases of ministry.
- Western Christian Ministry Groups (MG) – are active mid-way through phase I and into the onset of phase IV.
- Western Christian Professional Companies (PC) – are active from the start of phase I into part of phase III.

Bethany leave this blank I will insert figure

FIGURE IV-8

A STUDY OF EAST-WEST COOPERATION

Western Christian professional involvement with China first began in 1981. In order to remain true to the professional nature of their involvement, these companies can only go as far as the onset of phase III. Western Christian Ministry Groups are a more recent development in partnership with the China Church. Christian Leadership Exchange (CLE) is one such example. They can be further involved in ministry partnership with China than the Professional Companies. But Western Christian Ministry, out of respect for the sovereignty of the China Church, would taper their involvement at the onset of phase IV. Many Westerners see The Gap as a problem. But CLE would wish to invite their consideration that this is a meaningful exercise for China Church development. Furthermore, we can look beyond the Gap to rejoin in partnership with the China Church when it enters phase VI of World Mission.

Lastly, for the diagram to be operational, there are three assumptions:

- the unity of China Church is promoted,
- the Gap in the ministry partnership is accepted,
- and the legitimacy and authority of the Chinese government is respected.

Resources: www.ChristianityInChina.org

Pierson's "Renewal Movement" Scale: 13/20

Transformation: Mission in a Global World

Rolf Zwick

Globalization in economics and politics challenges us to develop appropriate concepts for mission and the church. During the past twenty years the term "Mission as Transformation" described a holistic view of mission.

Background

In preparation for the first 1974 Lausanne Congress in Switzerland, the 1973 Chicago Declaration of Evangelical Concern was issued which called on "evangelical Christians to demonstrate repentance in a Christian discipleship that confronts the social and political injustice". At the Lausanne Congress Dr. René Padilla and Dr. Samuel Escobar from Latin America gave public expression to a missiological understanding that focused on the whole gospel for the whole person, in their social, political, economic, cultural and religious contexts. The "Lausanne Covenant" included the emphasis on social concern as part of Christian mission in its paragraphs four and five.

Many projects in the Two-Thirds World already worked with an integrative approach of evangelism and social responsibility but without having reflected on it theologically. In a series of consultations a biblical basis and theological reflection on the relationship of evangelism and social concern took place. At the 1983 Wheaton Conference in the USA a statement on transformation was issued in the track on "The Church in Response to Human Need". It made clear that mission always expresses itself in transformation which means a "change from a condition of human existence contrary to God's purposes to one in which people are able to enjoy fullness of life in harmony with God". This concerns the individual as well as society.

International Fellowship of Mission Theologians

During the 1980s an international network called the International Fellowship of Mission Theologians, INFEMIT, was founded in order to coordinate the theological reflection on mission in the field of poverty and wealth, development as part of mission and contextual evangelism. The leadership of this fellowship included personalities, like René Padilla, Samuel Escobar, Vinay Samuel, Ronald Sider, Bishop David Gitarri, Kwame Bediako, Peter Kuzmic and Chris Sugden. The fellowship organized consultations, opened the Oxford Centre for Mission Studies in 1985 in Great Britain and published numerous books and the theological magazine "Transformation."

Toward a Trinitarian Theology

In the 1990s, the understanding of transformation was explored in the area of economics and environment. Also the dialog with the Pentecostal movement was intensified. In this process the theology was sharpened concerning God as creator and humanity as the steward of creation and concerning the role of the Holy Spirit for transformation. The former focus on Jesus Christ as basis for mission was broadened. With the view of God as Creator and the Spirit as a power for transformation the theology became more Trinitarian.

Meeting Twenty-first Century Challenges

After the end of the cold war in 1989, the establishment of only one world power, the influence of postmodern values in all areas of life, and globalization, the challenges to mission have changed again. Entering the twenty-first century the economic and political world in the West has affirmed the priority of the self in the globalization of economies, the dominance of the market and the retreat from state control of business or economic life. At the same time, the power game after September 11, 2001 has left the issue of justice behind.

A theology of transformation can be seen as an appropriate approach to the world as it is. First of all the theology of the kingdom brings us to reflect on kingdom values in times when revenge, hatred, and strife for economic wealth top the agenda of politics and economics. In the field of local engagement transformation theology looks for freedom and power for the poor, reconciliation and solidarity for the weak. In this an integral relation between evangelism and social change comes to the open.

As kingdom workers we are building communities of change in a given context. To arrive there Bible study is crucial and has to be done cross-culturally. At the same time, the structure of the local congregation has to become a liberating, merciful and powerful body. In fact it is the body of Christ in the midst of this world.

Jesus, Lord over All

We want to express the Lordship of Jesus over every aspect of life, economic, religious, personal and political. It does not give priority to any area of life as an area for mission, but insists that the change of a person through the Holy Spirit is at the heart of all real change. This change will effect change in the community and environment, whenever people address issues of life, rooted in a gospel perspective. “Mission as Transformation” will strengthen civil society so that society as a whole experiences and expresses Christian values of justice and righteousness.

The Bible in the Two-Thirds World was often seen as an instrument of white, male and wealthy cultures. But mission is determined by the incarnation of Jesus and his sacrifice on the cross. This contrasts all mission strategies not rooted in the context of the people

they are aimed at. It also contrasts all pain-avoiding concepts of mission which speak of easy success.

Resources: *Transformation* is a magazine on international evangelical dialogue on mission and ethics. For more information see the OCMS website: www.ocms.ac.uk

Contact: The Oxford Centre for Mission Studies
P.O Box 70, Oxford, OX2 6HB, England
General enquiries <ocms@ocms.ac.uk>

APPENDIX IV-A

GUIDELINES FOR REPORT OF AN EMERGING STREAM

1. Write down the name of the emerging or vital existing spiritual/ministry initiative/stream or concept or strategy
2. Describe the nature of the emerging or existing vital spiritual/ministry initiative/stream -- new practice or concept or strategy (especially collaborative consortiums)
3. Write down the background and how the spiritual/ministry initiative/stream came in to existence
4. Describe any collaborative consortium that is interdependent without losing the autonomy and distinctiveness of any of the cooperating partners.
5. List some of the surprising ways God is at work, especially "outside the box"
6. Describe the dreams of Christian leaders involved in the spiritual/ministry initiative/ stream as to what they sense God is burdening them to do in the future for His glory
7. Describe the biblical basis for the initiative.
8. List some of the conceptual issues emerging in the spiritual/ministry initiative/ stream. For example, understanding the nature of the church, what is a missionary? the mission of the church, etc.
9. Describe potential benefits and problems
10. Describe what you think God is saying to His church from this spiritual/ministry initiative/stream. Why is it important to the global Christian community?
11. Write down resources of books, articles, CD's media, website and leaders involved, with contact information
12. Assess whether you consider this emerging or existing vital spiritual/ministry initiative/stream to be a renewal movement by checking against the following list of characteristics of renewal movements and put a grade – e.g. this spiritual/ministry initiative/stream has_____ characteristics out of the 20 points in the list below.

21st Century Missiologists' Reflection

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Introduction

By Luis Bush

The purpose of this compendium is to reflect on the positions of respected and influential mission-minded scholars and Christian leaders with regard to:

- their view of the world of the twenty-first century,
- the emerging streams of the Church and
- the biblical foundation of the Church's mission of evangelization in the world at the beginning of the Third Millennium.

The position papers do not necessarily reflect the present position of the World Inquiry; they simply represent a position for purposes of interaction, for which we give thanks.

The World Inquiry uses an integrative methodological framework from reflection of the world; the Church and the church's mission of world evangelization (see Appendix I-A).

This methodology of assessing the mission of world evangelization encourages a cyclical process whereby reflection informs action and action informs reflection.

In his paper, Rene Padilla concentrates on incarnational witness in understanding the church's evangelistic mandate and its relationship to the whole life of the witnessing community.

Delia Nüesch-Olver prioritizes globalization and urbanization in developing six major challenges the church faces, including world unemployment, hunger, and AIDS as it prepares strategies for the 21st century that demonstrate relevancy of the Christian faith.

Wilbert Shenk steers our thinking of a church fulfilling its specialist "mission" function in the world toward identifying a missional ecclesiology patterned after Jesus Christ, whose structure serves its mission in the world and which is aware of the *eschaton* between the present reality and the future expectation of the Kingdom.

K and Pramila Rajendran seek to answer the question who and what is a missionary in the light of changes and challenges. They suggest that we should rethink the historic definition of a missionary to reflect our globalized context.

Rolf Hille with David Hilborn offers a revised statement of faith of the World Evangelical Alliance for our reflection and input.

Together these position papers provide a framework for the Evangelizing Our World Inquiry process. We are indebted to the authors for their thoughtful contribution to our

conversation in seeking to hear what the Spirit is saying to the churches of the twenty-first century.

By providing a foundation for reflection on the biblical basis for the mission of world evangelization, the context of the world of the twenty-first century and emerging streams of the Church and its missionary endeavor--each participant in the reflective process can connect their own personal pilgrimage and journey (see Appendix I-A). All thus can be clustered around a meta-theme (see Appendix I-A). The proposed methodological concentration in the process of ascertaining a unifying paradigm for mission should be Christ.

The centrality of Christ (as the meta-theme in our consideration of the church's mission of world evangelization at the beginning of the third millennium) was passionately articulated by Albrecht Hauser in his response to the position paper by Padilla.[1]

> The need for a proper understanding of the Gospel and the commitment to Christ as Lord and the need to be molded in the mind of Christ in life and witness is beautifully articulated. Since the whole council of God needs to be shared, our witness needs to be imbedded in a believing community and therefore the believing community should live in the centrality of Christ and thus be the hermeneutical key of our witness. Where that centre in Christ is lost, no means will really compensate this. And here we face the dilemma of much of the anti-witness which is also going on in our world through the "Church" which has lost its Centre in Christ.
>
> However, not our witnessing technique will convert and convict, but the Holy Spirit. The centrality of the Cross needs to be looked at as well as also the "why of the Cross" and that points us to the human predicament of our fallenness and the power of evil. I believe that Christ has dealt on the Cross with the question of guilt and with the question of power and evil, yet the conflict has a deep spiritual dimension which cannot be explained with socio-economic analysis only and needs to be looked at in the dimension of salvation history as well. The lack of confidence in the Gospel in Western Christianity needs also to be addressed, as well as the need for renewal and repentance in the body of Christ. The why of a kind of immunization against the Gospel amongst much of Western postmodern society and the world of the other religions.

[1] Albrecht Hauser e-mail of 7 April 2003.

> Where ever the Church and those called within the Church to special tasks (Ephesians 4) are witnessing to Christ in an incarnation way, Christ is present and because of HIS presence we can count that Kerigma (the Word), Koinonia (Fellowship), Diakonia and Martyria will be at work and experienced. Rene has rightly emphasis the need for a Syn-Koinonia, the sharing of the resources within the body of Christ, yet Rene has not addressed the issue of martyria and the encounter of the claims of Christ as Lord of Life and Creation against the many faiths claims. And this encounter can be very painful. We do face in our days a total rejection of Christ and His claim e.g. in Islam and I guess in fundamentalist Hinduism as well and this rejected can not be fully explained sociologically nor psychologically. There is an enemy which has been defeated on the Cross of Christ and yet the cross Christ's disciple have to bear adds to the authenticity of their witness. Yet the why of so much resistance to the Cross remains a mystery. I have been for eighteen years as a missionary amongst Muslims and I am deeply convinced that Christ wants to call Muslim too to the feet of the Cross, yet we also know how much suffering this religion and its adherents have caused to the Church of Christ in an Islamic context throughout history. How wonderful to know that our time does also witness many converts from Islam to Christ, yet the price at times is very high.

As we reflect together on the call of God upon the church with regard to its mission of world evangelization in the twenty-first century we should consider the conviction of Hauser when he writes: “I deeply believe that the great epoch of world mission is not behind but before us”[2].

[2]Albrecht Hauser e-mail of 7 April 2003.

THE WORLD OF THE TWENTY FIRST CENTURY

Delia Nüesch-Olver

Introduction

Our world faces many challenges and threats, from globalization and postmodernism, to poverty and disease, to human migration and religious fundamentalism. Given the enormous challenges and threats facing our world, only under the leadership of the Holy Spirit of God will we be able to discern a sense of direction and effectively call the church of Jesus Christ to its task. We must, then, help the church understand the environment in which the delivery of the life-giving Good News of Jesus Christ needs to happen, so that the church will be able to focus its strategies to reach as many as possible with the gospel.

I submit that the six major challenges the church faces as it prepares strategies for the 21st century are: globalization, urbanization, world unemployment, hunger, AIDS, and the relevance of the Christian faith.

Globalization

Any dialogue about the Church's mission to evangelize the world must start with two inescapable facts which underscore unprecedented challenge and opportunity – globalization and urbanization.

Commonly used, the word *globalization* refers to a world that is becoming rapidly smaller, increasingly more complex, with far reaching global linkages. Sociologist York W. Bradshaw defines globalization as "the process by which people all over the world are exposed to and affected by ideas, issues, and cultures from other places."[1]

In *Global Transformations*, David Held identifies four characteristics of globalization:

a. *Extensivity*: how actions that take place in one location have effects that spread further and further, making geographic distance less and less relevant;
b. *Intensification* of linkages: individuals and societies distant from one another are tied to each other by continuous connections;
c. *Velocity*: the speed with which communication spreads from one individual or society to another;
d. *Impact*: the effect these global connections have in shaping people's experience.[2]

It is too early to fully interpret the wide-reaching consequences of globalization, and clearly its benefits are not currently available to everyone, but these changes are

profoundly relevant to us who represent a religious movement that also claims to be global.

Urbanization

There is a sense in which urbanization and globalization are two sides of the same coin. Although globalization affects people in far-flung places, it is an extension of and it is intensified by the growing trend of urbanization. We talk about the global village, but really it is a global city. In numerous places in the world, cities have grown to the point where they have geographically engulfed each other to form a megalopolis. In the same way, globalization can be seen as the by-product of the interlocking influence of cities.

A century ago London was the only super-city in the world. At that time, 9 percent of the world's population lived in urban areas. In 1950 – only 50 years later – 27 percent of the world's population lived in cities, and 73 percent of the world's people lived on the land.

Year 2000 marked the dawn of the Urban World, when, for the first time in human history, more than 50 percent of the earth's population lived in cities. The growth continues. Worldwide, cities gain a million people a week.[3] The United Nations – which offers the most conservative growth estimate I have found – projects that by 2025 over 60 percent of the world's estimated 8.3 billion people will live in urban areas.

According to the World Heritage Centre, by 2020 – just 17 years from now – the urban population of Asia will be around 2.5 billion, doubling in 25 years. By then, more than half of the urban areas of the planet will be in Asia, and those urban areas alone will contain over one-third of the world's population. The same organization predicts that the cities of Asia will be growing twice as fast as cities in the rest of the world.[4]

The staggering growth of cities is found in unexpected areas of the world, such as Africa. Dr. Andrew Walls reports that the movement from rural to urban centers in Africa means that currently near half of the population of Africa is urban.[5]

For all the challenges of urban areas – traffic, pollution, noise, high cost of living, crowded and often substandard living conditions, economic disparity, stress, psychological overload, long hours of commuting, violence – cities provide people in the developing world the best hope of education and income. So, people continue to be drawn to the city through migration and immigration.

As a heart pumps blood back and forth throughout a body, cities pump people around, on both a short-term and long-term basis. This makes it harder to develop stable churches in cities, but it creates the opportunity for global evangelization as people find themselves relocated from one city to another.

I live in Seattle, USA, in a neighborhood called the Rainier Valley. According to our local newspaper, some 100 hundred languages and dialects are spoken within a mile radius of my home. Many of my neighbors keep strong ties with their country of origin through visits, phone calls and emails. If we reach our city we will touch the world through them.
A joke in Buenos Aires – the city of my birth – is that every Argentinean has a cousin in New York. And we stay in touch! If we reach either Buenos Aires or New York, we touch the other.

The leaders who met in Chennai, India for The World Inquiry conducted by Dr. Luis Bush, report there are 120 Tibetan students registered in Madras University, and 75 Tibetan children at Children's Garden Matriculation High School. Reach Chennai touch a world where missionaries are not welcomed. Surely, God has a purpose in this.

Oftentimes, people who move to the city are not just moving away from something, but moving toward something as well. People move to the city wanting change, yearning for new things, expecting to be exposed to new ideas, to make a new start. Whether through migration or immigration, the socially dislocating experience of moving into a city tends to "loosen ties to local divinities,"[6] opening doors for the gospel.

Given these facts and predictions, any discussion about the mission of the Church for the 21st century has to include urban strategy. Furthermore, because of the strategic nature of cities as centers of influence, business and finance, hubs of communication and transportation, education, entertainment, power and influence, to reach the world for Christ we will have to not just include but *prioritize* urban ministry. In fact, we cannot evangelize the world unless we reach the vast, growing, and influential urban centers of the world.

Developing strategies for reaching the world's urban areas for Christ cannot be based on the same methodologies or approaches that may or may not have worked elsewhere in other times. If we continue doing what we have done we will end up where we are. When we talk about urbanization, we are not just talking about a context that is more crowded, more diverse, more dangerous, and more intense. To reach the world's cities for Christ we will have to re-discover, develop and make known theologies of urban mission that touch people where they live and where they hurt. That is to say, our strategies must be holistic and relevant. They must direct the gospel and transformational ministries toward the most urgent social and economic challenges. In my view these are world unemployment, world hunger and AIDS.

World Unemployment

Globalization and urbanization, along with other things, are contributing factors to the largest world unemployment ever experienced. On January 24, 2003, the International Labor Organization in Geneva, Switzerland reported that world unemployment had

reached 180 million people.[8] At about the same time, the United Nations Labor Agency reported that in the previous two years alone, the number of jobless worldwide had risen by 20 million people and that hundreds of millions more were employed but make so little money they could barely survive.[9]

According to those reports and to subsequent media debate, the sharpest rise in unemployment was in industrialized nations and in Latin America, where average unemployment grew by ten percent in the brief period of 2000 to 2002. Argentina alone was hit hard by an economic crisis and, during that period of time, experienced a record unemployment of 22 percent.[10] The aftershocks of this crisis can be felt throughout Latin America. After the terror attacks of September 11, 2001 countless more jobs were lost around the world as global travel slowed down extensively and tourist industries slumped. In many areas of the world young people are the most affected by unemployment. Specifically, in the Middle East and North Africa 25 percent of young people are out of work and university graduates often find it impossible to land a job.[11]

Even those alarming statistics hide significant information. The number of unemployed people in large regions of the world is impossible to measure because official statistics often fail to reflect the reality of joblessness. Where there are no unemployment benefits the unemployed tend to not be counted. When there is an economic downturn often those employed experience a slide downwards in a continuum of poverty.

As part of the debate on world unemployment, The Associated Press reported that the number of "working poor" – people mainly in developing countries that earn less than the equivalent of US$1 a day – has risen drastically. By the end of 2002, according to that source, the figure reached 550 million.[12]

All things considered, there are "around 730 million people worldwide who are unemployed, underemployed or working poor,"[13] and because of population growth 500 million new workers will enter or attempt to enter the global labor force over the next decade. "Added to the some 500 million working poor, that means we need to create one billion productive jobs in the next decade."[14]

How does world unemployment impact the church and the proclamation of the gospel? A holistic urban strategy will engage both the unemployed and the factors that create unemployment.

G. World Hunger

I grew up in a Salvation Army family, where we talked about William Booth as if he were a Great Uncle. William Booth's teaching regarding "soup, soap and salvation" is deeply ingrained in my consciousness: Don't preach to someone with an empty stomach. Feed them first. Those who are cold and hungry need to have their primary material needs met so that their hearts and minds can grasp the gospel as it is offered to them.

Needless to say, what shaped my young heart now shapes my conviction that world hunger must be included as one of the major challenges the church faces as it prepares strategies for the 21st century.

On February 25, 2003, James Morris, Executive Director of the World Food Program released a report. After reminding his international audience that the world is being devastated by AIDS and torn apart by war, he concluded that the world's most enduring crisis is hunger. He emphatically pronounced: "the world is losing the war on hunger."

Research conducted by the World Food Program and supporting international agencies indicate that there are 800 million chronically hungry people in the world today, and that 24,000 people around the world starve to death every day. Shockingly, a child dies from hunger every seven seconds.

The overarching causes for these awful facts and figures are not difficult to identify: world unemployment, millions of people who grow and produce food have died of AIDS in Africa. Wars, some new, some so old the media does not report on them any longer. Catastrophic weather has triggered famine.

How does world hunger impact the church and the proclamation of the gospel? A holistic urban strategy will feed hungry bodies as well as souls, and address the factors that cause massive hunger.

AIDS

The spread of HIV/AIDS is overwhelming. Numerous sources indicate that, worldwide, there were approximately 3.5 million new infections in 2002, with more than 14,000 new infections occurring daily.

"Ninety percent of people with AIDS live in Africa, South and Southeast Asia, and Latin America."[15] According to the United Nations, AIDS kills some 6,000 people each day in Africa alone - more than wars, famines and floods. In four countries – Botswana, Lesotho, Swaziland and Zimbabwe – at least one in three of the population is HIV positive.[16]

Despite the stereotype in some parts of the world of AIDS as a male homosexual disease, women represent nearly half (46 percent) of all current HIV/AIDS cases and over half (52 percent) of the fatalities since 1999. HIV/AIDS is increasingly becoming a female disease in parts of Africa, where among young victims (ages 15-19) women outnumber male victims of the disease by a ratio of 4-6:1.[17] Dr. Kevin Neuhouser puts it succinctly: "Increasingly, it is poor women of color in Africa, Asia, and Latin America who are the faces of this global catastrophe."[18]

The devastation AIDS is causing is far worse than what was predicted. There is, of course, the suffering of the individuals with the disease and the enormous strain on health care systems. There is also the effect on victims' families: in Africa alone there are over 12 million children orphaned by AIDS.[19] As indicated above, in some parts of the world AIDS is contributing to the spread of famine, as key workers are lost to the disease. The International Labour Organization estimates that some African nations will have 35 percent fewer workers in 2003 than they would without HIV/AIDS. Because women grow 60-80 percent of the food in Africa, the high rates of HIV/AIDS among women will have a devastating impact on the food supply, increasing the likelihood of food scarcity and widespread malnutrition.[20]

The stigma attached to being infected with HIV/AIDS leads to the spread of the disease. At times hunger forces women into prostitution, enlarging the number of victims. "The United Nations World Population Prospects Report estimates AIDS deaths in the 53 worst affected countries as 46 million in the first decade of this century … [and] that figure is projected to ascend to 278 million by 2050."[21]
How does AIDS impact the church and the proclamation of the gospel? A holistic urban strategy will care for the body and the soul of the victims of AIDS, and work towards both prevention and cure.

My analysis is that the predominant issues in the world of the 21st century in which the Church is to fulfill its mission of world evangelization are globalization, urbanization, unemployment, hunger and AIDS. As indicated above, I am persuaded that to reach the world for Christ, the Church will have to not just include but *prioritize* urban ministry, and beyond that, that we will not evangelize the world unless we reach the urban centers of the globe.

As we gather to analyze and exegete the world of the 21st century in which the Church is to fulfill its mission of world evangelization, as we focus and plan strategies, we must recognize that to be effective in the propagation of the gospel in our world we must think of globalization and urbanization not just as the context for the gospel or merely the environment in which it needs to be proclaimed. Rather globalization and urbanization present great opportunities for the Church of Jesus Christ to address the crisis issues of unemployment, hunger, and AIDS – showing the gospel to be potent and relevant to those who do not yet know Christ.

And this is the sixth great challenge I choose to address through this paper – will the Christian faith be proven relevant through our urban strategies?

Relevance of the Christian Faith

My colleague Dr. Miriam Adeney recently returned from a sabbatical that took her to a number of countries in Southeast Asia. In one country she led a weeklong course for Christian community development directors. She was asked to focus on biblical and

theological foundations for community development. At the conclusion of the course one of the directors, a Christian leader, a well-known preacher in his context, said to her: "We've been studying the Bible to prepare for sermons. But now through this course we see that the Bible applies to life."

How does the Bible apply to those affected by the downside of globalization? How does the Bible apply to people living in stressful urban environments with daily paralyzing traffic, unhealthy levels of pollution and noise, high costs of living, substandard living conditions, economic disparity, psychological overload, and violence? Urbanization is not just about masses of people living in close proximity. How does the Bible apply to the intricate webs of social, political, and economic structures that make a city a city?

How does the Bible apply to the one billion people who need productive jobs just in the next decade, and to the 800 million chronically hungry people in the world today? How does the Bible applied to life change the world so as to prevent 24,000 deaths by starvation each day?

As I reflect on this, the words of Jesus at His inaugural address ring in my mind:

> "The Spirit of the Lord is on me,
> because he has anointed me
> to preach good news to the poor.
> He has sent me to proclaim freedom for the prisoners,
> and recovery of sight for the blind,
> to release the oppressed,
> to proclaim the year of the Lord's favor."
> Luke 4:18-19

What do such words mean to the world of the 21st Century? I am not asking the question from a human perspective. I am not asking how would an individual Christian address the issues, or how would different political systems address the issues, but how does *our faith* respond to such challenges? What answers does the church of Jesus Christ offer to such overwhelming concerns?

The challenge for the 21st Century is to present the Christian faith in a way that is culturally relevant. Given the context and conditions described above, I propose that the major focus of the Christian church in the 21st Century should be to develop urban, holistic ministries – which touch people where they live and hurt – so that the life-changing gospel of Jesus Christ can transform individuals, cities and societies.

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RESPONSE #1
by Wing Tai Leung

I concur with the holistic thrust of the paper and its advocacy for urban strategy. The challenges of the 21st century are not only the context for 'delivery of the … Good News," but also the very issues that the Gospel has to address.

The implications of globalization need to be addressed. Key issues include cultural imperialism, destruction of local cultural heritage and reduction in cultural diversity. Globalization also shift jobs to lower labor cost areas and transnational companies have little local commitment for development. How would the Gospel bearers be both local and global at the same time?

It seems the issue of urbanization was interpreted mostly in its negative aspects. I agree that the Church must face the 21st century world of urbanization. In the past, most missionary efforts were inclined to highlight the jungle experience and the tribal people. In the future, the battle field is in the cities. **How do we address the issues of media, economic divide, structural sins, and social relevance in the city? We need a new framework, competency, and theological reflection on the city to be effective.**

Unemployment is a pressing issue, aggravated by globalization and urbanization. It also reduces human dignity and creates violence. **How do we integrate the Creation Mandate in Genesis with the Redemptive Mandate of Matthew in a holistic gospel thrust?** Are there other alternatives to employment, such as co-ops, paid volunteer work, and education-employment mix?

World hunger is not only an economic problem, it is also a political issue. Feeding the people is one thing. Helping them to help themselves in holistic development is another. We need to explore the issue of world hunger in depth.

Problem with AID is as much a cultural-educational issue as health hazard. It is a social catastrophe by default. Education and self-reliance could be the solution, rooted in the Gospel's human dignity as the Image of God.

Issue or problem oriented approach to mission is good to bring relevance of the Church to the contemporary world. But it may also limit our views on the Kingdom of God, Image of God, Principalities and Powers as structural evils, and social ethics in community.

RESPONSE #2

By Darrell Bock

There is so much helpful here and right about the deep needs of the world and our current situation. These observations and statistics show how serious our light is.

However, I still ask myself after reading your piece, **what will make the Christian contribution to this discussion different from the myriads of efforts others are giving to such concerns?**

Does the church as church have anything unique to offer or are we simply to be content with being one human contributor to the solution among others? **What of the spiritual challenges of man's selfishness and sin that contribute to these problems, i.e., our human corporate responsibility for this situation as those who are called by Christ to care for those made in God's image?** Does Christ bring the possibility of changing such a cycle and, most importantly, if so, how does he do it (just through our labor to fix it or through other means)? I wish this had been addressed more at the end**.**

RESPONSE #3
By Albrecht Hauser

When one sees individual persons behind the impressive and disturbing statistics one wonders where all is heading in the new Century. I was recently visiting Churches in Tanzania and the AIDS crisis is really devastating, also for the Churches, since it effects life and church life terribly. At the same time I was impressed by awareness seminars conducted by the Church as well as booklets printed in Sudan and Tanzania by the Church. It seems that the silence is broken, yet how difficult e.g. For a leading Pastor when one son has died because of AIDS and another daughter is infected and the youngest daughter wants to study medicine, yet there is no money to be able to afford this. It struck me that there is much more need of real syn-koinoia within the body of Christ, the real sharing of resources and the sharing of the pain within the body of Christ.

Bishop Simon Barrington-Ward, the former General Secretary of CMS and later Bishop of Coventry wrote me in a personal letter of 12th July 2000 the real challenge to the Church in this new century which I would like to share with you: "**The great issue for this Millennium is still surely poverty and the resultant chaos which it breeds and is then reinforced by**. That's why our mission must have a sharp reverse thrust, an arrow to the heart of the West or 'North!' Our hearts need to be pierced and we must start from a redistribution of pain as in the Body of Christ, the kingdom community of Paul, rooted in the message of Christ Himself!"

I think the "redistribution of pain in the Body of Christ" is certainly a challenge to be faced theologically and spiritually.

I agree with you that it is probably too early to analyze all the negative and also positive aspects of Globalization. It is in fact one of these words and concepts which are used to describe a whole range of issues and as a world wide movement of people to share the Gospel from everywhere to everywhere we are participating and affected, since not only Christian Mission is engaged from everywhere to everywhere, but also the Mission of other Faiths, e.g., Buddhism and Islam. The Islamic Dawa (the Arabic word for Islam's propagation/mission) is certainly very successful in the West. The Islamic Dawa tries to influence structures and institutions and to keep a society busy with an Islamic agenda, while individual conversions to Islam are accepted but not in the strategy the primary objective.

I was surprised that you did not mention in your paper the **increasing religious violence and the growth of religious fundamentalism**, which certainly affects Christian witness locally as well as globally. The war in the Iraq is perceived in the Islamic world as a kind of "Crusade" and in Mosques all over the World "Jihad" in its classical sense is called for. The Christian minorities in Muslim dominated countries will be deeply and adversely affected and the missionary ministries in Islamic countries will become more complex.

I am deeply convinced that **History and Salvation History is in the Hand of Christ** and we certainly live in exciting as well as complex times, but the world is in a messy situation and Christian Mission has to face these Challenges in the Spirit of Christ. Thanks for your concluding thoughts and the quotation of Luke 4:18 -19. Since he is the only real Hope of this World and being captivated by Christ and doing Mission in His Way is certainly a costly challenge of our times.

EMERGING CHURCH STREAMS IN THE TWENTY-FIRST CENTURY

Wilbert R. Shenk

"For centuries a static conception of the church prevailed," asserted the systematic theologian Hendrikus Berkhof.[3] Historical Christendom emphasized the institutional and pastoral character of the church. Theology was concerned with the intellectual and pastoral concerns of the church, not its missionary witness to the world. Mission played no direct role in the life of the church of Christendom. When missionary impulses did arise, these were channeled through monastic orders or missionary societies so that the traditional patterns and structures of the church were not disturbed, challenged or changed in response to missionary engagement. The church was effectively insulated from the challenges that missionary engagement inevitably brings.

Since 1800 momentous changes have been reshaping the Christian movement worldwide. The modern mission movement contributed to the expansion of the church into Latin America, Asia, Africa and Oceania so that the Christian faith has put down roots in a wide variety of cultures and languages. In the process the very nature of the church has had to be rethought biblically, theologically, and missiologically.[4] This work is not yet finished, but significant contributions have already been made. In place of the static model of historical Christendom, it is now recognized that a missional church will dynamically engage its context in culturally appropriate ways.

The "emerging church streams" of the next century will flow from a wide array of linguistic-cultural contexts. Increasingly, we recognize that from this diversity of sources we are starting to reap a harvest of new insight and fresh perspectives on the meaning of the gospel, the varied ways it is being experienced by believers across the world, and the implications this has for the mission of each church.

In this paper I argue that: (a) the church was instituted by Jesus Christ for mission; (b) with the rise of the Constantinian Church in the fourth century mission was eclipsed and the church deformed; (c) the modern mission movement contributed to the "subversion" of this non-missionary model of church; (d) to complete this recovery, the vision of the *missional* church must link church renewal with continuing mission action; and (e) a missional ecclesiology will be tested by the quality of the life of the church.

1. The Purpose and Constitution of the Church

[3] *Christian Faith* (Grand Rapids, Mich.: Wm. B. Eerdmans Co., 1979), 411-12).

[4] Lesslie Newbigin, *The Household of God* (New York: Friendship Press, 1954) shows how ecclesiology must be rethought from the standpoint of the church's missionary purpose.

Although the nature and purpose of the church may seem to be quite straightforward, history shows that it has been understood and interpreted in different ways according to the historical period and conditions—reflecting social, political and cultural circumstances. *The biblical view is that the church has been sent into the world by Jesus Christ as the primary instrument or means of mission to the world (John 17:18). The church glorifies God by declaring his glory to the nations, calling all people to renounce the idols and turn to the living God.* Scripture emphasizes that the church has a special responsibility in relationship to the world.[5]

Although the church emerges only at Pentecost, its roots can be traced to the calling of the people of God in the Old Testament. The basic pattern is set in Genesis 12:1-3 when God enters into a covenant with Abraham and his descendents: "Now the Lord said to Abram, 'Go from your country and your kindred… to the land I will show you… and I will bless you… and in you all the families of the earth shall be blessed." This has been called the original "great commission." This covenant-commission is foundational for Abraham and the people of God. This makes clear that God's strategy for redeeming the world is to call out a people to be the means by which the nations will learn to know and worship God. This has been described as *pars pro toto*, the principle of the one for the many.

Since 1945 certain biblical scholars have pointed out that the Great Commission that Jesus gave his disciples following the resurrection is essentially an ecclesiological statement. That is to say, in giving the Great Commission Jesus renewed the Abrahamic covenant, instituting the church as a primary means of continuing the mission of Jesus in the world (John 17:18, 20:19-23), the one for the many. But the church was not yet ready to be launched. Only after the ascension of Jesus Christ and the coming of the Holy Spirit at Pentecost could the church be called into being. The period between Pentecost and the return of Christ is the age of the Holy Spirit, the time when the church is dispersed throughout the whole world accompanied by the Holy Spirit with the mandate to call men and women to believe the Gospel, repent, and live under God's reign.

The Bible interprets the meaning of the church primarily through narrative (e.g., the Pentecost event in Acts 2) and images (e.g., people of God, body of Christ, bride of Christ). Our understanding of the nature of the church has been enriched by such works as the classic study, *Images of the Church in the New Testament*.[6] In this book Paul S. Minear identifies ninety-six images used in the New Testament to describe the purpose

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[5] Inagrace T. Dietterich, *The Church and the Reign of God* (Chicago: Center for Parish Development, 2002), suggests the church is characterized by five things: (1) the church was founded at God's initiative, not by human decision; (2) the church's God-given mission is three-fold: *sign, foretaste,* and *instrument* of the coming Kingdom of God; (3) the church is called to discern and participate in God's vision of the future, not a program of the church own devising; (4) the church is called to continual renewal of its life and ministry around the "new thing" that God is doing (Isaiah 43:19); (5) each local church must discover the orientation for its life in terms of two processes: *discerning God's vision* and *discerning God's call* (2-3).

[6] Paul S. Minear, *Images of the Church in the New Testament* (Philadelphia: Westminster, 1960).

and functioning of the church. In other words, rather than didactic teaching, the Bible relies on word pictures and metaphors to teach us what the church is and what the church is to do. More recently John Driver extended this line of inquiry by examining these same biblical word pictures from the standpoint of their missiological significance.[7] These images readily cluster into four groups: (1) pilgrimage (the way; sojourners; the poor); (2) new-order (the kingdom of God; new creation; new humanity); (3) peoplehood (the people of God; the family of God; the shepherd and the flock); and (4) transformation (salt, light, and a city; a spiritual house; a witnessing community). Taken together, these images describe the church as a covenant community of missionary witness and transformation.

Two points from these studies must be emphasized:

(1) The church as the people of God are "set apart" because of their special vocation on behalf of all other peoples. There are no people to whom they are not responsible to witness concerning God's saving purpose; the scope of their responsibility is the whole world.
(2) The form of the church is not an issue. Indeed, it can be said that the church is infinitely translatable or adaptable. The church can be established in every language and culture, taking the form that is appropriate to a particular cultural-linguistic group.

2. The Church in History

Although historians disagree as to whether the rise of Constantianism was a positive development or not, they do agree that the church was decisively changed by the decisions taken by Emperor Constantine after 313 A.D. that ultimately led to the church being recognized as the official religion of the Roman Empire in 380 A.D. under the Emperor Theodosius I. The church was transformed from a movement located on the margins of society that was regarded as a threat to public well-being into the official religion of the Roman Empire. Such a profound change in the identity of the church could not fail to have far-reaching implications.

It is not our purpose here to evaluate this development. We only note that as the church became established as the official religion of the empire it lost its sense of missionary purpose. From this point on evangelization could not be separated from political and military conquest. Increasingly, the claim was made that lands governed by Christian kings were Christianized and the notion of *territoriality* was linked to the meaning of *church.* The church was viewed as an institution responsible for the pastoral care of the citizenry and responsible to help maintain public order. Prior to 313 A.D. Christians were generally a disadvantaged minority. Now they enjoyed official favor so long as they cooperated with church and state.

[7] John Driver, *Images of the Church in Mission* (Scottdale, Penna.: Herald Press, 1997).

The long-term consequences of the Constantinian Settlement are well known. By the sixteenth century the hierarchy of the Roman Catholic Church had grown corrupt. The Protestant Reformation challenged certain Catholic practices and doctrines, especially the great affirmation that sinful humans are "justified by grace alone," not by works. But the Protestant Reformers left intact, among other things, the traditional understanding of how church and state relate, including the assumption that Europe was a Christian culture. Some Protestants engaged in evangelization in Europe in the sixteenth century, but only in the seventeenth did a handful of Protestants begin to engage in missionary outreach. But Christendom offered no model for a *missionary* church and so these early mission advocates turned to the only model they knew: the trading company. It had become a common practice among European monarchs to grant charters for the establishment of trading companies for the purpose of trade and exploration in other parts of the world. These charters also included the requirement that these companies hire chaplains to provide pastoral care of the European employees along with conducting missionary work among the "heathen." The Christendom pattern of treating mission as an extra-ecclesial activity persisted among Protestants into the nineteenth century.

3. Mission and Renewal of the Church

Since 1800 the modern mission movement has contributed to the reshaping of the Christian movement. This did not come about easily and the process has not yet been completed.

Already in the seventeenth century there was growing concern about the widespread nominality among Protestants. Spiritual life was at low ebb. The Pietist movement arose in Germany in 1675 and in the 1730s the Evangelical Revival started in the Anglo-American world. At each step the official church opposed these efforts to renew the church. Yet the Pietist-Evangelical Revival was the catalyst for a multi-faceted process that resulted in a range of new initiatives in Christian witness at home and abroad. These many initiatives revitalized the church in the West generated resources for the extension of the church to other parts of the world.

What is not well understood is the way the world mission movement became a leavening influence on the so-called sending churches of Europe and North America. Andrew Walls has argued that missionary societies contributed to "the fortunate subversion of the church."[8] Walls shows that even though the Protestant churches in the eighteenth and nineteenth centuries were not prepared to endorse missionary work, the actions of groups of evangelicals who were committed to foreign missions and a range of domestic philanthropic and evangelistic work contributed to the reform of the church. Using the voluntary society as the mechanism for recruiting missionaries, raising financial support, and conducting the work, these "enthusiasts" created alternatives to the status quo. In the long-term this proved to be a "fortunate subversion" in that it exposed a fundamental

[8] Andrew F. Walls, *The Missionary Movement in Christian History* (Maryknoll, N.Y.: Orbis Books, 1996), chapt. 18.

defect in ecclesiological understanding and practice. By the twentieth century the attitudes of the churches had changed considerably.

Nonetheless, the overshadowing influence of Christendom continued to be felt throughout the Christian church so that the ecclesiocentric attitude has persisted. At least notionally, "mission" remained separate from "church" and missions were activities that continued to be carried on through special agencies or programs. In practice, the church has been content to maintain the status quo. The notion that "the church exists by mission as fire by burning" has remained a remote ideal.[9] The process of re-formation is not complete.

It is at this point that our understanding of the church needs to be rethought and reformulated. The conventional view has been that once a local church is established, it can be expected to grow and function as a viable expression of the Body of Christ; and the energies of the church ought to be continually focused on establishing new churches. Actual experience shows that this assumption must be questioned for it fails to take into account an important issue. We dare not separate church growth and church renewal. The seeds of decay and decline are present in every local church, no matter how healthy it appears to be at the moment. What is needed is an ecclesiology that addresses both dimensions by holding church *growth* in tension with church *renewal*. This is what a *missional* ecclesiology attempts to do.[10]

4. Missional Ecclesiology

Mission the test of faith. Without mission the church dies. Although it may continue to exist as a religious group, a mission-less church is no longer an authentic church. W. A. Visser 't Hooft proposed that missionary witness is a test of Christian faith and church reality because: (1) *In the missionary situation the church must demonstrate that it actually believes in the "happenedness" of what God has done in Jesus Christ.* (2) *In the missionary situation the church has to declare whether it believes in the universal claims of the Gospel*. And (3) *in the missionary situation the church must affirm that God's word is not bound to any one culture, and especially Western cultural forms.*[11] These three requirements put the church on notice that it carries special responsibilities in relation to both God and the world.

Today we have grounds for believing that we can look forward to the flowering of a missional ecclesiology in the twenty-first century for we have resources that hitherto

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[9] Emil Brunner, *The Word and the World* (London: SCM Press, 1931), 108.

[10] The term "missional" has been in use since the early 1990s. "Missional" describes the church defined by its relationship to the missio Dei (mission of God). "Missiology" refers to the process of systematic study of missionary action. For a recent attempt to rethink ecclesiology from a missional perspective see, Darrell L. Guder, ed., *Missional Church: A Vision for the Sending of the Church in North America* (Grand Rapids, Mich.: Wm. B. Eerdmans Co., 1998). Note that this book works out a missional ecclesiology in relation to a particular cultural context.

[11] In Ronald K. Orchard, ed., *Witness in Six Continents* (London: Edinburgh House Press, 1964), 23-24.

were not available. The growth of the church throughout the world over the past two centuries has been accompanied by numerous times of testing—sometimes in the fires of persecution, often in persistent opposition. The church has found itself increasingly to be a minority needing to cope with various kinds of opposition.

Mission and the signs of the time. Mission is the means by which God is restoring humankind to God's original purpose in creation. Mission gives history a goal. The Age of the Spirit is marked by intense conflict between the Kingdom of God and the Kingdom of the World. Mark 13 outlines the nature of this conflict and the way the church is implicated in it.[12] We can make four observations about the role of mission in this "end time." (1) The witness to the Gospel will take place in a situation of claims and counter-claims. Many will proclaim themselves to be "messiah," but these are all false messiahs for they cannot deliver what they promise (Mk. 13:6). Messianic options can also take the form of ideologies and revolutionary movements that claim they will deliver us from our present dilemma. This calls for careful discernment of the times under the guidance of the Holy Spirit. Unless the church is clear and convincing in its testimony, its witness will be confused and ineffective. (2) The Kingdom of the World will mount intense opposition, including resort to tactics of intimidation and physical abuse. But nothing must be allowed to stand in the way of witness to Jesus the Messiah "to all nations" (Mk. 13:9-10). The church should not make the mistake of thinking that it must gain control of a society in order to proclaim the Gospel. God has not called the church to govern the world but to witness to God's plan for a renewed world where his justice/righteousness will prevail. There is no part of this world that God does not claim for himself. That is why the witness must be given to the whole world. This claim is, of course, contested and those who witness to Jesus the Messiah must be prepared to suffer. (3) The missional church will not lose sight of the fact that the mission does not belong to the church. It is the work of the Holy Spirit who indwells the church. As Mark's Gospel reminds us, "Whenever you are arrested and brought to trial, do not worry beforehand about what to say. Just say whatever is given you at the time, for it is not you speaking, but the Holy Spirit" (13:11 NIV). The missional church will be acutely aware that it is the means the Spirit is using to accomplish the mission of Jesus. (4) In spite of the threats hurled at the church by the world, the church will remain quietly confident because of the conviction that only God will determine the outcome (13:32b).

Testimonies to the power of missional ecclesiology. We can draw insight and inspiration from examples of Christian disciples in particular situations who have had a strong sense of their missionary purpose at various times over the past two thousand years. The *Letter to Diognetus*, thought to have been written in the second century, gives one such example:

> Christians are not differentiated from other people by country, language or

[12] This section draws on Lesslie Newbigin, *Trinitarian Faith and Today's Mission* (Richmond: John Knox Press, 1964), 38-46.

customs; you see, they do not live in cities of their own, or speak some strange dialect, or have some peculiar lifestyle.

They live in both Greek and foreign cities, wherever chance has put them. They follow local customs in clothing, food and the other aspects of life. But at the same time, they demonstrate to us the wonderful and certainly unusual form of their own citizenship.

They live in their own native lands, but as aliens; as citizens, they share all things with others; but like aliens suffer all things. Every foreign country is to them as their native country, and every native land as a foreign country.

They are treated outrageously and behave respectfully to others. When they do good, they are punished as evildoers; when punished, they rejoice as if being given new life. They are attacked by Jews as aliens, and are persecuted by Greeks; yet those who hate them cannot give any reason for their hostility.

To put it simply—the soul is to the body as Christians are to the world. The soul is spread through all parts of the body and Christians through all the cities of the world. The soul is in the body but is not of the body; Christians are in the world but not of the world.[13]

The Meserete Kristos Church in Ethiopia provides us with a contemporary example. In 1982 the Communist government sealed all the MK church buildings and forbade the holding of church services. The main leaders of the church were put in prison. But the members of this church responded quickly. They worked out a scheme that organized the entire church into house groups, taking precautions to limit the number of members in each group, agreeing there would be no singing since that would attract unwanted attention, placing women in charge of many of these groups, devising a catechism and procedures for baptizing new converts. Over the course of the next three years while the church was officially banned the church grew by leaps and bounds. When the government finally lifted the ban in 1985, the church had nearly tripled in membership.

Other examples can be found in recent Christian experience where local churches have discovered a missional ecclesiology. What are the main features of a missional ecclesiology?

Defining characteristics. A missional ecclesiology will be recognized by certain characteristics. These include:

(1) The missional church is intensely aware that its first priority is to witness to the Kingdom of God so that people are being liberated from the oppressive power of idols.
(2) The church is deeply committed to the world but is not controlled by the world.

[13] Tim Dowley, ed., *Eerdman's Handbook to the History of Christianity* (Grand Rapids, Mich.: Wm. B. Eerdmans Co., 1977), 69.

(3) Mission is patterned after the example of Jesus the Messiah, that is, mission is cruciform. The vision of Isaiah is being fulfilled as God people *serve* and *witness*. The cross is central.
(4) The missional church has a keen awareness of the eschaton. In Jesus Christ the kingdom has been inaugurated but the people of God eagerly await the consummation of the kingdom.
(5) The structures of the church will serve and support its mission to the world. This will require the dismantling of archaic forms that impede missionary witness and devising new structures that support the mission.

THE CHURCH'S MISSION OF WORLD EVANGELIZATION AT THE BEGINNING OF THE THIRD MILLENNIUM

C. René Padilla

Inherent to the task that has been given me of defining the Church's mission of world evangelization at the beginning of the third millennium in a paper of 2500-3000 words is the danger of superficiality. The evangelization of the world is at the very heart on the mission of the Church. Nevertheless, it would be naive to assume that all Christians who agree with this statement really mean the same thing when they talk about "evangelization." My intention here is to view the task of evangelization as rooted in the Gospel—the good news concerning the life and work of the Lord Jesus Christ, the Son of God—through whose proclamation the Church carries it out by being, doing and saying the witness to Jesus Christ.

1. A basic requirement for a proper understanding of evangelization is a proper understanding of the Gospel.

To evangelize is to communicate good news, and the good news that Christians are called to communicate is centered in Jesus Christ, including his incarnation, his life, his death, his resurrection, his exaltation, and his second coming. The whole Gospel involves all these "salvation events," as they are called, and none of them can be left out without affecting one's understanding of the Gospel.

I grew up in an evangelical home, and I thank God for my evangelical inheritance. As time went on, however, I had to recognize that my understanding of the Gospel was inadequate. I had learned that salvation is by grace, through faith—"it is the gift of God, not by works, so that no one can boast" (Eph 2:9)—, but I had not learned that "we are God's workmanship, created in Christ Jesus to do good works, which God prepared in advance for us to do" (v. 10). In other words, I had received a gospel that emphasized the benefits of salvation but left out God's purpose in what he intends to do through his people, including me. I had, in fact, received an incomplete gospel.

Later on I realized that my lack of a proper understanding of the Gospel was the result of the kind of evangelization that was fairly common in evangelical circles in my country—an evangelization that majors on *individual salvation*, oftentimes understood as a subjective experience of forgiveness of sins, but has little or nothing to say on *God's will to bring humankind back to himself, to reconcile the members of the human race to one another, and to restore the whole of his creation, according to his original purpose.*

Once I was able to see my salvation in light of God's everlasting plan, it became clear that I was saved not in order to be happy, or materially successful, or free from suffering, but in order to cooperate with God, however modestly, in the accomplishment of his purpose in history. And I realized the importance of seeing myself as a member of the

Body of Christ and, as such, a person who has been called to participate in his mission to transform the world so that it may reflect God's glory and the justice and peace of his Kingdom—the Kingdom that became a present reality in Jesus Christ.

2. A proper understanding of the Gospel involves a commitment to Christ as the Lord of the totality of life and the whole creation.

There is common agreement that the confession "Jesus Christ is the Lord" was the basic confession of the early Church, the criterion on which one's relationship to both God and the faith community was based. Only occasionally does the New Testament refer to Jesus as "Savior," in contrast, the title "Lord" (*kyrios*) is frequently applied to him. In light of its historical context, it becomes quite clear that in many occasions this title conveyed the idea of deity and that, applied to Jesus, it implied that he deserved the same honor as God. *Kyrios* was also used in the Roman imperial cult, as well as in contemporary religions in Asia Minor, Syria, and Egypt to refer to "lords" and "gods." The confession of Jesus Christ, therefore, developed in conflict with other confessions and loyalties, and this leads Paul to state:

> We know that an idol is nothing at all in the world and that there is no God but one, whether on heaven or on earth (as indeed there are many "gods" and many "lords"), yet for us there is but one God, the Father, from whom all things came and for whom we live, and there is but one Lord, Jesus Christ, through whom all things came and through whom we live (1Cor 8:4-6).

The logical consequence of the confession of Jesus Christ as the Lord—a confession made possibly by the action of the Spirit of God, according to 1 Corinthians 12:3)—is the recognition of his sovereignty over the totality of life and over the whole of creation. Christians are by definition those "who call on the name of our Lord Jesus Christ" (1Cor 1:2); those who have received "the word of faith" which Paul synthesizes in the following terms:

> That if you confess with your mouth, "Jesus is Lord", and believe in your heart that God raised him from the dead, you will be saved. For it is with your heart that you believe and are justified, and it is with your mouth that you confess and are saved (Rom 10:9).

The confession of Jesus Christ as Lord, which may be regarded as the axis of the apostolic message, is equivalent to the affirmation that *the Kingdom of God has become a present reality in history in the person and work of Jesus Christ*—an affirmation confirmed by the Gospel, without however denying the future dimension of the Kingdom. Obviously, in the Greek-Roman world it made much more sense to proclaim the universal sovereignty of Jesus Christ in terms of his lordship than in terms of his kingly power as the descendant of King David. From the very beginning Christians understood

that Jesus's exaltation, following his resurrection, meant that he was enthroned as Lord and King of the universe. Thus, Acts 2:36—in which Peter, in his Pentecost sermon, states that God has made Jesus "Lord and Christ [King]"—, among other passages, points to the fact that this conviction was part and parcel of the proclamation of the Church already in Palestine.

The relation between the resurrection and the exaltation of Christ and his enthronement as Lord is clearly expressed in Ephesians 1:20-22, where Paul affirms that God's power for the believers is the same as the one

> which he exerted in Christ when he raised him from the dead and seated him at his right hand in the heavenly realms, far above all rule and authority, power and dominion, and every title that can be given, not only in the present age but also in the one to come. And God placed all things under his feet and appointed him to be head over everything for the church.

This is another way to state that the risen Christ has become "Lord of all," he has been enthroned to exercise, by God's power, the government over all creation; he has been given "all authority in heaven and on earth"—Jesus Christ is the Lord.

3. Discipleship as a missionary lifestyle—active participation in the accomplishment of God's purpose for human life and for the whole creation, as revealed in Jesus Christ—, to which the Church and every one of her members have been summoned, is the Church's mission of world evangelization.

In the so-called Great Commission in Matthew 28:16-20, the commandment to "make disciples" is preceded by the affirmation of the universal authority of the risen Christ: "All authority in heaven and on earth has been given me," he said. "*Therefore* go and make disciples of all nations" (vv. 18-19a, my emphasis). Because Jesus Christ is Lord of the whole universe, he must be proclaimed as such to all nations, that in all of them there may be disciples who confess him as "Lord of all" and live on the basis of that confession. The sphere where he is recognized as Lord should reach the same dimension as the sphere of the authority given him by his Father.

This aim, however, presupposes the proclamation of the whole Gospel. Without the proclamation of Jesus as the Lord there is no full Gospel, and without the whole Gospel there cannot be a holistic mission either. This is the problem with versions of the Christian message which restrict Jesus Christ's action to the private life—to "spiritual matters"—but exclude any reference to his sovereignty over other sphere of human life and creation. If Jesus Christ is Lord of the universe— if he has received "all authority in heaven and on earth"—, his sovereignty includes the economic as well as the political sphere, the social as well as the cultural, the aesthetic as well as the ecological, the

personal as well as the societal. Nothing and nobody are outside the sphere of his lordship. It follows that if Jesus Christ is Lord of all and everyone, the Church is not an agent for "individual salvation" that puts the benefits of Christ's work within the reach of people, but the community called to embody the witness to his lordship over the totality of life.

Accordingly, the proclamation of Jesus Christ as Lord and the invitation, addressed to people of all nations to submit to his sovereignty are essential aspects of the mission of the Church to the end of the earth and the end of the age. As Paul says:

> There is no difference between Jew and Gentile—the same Lord is Lord of all and richly blesses all who call on him, for "Everyone who calls on the name of the Lord will be saved." How, then, can they call on the one they have not believed in? And how can they believe in the one of whom they have not heard? And how can they hear without someone preaching to them? And how can they preach unless they are sent? (Rom 10:12-15a).

Whoever hears the Gospel and responds positively, by so doing becomes a follower of Jesus—he or she begins a transformation process which lasts throughout life and involves every aspect of life. God's purpose is to reproduce in the believer the image of his Son, Jesus Christ, the New Man. This is implied in the reference, in the "Great Commission," to how to *make disciples*, which is the content of the mission: 1) "baptizing them in the name of the Father and the Son and the holy Spirit" (Matt 28:19)—the initiation rite which marks the beginning of walking with Jesus and, therefore, of the Christian life; 2) "teaching them to obey everything I have commanded you" (v. 20)— the formation *in* and *for* the practice of Jesus' teaching, that is, the will of God without which there is no genuine discipleship.

From a biblical perspective, *orthopraxis*— the correct practice of all that Jesus taught his disciples—is at least as important as *orthodoxis*, if not more, since Jesus' aim is that his disciples live in order to love and thus show that they are "children of the Father in heaven"—"perfect as [their] Father is perfect" (Matt 5:45, 48). Jesus' disciples will not be distinct because they are mere adherents to a religion—a "Jesus cult," so to say—but because they have a lifestyle that reflects the love and the justice of the Kingdom of God. The mission of the Church, therefore, cannot be restricted to "saving souls" and "planting churches"—her mission is to make disciples who learn to obey the Lord in all circumstances of daily life, in private as well as in public matters, in the spiritual ad well as in the material sphere. *The call of the Gospel is a call to a holistic transformation which will reflect God's purpose to redeem human in all its dimensions*—a transformation based on the whole Gospel centered in the Lord Jesus Christ and oriented toward the fulfillment of Jesus' desire that his followers be "the salt of the earth" and "the light of the world".

In the "Great Commission" Jesus takes for granted that there is a body of teaching that he has committed to his followers and that they in turn should pass on to the new disciples. The implicit idea is that there is a tradition which is transmitted from one generation of disciples to the next—the apostolic tradition (or teaching) to which various New Testament passages refer (see, for instance, Acts 2:42; Rom 6:17; 1Cor 11:23; Gal 1-8-9; Col 2:6-8).

It must be remembered, however, that Jesus' teaching was nor merely, nor primarily, doctrinal o theoretical, but practical and paradigmatic. In other words, his pedagogy consisted mainly in his example and action, through which he transmitted the values of the Kingdom of God embodied in his own person. Quite clearly, the mission of his disciples would not be limited to increase the number of church members but to make disciples whose lifestyle would reproduce Jesus' example— his unconditional love to God and neighbor, his humble service, his solidarity with the weak and the oppressed, his commitment to truth, his intolerance toward every form of hypocrisy. The mission of the Church would therefore be an invitation and a call to follow Jesus as a means to "recover" him in practical life.

Conceived in these terms, discipleship would have a cost that could not be avoided. One aspect of that cost would be leaving aside anything that could interfere with an absolute loyalty to Jesus Christ as Lord. He defined the conditions of discipleship. And he defined it in such a way that he left no doubt that his call was a call to radical discipleship—a discipleship involving a consistent obedience to the will of God in all areas of life, from the area of family relations to that of material possessions (cf. Lk 14:25-33).

The formation of disciples in the image of Christ takes place in the context of the faith community, not apart from it. Jesus said: "By this everyone will know that you are my disciples, if you love one another" (Jn 13:35). Clearly, for Jesus the mark of discipleship is love. Nevertheless, no one can learn to love in isolation from others. In fact, the knowledge—the experience—of Christ's love, which according to Paul "surpasses knowledge," is only possible "together with all the saints" (Eph 3:18-19). It is in the Church, "the family of God", where disciples learn to love—and indeed not only to love but also to serve, to pray, to overcome evil, to practice good works. It is in the Church, the Body of Christ, that disciples discover their gifts and grow toward "unity in the faith and in the knowledge of the Son of God and become mature, attaining to the whole measure of the fullness of Christ" (Eph 4:13). It is true that one's initiation in the way of discipleship requires a personal decision which involves renouncing to a life in autonomy from God and willingness to identify oneself with his sufferings. It is also true, however, that one who decides to follow Jesus can only make much progress as a discipleship to the extent to which he or she experiences God's grace *in* and *through* the church.

4. Genuine evangelization is primarily the natural expression of life in Christ and takes place through when the Church lives, acts, and says the witness to

Jesus Christ as the Lord of the totality of life. This is the call to the Church at the beginning of third millennium.

When the Church loses sight of the centrality of Jesus Christ, it ceases to be church and becomes a religious sect, unable to relate her message to practical life, on both a personal and a societal level. *A holistic church is one that understands that all spheres of life are "missionary fields" and is constantly seeking for ways to affirm the sovereignty of Christ over all of them.* If Jesus Christ is Lord of all, the Church is truly *Church of Christ* in the extent to which she understands herself as "the community of the King" and defines her purpose in terms of witnessing to him, to the glory of God, through what she *is*, what she *does*, and what she *says*.

As Darrell L. Guder has argued in *Be My Witnesses: The Church's Mission, Message, and Messengers (1989)*, the framework for a proper understanding of the church's mission is God's purpose for the whole of creation. God's "election" of a people is related to his universal purpose; God's blessing, therefore, is inseparable from mission. The Church is the agency through which the message of God's purpose and his reconciling action through Jesus Christ is made known to the world. The central act of salvation history, as well as the main content of the Christian message is the incarnation, death, and resurrection of Jesus Christ. As "the community of witness", the Church is called to be the witness, to do the witness, and to say the witness. By taking these three dimension into account—being, doing, and saying—, the Church=s mission is defined "incarnationally."

Being a witness. According to Guder, in order to *be* a witness the church must *become* a witness; the indicatives of the faith must be translated into obedience to the imperatives. The presupposition for this step is the church as the "equipping community" that enables its members to see themselves as Christ's witnesses to the world. "God allows his Good News to continue to become flesh in the corporate and individual reality of the church in order to make his love and grace known to the entire creation, which Christ died to save."

If the Gospel of reconciliation through Jesus Christ is to be incarnated in the Christian community, there is no way to avoid the question posed by the division of society, on both a local and a global level, along social, cultural, economic, racial, political, or class lines. The Church is called to be, both locally and globally, the community of reconciliation fully committed to unity and mutual acceptance in the midst of diversity, fragmentation, discrimination, exclusion, and social apartheid. Consequently, the first prerequisite for mission at the turn of the century is the formation of churches that embody the Gospel of reconciliation.

The local Church whose constituency is a visible illustration of God's reconciling purpose in Jesus Christ is in a unique position to take the initiative in promoting the kind of open dialogue which is needed in order to enable civil society to find ways to cooperate towards the solution of social and ecological problems. As Toffler has pointed

out, much of the planning which is done today in the hope of solving these problems is "long-range," obsessed with economics, and elitist, far removed from the ordinary citizen. Therefore, it lacks the "vital negative feedback [which] can only come from an educated, informed, and involved public." If society is to move away from that kind of planning, however, the decision-making process has to be democratized, "not merely because that is good, just, or altruistic, but because it is necessary [since] without broad-scale citizen involvement, even the most conscientious and expertly drawn plans are likely to blow up in our faces." For the necessary change, "new ways will have to be found to open the entire process, even at the highest levels, to popular input, to feedback from below." No institution in society is more fit than the heterogeneous Church, that sees the whole of creation under the lordship of Jesus Christ and has a strong sense of unity in him across all kinds of barriers, to foster such a "feedback from below" for the common good.

Doing the witness. The Gospel, says Guder, is not "a program of morality or education, or a platform for political and social reform", but we are "saved to serve." thus overcoming "the heretical division of the church's task into mission and benefit."

From this perspective, there is no place in the life and mission of the Church today for the sharp division between the personal gospel and the social gospel, between evangelism and social responsibility, between faith and works. In a world deeply affected by poverty, exploitation, institutional violence, and injustice, the Church is called to embody God's love and justice. West's poignant question, addressed to fellow-Christians in the United States but equally relevant to anyone in a position of privilege anywhere in the world, is unavoidable:

> Will we keep our eye on the real issue: the use of our great economic and technological resources, or our vast financial system, to promote the welfare of all the people, not the profit of a few, to bring the poor and the dispossessed into full community with the rest of us---in short, to realize justice in the world?

For the community of "those who hunger and thirst for justice." every effort "to realize justice in the world" falls under the category of "doing the witness" to Jesus Christ, the incarnate Son of the God who "loves justice" (Ps 99:4).

Saying the witness. All too often in evangelical circles the saying of the witness has been isolated from the totality of the witness. In reaction, many Christians fail to see the crucial importance of sharing the Good News orally. Guder calls for "the saying of the gospel in full harmony with the being and the doing of the witness," and for not doing that only from the pulpit but "in such a way that the gospel surfaces out of the interaction of daily life."

Being the witness, doing the witness, and saying the witness are the essential ingredients of the Church's mission of world evangelism. And this is the order of the day for the Church of Jesus Christ in the "global village" at the turn of the century.

A RESPONSE

Atul Y. Aghamkar

World evangelization at the beginning of the third millennium is going to be an exciting as well as a challenging task. It is exciting because so much is being done to evangelize the world and there are numerous signs indicative of substantial efforts being undertaken to evangelize this globe substantially in the third millennium. But at the same time it is clear that the evangelization of the world in this millennium will be facing steep challenges because the global scene is rapidly changing.

Dr. Rene Padilla's paper is a crucial one because it sets the tone for world evangelization in the twenty-first century. His paper is strongly Biblical and his arguments are convincing. His appeal is genuine and his application is relevant.

Dr. Padilla makes four basic points in his paper and supports them Biblically. At the beginning of the paper he clearly mentions his intention by stating that he wants to view the task evangelization as rooted in the Gospel concerning the life and work of the Lord Jesus Christ, the Son of God-through whose proclamation the Church carries it out by being, doing and saying the witness of Jesus Christ. What is impressive about this statement is the fact that the Church is at the center of this proclamation and this proclamation is to be carried out holistically.

His first point directs us to the basic understanding of evangelization. He strongly argues that to evangelize is to communicate the person of Jesus Christ in its' wholeness. He makes a strong case of looking at the gospel comprehensively, which would include reconciliation of the whole world to God and restoring the whole of his creation. This holistic approach, Padilla argues, is strongly founded in the Bible. His appeal has to be taken seriously by the Christian Church in the twenty-first century.

I agree with Dr. Padilla that the Lordship and salvefic role of Jesus Christ cannot be bifurcated. However, we must remember that we cannot allow Jesus to be Lord of our life unless we first accept him as our savior. That is a foundational fact and cannot be sidelined if we are to enforce Jesus' lordship over the total sphere of our life. The implications for his lordship over our lives need to be worked out beyond our traditional Evangelical understanding and practice.

Dr. Padilla's point is well taken when he says that the confession of Jesus as Lord is to recognize his sovereignty over the totality of life and over the whole creation. However, he does not specify how to bring the creation under his sovereignty. This will have to be worked out further and would require a paradigm shift in our thinking and practice. His appeal that the church's mission of world evangelization is to be defined in broader and comprehensive ways has to be appreciated. Recognizing that Jesus' authority over all of human life means making sure that the authority of Jesus penetrates into every sphere of human life. Although this is a well argued point, the implications of the gospel from personal to social and public realms have to be developed systematically. Most

Evangelicals are comfortable in confining themselves with the personal transformational effect of the gospel and tend to stop there. Padilla's appeal is very relevant here; though he would have done well to show how this can be done.

His strong appeal to take discipleship and missions seriously, both in personal and public life has to be appreciated. The challenge to recover this holistic focus of the gospel in our daily lives is to be reckoned with. This means that both individual Christians as well as Christian churches as the body of Christ have a responsibility to model holistic transformation.

Padilla concludes his paper by saying that being the witness, doing the witness and saying the witness are essential ingredients of the Church's mission of world evangelism.

Now let us talk about challenges for world evangelism that we face at the beginning of the third millennium. We must address the issue of rapid change in the world. The world scene is drastically changing and we have to take these changes seriously if we are to take the task of evangelization seriously at the beginning of this century. Political changes are either restricting the spread of the gospel or enhancing. More and more countries that were traditionally considered to be closed to the gospel have become accessible in recent years. But many more countries of the world also have become more politically hostile to the gospel. What are the ways and means that we need to develop to present the gospel in such a context? While being grateful to God for many open countries, let us make sure that the opportunity the Lord has provided is used wisely.

Cultural changes are bound to affect the evangelization of the world too. On the one hand, globalization is sweeping many countries, affecting deeply many aspects of their culture. On the other hand some countries are becoming more hostile to the invading force of globalization. The younger generation is opting for a so called 'global culture' with its values and practices. This is bringing people of different countries closer and a common bond is being developed. Since the influence of globalization will continue to affect more countries in decades to come, we have to learn to address the issue of evangelization in the context of globalization. But at the same time, we also need to look at those countries that are reacting to the infiltrating influence of globalization on their people and trying their level best to stop the influence of globalization. At times, globalization is perceived to be a threat to more traditional cultures and thus is vehemently opposed. In a context where the gospel is perceived as a product of the so called 'Western Christian countries,' how do we go about the presentation of the gospel?

When we talk about evangelization, we normally don't think about the Church's central role. For a long time, the Church has not been given its' due place in the task of evangelization of the world. The twenty-first century will demand that the whole Church gets involved in the evangelization of the world. To see that happen, the church needs to be Biblically educated and equipped to fulfill the task. Unless the whole church is involved in evangelization, the task will largely remain unfinished. However, this does not diminish the role of para-church organizations in evangelization. There has to evolve a more meaningful partnership between the two.

This leads us to the further issue of our understanding of the Church. For so long we have confined ourselves to the traditional understanding of the Church, with big buildings, big programs, big budgets etc. Now we have to think more in terms of the New Testament understanding of the Church and its implications for evangelism in the twenty-first century. Perhaps, the contemporary context will demand that we think and practice more in terms of new ways of forming and mobilizing the Church to fulfill the task of world evangelization. We will have to think innovatively and creatively if we are to impact the world for Christ.

Since the global Christian scene is drastically changing with more Christians living in the non-western world, greater sensitivity is needed to address the concerns that emerge out of this reality. While the task of evangelization has to be carried out by the whole Church, we have to recognize the fact that the Global church is becoming a more non-Western Church. Therefore, the issues of partnership, sharing of resources and developing more meaningful approaches in reaching different segments of people have to emerge.

The twentieth century will be pre-dominantly an urban century. More and more people will be living in our cities than ever before. What does that mean for the task of world evangelization? Although the world scene is becoming strongly urban, the global Church is still by and large a rural/tribal Church. The emerging urban population has to be taken seriously. The decision-makers, the influential, the educated and the elites in our cities are normally by-passed or neglected by the Church. But since these people exert tremendous influence on different nations, they have to be approached appropriately with the gospel claims.

The Church's mission of world evangelization at the beginning of the third millennium is bound to be different than previous centuries. But the challenge of world evangelization remains the same. While being sensitive to the changing context of the twenty-first century, the Church has to march forward in humble obedience in fulfilling the mandate that is entrusted to her.

WHO AND WHAT IS A MISSIONARY IN THE LIGHT OF CHANGES AND CHALLENGES?

K. & Pramila Rajendran

In the present changing scenario, there have been several questions about who a missionary is. Should he or she be cross-cultural, cross-geographical, local, full-time, part-time or what? What are the criteria a church or mission should use to recognize and fund the "missionaries?" What is the place of the whole Church in evangelism, missions, and the follow-up of Acts 1: 8? In this century, what are the global Church's roles in the missionary venture? How does one evaluate the effectiveness and expense of missionaries who are closer or farther from the cultures that need the Gospel? How do churches and missions collaborate with the new definition and the newer missions and missionaries? In this paper, we try to analyze and find some answers to the new understanding of missions and missionaries.

Story 1: An established evangelical church in South India refused to support David, a Christian worker/missionary in Chennai city since Chennai is considered "reached." David was reaching Hindi speakers who recently migrated there. The Tamil-speaking church spent much money and effort to take the gospel to these people in Utter Pradesh, North India. But with these Hindi-speaking people at their doorstep, the church refused to acknowledge David as a missionary: he does not fulfill their norm of going cross-culturally to the "unreached".

Story 2: A strong church in Trichur, Kerala, refused to support Praveen, a cross-cultural worker in Patna, Bihar. The church reasoned that the cities are already reached, even in Bihar. The church believed that city people refuse to follow Christ even though the gospel was presented. Therefore, according to the church, a missionary should not only be cross-cultural but must work among illiterate tribals who wear no clothes! Cities are reached – Full Stop!

Story 3: Mani is in the rubber business; his wife Madhu is a teacher at Panipat, Haryana near Delhi. Panipat's people are quite well off in business. Mani and Madhu came from South India on business, wanting to reach out to Panipat and the surrounding area as there were no churches. They wanted to become a part of Living Light, a mission organisation among the "unreached" in North India. However, the mission refused to take them and highly recommended they either resign their jobs and join the mission or give money to support "missionaries" who worked among the illiterates in slums. The couple wanted to serve the Lord but not to lose opportunities of serving the people and planting a "Jesus group" while continuing in business and supporting themselves. They decided not to join the mission but serve as independent business people establishing worshiping groups. Are they missionaries?

Story 4: A missionary organization from Nagaland established churches among the Bhill tribe of Madhya Pradesh. Some Bhills became Christians and were discipled for

several years. Their young men went to seminary, becoming better educated than the original cross-cultural missionaries but the Mission would accept them only as Swarthicks – local workers in the second line of leadership and not on par with the missionaries. The organization also paid the locals who have become mature Christian leaders differently. Are the locals the same as the missionaries or second grade "natives"?

Story 5: Mr. Ranjit, a successful businessman in Bombay was asked to give ten percent of his profit to support a missionary in the Andaman Islands. He is willing to do this but wants to know if he could plant worshiping groups among his seeker friends in Bombay. The church and the mission disapproved since they felt he might reduce his actual giving for the Andaman mission and that he was neither a full-timer, nor had the experience to shepherd the seekers as he was not a theologian. Apart from that, unlike corrupt Bombay-ites the people to be reached in the Andaman Islands are poor, illiterate and uncivilized. What should Ranjit do?

Story 6: Rajan, who was working with Youth for Christ at Hyderabad and Mercy who was working with Scripture Union at Bangalore were refused support from mission-minded churches. The churches believed they were not "missionaries" involved in "mission work" since they only reached youth and children who were not tribals who did not live in rural areas. Further, they were living in the Christianized areas and thus were not missionaries!

Story 7: Several missions in India train people within their own culture and place them among their own people, culturally both near and relevant. Who are these workers? What shall we call them?

Story 8: The third and fourth year students in a prestigious Bible college defined a missionaries as a person who

- goes to tribals to share the gospel
- cannot become a pastor
- starves
- has no financial means to survive
- goes to another state.

On this basis, many students made decisions to become pastors who will be given a set salary and house as well as a ready-made church.

Applications:

These stories could be applied universally and questions asked about the meaning of mission and missionaries, with biblical definition, in the light of broader challenges of "unreached peoples." Broader thinking will have to affect the whole nation, not just Christianizing certain pockets of people who in the end may or may not have an impact in the nation.

The bigger question is whether these kinds of beliefs and practices are biblical. Have certain heroes and practices that seemed to have worked in certain areas of the world indoctrinated the churches? If so, can we be bold enough to correct the course and the tone of missions for the next 100 or 200 years? Please pause and think!

The following are the historical practices of mission and missionaries, showing the actual understandings and ethos of missions.

In the past, Jews went to proselytize, often crossing the seas.[1] "From the beginning Roman Catholic missions were closely tied to political and military exploits…"[2] During the Crusades and Holy Wars, the mission was to conquer Jerusalem and to expand the territory controlled by Christians, not to convert Muslims. Only a few, like Francis of Assisi, in the midst of the Crusades proposed that Muslims be won by love not hate.[3]

In Latin America, theologians and officials struggled over human dignity; some said that the Indians had no souls.[4] Martin Luther, certain of the imminent return of Christ, overlooked the necessity of foreign missions and claimed that the Great Commission was binding only on the New Testament Apostles, exempting succeeding generations from responsibility.[5]

"Christianising the natives became a powerful rationale for colonialism, and the colonial charters emphasized [American] Indian evangelism."[6] "The colonial system, in spite of all its evils, provided an umbrella under which the missionary could work in comparative safety."[7] "The advent of British Raj led to a time of 'religious, philosophical, and social ferment' as the traditions of India encountered modernity and Hindu leaders responded to the activities of missionaries and the influx of the Western civilisation." [8]

Modern missions had several ideas for reaching the locals and others cross-culturally and came up with scales to define the task such as E0, E1, E2, E3, E4 and M0, M1, M2, M3. [9]

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1 Matthew 23: 15

2 Ruth A. Tucker, From Jerusalem to Irian Jaya (Michigan: Zondervan Publishing House, 1983) p. 43.

3 Ibid. Pp. 52-53.

4 J. D. Douglas (Ed), "Christian Missions", The New International Dictionary of the Christian Church (Grand Rapids: Zondervan Publishing House, 1978), p.665.

5 Tucker, From Jerusalem. P. 6.

6 Ibid. P. 84.

7 J. Herbert Kane, Life and Work on the Mission Field (Michigan, Baker Book House, 1980), Preface ix.

8 Sebastian C. H. Kim, In Search of Identity – Debates on Religious Conversions in India (New Delhi: Oxford University Press, 2003), p. 12.

9 E0, E1, E2, E3, E4 and M0, M1, M2, M3. – Equivalent to being witnesses in Jerusalem, Judea, Samaria and to the ends of the world.

Mindsets and Realities of Missions/Missionaries and Possible Motions:

1. Though needed in the past, the present perpetuation of beliefs and practices of the past cripples the laity from reaching the cross-cultural people at our doorsteps.

2. Cathedral/Synagogue Christianity as the "church" keeps many genuine seekers away from the colonial appearances and practices of the "church".

3. Missionaries being considered as cross-cultural, cross-nationals, leaders and others as "native workers," *swarthicks,*[10] and as "agents" dampen the full participation and ownership of missions by the people to whom mission was taken. The faster missions produce leaders and pass leadership to locals, the greater the effectiveness and ownership of missions will be.[11]

4. Missionaries giving too much emphasis on meeting the social needs and less time focused on building disciples have watered down the Great Commission of Christ.

5. Missionaries have to shed the idea of civilising people as Christianising the poor, rural and tribals.[12]

6. Mission to the rural, tribals and to the poor have to change; the total picture must affect the whole nation.

7. The idea of "mission to win the winnable" has to be revised! Missionaries are pressured to report big numbers becoming Christians as the sending constituency spends huge sums of money on the missionary. This has eliminated ministry to strategic peoples who may be slow to respond.

8. The idea of taking the Gospel to "the least reached" is noble, but has to be kept in balance for bringing difficult people to follow Christ.

9. Missions must become sensitive in not calling and angering others as "heathens" and as "others". Unintended meanings are equated to colonial arrogance, creating enemies and in some cases destroying and dividing even good cultural practices of many nations.

10. Mission should not be labeled as liberating people from injustice to justice. Justice and liberation has to become the by-product of people following Christ.

11. Mission to the whole creation – Restoring the creation to order is a far-fetched idea and it diverts the actual proclamation and discipling people to be followers

10 *swarthicks* is the North Indian word for local workers.

11 K. Rajendran, Which Way Forward Indian Missions (Bangalore: SAIACS, 1998).

12 Douglas (Ed), "Christian Missions," pp.665-666.

and worshippers of Christ. Caring for other humans, animals, and environment has to be the by-product of being followers of Christ and appreciating the Creator God.

If the mission of Christ has to be successful, the whole Church has to be mobilised into the following challenges in India. Similar things can be seen in the rest of the world. This will change the whole concept of "missions" and the "missionaries".

- Massive population growth: from 400 million to 1 billion
  - ✓ Create more mass media to influence their thinking
- Cities, middle class, and urbanites: 300 million
  - ✓ Place high calibre Christians to witness among them
- The educated: 650 millions.
  - ✓ Produce meaningful literature; create a market and interest for them to read. Place tentmaking Christians as colleagues.
- Illiterates: 350 millions.
  - ✓ Work with the government to eradicate illiteracy
- Youth (below 30 years): 650 millions.
  - ✓ Current youth ministries will only cover one to two percent of the youth. Therefore, create youth networks and become members of many youth clubs and speak to them. Create worship groups where youths can be accommodated with changes in methods of communication.
- Muslims: 170 millions
  - ✓ Do something about it!
- Marginalised Dalits and tribals: 300 millions
  - ✓ Work alongside them, help them have a good self image and uplift them in society without creating a mentality of working against the oppressors. Teach Christ's way of forgiving oppressors.
- The handicapped – specially-abled peoples: 150 millions.
  - ✓ Create methods to accommodate them into the church.
- Global Indians: 20 plus millions.
  - ✓ Send tentmakers. Alert and teach churches in each country to be aware of reaching out to the Diaspora. Identify and help Diaspora Christians build bridges to churches and families at home.
- The Expansive Geography - PIN Code: Out of 28,000 PIN code areas, nearly 20,000 PIN code areas have no resident pastor, evangelist, missionary, or Christian development worker.[13]
- Multiplicity of Languages: No scripture portions are available in 85 languages.
- Increasing persecution.

13 [n.a.], "Prayer Resources Based on Research done by IMA ,," Indian Missions (January - March 1997), p. 24.

√ Place tentmakers with a reason for existence among the people as a continuous witness.

In all these areas, the churches have to reach out to their local people, creating the human contact to approach people in their "felt needs".

In this scenario, the missionary minded Christians have to be taught in the following areas.

- To be biblically sound and rooted in the Word.
- Development of good character
- Informed of contemporarily relevant areas in the globalized village.
- Create high-caliber Christians and place them in society, business, and politics to address the total nation.
- Help them to be the influencers, disciplers and multipliers.
- Help them to be broad thinkers and pragmatists–"out of the box" thinkers in theology and in strategy.
- Create an awareness about tentmaking to be able to work in some profession to sustain an identity, willing to be a part of the society and not perpetuate the "full-time missionary" and "priests" concepts.
- To understand peoples' felt needs through which to introduce the gospel without being extremists and meet the needs of only the poor, the down-trodden, the illiterate and unreached tribals.[14]

India Missions Association [IMA] originally had as members only the indigenous missions, of Indian origin, funded by Indian churches, which were cross-cultural and missions to the tribals. Missions of non-Indian origin were associates. Now there are no distinctions between members and associates as there is very little to differentiate indigenous missions. Most missions are in partnership with the rest of the Body of Christ in one way or another except personnel from abroad.

Now the mission organisations in IMA membership vary as direct church planters, supporting agencies, pastoral care agencies, training agencies, youth and other ministries, social ministries, ministries to the handicapped, special ministries to the cities and others. There are also various networks formed around several pioneering areas of ministries such as youth, students, children, and others. There is an IMA "think-tank centre" set up at Hyderabad to create new thinking, follow-up and to create a momentum in missions and churches to move forward and affect both India and the rest of the world in the next 100 years.

14 The whole lot put together in India is around only fifty percent. How about the rest of the fifty percent?

Conclusion:

"The decisive feature of Christian missions is not only conversion of men and nations, but obedient witness everywhere to the Lord who makes all things new." [15] Thus, the whole Church/laity have to be moved as missionaries. This will help the Church to become more responsible for discipling nations. This may redefine the idea of the full-time, cross-cultural and cross-geographical missionaries from the definitions of the past. The globalized world today has all the peoples of the earth in our doorsteps in physical and virtual sense of Internet. Are the churches and missions willing to change and affect nations?

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15 Douglas (Ed), "Christian Missions". p.666.

REVISED WEA STATEMENT OF FAITH (DRAFT 1)

By Rolf Hille with David Hilborn

"This is not an official statement of the WEA but rather it is the reflection of two theologians working together toward an updated draft of the WEA statement of faith. The aim is to give the international body of the World Inquiry International Coalition a chance to react and respond to it. We are in discussion to include the Lausanne Covenant as the expression of the self-understanding of the evangelistic and mission commitment of the WEA," Rolf Hille.

The World Evangelical Alliance confesses faith in:

> The one true God who is Father, Son and Holy Spirit - the loving creator, sustainer, redeemer and judge of the world.
>
> The unique divine inspiration and supreme authority of the Bible, and its full trustworthiness for faith and conduct.
>
> The worth and dignity of all people, formed in God's image to live in love and holiness, yet alienated from him and each other by sin, which duly incurs God's wrath.
>
> The deity of the Lord Jesus Christ, the eternal Son of the Father, the incarnate Word, born of the virgin Mary, fully human yet without sin.
>
> The sacrificial death of Christ in the place of sinners, paying the penalty for sin and reconciling us with God.
>
> The bodily resurrection of Christ from the dead, the first fruit of our resurrection to life, and his ascension to heaven, from where he now reigns, our only Mediator and Saviour, the hope of humanity.
>
> The justification of sinners solely by the grace of God through faith in Christ.
>
> The regenerating and sanctifying work of God the Holy Spirit, who prompts us to repentance, unites us with Christ through new birth, empowers our discipleship and enables our witness to the world.
>
> The fellowship and mission of the Church, the body of Christ both local and universal, endowed with the Spirit's gifts and called to proclaim the gospel throughout the earth, serving society in justice and love.

The personal return of Jesus Christ to raise and judge all people, bringing eternal life to the redeemed and eternal condemnation to the lost, ensuring the final defeat of evil and the establishment of a new heaven and new earth.

Media & Technology: Evangelism & Culture (A draft)

By Wing Tai Leung

Abstract: *A range of perspectives on media and technology as pertaining to evangelism is explored. These perspectives include the functional, cultural, technological, covenantal, linguistic, developmental, and communicative views of media in evangelism. Special issues are also explored as related to the mass media, information technology, folk media, and biotechnology. The conclusion of this paper is that while the functional view of the media in evangelism is the dominant view among Christians, the wider perspectives need to be explored to inform and enrich our evangelization as a cultural task.*

Models of Media and Evangelism

Media and technology as pertaining to evangelism or evangelization is an important subject for the Christian Church. Media is a capital-intensive undertaking. Technology implicates many ethical issues. For the Christian Church to be effective as witness of the Kingdom of God, soul-searching on the media as a cultural process is a necessity. The following will explore the various views of the media and evangelism that are prevalent to the Church, viz. the functional, cultural, technological, covenantal, linguistic, developmental, and communicative views.

1. ***Functional View:*** This is the most dominant view on media and evangelism. The Gospel is taken as propositional truths and faith statements whereby someone will proclaim and the audience will respond. Evangelism is a make-believe process. It is a communication process for diffusion of innovation. In this case the innovation is the Gospel for the unreached people. The decision-making process will involve a few steps: awareness, interest, knowledge, commitment, cognitive dissonance, and affirmation. Media is taken to be the message carrier and the affirmation tool to reduce cognitive dissonance. Media is simply a tool for evangelization. The communication process is linear and transmissional. Interpersonal contact is seen to be a "follow-up" reinforcement. Media content in this functional objective is highly predictable. The Gospel is reduced to a few faith-propositions. Conversion is summarized into number of decision-makers. It is an objective and mathematical notion for subjective commitment.
2. ***Cultural View:*** This view takes the context and culture of the people of interest seriously. Evangelism is taken to be a counter-culture process. It is a struggle between the City of God and the City of Man, using the Augustine language. Media is both the cultural context and the change agent. Christian effort in the media is a cultural redemption process. Culture must be engaged. Sin is both personal and structural. There are elements of culture that need to be affirmed, criticized, and redeemed. The Creation Mandate of Genesis that God commanded humankind to cultivate the land and bear fruit is taken literally. Culture is not only something that to be surmounted in mission efforts, but a legacy of humankind to be nurtured. Media is a culture-creation endeavor. Evangelism is to bring the principalities and powers into subject of God's Kingdom. Redeemed persons need a redeemed cultural environment to survive and blossom spiritually.

3. ***Technological View:*** Technology has its inner logic. It drives for efficiency and productivity. The technological system has a *la technique* principle that is dehumanizing, using Jacque Ellul's framework. Technology becomes an oppressive system that imprisons humankind. Evangelism is a liberating force that re-awaken the humanity within a person. Media in evangelism is a critical process to the technologically oppressed. Media criticism is therefore a liberating process for the restoration of human dignity, made in the Image of God. Media criticism involves awareness, criticism, and expression. Media producers for evangelism must be conscious of the mechanical and dehumanizing forces of media technology and subject them to human mastery. The human soul and community of faith should take precedence over media and technological excellence.
4. ***Covenantal View:*** Evangelism is a convenant-making process, between God and the faith community. Decision of faith is not only a personal process, it is also a communal endeavor. Media is taken to be the sign or seal of a covenant. It calls for a sense of vocation and mission. The Biblical covenants between God and the godly tribe follows the Hittite pattern, according to Meredine Kline. It comprises the components of historical clause (stating the relationship between both parties into a covenant relationship), command for action, choice of decision, blessing and curse toward fulfillment and failture, and an external sign, usually a medium. Christ is the Mediator between God and humankind. He is the High Priest for the eternal covenant. The Word of God is also a media, for the inspiration of faith. Media in evangelism is taken to be a sacred bridge, to bring the convergence between God and humankind, into a covenantal agreement for life.
5. ***Linguistic View:*** Evangelism is the process of communicating truth. Media is a language for that communication. The semiotic and narrative nature of the media must be explored for effective communication. Truth is absolute but the communication of truth is cultural. Media semiology is an important study for communication of meaning. The form is as important as the content because the medium is also the message, using Marshall McLuhan's perspective. Narrative theology for story-telling evangelism is cogent for mission.
6. ***Developmental View:*** Evangelism is a liberation process for the poor and the oppressed from their imprisonment. Jesus' inauguration reading of the Isaiah scripture is taken literally. Communication and media serve as developmental tools for liberation. Media gives voice to the voiceless, and power to the powerless. Communication through the media bridges the "power divide" between social groups and restore human community. A social system with open communication, even flow of information, and self-determination, tend to usher better social development. Media endeavors that enhance these factors bring about liberation and social capital.
7. ***Communicative View:*** Evangelism is to restore the deprived person from an object to a subject, a person made in the Image of God. Communication is neither a sender-receiver relationship, nor a broadcaster and audience positioning. It is an I-thou relationship of Martin Buber's conception. Media is called to enhance intersubjectivity among the communicators. It facilitates a communication process that enhances communication, communion, and community. The ideas of participation, celebration, conviviality, and initiative are encouraged.

Having explored and discussed the range of perspectives of media and evangelism, there are special issues that are related to a particular media form as pertaining to evangelism to be explored.

Mass Media Issues

Evangelism depends on the social climate. The social agenda prescribe the social climate of a society. The mass media has an agenda-setting capability. Christians can engage in the mass media to set the social agenda. Public opinion is a public space for shaping values and culture. In forming public opinion, "the spiral of silence" inhibits the minority view, according to Elizabeth Noelle-Neumann. Christian media can be prophetic and challenge the dominating view. In mass media, there is a struggle for control and gate-keeping. It is a game for monopoly. Christians should strive for a wider public space for genuine debate of social issues. In today's world, the Western media are controlling most of the global media, bringing hegemony of culture. Christian media can engage in protecting the marginal and social outcast. In the tradition of the prophets in protecting the orphans, widows, and sojourners, the Christian media must strive to give voice to the voiceless.

In addition, the mass media needs real lives of the communicators to confer credibility. The fall of many tele-evangelists could undermine the credibility of all Christian communication.

Information Technology Issues

While the digital media shares some of the concern of the mass media, it also has unique issues of its own. The pitfall of Christian communicators is to imagine that digital media obeys the same pattern as the mass media. There are myths as cybercasting, information as knowledge, object as learning, and access as communication. Communication is in fact a social process than a mechanical one.

Information technology enables a global network in place and ushers an effectively equidistant world. Space is annihilated through time. As contrast to mass media, digital media is interactive, participatory, and convivial. It is similar to the postal service and the telephone than group viewing. The narrative forms of the digital media encourage linkage of information as lexicon of knowledge, multiple points of view, multiform story with different paths and endings, and strong human-technology interface. The digital media is unique in the media landscape that it is both high in presence (realistic sight and sound such as in the cinema) and interactivity (such as computer game.)

As information technology is dealing with speed: transmission, fidelity of viewing, and data processing, it also has the issue of the information rich and the information poor. Christians need to bridge this digital divide through accessible technology, range of online options, and fidelity of information for the handicapped.

Also connectivity does not guarantee connecting among people. Connecting is a social process. The same is true for information and learning, knowledge and wisdom. Raw data is not information. Information is not knowledge. Knowledge is not wisdom. Wisdom is not formation (character building) and transformation (life changing).

Furthermore, one cannot take the virtual community as a full-fledge Christian community. Christian community must be enhanced by a face-to-face encounter. Digital and real life must be interwoven for genuine Christian communication to take place.

Folk Media Issues

The popular use of the electronic and digital media by the Christian Church in developed countries does not mean to undermine the effective use of the folk media as communication platforms and tools. For the folk media, one must respect the integrity of matter and material. In search of stones, in Scott Peck's term, is to respect nature as it is and listen to its message of humankind. Folk communication banks on folk culture. One must attempt to understand the cultural heritage of a people for effective communication. The folk media is a tool for this journey. One needs to search for the signs and icons of a people and her cultural tradition. There are ungodly beliefs embedded in the folk media that needs to be redeemed. There are also godly beliefs that need to be retained and amplified. In dealing with folk media, Christians can engage in the process of acculturation, disculturation, and enculturation. Acculturation is a blending of two or more cultures. Disculturation is to remove the evil elements of a culture. Enculturation is to embed the good ones. Most of the time it is both an affirming and a critical process. Affirm the good and criticize the bad. One must respect a folk culture, understand it, appreciate it, before one can be critical of it.

Biotechnology Issues

Integrating biotechnology in the discussion of media and evangelism is difficult. However, biotechnology is similar to media technology in a number of respects. It has its own technological inner logic, cultural presuppositions, and the need for redemption. Evangelism is dealing with "who we are," our state of spirituality, and back to the communion with God. Biotechnology is pertinent in all these issues.

As for presuppositions, biotechnology researchers have to ask a question: To know or not to know? Is there a limit to human curiosity that breaches our status of humanity and play God? Would "what is" and "what can be" warrants "what ought to be"? For example, the ethics of human cloning. Is it a forbidden realm for humankind? Can we tamper with the human genome and change its DNA pattern? Can we generate new living things in the name of science without knowing their ecological and biological implications, including the hazards to nature?

There is also an ownership issue. Should discovery of the DNA pattern of living things constitute to an invention that warrants patent registration? Does reading the genetic pattern of a herbal medicine of a village tribe constitutes a patent that forbid this tribe from future experimentation with what they own as their tribal knowledge? Is this modern-day piracy?

Will the Second Genesis be a dream come true or a nightmare for humanity? If evangelism is to bring the Kingdom of God into the human world and restore human

dignity as the Image of God, would biotechnology as step forward or backward in this direction?

Conclusion

Evangelism is more than proposing a formula of faith statements for people to adopt. It is a life-joining experience with God. It calls for a change of life-style and culture. Commitment on faith is both a personal and a community vocation. The media and technology, in particular the mass media, folk media, digital technology, and biotechnology, have spiritual implications that are conducive or obtrusive to the cultural task of evangelization. This paper is an introduction of the pertinent issues that deserve a broader discussion and deeper understanding.

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21st Century Action Plans Unveiled

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CITY-BASED ACTION PLANS UNVEILED

Luis Bush

Introduction

There were two distinct phases in conducting the World Inquiry survey. Phase one included both the quantitative and the qualitative survey. Phase two began in January 2003. In place of the quantitative survey Christian leaders from the cities shared stories about what they sensed and saw God working in their city. This was followed by focus group time of the qualitative survey.

The city-based action plan unveiled in the midst of the World Inquiry process well beyond the primary targeted intent of prompting survey data to be taken in many places of the world. Clearly, the moves to fuller understanding of local demographics and the moves to action plans for reaching that city or region, already underway, have been brought into intersection, serving to add impetus.

A few reflections on this reality are:

- World Inquiry process events already completed have added new bridges of understanding/inspiration, enabling "new bridges" that have helped strengthen and/or accelerate area-reaching movements already underway.
- The World Inquiry process contained/ included the intended and long-term action plans posed by the LCWE for the Lausanne 2004 Forum Issues program.
- The World Inquiry is now planned as an instrument for local area action plans beginning in Phase II, now in process as of January 2003. We praise God for what has been revealed in Phase I!
- As one powerful example: In Indonesia, members of their National Prayer Committee said: "We have been praying for cities transformation since 1989". They now have movements in 223 cities and are targeting 400 by June '03. They are now moving their prayer from transformation to action – in prayerful compliance with intended transformation of all by 2005, their original "Year of Transformation" target set several years ago.

This compendium is a collection of several city-based action plan case studies gathered along the way of the Inquiry survey process. It represents some that have been collected, not all that have been encountered or that exist.

Transformation of the City

When asked what God is calling His people to do in world evangelization over the next twenty-five years, participants from countries in the Two-Thirds World ranked social transformation as first.

Vision of Transformation Ranked First in Two-Thirds World

In the case of Jakarta one-third of the total percent response through the focus group discussions of two hundred Christian leaders opted for this as their top choice. The second choice had only seventeen percent total response compared to thirty percent. In New Delhi social transformation ranked highest.

Calling for a Mission to the Whole City by the Whole Church taking the Whole Gospel

For a suitable phrase (watchword) to capture the essence of world evangelization to serve as a unifying paradigm for the next twenty-five years, the overwhelming response was The Whole Church taking the Whole Gospel to the Whole World.

From the recent India case study it was clear that the one thousand Christian leaders meeting in eighteen cities in India over the course of a month in city-based inquiries developed vision shared their conviction regarding this national vision for their cities.

It was reflected in the second and third choices of a watchword reflected a mission to fulfill the vision of social transformation, which was expressed in action plans as follows: The God-given vision is fulfilled by the Whole Church taking the Whole Gospel to the Whole World so that the nation is discipled -- and the power, the presence and the peace of God is experienced by all.

Meaning of Transformation

Social transformation was defined as seeking positive change in the whole of human life materially, socially and spiritually, by recovering our true identity as human beings created in the image of God and discovering our true vocation as productive stewards, faithfully caring for our world and its people.

Some Questions and Observations Regarding City-Based Transformation

1. There are a variety of views still out there related to city transformation.
2. "The Inquiry should not be bound by too much structure within or too rigid a conceptual framework for developing a realistic set of transformation indicators.
3. Aspects of a city-based Framework would include:
    - The indisputable set of assumptions in which almost all would agree
    - The indisputable biblical principles
    - The disputable perspectives on what transformation looks like would consider various:
        - Indisputable indicators of transformation
        - Disputable indicators of transformation
4. Macro and micro measure in which macro measures would be high-level and could usually be applied fairly universally to any city. The micro measures may be unique to a particular city, though surely there would be some degree to which they could also be applied more generally.

City-Based Action Plan Emergence

During the India consultations in early 2003 a pattern emerged as city after city inquiry led immediately to action plans. Certain questions of the inquiry became the basis for very distinct action steps (See Figure V-1).

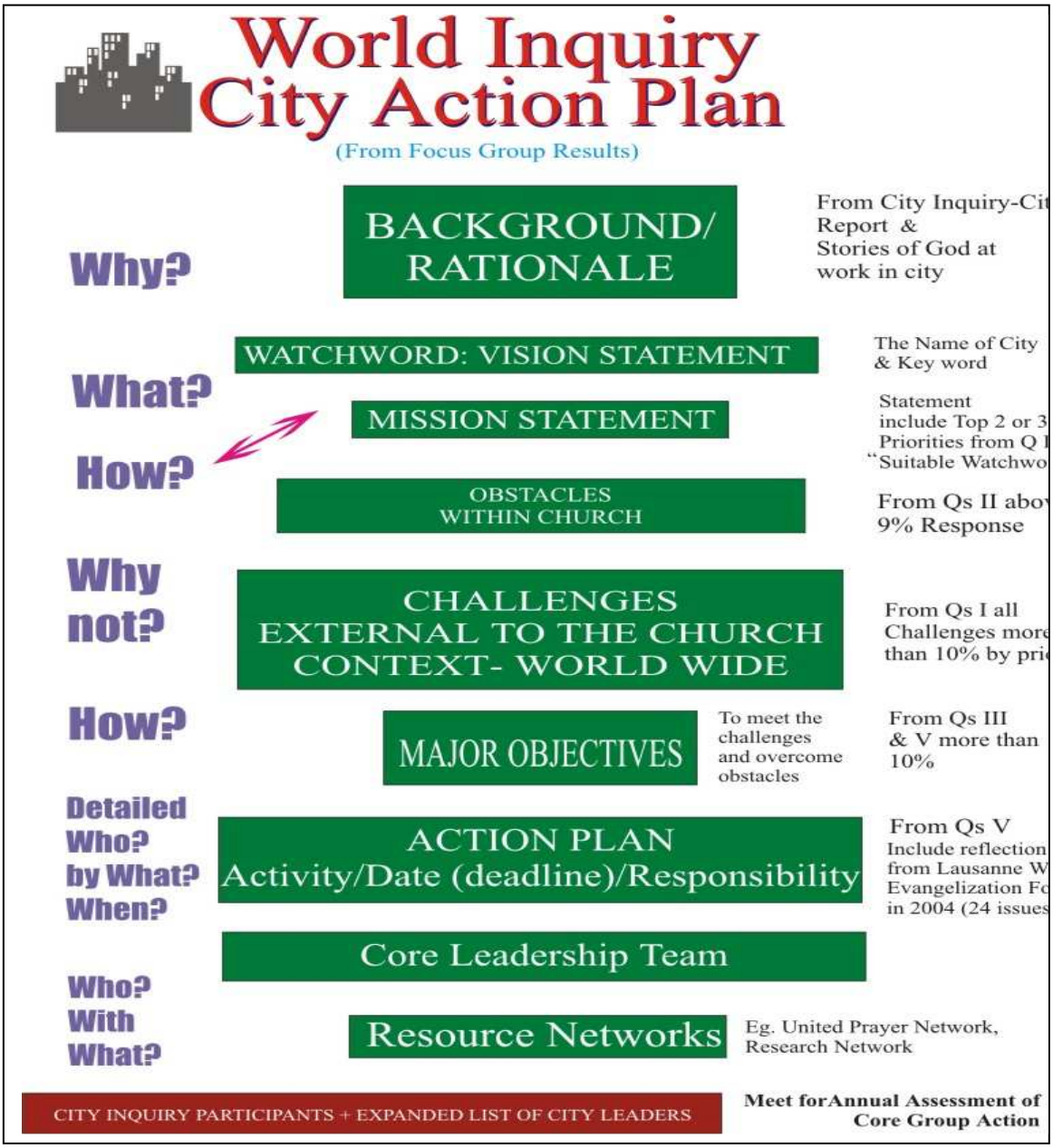


FIGURE V-1

WORLD INQUIRY CITY-BASED ACTION PLAN

Lausanne Planning Document Action Plan Development Envisioning

Under the heading EVANGELIZING OUR WORLD INQUIRY–Creating the Foundation for Action Plans, the Lausanne planning document reads:

> While each of the 24 specific Issue Groups are called together with focused vision on their topic, they will be challenged to apply their issue globally in light of unprecedented research to be presented at the 2004 Forum. The action plans developed by each group will not only address the depth of their topic issue, but it will be woven into what we are hearing God saying to the Church through a two year World Inquiry process.

With the city-based action plan there is natural linkage for action-oriented reflection from the Lausanne issue group reflective process (see Figure V-1 near the bottom of the figure to the right side of the phrase ACTION PLAN).

EMERGING CITY TRANSFORMATION MOVEMENT IN THE PHILIPPINES

A CASE STUDY

Manila World Inquiry Report

Date of Inquiry: Nov. 27, 2002

Focus City: Metro Manila, population 10 million Churches in MM: 2,834 up from 2,500 in 1994.

Country: Philippines, pop. 76,000,000

Churches in country: 50,000, up from 33,000 in 1994

Estimated Christians in country: 6 to 10 million

Participation:

The Philippine Council of Evangelical Churches, DAWN International and the Ministerial Fellowships of Metro Manila sent 32 pastors, denominational leaders, bishops and lay leaders to participate in the World Inquiry.

Program:

The whole day was done in two stages: Stage 1 was the World Inquiry process which ran from 9 am to 2 pm. Then **Stage 2 was the Vision for the City, helping the leaders articulate a vision for the City.** Metro Manila actually is a network of 8 cities and 9 huge towns, with a population of 10 million. Since it is the hub of the Philippines, the vision for the City is essentially a vision for the nation as well.

Reflection period:

Initially, the group had a negative impression of Metro Manila: overcrowded, heavily polluted, increasing homeless families and street

children, corruption, crime and kidnapping, mammoth traffic jams, divisive political leadership.

But as the discussion proceeded, the pastors and leaders were inspired by: a noticeable improvement in the political leadership and integrity in the metropolis; improvement of the traffic situation; increase in crime solutions; reform of the judiciary; Christian witness by movie actors, singers and political leaders; more aggressive involvement of churches and Christian in the governance of the metropolis and of the nation; and thousands of bible studies in military and police camps & offices.

The city was deemed a city of contrasts: wealth and poverty, busy and chaotic, global yet Asian, materialistic but open to the Gospel, a melting pot of culture marked by tolerance for cultural and religious differences.

There is an earnest seeking for peace and peace-making in the aftermath of the 9/11 bombing, making the Muslims open and eager for dialogue. There is a greater door of opportunity and receptivity to the Gospel, which unfortunately is also being exploited by cults and the new age movement.

Focus Group discussions:

The participants first answered the individual questionnaires, and then divided into 6 groups for Metro Manila and one group for Burma. Burmese students and Filipino missionaries to Burma were invited as well and so formed one group. Their report is separate.

After two hours of group discussions, presentations and plenary discussions, the participants came to the following conclusions:

Question 1: On the issue of external challenges that the Church in the Philippines faces:

1 Relevance of Christian Faith
2 Unreached Social Groupings
3 Materialism/ Distraction

Question 2: On the issue of internal obstacles that Philippine churches may have:

1 Lack of Vision
2 Lack of Effective Leadership
3 Lack of money

Question 3: On the calling of God on His people regarding world evangelization:

1 Preach the Gospel to every person using personal evangelism
2 Seek Social Transformation
3 Establish indigenous church planting in every people group

Question 4. On the choice of a watchword:

1 Whole Church taking the Whole Gospel to the Whole World
2 Church for Every People
3 Discipling the Nations

Question 5. On global evangelical structures:

1 Inspiration & prayer networks
2 Leadership Development
3 Relationship building with other leaders

What a Transformed Manila and Church in Manila looks like

The Vision for the City

- Metro Manila: a global metropolis where the spiritual witness, holistic ministry and moral ascendancy of the Church and Christians influence and transform it into
- a city of moral rectitude and safety,
- a city of order and discipline, where justice works and people obey the rule of law,
- a city of a productive economy and balanced ecology, jobs with clean air for all,
- a city of hospitality, and cultural tolerance,
- a city that provides affordable housing for the poor and basic services affordable and accessible by all,
- governed by honest and competent politicians and public servants.

The Vision for the Church

- We see a prayerful, holy and loving Church
- of empowered and equipped members,
- united by their love for the Lord and His Word,
- who reach out to disciple individuals and transform villages
- into God-fearing, law-abiding, neighbor-loving, economically prosperous and ecologically balanced communities.
- We see churches multiply,
- formed and led by lay leaders or bi-vocational pastors,
  - who receive on-the-job training, and
  - are honest, have a servant spirit, and are competent leaders.

These vision statements are summaries of the stated preferences of the participants in the workshops. Succeeding attachments reflect all they said. These statements are **works in progress**, and additions and improvements are welcome.

AN INQUIRY INTO THE TASK OF TRANSFORMING THE PHILIPPINES

By Rafael G. Navarro

Productive Surplus

Any society that aspires to progress and have economic stability must produce a surplus. Poverty is the inability to produce a surplus. There are many employed people who are poor! Having a job does not automatically mean you are not poor. A poor man must produce a surplus and save that surplus or else invest it. The developed nations would have us believe that we must spend the surplus on purchases. This is not the complete truth. This only works if the country produces the products. But in many underdeveloped countries, this is not the case. Most of our products are imported. Thus developed countries encourage us to buy so that we will perpetually be at their mercy.

Christians must patronize local products and minimize consumption of imports. If we must import, let it be for manufacturing purposes.

The emphasis here is on the creation of a surplus through production. There is something wrong with an economy whereby the most profitable industry is banking, while the manufacturing sectors are floundering. That means that our bankers have become greedy and are making more money than can be sustained. When bankers become carpetbaggers, then the whole attitude is getting the most out of the carcass now. The people sink deeper in debt while bankers reward each other with bonuses. Our situation now is reminiscent of the days in Nehemiah's time when usurers were taking advantage of the misery of the poor.

We must engage in production. The Bible is very clear. He who has diligent hands will have abundant food. But he who chases fantasies will grow poor. The current rage on multi-level marketing merely creates more consumers, lure many through their get-rich spiels, and in many cases do not produce locally manufactured products.

Then, churches must encourage savings by organizing savings cooperatives and stores. The savings can be used to buy basic goods that are under monopolies and make those available at affordable prices. Micro-finance organizations must identify and fund micro-enterprises in preferred areas of investment: import replacements, food production, post-harvest technologies, etc. Investment seminars should be made amongst church members to make productive use of idle resources and properties.

Productive Use of Technology

Usually an underdeveloped country must buy technology. But it must be put to productive use. As a Third World country, Filipinos waste their meager resources on toys, TVs, or ornaments. Compare that to overseas Chinese who may start as an ambulant junk dealer and yet eventually get to put up a small factory the processes the junk!

I know of a Christian whose son was able to work in the Middle East. Upon his return, the first things he bought were: Nike shoes, fancy cell phones and other luxury items that were non-productive. To this day, their family is still in debt and their house still a shanty. The poor are poor because they do not know how to handle money and how to save. They do not know how to make money work for them.

And what do the poor use the TV or computers for? Literacy? Internet information? Sadly, no. Usually, these are used for entertainment and pleasure! Unless we use technology first on production of surplus, we will remain a consumer and a borrower. As Deuteronomy 28 warns us: the foreigner in our land will be the head, and we will be the tail.

Proper worldview and values

We have seen that the worldviews inherent in the religions of the East and of Islam and of a Darwinist philosophy have been inadequate in preparing their peoples for a 6-billion people world. A 10-billion people world is too awesome to comprehend. One cannot but fear the consequences of such a society. It is therefore important that the Church help present societies define a more comprehensive worldview that can influence the arts, the sciences, the economics, the politics and the morality of societies. That worldview must also be able to define the identity of a person, not merely relative to the next life, but as a steward in this present life. It must have the capacity to move from the individual to the society. It must be based on a Personal God and a caring Creator.

We are witness to the on-going clash of cultures that flare up in low-intensity conflicts and all-out wars throughout the world. Churches can sponsor inter-faith dialogues to foster greater understanding and tolerance for divergent worldviews. Churches can initiate bridges of peace, like schools, hospitals and cooperatives where different cultures can cooperate.

Rather than use relief or medicine as pressure tactics to extract confessions of faith, churches must learn to project Christianity as an option in the midst of pluralism. We must develop salt, light and leaven methods of ministries. Discipleship is more than membership, and encompasses values, transformed behavior, and participation in society with integrity and compassion.

Churches must develop transformation education and not mere informational education. This includes transforming archaic worldviews while imparting 21st century information.

We must have education that has a worldview that supports the dignity of the individual, stewardship, social responsibility, progress and prosperity.

Governance

The Church must be able to set standards for governance which includes the values of servanthood, stewardship and skills. It must be compassionate as well as competent. It must be just and merciful. The Church is the conscience of the State. As we have seen, good governance is essential to the advancement of societies. Without it, production cannot be sustained and society will eventually crumble. The competence of government is the structure that determines how high a society can reach.

Peacemaking, Reconciliation and Transformation

History is replete with collisions of culture and the ensuing conflict. Sadly, much of these remain unresolved despite the passage of time: Serbia, Indochina, the Middle East, and South Asia. Much of the conflict revolves around the rights to exist and to own property. The right to exist has time and again been violated by the political borders and political authorities of majority government. Globalization has created a maelstrom of cultural flux that has left millions of people frightened and unsure of their destinies.

The Church must be at the forefront of establishing peace. We can develop a ministry of peace-making and conflict/cultural transformation to facilitate the peaceful transition of many cultures into the 21st century.

We must realize that there can be no peace with out the just resolution of conflict. Hence, we must be consistent advocates for justice in society. Judicial reforms are necessary for the support of a moral standard in society. Justice must be affordable, accessible and timely.

Next is reconciliation between conflicting sides. In many cases, this includes restitution of property. We must define individual rights to property. Indeed, we must define property itself. Is it ownership or the ability to create wealth that is the ultimate financial security? Can ownership exist without stewardship? Can rights exist without responsibility?

If the Church can transform the concept property ownership and rights, then the panic caused by landlessness will be reduced. Only then can people relinquish property peacefully. The model in Singapore is quite interesting where most properties are owned by the government and leased to people who can make productive use of it. The right to property then is premised on your productive use of it.

Rights must be transformed to responsibilities. President Kennedy once said: “Ask not what your country can do for you, but rather what you can do for your country.”

Property must be transformed into product. We must realize that ultimate security is not in land, but in our capacity to produce and create wealth.

If the Church can bring this transformation of worldview and values, then peace will have a chance. We would do a great service to mankind if we could promote a worldview that:

- loves all of humanity,
- honors the dignity of the individual, and,
- celebrates the diversity of ideas.

Conclusion

This is enough for now I guess. I know that even this much may already be too much. But we have to start somewhere. And we must start right. To start with micro finance is to start at the middle without knowing what kind of economy we need. To start with relief is to start near the fire. We must start therefore with the right framework to build a society and an economy.

In a way, WW2 was a blessing to Japan. It destroyed their worldview, their politics and their economy. MacArthur, a Christian, gave them a new worldview, a new set of values in the new constitution and a new start. The progress Japan has made in the last 40 years is indeed spectacular and could never have been achieved with the old worldview of Imperial Japan.

With the Church's involvement, hopefully we do not need a war to destroy everything in order to rebuild.

EMERGING CITY TRANSFORMATION MOVEMENT IN THE INDONESIA

A CASE STUDY

By Iman Santoso with Soleman Irwan

Background

- The prayer for the transformation of the cities of Indonesia has been going on since 1989
- From the year 2000 to 2003 there has been an explosion of interest and expansion in the development of a prayer network for the transformation of the cities of Indonesia.
- There are prayer networks in at least 233 cities in Indonesia today accompanied by reconciliation between Christian leaders and fresh expressions of unity in the Church
- The Jakarta Concert of Prayer at the Jakarta Convention Center held 13th February 2003 was filled to its capacity of 5000 people. During the prayer concert an historic reconciliation took place between leaders from different Christian streams in Jakarta. The organizers said this reconciliation was a major spiritual breakthrough.

World Inquiry Events Held in Three Largest Cities

- The Jakarta World Inquiry was held on the morning of the 13th with 200 Christian leaders building on the foundation of the Jakarta prayer network. The Jakarta Inquiry resulted in the agreement of the 200 leaders present on a common vision for the city.
- A world inquiry was held with Christian leaders in the second (Surabaya) and third (Medan) largest cities of Indonesia on the 17th and 15th of February respectively in which the network for prayer for transformation of the city was expanded to a core group of leaders appointed to finalize the development and implement an action plan for the transformation of the city.
- These Christian leaders were desirous of developing an action plan for their region as a pilot project.
- They have called the year 2005 the year of transformation.
- There is a growing concern among Christian leaders that prayer for transformation and talking about transformation turn into meaningful city-based action plans for transformation.

- The World Inquiry that took place in the three largest cities of Indonesia became a tool for implementing the desire to move f**rom Prayer for Transformation in the Cities to Action for Transformation for the Cities of Indonesia. O**ut of the focus group surveys conducted during the World Inquiries in which more than 500 Christian leaders took part a united vision for the city, a mission statement to fulfill the vision and a core group committed to develop and implement a detailed action plan were established.

The Preparation of Facilitators as Agents of Transformation

Iman Santoso

If our purpose and goal is toward the transformation of the cities or of the country, we need to have a holistic and global perspective on the movements of God that work simultaneously in different areas of life. We cannot separate the prayer movements from mission movements or other movements of God, for example, in mass media, in church planting, evangelism, or in acts of mercy.

In order to have a maximum impact for the work of the Kingdom of God, there needs to be the role of facilitators who can relate and join many functioning parts of the Body of Christ. Within the last one or two decades, we have seen the movements of God in rising up a new model of ministry that is: **the facilitating ministry**.

City-based Seminars to Equip Facilitators are being held throughout the country of Indonesia. For more information see Compendium IV: A Facilitating Ministry for the Movements of God within Society: Case Study Indonesia.

Indonesia Proposed Action Plan

Soleman Irwan and Iman Santoso

Purpose

We met to discuss how to move from prayer for transformation of the cities in Indonesia to Action for the Transformation of the Cities in Indonesia

Commitment by parties in the meeting to take the following steps

1. Communicate to the other members of the … the commitments made in this meeting
2. Use the World Inquiry as a tool for city consultations of Christian leaders from all groups representative of the Church in the city
3. Complete the Inquiry in a pilot project in Kelapa Gading in Jakarta with … as consultation conveners by 30th May 2003.
4. Prepare a facilitation team to hold city by city consultations throughout the nation using the Inquiry by 30 June 2003
5. Conduct an inquiry in every one of the 400 cities in which there is a prayer network between June 1, 2003 and 31 Dec. 2005, which would lead to city-based action plans for the transformation of the city
6. Translation of the Computer Program to generate reports into Indonesian. It was done by March 30, 2003



FIGURE V-2

MAP OF KELAPA GADING IN JAKARTA

EMERGING CITY TRANSFORMATION MOVEMENT IN INDIA

A CASE STUDY

Richard Howell

I. Overview

Introduction

India has a population of more than one billion and has the largest emerging middle class in the world. The movement of people from rural to urban is a clearly noticeable characteristic with the accompanied challenges. The Church in India is growing. It is believed what happened in the 19th century missionary movement of South India during the hey days of Western missionary movement is now happening in the North India but it is led by Indians in partnership with the universal church. Christian workers who are sons and daughters of the soil own the vision and the church in India is indeed Indian. What started, as essentially a cross- cultural missionary movement in India is now very different in character! There is greater emphasis on the local church doing missions. The emphasis is on the whole church taking the whole gospel to the whole city/nation/world. Transformation as a way of doing missions and living out the values of the kingdom of God is increasingly emphasized by the various churches. The denominational walls are gradually but surely breaking down. The focus is on partnership and networking in the process of doing missions.

In 1999 Evangelical Fellowship of India conducted All India Congress on Church in Mission in Delhi. One of the major recommendations was the launching of an urban ministry initiative. The process of implementing this was not easy. The challenges of initiating a new movement are like giving birth which is accompanied by labor pain and we have had our major share of pain but we praise God that the painful process now has culminated in the formation of Evangelical Fellowship of India National Urban Network (EFINUN). Each member of the network retains its identity and at the same time is involved in synergistic relationships. EFINUN is primarily a facilitating body.

Evangelizing Our World Inquiry

Then came the City Inquiry process which worked as a catalyst in birthing something new and wonderful. Dr Luis Bush was invited by the Evangelical Fellowship of India to be an external facilitator for the Inquiry. There were sixteen World Inquiry events between January 6th to the 27th, mainly in capitals of the states and mostly one-day events from 10:00 a.m. to 5 p.m.

It all started on 6th January 2003 in Delhi, the capital of India. Rev. Richard Howell, General Secretary EFI, moderated the proceedings. The participants were male and female, older and younger who were carefully selected Christian leaders from mainline churches, Evangelical and Charismatic churches and other inter-church agencies from the primary ethnic cultural and linguistic groups. Listening to the stories of transforming power of God at work and sharing by the participants of God's initiatives through churches, fellowships, institutions and individuals added to the dimension of excitement and all became aware of how God is working in and around the city. The Church in India is growing largely outside the established ecclesiastical structures. The work of the ministry is carried on by men and women and both lay and ordained provide leadership. All this is happening while the country is passing through a social economic and political turmoil

Converging of Different Streams

while in Chandigarh as the sharing progressed all were excited to hear what God is leading the pastors and lay people and youth groups into creative ministries. But towards the end of the session it appeared we will not have oneness on the way forward. One insisted our focus should be proclamation of the gospel, "taking gospel to the hearts of people,'as he put it. Another insisted we need to live out the values of the kingdom of God and address the issues of social justice. Consensus was reached when a participant unable to contain himself said, "we need a mega vision", it was as if the Holy Spirit had spoken through him. We visualised how all the pieces fit together. It was a real 'Ah' moment for us. Polarities are man-made primarily because our vision is small. If the vision is of God and His Kingdom the process of renewing is unleashed. God opened our eyes to something very wonderful-His Kingdom. We overcame the polarities of evangelism, social action and development. We learnt that all peoples and communities need transformation.

Need For Paradigm Shift

It was most interesting in Ludhiana where about 70 pastors church planters came together. All are involved in church planting ministries determined to reach every people group. However it was revelation when the results of the city Inquiry were made known. It was unanimous finding that God is calling his church to a ministry of social transformation. The time is ripe for paradigm shift. In stead of understanding Christian mission solely in terms of personal transformation the communities needed to obey the Gospel of Jesus Christ in value transformation.

Conducting city inquiry was a multi-faceted adventure. The fog led to delayed flights and even overflights the venues were we were supposed to land. In one such incident the following was written by Johnny Desai the facilitator of city Inquiry. "What had happened in Patna was very interesting. The flights were cancelled and my train was delayed. When I reached there, they were struggling with the questionnaires. The dinner was waiting and I was given the charge – No Luis Bush, not his computer, no nothing… I wound up with running through the questionnaire – taking majority response in terms of

preference and importance of the issues… I shared with the group what had been happening in other cities and the voice of Patna was the same! Transformation”!

In Serampore at the College that William Carey founded, the participants involved in the Inquiry included the Principal, Vice-Principal, faculty of the Seminary, pastors and Christian leaders in the community and the graduating class of the seminary.

The principal kept saying "This is the kind of meeting I had been hoping to have for a long time." Amazingly with such a varied group present, in part, because of the minority they are as Christians in the Serampore city a definitive city-based initiative birthed with vision statement, mission statement core group including representation of the various constituencies present at the meeting.

Mission as Transformation

In South India and North –East India where the Christian presence is strong the discoveries were no less amazing. The city Inquiry threw up the finding that the number one hindrance to Christian work is the relevance of Christian faith, not that the faith is not relevant but the way the church and mission agencies have presented is perceived as irrelevant. Therefore the society at large perceives of Christian faith talking only about sending people to heaven and very less about the challenges facing the society here on earth. It was recognised that it is not sufficient to emphasise that societies would be transformed by converting individuals to Christ, we also need to stress that communities needed to enjoy fullness of life in harmony with God through obedience to the gospel. In the ever changing local and global context mission as transformation is the way forward.

Renewal of the Church

In every city that we went there was a consensus that the transformation movement will lead to renewal of the Church. Since the emphasis is on the whole church taking the whole gospel to the whole world. For this to happen there is greater need for vision, united prayer movement, discipleship, mentoring of younger leaders, study of the word of God, the need for transformation has been stated in the inquiry focus groups. However, it was recognized that it is not only the city and the church that needs transformation it is the Christian leader and his family and other Christians that do.

II. New Delhi Model: The Inquiry

Introduction

Evangelizing Our World Inquiry, a one- day consultation took place on the 6th of January 2003 at Bible Bhawan, New Delhi. It was organized by Evangelical Fellowship of India (EFI) and the chief resource person was Luis Bush. Rev. Richard Howell, General Secretary EFI, moderated the proceedings.

Listening to the Word of God and the insights on it was highly inspirational. The sharing by the participants of God's initiatives through church institutions and individuals added to the dimension of excitement and all became aware of how God is working in and around the city of Delhi. Expectation increased as the day went on that God was up to something new and great in our midst. Immediate commitments were made of resources, places and worship to take up the initial major concern for the leadership of Christ in this birthing initiative by means of intercessory prayer to seek his face on behalf of the people of the city of Delhi. The first specific agreement was to launch a city prayer watch inter-church initiative 24/7-twenty four hours per day seven days a week in different churches who would take responsibility for specific focused prayer over a time period every week.

One approach to the transformation graphically proposed at the consultation was by means of increasing leadership influence of Church in the city (See Figure V-2). The reality that was recognized that for the city to be transformed the church need to be transformed. It is a parallel process. Nominal Christians need to be renewed and transformation experienced by the spiritual core of the city.

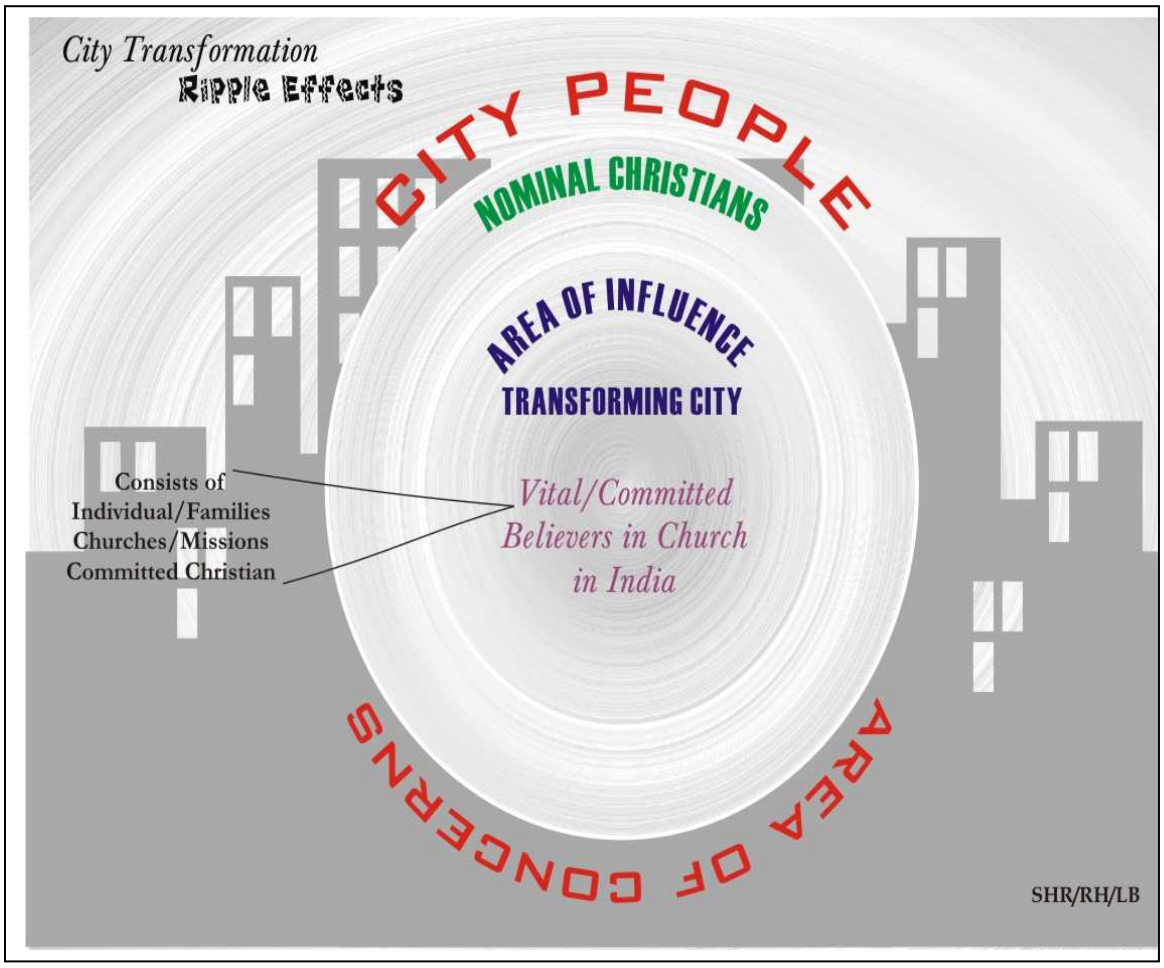


FIGURE V-3

AREA OF INFLUENCE AND AREA OF CONCERN

The major challenges facing the Church

1. Materialism
2. Religious fundamentalism
3. The relevance of Christian faith
4. Post modernity
5. Unreached social groups e.g. the youth.

The major obstacles internal to the Church

1. Lack of vision
2. Lack of united prayer
3. Unhealthy churches that are not able to reproduce themselves
4. Lack of effective leadership
5. Lack of effective cooperation and coordination

God's call to His people for evangelization over the next 25 years

1. Seeking social transformation
2. Establishing an indigenous people's group
3. Preaching the gospel to every person using personal evangelism

Suitable phrase/watchword for the next 25 years

1. The Whole Church Taking the Whole Gospel to the Whole City
2. Discipling the Nation/City
3. Transforming our World/City
4. Filling the World/City with the Glory of God

Global Evangelical structures to enhance city/world evangelization efforts

1. Inspiration and prayer networks
2. Leadership development
3. Relationship building with other leaders/fellowship network opportunities
4. Resource networks linking to resource geographical and/or functional world evangelization initiatives
5. Reports of what is happening in other cities/countries

III. New Delhi Model: The Action Plan

Based on the above reflection an Action Plan emerged:

Watchword Transformational Movement New Delhi

Mission Statement

The whole Church taking the whole Gospel to the whole city of Delhi so that the power, the presence and the peace of God is experienced by all and the country is discipled.

Major objectives

- Acknowledge the Lordship and leadership of Christ as the head of the body of Christ in Delhi.
- Develop a city leadership team submitted to the Lordship criteria and committed to the Delhi City Transformation mission.
- Facilitate a Delhi city- based Transformational mission initiative.
- Build a community of truth, love and faith especially in the urban heart of India through the multiplication of the World Inquiry Process through the city of Delhi and the nation of India.
- Increase the positive influence of the church in the spheres of life/community in Delhi such as medical, primary health care, communal harmony, educational, legal, slum, political, refugees by means of a common vision, effective communication and developing peoples skills of individual Christians, churches and other Christian structures and the community of believers in the city of Delhi.
- Raise up Delhi City Transformation advocates.
- Raise up Delhi City Transformation implementers for the different city based networks.
- Seek to bring positive change
- Proclaim in word and deed the good news of the Gospel to the poor, the oppressed, the sick and the marginalized of Delhi with intentionality and to every person in the city of Delhi.
- Support existing and build new ongoing, life- giving united programs and projects that minister to the poor, the oppressed, the sick and the marginalized of Delhi.
- Establish meaningful training mechanisms with appropriate training materials for the discipling of the people in each congregation in the city.
- Establish a congregation of believers in every class and kind of people and within practical and relational reach of every person, that are permeating every segment of society in Delhi with the love, truth and saving power of Jesus Christ.
- Cultivate younger leaders for leadership and in their discipling of younger people.

Immediate Action Plan

- City watch prayer 24/7 for Delhi by end of February 2003
- Reproduce/multiply the World Enquiry process among four geographical areas of Delhi by the end of February 2003
- Hold a National Consultation with the leaders of the Inquiries in each of the 20 major cities in which city-wide consultations were held in January 2003 by September 30, 2003.
- Reproduce/Multiply the World Enquiry process among 320 cities in India with more than 1,00,000 by the end of December 2004.
- Build a City Transformation network of 16,000 (50 X 320) Christian leaders by December 30, 2004.
- Establish/strengthen Delhi based resource networks for prayer, youth, family, marginalized, refugees, transients, AIDS, political leadership, women, evangelism, unreached people, saturation church planting, revived families, professionals, etc by December 31, 2004.
- Establish a monitoring centre for information gathering and distribution.
- Conduct workshops on transformational leadership with special emphasis on younger leaders (under 35 years old) in 320 cities (over 100,000) by December 2005.

It was decided that the programmes and processes highlighted in the consultation and the steps suggested in the action plan should be regularly and continuously followed up by a core group from among the participants of the consultation. Accordingly, a core group was formed.

Conclusion

The Inquiries were highly motivational and spirit filled. The unanimous Mission Statement focused on the need to mobilize the whole Church to take the whole Gospel to the whole city so that the cities are is transformed by the power, the presence, the peace of God for all and the country is discipled. The strategy is based on principles of communication and partnership. The transformation of communities to reflect kingdom values is a Christological concern for it recognises that enabling people to experience Christ's Lordship is the key to holistic ministry.

CASE STUDY BANGLADESH
DHAKA INQUIRY ACTION PLAN DRAFT
Richard Howell

Introduction

At the invitation of Emil Jebasingh Richard Howell facilitated an inquiry in the capital city of Dhaka on 5th march 2003. Participants were invited to the conference under the umbrella of the evangelical Fellowship of Bangladesh by its General Secretary, Dennis D. Datta.

Using the World Inquiry database, Howell entered the data and produced the following report:

Catalytic Event

Name of Consultation:	Evangelizing Our World Inquiry
Consultation Location:	Dhaka, Bangladesh
Internal Facilitator:	Dennis D. Datta
External Facilitator:	Richard Howell
Consultation Date:	5th March 2003

Resulting Action Plan Suggestions

A. Suitable phrase/watchword for the next 25 years:

		Sum %
1	Whole Church taking Whole Gospel	43.3
2	The Church for Every People	16.7
3	Christ's Kingdom Come	13.3
4	The Power, the Presence and the Peace	10.0
5	Discipling the Nations	10.0

B. The major external challenges facing the Church in our city/region are:

		Sum %
1	Religious fundamentalism	50.0
2	Materialism	16.7
3	Illiteracy	13.3

C. The major internal challenges facing the Church in our city/region are:

		Sum %
1	Lack of effective leadership	33.3
2	Lack of vision	23.3
3	Lack of cooperation	16.7
4	Lack of united prayer	10.0

D. Fulfilling our mission and vision will require:

		Sum %
1	Scriptures available in every language	36.7
2	Church planting movements all people groups	20.0
3	Social transformation	16.7
4	The church a prophetic voice	10.0

E. Immediate action plan:

		Sum %
1	Inspiration and prayer networks	43.3
2	Relationship building/fellowship	20.0
3	Leadership development	16.7
4	Resource networks	13.3